

Medicare Shoppers (AEP) — Voices by Theme

Appendix to *Medicare-Shoppers-Research*. For every measured theme, the most engaged voices (up to 20) in full, with replies and source links. Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/medicare-shoppers/research/>

Tab 1 — Fears

Not being able to afford it on a fixed income · 68 documents · 20 voices

"Reality check. I'm embarrassed. I've done a bad job preparing for retirement Hi all, My husband (66) is planning to leave this fall from his job of 30 years with a pension. I (65) have a small business and work PT which I plan to keep doing to some extent. We both plan on taking SS when we are 70. We don't have a lot in the retirement fund but our financial advisor says we will be ok. I have been fussing over the numbers to make sure we have a budget and can account for the type of living we want to have. Our house is not paid off. I'll provide some of the numbers below for context. The plan is draw the investment down and it will get scary low for a while. But then after SS kicks in we probably will not need to pull much if any, as long as we both survive a bit longer (we are in pretty good shape) and we don't go crazy spending. The thing is we both have things we want to do other than watch Netflix all day. He wants to do more screenwriting and filmmaking, and I want to continue doing my work (I self-publish books), and we both want to travel. Sidenote: I have a sister and BIL who did not save a dime for retirement, sold their home and took the 500K proceeds put a good portion in an annuity and took their SS at 65 (\$4440 monthly) and high-tailed it to Madrid. And I have family in Italy and Switzerland so we plan to spend some time in Europe. Not worried too much about the emotions of not knowing what to do. It's all about money for me. Anywazzzz... I kinda want to know from all of you what to expect if you have been in this situation and any tips to ease my mind. My family thinks I am over-reacting and over-thinking all of this, as in just do it, relax, you have enough to live your life, and IDK. Obviously my math and financial skills are lacking, and I know I can't make up for lost time now, but I want to try to do better. And now I feel even more unsure. Then when read this sub and see people who have millions in their account are fussing over whether they have enough \$\$ to stop trading time for money. I feel-- bleh. So here goes.... Our monthly spend is between \$3900-5500 (depending on unexpected things) AND I have heard that some retirees spend more cuz they have the time to time to travel and do other things. Pension is about \$2900, and my income is about \$1500 per month (total \$3400) after tax. But I hope to NOT be working after 2026. His SS will be \$3300, mine \$2100 Our net worth number is \$650k Our investments are \$322k. 250K in mutual fund/65k in EFT (Mainly Trad IRA some Roth), 6k Robinhood (planning to move this somewhere else) Mainly Trad IRA some Roth. Our HYSA emergency fund is \$9k We have only our mortgage as debt. \$127k. Current Zillow price for selling our 1500 sf townhome is at \$333K We both have long-term care policies. With 100K cash payouts - I don't really know how this will work in reality. We have 2 old cars (2008 Lexus and 2009 Caddy). Plan to wait until one of them really dies and deal with one car, then when the other dies, hit the investment account for another budget car, I don't know the amount, guessing no more than 20K? HVAC and under home plumbing to pex is complete. Our roof has been replaced, and the house just got painted. The interior is in need of a paint job, some rooms more than others, I think we can handle painting, and our appliances are over 10 yrs old. I know the stove needs replacing, but everything else seems ok. Ideally I love to have new kitchen cabinets, or some update there. So I think I will need 20-40K to fix this part. None of this is urgent really and could probably wait- unless the fridge or washing machine goes down, then those I really need. My plan would be to take more from the investments to cover said large home emergency. One of my biggest fears is healthcare. Those unexpected costs could add up to \$5000 every year, since I am new to Medicare I don't know if I really trust that my supplement plan will really pick up the 20% that Medicare does not. And my husband's employee plan is projected to be an advantage plan that I trust even less. These insurance questions are probably better in a different sub? I think this may be enough detail, but let me know what I missed. Is this scenario as bad as I think? Would you relax into it? I appreciate you reading and this generous community. EDIT: You peeps rock! Thanks. I am still reading all your comments intensely. Net worth is really \$526 as someone pointed out, AND I can't add apparently lol, you can see why I am worried :) The pension is 100% survivorship to me so that stays level. Not sure about COLA on this, I think so tho. Don't know what to do about life insurance after he retires, maybe the company will offer us a decent plan?, we already pay soooo much for insurances. The expenses noted does include mortgage and premiums. The pension and SS income is after tax. So many good ideas!"

— r/retirement · 191 upvotes · None

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"I like traditional medicare and medigap. After my initial \$300 deductible, I can see any doctor and never have to worry about paying a bill. If I have something that bothers me, I never have to think if its worth seeing a doctor, I just go."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 72 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugy8-mL2CmVrjVCpPzl4AaABAq>

↳ @golffanatic1102 (7): "@roncollins1046 🖐️🖐️ Yep, found the MAGA troll."

↳ @roncollins1046 (5): "Sorry to hear about your doctor-addiction. I haven't seen one of those quacks in years, and mean never to again. They literally make people sick, that's their business model."

↳ @tedlahm5740 (3): "could not be better."

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"Observation Status is Bullshit: A Rant Just like the title says. I fully understand that Observation status was originally invented as a cost-saving measure for Medicare, but it has become an all-too convenient way to deny patients Medicare coverage for post-hospital rehab stays. These stays can cost upwards of \$10,000 a month (far more if you want to stay at a facility that isn't a death trap), and without those 3 midnights in Inpatient Status (which can be taken away from you for any reason at any time with little notice), Medicare doesn't touch a dime of that cost. So elderly patients end up in situations where a broken ankle or a fall at home can cost them their entire savings, their homes, and their lives all because one stupid bureaucratic bullshit rule says "actually you can pay for this, we don't want to". And patients have ZERO recourse to appeal that status, so even if they've been hospitalized for the 3 required midnights, AND they meet the medical requirements for continuing PT and OT, AND they have proven need for direct support for ADLs, because the hospital decided to put them in Observation status none of that actually matters. And the discharge planners don't give a fuck, because their job is to empty the bed while doing the least amount of work possible for the hospital. They don't give a shit that the rehab list is full of 1 star shitholes with rap sheets longer than Kanye's, and forget about them providing actual notice of things like the patient's right to appeal the discharge, get financial assistance, etc. Medicare has a lot of problems. Observation status is one that isn't talked about enough. It needs to be done away with. If a Medicare beneficiary is put in a numbered bed in a hospital, they're Inpatient now. And when they're discharged, regardless of how long that is, they qualify for a paid rehab stay. Full fucking stop."

— r/medicare · 55 upvotes · None

"You're a tiger in this video. I bought a plan G supplement as a perfectly healthy person taking no meds. I liked the predictability of the out of pocket maximums. The next year, I hurt my wrist and developed prostate cancer that required treatment. I was able to get scans and radiation and visit specialists that I wanted without ever worrying about the costs. I am very happy with the choice I made. This video is very fair and unbiased and accurate. Well done."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxPjKemu-lqNJsIszV4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you! 🐯 Glad you are doing well!"

"I turn 65 in January 2026 and I chose plan N and I live in a very expensive area (Northern Va.) and will only pay \$87 and the Part B so about total \$294 a month so I'm pretty happy. And I also purchased a zero payment part D premium. I don't go to the doctor much so not worried about \$20 copay visit."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 28 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg_AODI8bYlzmOAOE-L9QNWYq

"The Medicare Plan Shuffle: Why NOT Shopping Part D Annually Could Cost Thousands Let's face it—when it comes to Medicare Part D drug plans, there are two types of people: those who compare their options each year... and those who don't. The first group might sleep easy knowing they're not overpaying for their medications. The second? Well, they could be unknowingly flushing hundreds—or even thousands—down the drain every year. We're not trying to scare you... Okay, maybe we are. A little. # The \$0 Trap: It Sounds Good, But... A \$0 monthly premium sounds amazing, right? Like free pie. But what they don't tell you is that the crust costs extra, and the whipped cream? Outrageously priced. That "free" drug plan might not cover your medications—or might do so at sky-high copays. Drugs like **Eliquis**, **Zepbound**, **Wegovy**, **Ozempic**, and **Mounjaro** aren't just pricey—they're plan landmines. Some plans cover them. Some don't. Some charge you your left arm, others your right. We've even seen plans list one of these drugs at over \$1,000 a month while another plan had it at just \$35. Same drug. Different nightmare. # The Annual Game of "Gotcha" Here's the kicker: every year, plans change. They change their premiums. They change their copays. They change what drugs they cover and what tier they're on. That \$10-a-month generic from last year? Surprise! It's now \$85 and mysteriously moved up a tier. Imagine showing up at the pharmacy in January thinking your plan still loves you, only to find out it ghosted your medications over the holidays. # Why This Year is Different (And Maybe Worse) Whispers from Washington are raising eyebrows. With big changes coming to how Medicare negotiates drug prices and funds subsidies starting in 2026, we could be on the edge of a "musical chairs" situation—except instead of chairs, it's coverage for your heart medication, and when the music stops... well, you get the picture. If you're banking on "the government will fix it," remember: these are the same folks who brought you the DMV experience. # The True Villains? The Middlemen & the Markups Let's not forget the real fun part: drug manufacturers and pharmacy benefit managers (PBMs)—the shadowy middlemen who get rich while seniors juggle pills and price tags. They're the ones who make your life-saving medication more expensive in the U.S. than a luxury vacation in Mexico (where, ironically, the same drugs often cost 80% less). So yes, it's not just about "shopping" your plan. It's about taking a stand against a broken system. One click, one form, one chat with your agent could save you thousands. # Moral of the Story? Don't Be That Guy. Every year, we talk to someone who didn't bother to compare plans. They "liked what they had" and "didn't want to mess with it." By February, they're calling us in a panic because their meds are costing more than their rent. Don't be that guy. Reprinted from Lisaknowsmedicare.com. blog posts"

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · None

"Great review of the topic, Erin. I started with Medicare Advantage for several years after I turned 65, enjoying the zero cost and dental and vision benefits. I'm healthy and have no extra medical expenses beyond routine care. However, Advantage plans have been dropping out of my low/aging population state, and starting in 2026, only 5 of the 14 counties in my state have access to an Advantage plan (my county not included). As a result, I exercised my Guaranty Issue right and purchased Medigap and Part D plans, with total annual premiums of about \$2,100 for these plans. I'm not mad about it. While I'm healthy for now, that can change at any time. The annual cost of the new plans is not a burden on me (which I know is not the case for everybody). I have the assurance that, if I get sick or injured and require a lot of medical care, I won't have to worry about high medical costs. I've watched others who have Medigap plans and had major medical expenses get good care with no problem and not have to take on a financial burden to meet their care needs, or go through a lot of bureaucratic rigamarole to get care and have bills get paid. While my insurance choices got molded by market forces outside my control, I do feel I am now covered better than ever, and that is reassuring. My suggestion is this: If the costs associated with a Medicare and separate Rx. plan fit comfortably in your budget, make that your choice."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyE_Alm8EugoAtW-Ax4AaABAg

↳ @dennmillsch (4): "" If the costs associated with a Medicare and separate Rx. plan fit comfortably in your budget.." -- and if you choose MedAdv, make sure you have enough income to pay the Max Out of Pocket if big issues come up. Depending on how many years you have higher medical needs, either plan can be cost winner. But you don't know. The most conservative approach is Medigap."

↳ @francesw.6774 (0): "@robnunurbiznezz7618 I hope you make it to Medicare eligibility without any problems. Without Medicare, I'm assuming that huge numbers of retired seniors would have to go without insurance and care. Do keep in mind that the \$2,100/year I'm paying only covers Rx insurance and the 20% gap not covered by Medicare (as you probably know, Medicare only covers 80% of medical care expenses). Also, Medicare recipients have to pay a monthly fee for basic Medicare insurance (\$203 in my case - it's taken out of my Social Security). So basically, I'm paying about \$4,500 per year for very strong insurance coverage, with low deductibles."

↳ @dennmillsch (0): "@robnunurbiznezz7618 -- Yep, Obamacare only helps a bit if you are below 4x poverty level, which is something like \$70K for married-filing-joint-nondependents. Then your health care for one person can be below \$4K per year. But if you earn above that 4x poverty threshold, Obamacare doesn't help much."

"I want the advantages offered by having regular Medicare over my \$0 upfront and nightmare back end Advantage plan. However, the choice I was given was Medicare plus supplement, drug, dental, optical = nearly \$600/mo for me. No. And that's this year, with no premium caps for any coming year. This, during an administration that is shifting the government costs to citizens. Who knows the monthly costs or sudden share of cost later on? As of now, underwriting is required to change from one to another. If you can afford Medicare, you are blessed financially. I have so many other ways that I am blessed, and I'm grateful. May there come a day that I can rest assured that I will have the same access to the USA Healthcare system as the well off enough to get good health insurance and the poor with Medicaid (for now?)"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzlqliHk3WjxbMpKUB4AaABAg>

↳ @Jamm607 (5): "@SuBee71 This was how my previous plan was, rarely an issue. I moved from one state to another, requiring a change as there aren't many doctors here that take the original. My current plan has been challenging with most interactions, too. I've been making great use of Dr YouTube. There's one high note positive from it all though. Better choices are underway to create a healthier body that doesn't need any of the insurance at all anyway! 👍 😊 "

↳ @SuBee71 (4): "I pay 0 for my advantage plan, it's not hmo. I can go to any specialist if it's on the covered list without a trip to pcp. Same with dentist. I just find one that takes it, and most do. 0 charge pcp, specialist is 25., no charge mammogram"

"@Wildflowerz57 good plan! My parents are both on med advantage and love it, same with my Medicare clients. Advantage isn't for everyone, and I have some clients on supplements because that is their preference and they can afford the premiums, but the vast majority are happily on advantage PPOs with huge networks & solid care. I have also seen older folks paying \$700 plus total monthly for part B, med supplement, and drug plan because they're stuck in an obsolete med supplement and can't qualify for another one, and are scared to move because of videos like this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyxwtlsnO3Manu9DFx4AaABAg.9Zo-abmMTzA9aY40j57arF>

"Supplements are too expensive and do Not want to pay when you need them. You work all your life and get screwed over for continuing to live after retirement. MEDICARE FOR ALL is what we need."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyuQrzYzibBWylq2GZ4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (1): "I understand your frustration — healthcare costs in retirement can feel overwhelming. But just to clarify, I've personally never seen a Supplement plan refuse to pay as long as Original Medicare approves and pays first. That's how these policies are designed, period. As for Medicare-for-all, we already have a version of that in the form of Obamacare, and it has not worked well in practice. Premiums and deductibles have risen sharply, even with tax credits, and many families are struggling to afford coverage. So while I hear you, the reality is that no system is perfect — and right now, Supplements still remain the most reliable option for protecting against big medical bills."

↳ @billmulvihill8452 (1): "You are plain wrong!"

↳ @karencloskey7147 (0): "@policyguides we should have free healthcare and no insurance agents"

"You can state whatever you want to say, about original medicare with a supplement is best. It's just not best for everybody. I for one, chose an Advantage plan. It's a plan with one of the big insurance companies, and the best part is that I don't have to worry about having to purchase a separate drug plan, then have to add a dental and vision plan, and pay an astronomical \$250 to \$300 a month. I also get the part B monthly give back of \$125. I have a great primary care physician and a Cardiologist. I just cannot afford those kind of premiums."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=Ugy2snfj7D_pwRWIu8B4AaABAq

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (3): "It's very important u stay healthy with the Advantage plans. Most people are very happy with them until they experience a serious health issue. That's when the reality of these plans kick in."

↳ @lynnehall5125 (1): "Me either I'm a widow and they just tax you to death..."

↳ @PatriciaOhnstad (0): "Economically, it all boils down to the Dirty Harry dialog: Well punk, do ya feel lucky, do ya??"

"Well just got the dreaded letter from the state of California regarding my Medicaid.they are reinstating the asset test again,so on Jan 1 I will lose it,I can't afford the medigap plan and the part b premium,so most like me will be forced into a advantage plan,issue is here ,is only five choices for advantage plans and plan g and n are about 200.00.i like in a rich zipcode of course!😭.this is going to be ugly."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxLdnN0qZxAz-3XtwV4AaABAq>

↳ @TenaB-j2l (4): "Check out high deductible plan g that at least will put a lower cap on your out of pocket costs."

↳ @billjones4986 (1): "@TenaB-j2lthanks,could be a idea,I do have funds in the bank,might make sence for me."

"My G plan is autopay from the bank (\$140) and Part D (\$106 w/o ded) is deducted from my SS deposit so I basically don't see the money. I try to not think about it. I really only worry about paying the part B deductible (\$288 for 2026) and the same co-pays for prescriptions when I pick them up. ❤️ I'll keep it as long as I can... (I quit smoking a year ago and apply that money to this)..."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw6cM8NcGumoqRYwOF4AaABAq>

↳ @suloget (0): "Your premiums seem very low."

↳ @rogerclark3 (0): "@sulogetThat's what it is. It's Ace Insurance. We'll see what the price increase is..."

"I'm a fairly healthy 65 year old...took advantage for the 3 allowable months to switch, I'm in IL. Seven years in my 30's was spent in cancer treatment...makes me want a supplement but afraid of the cost in subsequent years. Medicare needs to be simplified and less confusing. Thank you nerds for the plethora of information you provide in this dog eat dog world of insurance."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzXmDr8hmo0YRSr_2d4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! 🤔 it is pretty crazy how complicated it gets"

"I love this type of video and you did a great job as usual. As an anecdote, this year (2024) I switched from a supplemental plan F to a MA plan and I couldn't be happier. I retired in 2015. Now, gone is my \$240 per month premium for supplement plan F, gone is my \$110 per month part d plan where the drugs also cost twice as much and present is my \$0 premium health plan, \$0 premium drug plan, and I still see the same doctors and hospitals that I was anyway. I now save enough in one year, that if I ever reach my maximum out of pocket (\$4100) I am still way ahead financially. Love my Advantage plan. Plus, I am 74 this year. I hate to think how much that supplemental will cost by the time I'm 80. (\$450 - \$500 per month?) I don't have to worry about it."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgyL90JITftyVjlvAnt4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! So glad to hear you are happy with your choice :)"

"My anecdote is a worry: that premiums for original Medicare plus supplement plan G will rise so much that I'll be forced to switch to an advantage plan. Scary."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgyhV7_XI00FXNLqAoF4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "This does happen for people. Premiums can get pricey."

↳ @rogergardner7740 (0): "Correct Reson I left my supplement and plan G plus dental about 5500 year and went to Humana ppo advantage"

"I am thinking that if I go Medicare advantage, and later have a \$6500 out of pocket maximum, my retirement can afford to cover that each month. If I can go 10 years of not paying \$3000 more a year for medigap insurance, while not having much in the way of out of pocket expenses in the first 10 years on Medicare advantage, that is going to cover many years of that \$6500 maximum out of pocket costs later in life if I start hitting it. Then at the same time, my retirement expenses can afford the \$3000 a year extra for the medigap insurance as well, so later in life when I need more care, it should be better. But what if they increase the premiums on medigap? So if it goes from \$3000/year for the first year to \$6000/year after 10 years? Meanwhile if I was still on Medicare advantage, I would have that same \$6500 max out of pocket, but I would already hit that just with the premiums with medigap. Sounds like time to flip a coin..."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugxz_jAlkSwqA6lFXkp4AaABAg

↳ @SilverSergeant (0): "Who do you want making decisions about your health care? A for-profit insurance company case manager or you yourself (and your doctor)? Are you OK with waiting for that for-profit case manager to pre-authorize the things your doctor says you NEED? Are you OK with reaching the max out of pocket every year when you get older? Medicare Advantage puts YOUR health care in the hands of an insurance company.....out of your hands."

"I am beginning to wonder about my BCBS advantage plan. When I got medicare I had no health issues and the sales person said this would be the best for me so I got it. On the second year of having the plan I got stage 1 breast cancer. They pretty much covered everything except they disagreed with my doctor on the number of radiation treatments. They said for my stage of breast cancer I only needed 4 instead of 5 or 6 treatments. So I got the 4. Turns out so far they paid all but 6000+ of my treatment. When I had to have another biopsy done they only covered \$208. of the procedure. They are both still pending and I'm worried I am going to be stuck with the bill totalling over \$10,000."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugynw5nW7W69BUVLOqV4AaABAg>

Networks, prior authorization and being denied care · 44 documents · 20 voices

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"I am a nurse. I am amazed at how many people who have advantage plans actually think they have Medicare. They forget that those insurance companies are in this business to make money. There is only one way for them to do that. Pay out less than they take in. Those plans sound fabulous. However, don't get sick! Fighting for care, and still being denied is a nightmare as you mentioned. I remember a case that I was working on. The patient was threatening to stroke. They desperately needed to have a carotid surgery. The Dr was on the phone and the company would NOT give permission for this patient to have surgery that would prevent the stroke. I would never get an advantage plan. I'll pay for my own gym membership and toothpaste!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 160 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw3YwX-OW2erk9tJPN4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (20): "Smart move on your part. Unfortunately, marketing and gimmicks sell."

↳ @christinedaley5580 (17): "@medicare365don't need free q tips when you're dead.,😞😞😞 "

↳ @appaloosa42 (9): "It amazes me how poorly people value long term planning!"

"This video was so informative. My late husband was blessed to have a Supplement Plan G. Prior to beginning Medicare he began having neurological problems and was diagnosed with ALS. Thankfully we were able to receive the treatments he needed without the stress of co-pays, referrals, or pre authorizations. Instead of the healthcare process being a bear to deal with, it seemed more like leading a lamb."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 98 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxnPLA_JdSH8Od-IRF4AaABAg

↳ @debbycoffey4788 (7): "You never mentioned underwriting, questions about your health, in order to switch from a MA to Original Medicare if you aren't happy with the Advantage plan you chose. I understand it can be very hard to switch if you have an underlying condition. What are some questions they might ask to deny you from switching?"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "So sorry to hear about your husband. Yes, the ease of use is quite different between the two plans. I like your animal analogy 😊 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "@debbycoffey4788 we have a video that goes over switching. And, we just finished filming an update to this video where we go through the medical questions in more detail that we hope to release next week. Hopefully you are subscribed and can see that when it comes out. Here is the existing video: <https://youtu.be/djuGel829M4>";

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAg>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"So glad we were advised to take a supplement plan when we started Medicare. A few years later my spouse was diagnosed with cancer and was able to go to a hospital that specialized in that one. We never had to worry about being in plan or getting approvals. Paying more upfront meant we had no bills through the years of treatment. I continue using my supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 61 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwhJu-QYROdQEUKL_h4AaABAg

↳ @jimarnold7561 (3): "Can't speak of other advantage plans but I couldn't be happier with my Kaiser senior advantage plan. Low cost, good doctors, modern hospitals, etc."

↳ @txladywolf01 (1): "Same here. Straight Medicare and Medigap plan N...no issues and I travel USA"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (0): "@jimarnold7561 Dream on Jim. The data doesnt support your statement. When you need it most you will discover the mistake you made."

"I signed up for an advantage plan my first year of Medicare and then attended this workshop live in St. Louis. I switched over to regular Medicare with supplements, and I'm thrilled I qualified. I pay more, but I don't have to play "mother may I" with the insurance company. As a physician, I don't want an insurance company to deny life saving therapy should I develop something they don't want to cover. This company is knowledgeable and honest!"

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 30 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Be_bQ04cKzJc&lc=UgyTPvcDti90LupWwSR4AaABAg

"Medicare Advantage is being subsidized and promoted to weaken Original Medicare, I think. Health insurers want to get everyone into a plan where they control everything. I thought retirement would improve my health insurance, but now the dreaded private insurer network rules are creeping into Medicare. I am on an Advantage plan, I was seduced by the low premium, but I wish we did not have to make choices like this for health insurance in retirement"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyerDoHLB2gXsjJRLV4AaABAq.ATT6lcfcPqnATZbikhLmzv>

"At 39:53, you say, "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, lean towards Medicare Advantage." I feel the unspoken part of that sentence should be: "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, *AND MUCH MORE LIKELY TO BE DENIED COVERAGE* lean towards Medicare Advantage." With Medigap, your doctor and Medicare determine what procedures you can get. With Medicare Advantage, the Corporate Healthcare Provider determines what procedures you can get. The Advantage Plan Provider's incentive is to maximize profits. How do they do that? Deny coverage for procedures that they don't want to pay for."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwU_3aKoZJXMaRelzl4AaABAq

"I have traditional Medicare along with my supplement plan. I love knowing exactly what I am responsible for each year, and I really love that I can get the treatment my doctor recommends without worrying about some greedy insurance company denying my care. Yes, I have to pay my monthly premium, plus separate policies for dental, vision, and prescriptions, but it's worth it to me."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugzg_E5Vh8nOezLYz6V4AaABAq

"Another extremely valuable post. Are you paying attention kiddies? I love how you (Stephanie) covered the "one way door" on switching between the two. My main reasons to stay with original Medicare is that next largest town to me is in another state. I don't want to have to deal with networks. Also don't want to deal with for profit insurance that has me get prior approvals and can deny me. I'm in great health right now but in the event that things go very wrong the last thing I need is the insurance company causing me headaches. Stephanie, you need to once again post the side by side cost comparison that shows yearly deductibles, max out of pocket, max coverage, co pay comparisons. If I remember correctly, Advantage has more out of pocket (yearly deductible) and less max coverage. IMHO Advantage would be okay if you lived in a large city. But for us rural folks not so much."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxYtDAJ72cFpoJQfD14AaABAq>

"I was in a unique situation because I got Medicare at age 64 due to disability. I chose a Medicare Advantage plan (Anthem). I had 2 surgeries, another procedure at the hospital that required general anesthesia and a lot of hospital based tests plus I am on several RX's. I paid nothing up front but by the end of the year, I had paid over \$5000 in co-pays etc not counting RX copays. Plus it was a pain to followup on bills they disallowed. Thank goodness I found out I could change back to regular Medicare with a supplement at age 65 with no underwriter requirement or extra costs. This year has been a breeze compared to last year! I have had one surgery that required numerous trips to a wound care doctor specialist, an ER visit, starting PT and stopping PT several times, lots of expensive RX's, etc. I am going to have another major surgery next month too and know I will need one or 2 more next year. My uncovered medical costs out of pocket have been \$150 for this year for a specialized medical device that Medicare will not cover. My RX cost have been a lot less too. The nice thing is I can go to any doctor that accepts Medicare!!! My first surgery this year was done in a Bon Secour hospital and the next surgery will be in a Riverside hospital. All covered!!!! I can research and find the best doctors in my area and not be restricted to one group. I also travel so no worried about being out of network. Last year while out of state, I ended up with a simple eye infection and it cost me over \$250 for the doctor visit and RX that was not covered out of network. Yes, I pay extra but at \$190.29 a month (supplement policy, a drug plan and a dental plan) I am still way ahead of last year. I need to say I got a high end drug plan because it equals less out of pocket for my drugs over the year. I also chose to do a dental plan with the dentist I have used for over 30 years at \$29 a month. The Anthem plan only had dentist an hour away from me. I get my glasses at Costco or Sams so the cost is reasonable so no insurance needed. So $\$190.29 \times 12 = \2283.48 for the year.....a lot less than the over \$5000 from last year. Even if I add the \$150 that none of the insurances would cover I am less than the \$5000! I am a retired math teacher so the numbers are my thing and I researched a lot of plans before I chose the right supplement plan for me. After months of searching I picked Mutual of Omaha for me. Then when I was almost confident in my research I stumbled on a EXCELLENT group that does it all for you and even helps you if problems come up. BOOMER BENEFITS. They were wonderful even months later when there was an issue with my drug plan. I was always informed during the process. I even did not have to run the figures to find the best drug plan, I just sent them a list of my regular RX's. Save yourself a lot of work and money and call them. No, I am not a rep or am I paid to say this. Just someone who put a lot of time and effort to get the best cost plan for myself only to find a free phone call could have saved me A LOT of time and work. And yes they do advise you on the Advantage plans if that is what you want. They take the time to find THE best plan for their clients and it is all FREE!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgzB3E8lInNx0KYQAzh4AaABAq>

↳ @keilana6 (1): "Great if you have the income to afford the supplement. But why have Medicare coverage for only those who have been able to save thousands of \$ for premiums? System needs to work for all income levels."

↳ @jdenino6022 (0): "If you live in NY State the rules for going onto a supplemental plan after an Advantage plan are different than most other states."

"I wish I had educated myself when I turned 65. I chose to stay with my employers retiree health plan which we pay ourselves. This year the price has jumped dramatically and I am looking at marketplace. It looks like I missed out on medigap because I know I would now be turned down if underwritten. I could stay with my employers plan and if they discontinued it I could get medigap, but leaving voluntarily my only option is advantage. I will save 4000 a year by choosing advantage but fear the authorizations/denial process."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyNq-I5E9DgaRdfDEN4AaABAg>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (2): "As someone told me when I was turning 65. You can pay it now (traditional and supp) or pay it later (advantage) as far as costs. As far as quality of care there is no comparison. Advantage Plans kill seniors prematurely by the hundreds every day in the US. And thats a fact"

↳ @ahemphill44 (0): "@JohnJohn-wr1jo That's the most ignorant statement (of many) that I have read on this old post."

"CALIFORNIA GAL here so don't poke the BEAR. I just sat for 3 hours with my son on the lesser cost but the insane admin so I'm moving Advantage to Supplemental by January. The stress of approvals, authorizations, then getting the doctor appointment. A terrific imaging facility fell out of network...this threw me into buckets of tears. I've had a couple big accidents in my life and maintenance requires top self specialists. Overall I'm incredibly healthy just busted up. Thank goodness I found you tonight! 🐻 🐻 🐻 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgyrUsb1_bdlrvfyvZ4AaABAg

"I've thought along the same lines. But based on the meetings I've attended over the years with different insurance companies, I believe the future of Medicare Advantage is going to be heavily weighted toward HMO plans. Last year was a good example of that shift, with many PPO options being pulled from the marketplace. Because of this trend, I actually think it will cause more people to hang on to - and even purchase - Medicare supplements than we might expect, since many don't want to be locked into restrictive HMO networks."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyNSEImQ0NTVmpgkcV4AaABAg.AMN6TrEcJsQAMNOraNjvCT

"Thanks for sharing this information .Prior to my retirement 2 years ago I was an RN in an acute hospital.It was a nightmare sometimes getting approval from an Advantage Plan office for most things,patients would get upset as they had no clue this might happen."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwreA4fmD8KJzkui9p4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (3): "Hi Margaret. I understand. My wife was director of billing and Medicare analyst for a local medical center. The stories she has to tell were heartbreaking. Yes, the lack of transparency within the Medicare industry is harmful to consumers."

"That's an emergency event. Cancer is the real killer when it comes to Advantage. Advantage plans are simply an inferior product. With HDG there is simply no financial reason to go on an advantage plan. For the cost of cable every month, you can have access to literally the best possible healthcare. No annual changes outside of part D, no worrying about doctors going in and out of networks, No worrying about approvals for procedures, 100 verses 20 days of skilled nursing care, and of course coverage that travels with you. Without HDG that changes everything. Places like New York and Connecticut, it would simply not make sense to choose traditional Medicare. Even if it means losing out on the ability go to Mayo clinic. I believe in a video about Nevada there were Advantage plans with limits around \$1,000. Of course those are outliers and usually when limits are that low they are HMO versus PPO plans."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgzKqkvNJIdLAdIKaTB4AaABAg>

"Erik - MAHALO (thanks) for providing a comprehensive and unbiased comparison/explanation between Advantage and Supplement plans, including the pros and cons. After my brother was declined a cardiac procedure pre-authorization, even after his doctor appealed the decline, he switched to a Supplement Plan. Subsequently, he had triple by-pass surgery. Because I don't want to be subject to stricter pre-authorizations, I will opt to select a Supplement Plan. Thankfully, I can afford this option. I was planning to use a local Medicare consultant/insurance broker, I'm now leaning toward using your firm simply because of your unbiased and trusted education."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgwhNRa14NsfQk0KePZ4AaABAg>

"Thanks. I did not know the restrictions of advantage plans. I have a retired medical plan under my old company. When my wife got off my plan due to eligible for medicare, they offer us a supplemental plan. It is close to 500 a month now and I thought of switching to an advantage plan. But after hearing your disadvantages, we will stay with our supplemental plan and just pay the higher premiums. For us, medical problems need to be address right away. I do not want to fight the gate keeper. The ease of getting medical treatment our doctor thinks we need is worth the extra monthly premium we pay."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugw85lKOFxLtR7dCLZp4AaABAg>

↳ @janyenyo (2): "another thing is this: my retiree health plan will never let us get back on if we leave....."

↳ @TheMrprez (1): "Do your own research. Don't take everything presented here as the complete and total facts."

↳ @janyenyo (0): "same here, we go to Dr yearly, I have the retiree health plan but premiums are jumping 20 dollars for each of us. The reason I am staying with it is this. The zero premium Adv plans do have a co pay of 3700 dollars or more for each hospitalization. Say we each wind up in the Hosp at the end of the year, we would owe over 7000 dollars and then in Jan of following year it starts all over again, we could end up in deep doo doo. I suppose we could take the premiums we pay and put into savings and use to pay these fees but it would never cover. I view the premiums we pay now as extra insurance and peace of mind I guess. I'm willing to listen to other's advice if I am wrong here."

"@SilverSergeantI'm happy that I don't have to pay for a medigap premium, a dental plan, a vision plan, a drug plan, and an annual physical. I don't worry about my doctors leaving the network next year. There are many doctors in the network and I don't have a must-see doctor."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgygHOcla3eZluceAOZ4AaABAq.ATT6lQ03l0_AU3vxEaDVbR

"Insurance Question After a CT scan this week my doctor believes I have cancer. Biopsy is scheduled for Friday. I have a United Healthcare family plan through work that's pretty good. My wife has the option to take a family healthcare plan with Blue Cross Blue Shield. Her healthcare currently pays us \$3600 annually to not take it. It would cost us \$4200 annually for family coverage, so it's a \$7800 swing. The problem is her open enrollment ends tomorrow. My worry is we don't take her insurance and end up with a diagnosis that takes us to a specialist that is out of network for UHC. I know most major hospitals take it but have also read Hopkins doesn't for example. Also my out of pocket max is about 7k Any insight would be appreciated. Thank you!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wicqeo/insurance_question/

A big illness and the bills that follow · 25 documents · 20 voices

"My husband was given the sales pitch about how great an advantage plan was. So he switched to Humana and the first two years were good. He was never sick. Then Covid came and he was diagnosed with cancer. We live in NH and the ER put him in an ambulance to go to Dana Farber in Boston (an hour away). Well guess what, the ambulance and hospital was out of network. Ambulance was \$5000. After he was diagnosed he passed away 72 days later. He was laying in the hospital bed stressed out about how I was going to pay all the medical bills when he dies. Sucks pretty bad when you're on your death bed and the only thing you think about is how your surviving spouse is going to pay the medical bills! Needless to say, when I signed up for Medicare I took a supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 92 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgztwkgUWWxR35VyLN4AaABAq>

↳ @rshoe1023 (14): "Sorry for your lose! It really shouldn't be this way for seniors! The whole health care system here in the states is entirely broken!"

↳ @truthhearit1471 (7): "YOU LEGALLY DO NOT HAVE TO PAY HIS MEDICAL BILLS"

↳ @johndoe-ss9bz (1): "Capitalist - Medicine 101.. "Profits First"..."

"I'm a person who needs "peace of mind" -- I'm very happy with my Plan F supplement (for newer retirees, that's been replaced by the very similar Plan G). I receive a high level of care, easy access to specialists, and am not worried about suddenly losing my life's savings due to a catastrophic injury or illness (or severe sunburn)."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyAg3Um5_OW_9HCDen4AaABAq

↳ @lynnebucher6537 (0): "My best friend has several chronic issues and also chose Plan F, and definitely gets her money's worth."

"I'm a fairly healthy 65 year old...took advantage for the 3 allowable months to switch, I'm in IL. Seven years in my 30's was spent in cancer treatment...makes me want a supplement but afraid of the cost in subsequent years. Medicare needs to be simplified and less confusing. Thank you nerds for the plethora of information you provide in this dog eat dog world of insurance."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzXmDr8hmo0YRSr_2d4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! 🙏 it is pretty crazy how complicated it gets"

"Selected original Medicare, part d and supplemental g. When I did a cost analysis, the cost was an additional \$100 per month. I rather pay a little each month and not have to worry about maximum out of pocket when I get sick. This was based on the comparison of Medicare advantage PPO and original Medicare. The PPO cost was \$125 a month more. Although the HMO had \$0 premium, it had a smaller network than the PPO. Both had limited within network, pre authorization, and referral requirements. Could I have chosen supplemental N and save some money? Yep, I could have but I am very happy with my choice. For me it has been peace of mind. Thank you for providing great videos. If I did not see your videos and get educated on the differences in both programs, I would still be with Medicare advantage. Thank you Matt!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=Ugz3eGJgpuDkcf2QVil4AaABAg>

"Hi Matthew! I am on the cusp (literally, I have 2 weeks left to decide about plans) of getting on Medicare. I have been tortured with this for months now, not understanding any of it totally, even with extensive researching on my own. I do not have anyone with whom I could speak to about a decision, so I am very grateful that you just explained the critical differences between an Advantage plan and a Supplement plan. I can now make an informed decision without ending up as one of the medical system casualties you spoke of! I was actually in tears (of relief) watching this video. My 24 year old son has already had 2 Cancer surgeries, and I really do not want to add to my family's future medical worries any more than necessary. Thank you SO much again! God Bless people like you."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgxMwp6sR0xaIT6KFx14AaABAg>

"Thanks for sharing this information .Prior to my retirement 2 years ago I was an RN in an acute hospital.It was a nightmare sometimes getting approval from an Advantage Plan office for most things,patients would get upset as they had no clue this might happen."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwreA4fmD8KJzkui9p4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (3): "Hi Margaret. I understand. My wife was director of billing and Medicare analyst for a local medical center. The stories she has to tell were heartbreaking. Yes, the lack of transparency within the Medicare industry is harmful to consumers."

"Do not, I repeat NOT use United Health Care on the Advantage plan. UHC is a sunburn of a nightmare - a mess and my hospital dropped them. I signed up with the Advantage plan at the hospital. All went smooth until they sent a letter that said Advantage is going away in Oregon? :("

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugys1pC3NFzodwwwYlh4AaABAg.AKdMkH291hCANZVXQWelul>

"I've had Medicare Advantage for 17 years now. The last two years I've had one that, so far, nothing out of pocket at all, ever, except for one expensive drug. Excellent doctors in my area, that I've been using for years even before I turned 65. First time in my life I've had real "universal" type medical care and I absolutely love it. Never a worry about a co-pay, no charges for surgery. My husband had a stent placement after a heart attack a few years ago. The cost to us was \$0. We went to Georgia to visit our son and my husband got sick while there. He was treated at Emory University Hospital. Charge? \$0. I feel like I'm living in Europe. The first 15 years we had MA, we did have small out of pocket expenses. I have always chosen physicians I knew compared with the benefits of each plan. I will chose a plan that has a co-pay if the doctors and hospitals I want to use are members. All the top physicians my this area accept the plan I have now. I'm happy as a bug in a rug."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugx1dm-lamj-wu1PvoV4AaABAg.9ZCILW366mm9ZHKJcsxpyq>

"Did my homework, and decided traditional Medicare was the best choice. In the future, I don't want to face a catastrophic illness, and a large medical bill at the same time, or a provider denying me treatment that a doctor recommended. And I want the freedom of going to the doctor/hospital of my choice. It's more expensive, but it gives me "peace of mind" if the worst happens."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_l8Clhv0iUwr3Eox4AaABAg

"I don't think the advantage program is worth anything if Medicare will pay for your gallbladder surgery you just have to worry about the deductible. You'd never be denied and you get the treatment."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=Ugypul9EmnhP1JOBSTx4AaABAg.A8aqxgPfWm2A8cxy1rT30e>

"I just checked Part G plans through Via Benefits, my former company's retiree benefits site that supposedly negotiates less expensive rates. AARP United Health is the only Part G available in my zip code, a somewhat rural area in north Texas abutting the DFW Metroplex. My premium would be \$432 a month which seems a bit pricey, although I'm lucky enough to be able to afford it with my pension, 401K, and savings. It does seem a bit restrictive in that no other plans were offered so it's take it or leave it for me unless I decide to go with MA when I become eligible for Medicare when I turn 65 in February 2026. Having high blood sugar and high blood pressure, although still in good health, it does make me worry about hospital stays and bills the older I get with Medicare Advantage so I may take the monthly hit and go with a Part G plan. Your video was really helpful to me in helping me decide which direction to go in the next few months."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgziZybJP4JiD40WR_d4AaABAg

↳ @medicare365 (3): "Why get it through your job if it is that expensive"

↳ @loiswells3062 (0): "Did you consider moving?"

"I appreciate your videos; they definitely win the match! One of the things I wonder is the likelihood of extra costs with an advantage plan. If not everyone who treats you is on the plan. For example, what if your hospital and regular doctor are participants, but the anesthesiologist is not in the network. I've seen things like that with other insurance plans and wonder if it happens with Medicare advantage plans? Do you have a video that talks about those kinds of costs and the possibilities?"

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgzQEhahSEVpr4wmmeZ4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching 🍌 There are laws and rules in place now that do not allow for providers/facilities to do this. If you get care at an in-network facility, and have an out of network anesthesiologist, they can't bill you as out of network. <https://www.cms.gov/newsroom/fact-sheets/no-surprises-understand-your-rights-against-surprise-medical-bills>";

"I'm not yet on Medicare. Have a year before retirement. But I am in an employer health insurance plan that uses networks (Aetna). My fear has always been that I might be taken to a hospital and someone who is out of network treats me, giving me a bill that might cost me thousands or tens of thousands. Then I lose my house."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgxZR3bWgLfHj6zcfgR4AaABAg>

"Well I have a question for you OK they put me on Medicare when I was 55 I was still at the American United healthcare at the hospital that was my primary insurance when I went to the doctor so Mary Kay I've been getting money for me all these years taking out \$144 out of my money and telling me I have so much for dinner I need it now can you help me get it that's about it no OK the people since I've been using America the best since 2018 no they call me every time it's time to come get your teeth cleaned and asked me why because I wanted they want to get the money from you all I know you're gonna be amazed at the point where now sorry I finally put out anywhere you go you're nice lady I finally told the people I'm trying to just come to get my teeth clean I need my breeze don't fit no more OK cause I had leukemia pool so the reason fit normal and I need help OK I talk to the lady she's 50 years old she's a top Medicare person as I can get away at the moment and she told me to talk to the governor because I want him as it is the bottom line OK God bless you are you seem like a real nice lady but I miss you OK I have a BCND I called Medicare they give me a ride to the doctor they give me a ride to get my test I can finish the call me baby we're gonna do all the mamas gonna check for you if you ever want to wear a dress I want to say the mood for my teeth tell my want to eat it's so busy worry about my body it's going to get my quarterly check: Teknowledge the Pap smear because I have a 667578 OK but I don't want it is him so anyway can you help me get my money back with you we got a call the governor I talk to the medical lady she's 58 you gonna see what I feel but she said she had a complaint from people like talking to her she enjoy talking to me because I want to see what y'all got to face your fear OK God bless you pray for your help with Jesus is with 80 will you have reached we have you tell Ray but I have United Health Care supplement ABC D and I go for chronic and well now that's one way to get one of her chronic I don't know if they're on the way I say I will now where is the I got the best where is the damn list a problem tell the governor now they say so I got to talk to I want to money went OK tell him tell him one day it is I need 3000 I paid 15 is that for you OK with the 2000s yeah yeah I work with that word before I need 800 800 did I need 35 did you pay 50 and I paid 1500 for doing this why is he into the network OK God bless you and what is America they not bring up my day as she gets with me back to them OK but still they paid 2500 and why my previous 2000 talk to the governor they say the governor of your state country whatever I don't care where he got it that's all I wanna know where my money yet because I'm waiting to have a business charge me until I need it now but do you date "I feel very reasonable pretty good we're at Marti goes to her let you know what I do you know Heb has an omelette with raisins and ate my egg my day is the cosmetic on my two front teeth he's the want to tell me that they pull my God I'm open for that phrase go out for a ride my teeth and he made me go to pretty cosmetic tea anyway I didn't have medication and I pay for everything made my insurance to hear everything glad to talk to the right to talk if she's smart she's happy she's not ready I want to talk to us about a mile insurance lady she's nice to the neighbor silver now my doctor said that he had a pretend me to describe anything or whatever I'm not even sick but I guess he really is he's a good doctor and I like to Denises it's a big deal between the dogs and Denist you know that I'm a nurse and no no the doctor gonna take care you say you do then he get his money he doesn't yell at you any money I don't get my money OK God bless you oh she's not really she's nice to do OK"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7S-VZXiV>

"I have financial resources, good health and low medical usage (for now, but hey I own a horse). I chose traditional Medicare with supplement N and a drug plan because I'd like to travel around the US, possibly snowbird one day, and despise restrictive HMO/most PPO networks and dealing with all the red tape those plans come with. I also was thinking ahead to the day when I may not be able to personally deal with all that deductible/copay/network garbage and have the energy to fight an insurance company. My sister has a MA Advantage and has to deal with all that now. Another thing I like about traditional Medicare is that I'll never be tempted to skimp on care out of fear of high out of pocket costs and inadvertently end up with a serious complication. I saw my mom do that."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugz0z7Y53ScNG-YCGyp4AaABAg>

"I signed up for Medicare Supplemental last year when I turned 66 years old. Had a bad accident and was in hospital a long time, rehab a long time, and at home therapy a long time, now outpatient rehab for what is to be expected long term. I HAVE NEVER seen anyone talk about "planning" for the worst (cancer) when signing up for Plan D. I have always gotten the cheapest and has worked well, but do those cheapies even cover \$\$\$ cancer drugs in their formulary? I wouldn't even know what to look for as to name, but gosh, I don't want to find out I have cancer in February, and NONE of the treatment drugs are covered. Can you cover this situation and talk about? Thanks."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwCtGGA81ZHCw36E5l4AaABAq>.

↳ @doc5701 (1): "Hey friend! Awful what you've been thru. I'm so sorry. Wanted to comment on Part D and cancer treatment drugs. Generally if you get infusion therapy that's covered under Part B not D. If you are prescribed one of the newer biologic drugs it will typically be a Tier 5 drug which will be very expensive BUT with new federal legislation you will only pay max of \$2000 (2025 and \$2100 in 2026). Plans are required to provide drug which may cost \$800/mo or higher. Further you can elect to get on the Part D Prescription Plan where you can spread out the high cost over 12 or fewer months. Best wishes for continued recovery."

↳ @barleyhops38 (0): "@doc5701 So, I was thinking that that LIMITS only covered what was in their formulary. So you are stating above " Plans are required to provide drug which may cost \$800/mo or higher." So I'm thinking that you are stating that expensive stuff like that HAS TO BE on my cheapie plan, therefore in the formulary, therefore... at least it has a cap! If I'm right in understanding what you are stating... I'm good! AND..... thanks for answering this question as many channels don't answer as you do as plan D's don't give them income so much. You indeed are doing a service, THANKS from the bottom of my heart! (By the way, why doesn't YT have the word formulary in it and it has squiggly lines under it as if was misspelled lol.. am I not using a correct word?)"

↳ @doc5701 (0): "@barleyhops38Hi! I have 6 years experience w prescription Cancer drugs. Good news is I'm still kicking. My experience with 2 drugs is that they ended up being Part D Tier 5. Both had to be approved by Part D admin before I could get but were. Tier 5 are the high cost specialty drugs. The max limits for Part D are a Godsend because of the very high copays. One drug was \$800/mo and on the formulary. The other drug was \$1700/mo. Now I'm on a drug classified as chemo so it is covered by Part B not D. As mentioned if you were diagnosed with cancer you'd likely do chemo infusions and that is covered under Part B. You should not worry ahead of time bc it's kind of impossible to predict or plan. My onc team, Sloan Kettering, helped with obtaining one of the drugs and I was able to take advantage of a drug company's offer to provide for free. So options exist for obtaining drug from pharma, cancer center might help w financial aid. I'm very thankful for my experience to date and thankful to God for extended life which is pretty normal. Best wishes."

"I'm turning 65 on July 3rd 2024. I have ACA for me and my husband. He has no earnings. Can he stay on our ACA plan or must we figure out how to get him insurance separately.? Also how can I get it help to do my Medicare? I was thinking advantage plan but on many meds and have ling and heart issues and worried I will be stuck on it forever and Dr and hospital will stop accepting it. I have lower end income of \$55000 yeah for 2 people. Can u help me decide? Ty"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgyqI5eN6o3erb_Ru14AaABAq.

"I was able to switch from an advantage plan to a supplemental plan G with no issues because my hospital stopped accepting Advantage plans. My advice is to sign up for a supplemental plan when you are first eligible. You will pay more out of pocket but the benefits are much better. You never have to worry about if your doctor or hospital will continue to accept your advantage plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgzjzPKydhSOH_FBfZ4AaABAg

Choosing wrong, missing a deadline, the penalty · 11 documents · 11 voices

"I've been researching Medicare for the past few months as I am getting ready to have to make some decisions.. I found this video very helpful and informative... I have been so stressed as I don't want to make the wrong decision. This was a great overview and just helped calm my mind a bit. Nothing is easy or straight forward for sure...Thank You!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211lpLq6moM&lc=UgzdEe01DRkZ7syX6od4AaABAg>

"I do find MA plans to be somewhat deceptive. These plans are also heavily promoted unlike traditional Medicare. A friend went to a free lunch presentation of an MA plan, signed up for it, and abandoned her previous traditional Medicare/Supp. plan. Initially, it was all quite good for her. The MA plan included a senior exercise program and very basic vision/dental benefits which were not included with regular Medicare. Then, she unexpectedly developed a serious illness. She could no longer go to the exercise class. Several of the doctors she trusted dropped out of the approved MA plan network and she had to seek new ones which was very upsetting at a time when she was quite ill. Then, she started having to pay all these charges not covered under her MA plan. Before she passed away, she told me that switching to the MA plan was a huge mistake resulting in undue anxiety and stress for her and her family. An MA plan may be right for you, but be aware of what could happen. There are costs on the back end and you may have to change to an in-network doctor or doctors at some point."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzijlkC4UNmgDhmvTI4AaABAg>

↳ @commonsense6967 (1): "Unfortunately, most people don't check to see whether their doctors, or hopefully, most of the doctors in an area accept their MA plan before they take it, AND they never check the CMS star rating on a plan before signing up for it. Many of the plans people are unhappy with are only rated one, two, or three quality stars, and then they're disappointed by their experiences with the Plan, If they'd pick a 4 or 5 star Plan instead, they'd be much happier with the level of care, cost and choice/number of doctors in the plan. (I know, mine is a 5 star MA and it's a good one. Very few doctors ever leave it.)"

↳ @RudyDoody-z3q (0): "Margaret, you are right! They NEVER tell you about the deductible. They paint such a rosy picture. When you get over 65, you never know when your health is going to be compromised. Prepare for health problems with a Medicare Supplement. Those problems ARE coming, down the road. When you're in the hospital, you don't want to worry about bills and empty bank accounts."

"what if you are still working past 65 and currently live abroad. should I still enroll for Part A? How do I prove I have insurance at my job, to delay Part B and not be subject to penalties? Thank you"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwUVedcmSuAJezf8hl4AaABAg>

"Thank you for all your advice. I will soon be a first time medicare person so I'm afraid of making any mistakes."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxCdGlo5Xwn9yEChkB4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (0): "You're very welcome! It's completely normal to feel that way—Medicare can be confusing at first. The good news is, you're asking questions and learning early, which puts you ahead of the game. If you take your time and compare your options carefully, you'll do great! Call us if you need help when the time comes."

"Medicare enrollment is not automatic. I did not receive any letter from them. I called 3 mos. before I turned 65 but I was told I was not eligible as I was still working because I had health insurance. 3 mos. after I turned 65, I applied in 2021 again for Medicare as I was afraid I'll get the forever late penalty. Again, I was told that I was not eligible because I had health insurance. After I turned 66 & a month before I retired, I went to SS office and I was informed that I was given a wrong information. I should've been enrolled. I got retiree health insurance from my employer for part B & D. I wrote them a letter about their error but they are still charging me for the late fee. Now, I pay \$430 with IRMAA surcharge."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgwbnsFcBI-Ec_4cxd4AaABAg

↳ @GUITARTIME2024 (0): "Send another letter. Dont give up. You might get lucky and hear good news."

"I have Medicare and anthem Blue Cross is my Supplementary insurance. My Anthem premium is 268.00 per month. I do not have dental or hearing. I will be 90 on the first of December and I am fearful of jumping around and discovering later I made a mistake. I'm on a fixed income and when I pay all my insurances and credit cards and taxes, there is not much left. I do wish I had some help with dental for dental hygiene, etc. Do you have any suggestions or do you think I'm doing the best I can? STEPHANIE WHAT DO YOU THINK?"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzB9wGtjWm2yVNotIl4AaABAg>

↳ @tonyalexa1120 (0): "Hello 🙌 Roberta... How are you doing today? And happy 🍷 thanksgiving to you and your family over there! 😊 "

"What if you're about to turn 65 and you're still working and you have employer insurance through United healthcare. If you sign up for part a which, if I'm understanding everything correctly it would be secondary. Are you required to choose a supplemental at that time or do you wait until you fully go on Medicare?"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixg9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugym9HlaNqrN3yoeHuN4AaABAg>

"What if you started working at 69 and had medicare since 65 , but the employer plan is better then the HMO plan on medicare. I paid no premium for part B because of low income. Now I have a six figure job which I plan to keep till I drop. lol"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙌 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxAbw4yqeJa9HmxKHF4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "<https://youtube.com/shorts/dZRI8HThYNM?si=mfJW6CmrMrCcBc3L>";

"Is highmark considered a Medicare advantage? I'm so lost in this. My specialist told me I'm not technically on Medicare so I'm scared I enrolled in the wrong plan. And I can't unenroll?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgweyeASuiOtc3eK8714AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (0): "Reply: Hi [User], I understand that navigating Medicare can be overwhelming, but no worries, we're here to help clarify things for you! Highmark is a health insurance company that offers Medicare Advantage plans, among other insurance options. Medicare Advantage plans are private health plans approved by Medicare to provide benefits to Medicare beneficiaries. If your specialist informed you that you're not technically on Medicare, it's possible that you may have enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan offered by Highmark. These plans work differently from original Medicare, but they still provide you with Medicare benefits. If you're concerned about being enrolled in the wrong plan, I recommend reaching out to Highmark or your plan's customer service to further understand the details of your coverage. They should be able to provide you with the necessary information and options available to you. Remember, open enrollment periods may allow you to make changes to your Medicare Advantage plan. It's important to familiarize yourself with your plan's rules regarding enrollment and disenrollment. Consult with a Medicare specialist if needed to make sure you're making the best decision for your healthcare needs. Please don't hesitate to ask if you have any more questions or need further assistance. We're here to support you! Take care, Medicare on Video"

"What if I move during a plan year and have elected a supplement plan, is there a penalty or medical exam required in my new state?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxyxJSN_dAYhsi1VPp4AaABAg

"My parents with chronic diabetes related health issues like heart failure and kidney disease mistakenly went into the advantage plan nightmare. This was a big mistake in their situation. They started rationing their medicine because of the high costs passed onto them. And once you are in that system you can't get back to original plus supplemental without underwriting. They were basically stuck until they ran out of money all together and ended up on Medicaid. I tell everyone I know how bad advantage is and warn people to stay away from them. They are the biggest scam on retirees from my perspective. They lure people with limited income into these plans because of the low cost premiums. I feel the same way about the High Deductible plans as well. This was a great video to help explain the maze that is Medicare and supplemental plans."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzo7ymquxD-781pCLR4AaABAg>

Travel and care out of state · 9 documents · 9 voices

"I was in a unique situation because I got Medicare at age 64 due to disability. I chose a Medicare Advantage plan (Anthem). I had 2 surgeries, another procedure at the hospital that required general anesthesia and a lot of hospital based tests plus I am on several RX's. I paid nothing up front but by the end of the year, I had paid over \$5000 in co-pays etc not counting RX copays. Plus it was a pain to followup on bills they disallowed. Thank goodness I found out I could change back to regular Medicare with a supplement at age 65 with no underwriter requirement or extra costs. This year has been a breeze compared to last year! I have had one surgery that required numerous trips to a wound care doctor specialist, an ER visit, starting PT and stopping PT several times, lots of expensive RX's, etc. I am going to have another major surgery next month too and know I will need one or 2 more next year. My uncovered medical costs out of pocket have been \$150 for this year for a specialized medical device that Medicare will not cover. My RX cost have been a lot less too. The nice thing is I can go to any doctor that accepts Medicare!!! My first surgery this year was done in a Bon Secour hospital and the next surgery will be in a Riverside hospital. All covered!!!! I can research and find the best doctors in my area and not be restricted to one group. I also travel so no worried about being out of network. Last year while out of state, I ended up with a simple eye infection and it cost me over \$250 for the doctor visit and RX that was not covered out of network. Yes, I pay extra but at \$190.29 a month (supplement policy, a drug plan and a dental plan) I am still way ahead of last year. I need to say I got a high end drug plan because it equals less out of pocket for my drugs over the year. I also chose to do a dental plan with the dentist I have used for over 30 years at \$29 a month. The Anthem plan only had dentist an hour away from me. I get my glasses at Costco or Sams so the cost is reasonable so no insurance needed. So $\$190.29 \times 12 = \2283.48 for the year.....a lot less than the over \$5000 from last year. Even if I add the \$150 that none of the insurances would cover I am less than the \$5000! I am a retired math teacher so the numbers are my thing and I researched a lot of plans before I chose the right supplement plan for me. After months of searching I picked Mutual of Omaha for me. Then when I was almost confident in my research I stumbled on a EXCELLENT group that does it all for you and even helps you if problems come up. BOOMER BENEFITS. They were wonderful even months later when there was an issue with my drug plan. I was always informed during the process. I even did not have to run the figures to find the best drug plan, I just sent them a list of my regular RX's. Save yourself a lot of work and money and call them. No, I am not a rep or am I paid to say this. Just someone who put a lot of time and effort to get the best cost plan for myself only to find a free phone call could have saved me A LOT of time and work. And yes they do advise you on the Advantage plans if that is what you want. They take the time to find THE best plan for their clients and it is all FREE!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgzB3E8lInNx0KYQAzh4AaABAq>

↳ @keilana6 (1): "Great if you have the income to afford the supplement. But why have Medicare coverage for only those who have been able to save thousands of \$ for premiums? System needs to work for all income levels."

↳ @jdenino6022 (0): "If you live in NY State the rules for going onto a supplemental plan after an Advantage plan are different than most other states."

"Sunburn: I'm 77, I live in Florida, since starting Medicare (12 years ago!) I've tried many plans. At first while my husband was still working as CFO of the company he owned we just stayed on his company's employee plan. Then I did some calculations and it appeared that not only were WE paying more, but HIS COMPANY was paying more needlessly! HE was shocked. From there we went on plan N, later on G, then Advantage, then G. He passed. Now I'm on Advantage. Since I spend 4 mos/yr in another state, I feared that if I had medical needs there they would not be covered. I see a dermatologist in my other state and this year I only paid \$80 out of pocket for that visit. Until my health deteriorates I plan to stay on advantage. This was the best video on Medicare choices I have ever seen— nor has anyone ever carefully explained the cost differences among the plans. Bravo!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwQ3lPiQ5wr80EKjrp4AaABAg>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (2): "Once your health deteriorates, you may be stuck in your Advantage plan. If you want to move up to a G or N plan....you will probably have to go through medical underwriting.....and they will likely deny you if you have bad health."

↳ @jamesmcconnell2131 (0): "@DankFarrikMe Yes, Always try to be so healthy you wouldn't need health insurance even though you actually have health insurance."

"That's an emergency event. Cancer is the real killer when it comes to Advantage. Advantage plans are simply an inferior product. With HDG there is simply no financial reason to go on an advantage plan. For the cost of cable every month, you can have access to literally the best possible healthcare. No annual changes outside of part D, no worrying about doctors going in and out of networks, No worrying about approvals for procedures, 100 verses 20 days of skilled nursing care, and of course coverage that travels with you. Without HDG that changes everything. Places like New York and Connecticut, it would simply not make sense to choose traditional Medicare. Even if it means losing out on the ability go to Mayo clinic. I believe in a video about Nevada there were Advantage plans with limits around \$1,000. Of course those are outliers and usually when limits are that low they are HMO versus PPO plans."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgzKqkvNjldLAdIKaTB4AaABAg>

"Thank you very much !! We are Retired. We will stick with our employer's Health Insurance and Medicare A and B. The monthly cost is more but we have zero out-of-pocket expenses (zero co-pays) and our Insurance company pays us \$800.00 a year as long as we keep Medicare Part B. We do travel and we don't have to worry about "the network" issues. Our premiums may go up annually but never because of overuse. If the premiums go up they go up for the entire nationwide group - not just the single policy holder."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgyUF1q4CQxr82hVwuN4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "You've got a great plan! Thanks for sharing."

"Sunburn, very educational. I am 73 and always on Medicare plus supplement G, pretty healthy but I travel, and don't want the unexpected costs of deductibles. I never want to have to defer going to an ER for worrying over costs, want to pick my own docs, etc. semi retired RN here. Did go to an advantage plan for one year to help pay for hearing aids only 😊 ."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwNaYh6SuefVkuWJW54AaABAg>

"what if you are still working past 65 and currently live abroad. should I still enroll for Part A? How do I prove I have insurance at my job, to delay Part B and not be subject to penalties? Thank you"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwUVedcmSuAJezf8hl4AaABAg>

"So much is just guesswork. Guess how long you'll live? Guess if you'll get a major illness? Guess how long it will be before you get that major illness? Guess how much it will cost since it goes up every year? It's all guesswork and estimates so run the numbers. ALSO Medicare Advantage Plans are local. If you have a carrier that has a great plan and good network in your area then Medicare Advantage will work just fine. If you travel and have an emergency, ER is always covered and if you're worried, take out a travel insurance plan before you travel. If money is no object then yes, Original Medicare plus Gap plan, drug plan, purchase your own eye, ear and dental plan separately, just know that all the supplement insurance is ALSO administrated by a private health insurance company, same companies that offer the Advantage Plans. Just research the plan carefully. If they cancel the plan, find a new one, not that big of a deal. Same if you move, you'll need a new plan. Also, there is no max out of pocket with original Medicare. With Medicare Advantage Plans they do have MOOP. I'm sorry but if you're healthy and don't have a family history of serious diseases or other health concerns, I would go with MA over the original Medicare, plus supplement plan, plus drug plan, plus dental plan, plus ears and eyes, plus gym membership plus, plus, plus. All the extras that come with the MA plan vs. original Medicare. The Medicare supplement plan only covers the gap in costs. That's it. Nothing more. The key is if you are considering an Advantage Plan, check the doctors, hospitals and pharmacies in that plan. Your going to use local providers so see who that is and ask them what they think of the plan you are considering. Don't rely on salespeople to do the work for you. It's your health and your plan. AI helped me compare plans, run scenarios, check ratings etc. It's a lot to learn but it's pretty easy if you just learn about it in detail. You'll still have a lot of guesswork even with a ton of research because we don't know what the future holds. Best plan is to stay healthy. ♥"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=Ugx-8xnmnvB7u7liCO54AaABAg>

"I like dogs. Thank you for the information. My current plan is with a regional provider, Sentara, which is ending. When I 1st went on Medicare, I chose traditional Medicare and a supplement. While I worry about travelling and the thought of being out of coverage for a needed but not emergency visit, I like the ability to not have several different premiums every month. I also like the perks of the allowances and silver sneakers. I work part time and have dental and vision coverage at a good cost. I am 73 and healthy, but I worry about what the future might bring. I have experience caring for older family members so I have had long term care insurance for over 20 years. My wife and I are meeting with our insurance agent October 24th so we will obtain a new plan then."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzZkJBqSSfapSa01814AaABAg>

"We are going onto medicare now. Part D and Medicare gap plan G along with A&B. Sleeping well and good to go. We travel in the country and over seas, no worries."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgwCMwm8vbXG9P14dAJ4AaABAg>

Stuck: failing underwriting, no way back to a Medigap · 7 documents · 7 voices

"@Wildflowerz57 good plan! My parents are both on med advantage and love it, same with my Medicare clients. Advantage isn't for everyone, and I have some clients on supplements because that is their preference and they can afford the premiums, but the vast majority are happily on advantage PPOs with huge networks & solid care. I have also seen older folks paying \$700 plus total monthly for part B, med supplement, and drug plan because they're stuck in an obsolete med supplement and can't qualify for another one, and are scared to move because of videos like this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyxwtlsnO3Manu9DFx4AaABAg.9Zo-abmMTzA9aY40j57arF>

"I am beginning to wonder about my BCBS advantage plan. When I got medicare I had no health issues and the sales person said this would be the best for me so I got it. On the second year of having the plan I got stage 1 breast cancer. They pretty much covered everything except they disagreed with my doctor on the number of radiation treatments. They said for my stage of breast cancer I only needed 4 instead of 5 or 6 treatments. So I got the 4. Turns out so far they paid all but 6000+ of my treatment. When I had to have another biopsy done they only covered \$208. of the procedure. They are both still pending and I'm worried I am going to be stuck with the bill totalling over \$10,000."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugynw5nW7W69BUVLQqV4AaABAg>

"@ThanksForTheLaugh Im just starting in January and Im looking at the HDG as Im worried in 5 years i wont be able to manage a G premium as it is over 300 a month here now and then the only option is a MA plan if I need to avoid underwriting.. so for close to the same price premuim as a MA plan, the HDG plan deductible is about 3,000 and where i am and the MA plans are 5,000 to 6,000 max out of pocket. Im still uncertain which is the best risk ratio to try"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugw1Papg7_BLo3AgLm14AaABAg.AOIngKCLjCWAOKaMqj_1b0

"I am 78 and have a plan f. Unfortunately, my supplement company has become unstable and has been raising my premium 10% a year for several years. My current monthly premium is \$440. Mo. I would like to change to a different company for a lower premium but am afraid I will not pass underwriting due to my weight. I am 5'2" 300 lbs. Any suggestions? My zip code is 60067."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgwD0BssDok_O_vK1dd4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Hi Beverly, this is quite common with supplement plans. Would you mind sending me an email to erik@90daysfromretirement.com with your zip code? Where you live will impact the answer to that question. Thank you for watching and sharing your experience."

"Almost 65, still learning but what I've learned is overwhelmingly this: Get Plan A, B, and Medigap (G). Now, my "final" thing to decide is regular G OR high deductible G. I can easily afford the higher deductible of the HDG AND/OR the higher monthly of the regular G. But still, trying to figure out which way to go. I'll keep looking because I'd bet you have a video about exactly this somewhere. My gut says the HDG but "worry" I can't go to the regular G down the road without underwriting. But why should I worry about? Why not just keep HDG forever? I guess I'll look for that video comparison of those 2 only. Thanks!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwjbE7ivR7hnQGkfQh4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (1): "I totally understand where you are coming from! Here's the High Deductible Plan G video you mentioned 😊 [https://m.youtube.com/watch?v=NQHG_o1vxVU&pp=ygUqUGVvb2xllGFyZSBzaWNrIG9mIG1lZGlnYXAgcmF0ZSBpbmNyZWZzZXMG";](https://m.youtube.com/watch?v=NQHG_o1vxVU&pp=ygUqUGVvb2xllGFyZSBzaWNrIG9mIG1lZGlnYXAgcmF0ZSBpbmNyZWZzZXMG)

"I'm turning 65 on July 3rd 2024. I have ACA for me and my husband. He has no earnings. Can he stay on our ACA plan or must we figure out how to get him insurance separately.? Also how can I get it help to do my Medicare? I was thinking advantage plan but on many meds and have ling and heart issues and worried I will be stuck on it forever and Dr and hospital will stop accepting it. I have lower end income of \$55000 yeah for 2 people. Can u help me decide? Ty"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgyqI5eN6o3erb_Rul14AaABAg

"Anecdote. My husband is on a humana medicare advantage plan. He has a 13, 000 hospital bill denied for no authorization. We are going around and around with insurance and the hospital. I am so scared we will be stuck with this bill. The hospital has sent a second level appeal to humana. Nothing has happened. Is there anything we can and should do????"

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgwNqtiuT3d0c_rvxvh4AaABAg

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Any doctor, any hospital, no approvals · 15 documents · 15 voices

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.])(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— r/medicare · 88 upvotes · None

"My experience with UHC was that they initially gave me \$3000 for dental the first year, which basically covers cleanings, and filling cavities, then they dropped it by \$500 dollars for the next 2 years. I needed a bridge, which costs a lot more than \$2000, never mind that I would still need my routine care. I finally went back to regular Medicare last fall. My secondary insurance covers my routine dental care. Still no bridge, but at least I do not have to be manipulated by a for-profit advantage care corp. Oh! And I can see any doctor I want and go to any facility that takes Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 37 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgwjTPflbhOs9e-qKml4AaABAg>

↳ @elizabethconnolly3260 (0): "Exactly! Their "additional benefits" are subpar and have very limited providers."

"Erin, I went on Medicare at 65 and got a medigap Plan N for \$91.00 a month. Now 4 years later in 2026 my medigap plan N is \$131.00 a month. Very importantly with Plan N which is way cheaper than Plan G, the only difference is a \$20.00 copay but none of my doctors have charged me the co-pay. I am very adamant about choosing any Doctor I want and flexibility to go anywhere to see a specialist out of state if nessary. I LOVE my Plan N!!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwcrcxukaLOJTehg6qV4AaABAg>

"I have an advantage plan and love it! never denied care or been delayed. I have had it 5 years. and it is a ppo. I can go to any doctor I want anywhere in the United States and I don't need any referrals."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgxalqomxKqFNno0H0R4AaABAg.A1wcNx6624wA2OL5RyPEkl

"Great info! My daughter is in the medical field, as I approached my 65th birthday a few months ago...I began asking her about medicare options..she said mom just remember plan C stands for "criminal"...that is how she sees Advantage C plan...criminal...that is all I needed to know as I was going with medigap anyways to have the option to go to any doctor in the country I want as I fee thus is essential as I age!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz0_VOA_xQEg_xA6054AaABAq

"I am 75. I did the math at 65, and every year since then. I have had triple bypass surgery and a knee replacement in that time, plus pain management and physical therapy. I have NEVER even come close to the cost of any Medicare Advantage premiums with my out-of-pocket costs after traditional Medicare pays most of my bills. These plans MAY make financial sense to SOME people, but for me, they make NO financial sense. I love traditional Medicare and my free choice of any doctors I want to see. At this point, I cannot even qualify for an Advantage plan, so it's a moot question in my case. Still, I advise healthy retirees to skip the Advantage plans. Just get Part B and D coverage. I have saved roughly \$60,000 in ten years by choosing NOT to have a Medicare Advantage plan. This, by the way, is a GREAT video. Perfect explanation. Superb examples. Thanks to the creator of this content."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxRMkd2TW-71CFSy0V4AaABAq>

↳ @TrippinWithTim (0): "@geraldarcuri9307 Not sure I understand your post. Most Advantage plans have \$0 cost to you. No premium. And many have a maximum out of pocket cost as low as \$900/year. So if your bills were \$20000 or 2 million dollars your total responsibility would be \$900 for the whole year in worst case. With no monthly premiums. Some have higher limits but most are less than \$5000 if your co pays were to ever reach that. Also, all Advantage plans are guaranteed issue every year. I think you are talking about Supplemental plans like plans N, F, G and all the other letters. Those have very high premiums and usually you have to qualify. Not guaranteed issue...."

↳ @SecondSources (0): "@geraldarcuri9307 I just went on MC and my wife and I pay 50 each for high deductible G."

"I switched to Medicare advantage on January 1st. I switched back to a supplemental plan after watching this episode of John Oliver. I found a similar situation that John had described with my new Medicare advantage insurance plan. I had my primary doctor schedule (referral) a sleep study for me. The sleep center contacted me and told me they did not accept my insurance. I explained that the sleep center was listed on the insurance website as being in network, however, that was not correct. The sleep study center explained that they were not contracted with my insurance. As I found, the Medicare advantage insurance plan has a limited number of available doctors and facilities. Even though the financial incentives are very attractive, I don't want to sacrifice my health. The incentives for the advantage plan includes refunding my monthly Medicare premium, waived the deductible, and included dental and vision. At least now I can see any doctor I want without a referral."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgyVG9Ymah-dmbtFjRB4AaABAq>

"@LeeCountySpeedShop This is exactly what I did. I strongly oppose Medicare Advantage. You get what you pay for. It's cheap for a reason. They can deny care, tests, procedures and they have doctor networks. I can go wherever I want, without pre-approval, and see any doctor I want. I also ended up suddenly in the hospital last year and got diagnosed with an autoimmune disease out of the blue. I was a week in the hospital and paid nothing. I got weekly in home nurse and PT visits for 2months after I was home. Without part D I estimate my drug costs would have been >20,000 last year. Instead my costs were capped at 2000 and everything free after that. I had no clue this was going to happen to me. I have been in doctors offices when people came in with their Medicare advantage cards only to be told that office doesn't accept that plan. People think it's the same as traditional Medicare. It is NOT."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211lpLq6moM&lc=Ugygro_vH19Oogf8kHN4AaABAq.ASpiXZR9M9GAWks_vZXDUG

"Have never had one problem with my Advantage plan. Yes, there is a higher annual out of pocket before everything is covered at 100%, but I have been able to go to any doctor I want, as I have yet to find one that doesn't accept my plan. I do not need referrals for specialists. I am in good health. I take no prescription medications. I only go to dr for annual blood work and check up, and I see an ophthalmologist annually, as well as a dermatologist. For people needing ongoing medical care and Rx, I can see why they would want a Medigap plan. If you are healthy and don't need ongoing medical treatment, then it can be to your advantage to be on an Advantage plan. There is a lot of misinformation going on here about advantage plans. Both Medigap and Advantage have their pros and cons."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugz7ZCg8WF1391OtQdJ4AaABAq.ACWjHW9hH_0AYh2NtRXogp

"I have HDG and incentive to stay healthy. I am relatively healthy and so visit doctor for 100% covered annual wellness visit for preventive care and annual checkup only. My HDG is less than \$40 per month. Some years I do not have to pay full amount of annual deductible. The reason why I want to HDG is to avoid risk for potential bad year to set MOOP. I want to keep original Medicare to be able to go any doctors whoever accept Medicare assignment and I do not want to take chance to delay time critical treatment due to appeal process or deny treatment when it is medically necessary."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgzaP4_nahoAP1rqPgB4AaABAq.ALLt1vWRmfZAMfTp4WYqI2

"I've always stayed away from medicare advantage, but my new pcp suggested uhc so I signed on to their ppo. They have all of my doctors in network, but if one went out of the network it would only cost like ten dollars more, since it's a ppo i could still go see whoever I want. Humana is definitely trash. I can't believe this happened to op. Completely outrageous"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1puvefe/humana_screwed_me_over/nvucp63/

"Just because your healthy doesn't mean you will be next week. Healthy then colon cancer and the esophageal cancer for me, glad I have traditional plan F and have no out of pocket or co pays and go to any doctor I want without referrals. I will keep it and sacrifice anything I need to to keep it that way. No health= no life!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgyZoocucOX58PhVONB4AaABAq>

"@Groundhog-58 I actually get almost all of my medical care from the Indian Health Service. I get primary care and dental and vision plus prescriptions from the pharmacy. I carry Medicare and a plan N because my wife and I do a lot of traveling and I want to be able to go to any doctor that I need to."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=UgyGRM6Xj6lEP5-CRZ14AaABAg.AOBQ33Cxy6xAQg6TpcX14q>

"Both my husband and I have HDG. We do not visit doctors very often; however, if medically necessary we want to have freedom to go any doctor who accepts Medicare assignment and want to be treated with the best care possible."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugy1DghjQypZuQ1oqLB4AaABAg.A2EMIFfllepAMfXVlW7DF1

"I have Medicare Advantage and can see any doctor any time I want. No doctor is "out of network" on my plan. You should be living near a large metro area before choosing a plan with network restrictions."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugz6QArYF74puNK1hyp4AaABAg>

↳ @stevehoge (0): "@markrosenthal9108 please list the details of your provider and state"

Paying less for the same care · 15 documents · 15 voices

"Excellent information. My suggestion, respectfully, when comparing prices, you did not clearly explain that Supplements "Do Not" include prescriptions and will require an additional PD plan. Which is not a big premium but it is additional monthly dollars. Supplemental plans are Superior if the Senior can handle the monthly premiums. I've worked with some seniors who live social security "paycheck to paycheck" and while there are government programs that help assist, they have to decide premiums or food/medication. I love Medicare. I love our country. I love our Seniors. I pray for affordable, excellent medical care plans for ALL. In the meantime, explaining the Medicare plans as you do, is exemplar!!!! You are my hero 🙌🙌🙌"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgyNdbQBZ9WoEBX6e5V4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (5): "The great advantage to having a Stand-Alone Part D plan, rather than bundled with an Advantage plan, is that the consumer can change Part D Plans annually without any impact on their healthcare. With an Advantage Plan, a person can be left having to choose between the healthcare they want, the doctors they want to see, and low Part D costs. Too often, the best of all three is not in one plan. By the way, when comparing PartD plans it's not the premium that is important, it's the total cost of premium plus prescriptions."

↳ @toriless (0): "Yeah, but do you get decent coverage under a PD plan. The regular one is as crappy as a MOA is for their services. I have lost count how many times I have to pay for a medication because it is not covered. I had a doctor write 3 different prescriptions just so I could test each one to see which gets denied. The one that was approved was one that was previously denied a year before. The difference was \$3 vs \$200 and they only paid another \$8 or something."

"Thanks for another great video! I recently switched to a High Deductible Medigap plan. Monthly premium is currently \$67 with an almost \$3,000 out-of-pocket maximum. I'm hoping that it provides the flexibility and predictably that I want with a lower premiums throughout my life. Not too many people choose the High Deductible Medigap plans, but it seems like a good compromise among all the available options."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugx Ct-3YOkOpHjJyLt94AaABA g>

↳ @shirl5953 (6): "YES!!! You found the BONANZA of HDG! Erin did not talk to this but I am hoping she does in her follow up videos!!"

↳ @stevevenn1 (0): "Thx I'm a fan of this kind of choice. A form of mini self insuring just the HD portion. I like that trade off for lower premium."

↳ @scottpearson5871 (0): "If a person has a decently sized (50-100k) HSA this seems to be the best option."

"Hope I'm not too late in posting this. I have a question about the pricing basis that you used for the Plan G and Plan N average premiums. Are they Attained Age pricing, Issue Age pricing, or Community pricing? I have had a Plan N for about 8 or 9 years, now, and live in a Philly suburb; my monthly premium is significantly higher than the average that you quoted (Issue Age pricing, I believe). I'd be grateful for a video that addresses more of the details that go into annual premium adjustments for each of the 3 pricing methods and how that might play out over, say, a 10-year period so that I can guesstimate the total cost of coverage over a longer term. Am wondering whether I want to change to a lower cost policy this year, but don't want to set myself up for ballooning rates over the next several years that end up wiping out any advantage from changing now. Thanks for any thoughts you may have on this topic, and thanks posting this video in which you raise many good points!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugz0A5Y179J8GVLPxKp4AaABA g>

↳ @medicare365 (0): "I appreciate the long question and comment. I can say this with certainty. There is no way for me or anyone else to predict 5 or 10 years from now when it comes to price increases. The truth is attained age, issue age etc is a scam. They all go up in price. The only way to keep the price down is to stay healthy and change your plan every 2 years. Unfortunately, many people believe there is a silver bullet to beat the Medigap increases, but I have been in this space for 20 years and it doesn't happen. The HDG increases have been way less than Plan G and Plan N ... but many people don't like high deductible plans. Hope this helps."

"I am happy that you are pleased and that you are healthy and in your nineties. If you had a Medicare Supplement Plan, your coverage would have been good too, but since you are in your nineties, the premiums would be through the roof. I hope you are using the money you saved by not paying for a Medicare Supplement all these years. Do the math. Yearly cost of Medicare Supplement times years you I wish you the best of life and health."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzzWqANhIEv6bwWtH54AaABA g.Am dEB4j9IblAO14eTen_FC

"I am 78 and have a plan f. Unfortunately, my supplement company has become unstable and has been raising my premium 10% a year for several years. My current monthly premium is \$440. Mo. I would like to change to a different company for a lower premium but am afraid I will not pass underwriting due to my weight. I am 5'2" 300 lbs. Any suggestions? My zip code is 60067."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgwD0BssDok_O_vK1dd4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Hi Beverly, this is quite common with supplement plans. Would you mind sending me an email to erik@90daysfromretirement.com with your zip code? Where you live will impact the answer to that question. Thank you for watching and sharing your experience."

"I'm turning 62 this year and wanted to retire but it looks like the sweet spot is 65, However I can't hardly remember anything anymore, and I would love to save your info but don't know what to do, I can't keep subscribing to every post I come across. But you do seem pretty knowledgeable....."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2I1pLq6moM&lc=UgxyB0M9rcbRs6lq7ed4AaABAq>

↳ @jwheelerww4 (1): "You don't have to subscribe. Just hit save the video"

"I've been on Medicare for 3 years now and am very lucky to have 2 different previous employers supplement the cost of my supplemental coverage. I never understood the difference between supplemental and advantage until viewing your video. I knew advantage was cheaper but did not realize that by signing up for it, you are ending your regular Medicare A and B coverage and putting your trust and health care into the hands of an insurance company who's goal is to maximize profit. Terrifying. My plan F is through Anthem and it goes up significantly each year. It went from \$130 the first year to \$235 per month for 2022. I expect it to continue at that rate but still feel fortunate that I lucked out into picking a coverage that works for me, even though it costs more so far. Your clear explanation of the difference between the types of coverage made me realize why the companies run their non-stop commercials this time of year for their most profitable products."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgzSV2VfWlvEN64bO6F4AaABAq>

↳ @jodyhahn825 (0): "William Lackner you can save a lot of money by switching to Plan G. It is identical to Plan F except with Plan G, you will have to pay the \$233 deductible. After that, it's identical to Plan F. My plan G is with Blue Cross/Blue Shield in MO I am 69 and in 2022 my monthly premium will go up \$6.79 to \$155.68. I'm under the impression that all plans increase as we age so that's why I included my age"

"Your insulting rant on Point #6 is completely false. AARP United has a foreign (albeit limited) benefit. I have not checked any others because I don't have to. When I travel out of the USA I buy a very inexpensive BCBS overseas medical plan for the duration I am over there. Costs less than a nice dinner and covers \$2million. I could carve up some of your comments too, but I don't have the time or the inclination - but I can give many examples of people I know on MA plans who unfortunately get long drawn out minor levels of care or previous generation meds (warfarin vs Eliquis) while my doctors compliment me on having all options open for the best care at the best locations. Sorry, some healthy people can save some bucks using a MA plan, good for them, hope they stay healthy...but I planned to have the best options in retirement and I know MA plans are profitable - and those bucks did not come out of thin air."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/the_hidden_dangers_of_medicare_advantage_plans/k7qpe2g/

"Would love to get your thoughts on supplement plan selection for diligent HSA savers? We should have approximately \$250k in our HSA brokerage and bank accounts at age 65 after staying on HD policies since the HSA program became law. As I understand the current law, HSA funds can be used to pay Part B premiums but not supplement costs. We are relatively healthy but my wife does need knee surgery that was denied by Aetna. Based on that Aetna experience (surgery denied two weeks before the procedure after prior approval) we would NEVER chose an Advantage plan. Thank's for all you do to help us pre-retired folks make wise decisions and hope your sunburn resolves quickly! Best Regards, Leo Melbourne, FL"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugxg7VviP_2WkrJO3Gh4AaABAg

"The one thing I hate about getting old is I now get a sunburn on my bald head. Thank you so much for your breakdown of costs for the different coverage options. I wasn't dealt a good hand for health. Cancer runs in my family. Hereditary is something you didn't address in your video. I have had cancer, and now developing heart trouble unlike family health. Sounds like a plan G is my option until I can't afford the premiums, then I hope I die because I have really no savings. There is no such thing as golden years!!! Again, thanks for tackling such a depressing topic. At 70 years old, and now I see how this all ends drowned as a child would have been better."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugz6elvSILV6tNnK8114AaABAg>

"Blue Postal here. At 9:18 it mentions postal employees being required to sign up for medicare B. However from what I've seen there is an exception for those who are over 64 years old. So they can stay on the FEHB or its successor which is coming into effect this open season. Correct me if you think I am wrong but that is the last that I've heard on all the confusion with the new program. Thanks for the video. I wish I'd seen it earlier as it would have saved me some research time."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugx96a2ZNwLXtmHQQBp4AaABAg>

"SC here, and I'm now paying \$657 a month for Bronze plan with a \$9000 deductible for each of us. 2026 is looking like \$2300+ for same plan. I'm just going to put my money in a separate savings account, and pray neither of us have a big event happen. I'll be 65 next year, and then I'll be on Medicare. Wife is 60, so she's got 5 more years. That is if it is still there for us. 🙄 "

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o9m8gp/2600mth_6k_deductible_for_wife_and_i/nk6khwz/

"Insurance companies are evil and take every opportunity to steal your money and not pay you. We are all better putting our money in the bank for the future. I could retire early if it wasn't for ins companies outrageous rates. So looking forward to 65 and saving \$15k a year just for me."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=UgyEMg2JkQEn82PMuIZ4AaABAg>

"For the year 2026 there was a zero dollar premium for Part D , do you know if they have this for year 2027 ? I did not know and paying \$100 premium for part D for 2026 , I am healthy , so I want \$0 premium for 2027 , Thank you"

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgwRns-VmxdMXIrcEdx4AaABAg>

"At age 65, my companys retirement plan stops paying for health insurance. Im looking forward to saving \$500 per month with better insurance."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgxIBk4EP15H42kpQix4AaABAg>

Dental, vision and hearing covered · 9 documents · 9 voices

"What if you don't want Medicare at all. I was forced to enroll it this scam. I don't do standard medicine. I want Vision Dental a naturopath and natural medicines. I was told I had to enroll in Medicare or I would be penalized. I think I should be entitled to a refund since they don't offer what I want. I am majorly pissed off. I have been paying into the Plan for 50 years..."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugx5OsbJ2vzX0jjoFzJ4AaABAg>

"Thanks! I have a Medicare Advantage plan that I love; but I missed the age 65 window to get Medigap with no underwriting. I have more than one health issue; but my doctor says I'm doing well compared to most people my age. I was thinking about moving near Hopkins but good to know they don't take Medicare Advantage. Medicare/Medigap is now so expensive and the economy so bad I can see why many if not most seniors are on Medicare Advantage. I love my plan. I'm not looking forward to paying 180.00 or more for Medigap, plus out of pocket vision and dental. That will be at least 300.00 out of pocket if not more. What's the point of Medicare then? Medicare is no deal for seniors. It just benefits the insurance companies."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzBDlw8S7yJJKnQKq54AaABAg>

"Well I have a question for you OK they put me on Medicare when I was 55 I was still at the American United healthcare at the hospital that was my primary insurance when I went to the doctor so Mary Kay I've been getting money for me all these years taking out \$144 out of my money and telling me I have so much for dinner I need it now can you help me get it that's about it no OK the people since I've been using America the best since 2018 no they call me every time it's time to come get your teeth cleaned and asked me why because I wanted they want to get the money from you all I know you're gonna be amazed at the point where now sorry I finally put out anywhere you go you're nice lady I finally told the people I'm trying to just come to get my teeth clean I need my breeze don't fit no more OK cause I had leukemia pool so the reason fit normal and I need help OK I talk to the lady she's 50 years old she's a top Medicare person as I can get away at the moment and she told me to talk to the governor because I want him as it is the bottom line OK God bless you are you seem like a real nice lady but I miss you OK I have a BCND I called Medicare they give me a ride to the doctor they give me a ride to get my test I can finish the call me baby we're gonna do all the mamas gonna check for you if you ever want to wear a dress I want to say the mood for my teeth tell my want to eat it's so busy worry about my body it's going to get my quarterly check: Teknowledge the Pap smear because I have a 667578 OK but I don't want it is him so anyway can you help me get my money back with you we got a call the governor I talk to the medical lady she's 58 you gonna see what I feel but she said she had a complaint from people like talking to her she enjoy talking to me because I want to see what y'all got to face your fear OK God bless you pray for your help with Jesus is with 80 will you have reached we have you tell Ray but I have United Health Care supplement ABC D and I go for chronic and well now that's one way to get one of her chronic I don't know if they're on the way I say I will now where is the I got the best where is the damn list a problem tell the governor now they say so I got to talk to I want to money went OK tell him tell him one day it is I need 3000 I paid 15 is that for you OK with the 2000s yeah yeah I work with that word before I need 800 800 did I need 35 did you pay 50 and I paid 1500 for doing this why is he into the network OK God bless you and what is America they not bring up my day as she gets with me back to them OK but still they paid 2500 and why my previous 2000 talk to the governor they say the governor of your state country whatever I don't care where he got it that's all I wanna know where my money yet because I'm waiting to have a business charge me until I need it now but do you date "I feel very reasonable pretty good we're at Marti goes to her let you know what I do you know Heb has an omelette with raisins and ate my egg my day is the cosmetic on my two front teeth he's the want to tell me that they pull my God I'm open for that phrase go out for a ride my teeth and he made me go to pretty cosmetic tea anyway I didn't have medication and I pay for everything made my insurance to hear everything glad to talk to the right to talk if she's smart she's happy she's not ready I want to talk to us about a mile insurance lady she's nice to the neighbor silver now my doctor said that he had a pretend me to describe anything or whatever I'm not even sick but I guess he really is he's a good doctor and I like to Denises it's a big deal between the dogs and Denist you know that I'm a nurse and no no the doctor gonna take care you say you do then he get his money he doesn't yell at you any money I don't get my money OK God bless you oh she's not really she's nice to do OK"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7S-VZXiV>

"Hello Stephanie I live in Maryland. Currently I am eligible for financial assistance for the time been not my choice. Since I am getting this for know and I just 65 so the advantage plan works. I am not collecting social security at moment but I am afraid when I do I will or might loose the assistance. So I am in a rock and a hard place. I will need 3 necessary procedures but been putting them off because I limited on which surgeons I can pick with the advantage plan. Now you work out a price example for plan G in Maryland which includes of course A and B and of D and I would like dental and vision. Do you have any plans for me that would make sense for using plan G those other coverages I need. Currently my max for in network is 8,000.00 per year. Any suggestions? I am worried and concerned. Do I need to spell out my email or can you see it on your side. Thank you."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwszfVUPldZ477apQh4AaABAg>

"I have Medicare and anthem Blue Cross is my Supplementary insurance. My Anthem premium is 268.00 per month. I do not have dental or hearing. I will be 90 on the first of December and I am fearful of jumping around and discovering later I made a mistake. I'm on a fixed income and when I pay all my insurances and credit cards and taxes, there is not much left. I do wish I had some help with dental for dental hygiene, etc. Do you have any suggestions or do you think I'm doing the best I can? STEPHANIE WHAT DO YOU THINK?"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzB9wGtjWm2yVNotlI4AaABAg>

↳ @tonyalexa1120 (0): "Hello 🙌 Roberta... How are you doing today? And happy 😊 thanksgiving to you and your family over there! 😊 "

"I have united healthcare advantage dual plan, my plan decreased in 2025, dental, vision, OTC, looks like my going have to visit dental regardless once a year, on my vision, hell where to go to get yearly vision testing, and new glasses that's not going to go over 350, that's going to be impossible, the OTC amount from 187, to160 for food, hope snap program increases , but I doubt it, that's government, well what can u do, can't fight the government"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1f93bec/anyone_else_receive_their_2025_annual_notice_of/lrjypxh/

"@davidcarp5935 I'm healthy. I do I take 2 meds regularly, had a Ct scan, cot Az one shot, knee physical therapy and never pay a cent. My dental, vision, check ups free. If I want glasses or contact I pay. Medicare allows me 4 free classes in any workout center nearby!"

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugz5U0NbhmvpnoEB4BI4AaABAg.A2dSZGiXINyA2kpeBFxRCC>

"@policyguides Most of us have been on HMOs our whole working lives. None of MAs quirks (like preauths, etc) are new. I wish I could afford a supplement but with adding Part D, Dental, Vision on top of the Supplement, its a fools errand to go that route."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugwihp7iSAC2y-eYfCB4AaABAg.AM8sjxPZkEXAOhL5HIINZ-

"Keith, Great video but wish you could have touched on dental that Advantage covers. I'm on original Medicare but paying through the nose for crowns."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxUCr0DDomjitobiBN4AaABAq>

Getting it right the first time · 6 documents · 6 voices

"I don't have an anecdote. I just want to learn as much as I can about Medicare before I turn 65. I've been learning about it for 2 years now and I still learn something new every time I watch a video. I'm pretty sure I will go with the supplement. I don't like networks. Plus doctors can leave a network at anytime leaving you to start over with a new doctor. Whoever says they want Medicare for all doesn't know Medicare at all."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgynpQyRNd5K2lg6N-Z4AaABAq>

"I agree completely! I'm so glad I requested a quote for my wife recently, and that you reached out to us personally and debunked some of the inaccurate info we had already received from a retiree trust that we were planning to use. I'm very happy with the supplement plan that you and your staff helped us choose, and I'm looking forward to doing it again when I turn 65 next year. Thanks Matthew!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugz0w8k5IZqJSnvw85d4AaABAq.9UjnTroRTKC9UkReofVKaZ>

"Thanks for providing this great info! I'm turning 64 in April this year and still working for my own solo LLC on a long term contract. I use ACA insurance now but hoping I can use Medicare when I turn 65. I make a very good living well into the low 6- figures and am also earning passive income from a digital publishing biz I set up. Should I delay taking Medicare if I'm still working a year from now? 😊 I just assumed I'd be eligible at 65 for Medicare even as a solo entrepreneur ?? Is it tied to my income or is it my right upon turning 65?"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgzhMS8ScBvMQ6a00Yx4AaABAq>

"I know the first time I ever had a UTI and pull anything I want to go to the jazz festival down in Houston that afternoon when I first became a nurse and I knew this medical student he was going to school to be a dentist and he put it he told me a pull my name up I want to be out for a weekend he told me I need my full wisdom tooth so he pulled them off all went down there today and I have a knack with you but now I said now OK and the universe is yours that I called his people they tell me insurance for the agents to Shema started to say 123 pool OK now but I have I will get Medicare thing and she told me theylt's nice that they told me they give me \$500 OK name and I'll go for the x-rays so yeah the 400 wouldn't want to eat she won't tell me what I did he wanted something he doesn't know kind of programs out there I got all the phone number babe relieve me a call around then as soon as I am afraid is calling that Medicaid they call it a boom boom boom boom boom they get everything they won't know they got my money or if I want my money from the time I was 55 on American you tell him you're my baby enough to pay the dentist do you think I need to get a lawyer that will leave you alone it was amazing that we are the same batch as governor they told me the governor's fault but now that my money roll over and I'll kind of stuff I had to put my foot down baby what is your name Stephanie know that I want to call me to clean with clean Mathis a possibility kind of stuff I told Medicare I'm at La Quinta marina Tato next week I don't know what I want to get real time ago that's why 3NNJEJ OK God bless you she's not sure she tried to go to"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7qE4D49X>

"Erin, your explanation is better than any I have seen, including all the YT channels devoted to choosing Medicare plans. I wish I had this when I was making my decision last July, but it was still helpful today because it helped me confirm I did make the right decision, even if it was somewhat a gut decision at the time."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugw8gHpPD4OMDfixMUx4AaABAg>

"Still confused. Should L564 and 40D forms be filled and submitted before 65 or SEP at 67 if I want to retire from my company and its health insurance at age 67?"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxjGSrqynnx5qDlqPJ4AaABAg>

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

A spouse on a different plan or losing coverage together · 28 documents · 20 voices

"OK. Now I am just turning 65 and I have some things to add. My wife was 71 when I had to retire to take care of her. When I did so, I lost my health insurance. I enrolled in COBRA and it was damned expensive. Had I known then what I know now, I may have chose differently. Both insurances together were 1600 a month, which is a horrible price to pay, but it was an approved plan so she slid onto part B with no problem. Here's the thing. She went to the hospital and the finance people were telling me that BCBS was the primary and Medicare was the secondary, this is just information. COBRA through your former employer is the secondary payer and Medicare is primary payer. Hope this helps when choosing what to do. It doesn't matter now. RIP Linda B. 07/16/23 I miss ya baby. Thanks for 45 years. It was worth everything we went through. (I made a couple of edits because I made some mistakes on the post. Thanks to youtube for allowing me to edit. 🙏 "

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙏 · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzLz7ljSVYL8z78XYJ4AaABAg>

↳ @zebragiraffe1 (10): "You must have been a great husband. Sorry for your loss."

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "My team would be happy to assist you. Give us a call at 800-864-8890 or schedule an appointment at www.medicareschool.com"

↳ @djmydlack (1): "Hi. Thanks so much for posting. Could you say what you'd done differently? My wife is dying of ALS and I may be forced to retire to care for her. Thank you."

"Very well done. You did your homework. I'm 66 this year. I had to do a LOT of research to decide what was best for me. I agree about choosing for my future me. That said: I have a high deductible G plan in place (55.00 mon) in case I get very sick or have an accident but I spend a couple hundred a month (about what I'd pay for regular G premium 210.00) to take care of my metabolic health the way i want to. I use functional medicine, naturopath, no conventional drugs, acupuncture, massage therapy and supplements that are not covered by Medicare on any level. My husband died at 58 from a liver disease and a transplant. We had an HMO. I refuse to do it that way for myself. It was a chaotic, frustrating and terrifying experience for both of us. I know that if I'm hit with a chronic disease or accident I'll be set. So I chose ease of mind over just dollars. Everyone does it different. My parents have always done an advantage plan"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwDoFtNU8GrgWx3-O94AaABAg>

"I'm currently 66 and my wife is 11 years younger than I am. We had a bunch of kids so we had no tax liability for many years. I invested solely in a Roth IRA for many years. I retired at age 61 and rolled my company retirement into a traditional IRA. I made a few Roth conversions in the first couple of years of retirement. Then my wife's company moved overseas so she retired too. Now, I'm on Medicare but my wife has about ten years before she is eligible so she is on the ACA. We take money from my traditional IRA and supplement it with money from my Roth IRA. She gets a tax credit each year that reduces her premiums to around \$50 a month. I am waiting until 70 for my Social Security. I have already looked at RMDs but we don't have millions so it's not that big of a deal. Once I'm on Social Security, I may do some Roth conversions at that time. I would like to get all of my pretax accounts by the tax man before I pass away so my wife is not caught in the widows tax trap."

— YouTube · The Surprising Truth About ACA Subsidies and Your Retirement! · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3WkluzzgD14&lc=Ugz79XRd2gGJQgd0JF14AaABAg>

↳ @davidmarshall1094 (0): "I'm five years behind you, but with a very similar situation. I've gotten advice not to do Roth conversions (from two different advisors) and also not to touch Roth until much later in retirement. I'm going to have deeper discussions on this, but I could draw down my entire Roth account during this subsidy period if necessary. The cost of ACA without a subsidy is comically high (it actually angers me how this system works)."

"Couldn't agree more. We are approaching that age, and are fortunate to have our future MediGap needs met by the spouse's military retirement benefits, but this makes me even more convinced that I would not have signed up for Medicare Advantage if we didn't have TriCare available to us."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRIqEu63hvwv4AaABAg.ATSYgYfhd1hATTBWyFJe4v>

"Me and my husband are in a fight. He turns 65 in July 2026 and has full coverage health insurance through his employer. The company has thousands of employees. He plans to work past 65. He loves his job. He still says he plans on signing up for Medicare when he turns 65 because he has to per 'Medicare rules', and just not use it, and continue health insurance through his employer. I say he doesn't have to sign up and if he does, Medicare will start because he signed up for it and he'll have to pay for it. So which is it? He signs up when he turns 65 but doesn't use it and gets charged or doesn't get charged? He says if he doesn't sign up when he's 65 he'll be penalized. I say he won't because he has health insurance already. Can someone please help? I'm tired of bickering with him. LOL"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=Ugyb_hEdA7WmhsXa-214AaABAg

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "I love that I get to settle this dispute and tell you... YOU ARE RIGHT! He can delay Medicare without penalty. 😊"

↳ @cattastroficka (0): "@AbtInsuranceAgency Thank you for answering. 😊"

"I am younger than my husband and am on his health insurance since I don't work. He is getting ready to retire and it looks like his company offers something called under 65 retiree insurance that I believe covers spouses and dependents. I am pretty blue since I cannot find any information about this kind of insurance and honestly don't know if we will have to go out to the marketplace for coverage. It makes it super hard to plan for retirement - meaning whether he should continue to work for family coverage or can retire without worrying about spending extra greenbacks for us."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugyb4DYelkCeDg6HWCv4AaABAg>

"I agree i can't afford a supplement right now have no choice to be on advantage plan.. My husband passed im 67. He died at 52...im a hairdresser and still having to work...after covid we got slow make way less...have husbands ss but just meets bills...medicare stinks why is gov in our insurance...was on medicade but ss set me off for too much to receive medicade by 200..but yet people who are illegal get covered..sad and unfair..was greatfull for medicade really was a blessing.."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwnnXAcJzUJhCSBVHB4AaABAg.AOiDD20EzJ_ATNBiTI9xS

"I have Medicare A/B. I became disabled at 58. My husband works for a large company. According to the CMS official book my husband's commercial company is my primary. However, it has been a constant fight with my husband's insurance. They keep saying I have Medicare so they aren't paying. They say they are secondary. I finally told them to turn to page 21 in the 2025 book and you will see. It has taken me hours with two different insurance companies since 2019."

— YouTube · Medicare Explained in Plain English — Every Part, Every Cost, Every Decision · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ooZKCnbXw-M&lc=Ugy4iNo7PbsPB5r7YJZ4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "This is so unfortunate! Sorry you have had to deal with that!"

"We are with an Advantage plan here in California. It's been great, and we have few needs and are in great health. However, for future planning, we are ready to make the switch and are finally ready to pay a monthly fee for a supplemental plan. I only take a \$5 blood pressure pill at age 72; my wife takes nothing. We will wait until Oct 15th and will follow up with another comment. I hope not to have any underwriting issues."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwFy-hynbA4bTEj6l54AaABAg>

"My thanks for just about the best explanation of the differences yet. Clear, concise and easy to listen to with no "histrionics". Finally, I have the ammunition to fight my wife's leanings toward the "advantage plan?" The part about future qualification is not well known and the fact the insurance company has total control over my health is completely unacceptable. Thanks again!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgxNX8sdBgbG5wjIqUh4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "Both the 2018 and 2022 Inspector General (IG) Reports on Advantage Plans are linked on this page: <https://medigapseminars.org/resources/>;

"Anecdote. I am getting ready to go onto Medicare between 6-18 months depending on my wife's employment. We are leaning heavily toward Plan G with drug coverage when I and my wife go onto Medicare. But, it is scary to navigate thru all the BS that is out there. However, I am going to start following you as you have one of the best that I have seen...so far. 😊 "

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=Ugy-W10bsIBFbmKJd6F4AaABAg>

↳ @marct9587 (0): "I switched from a Plan G to a Plan N after two years. My plan G monthly premium was going up significantly every year and was going to go up to \$168/month. Fortunately, I was able to switch to a Plan N with a monthly premium of \$78/month. Thus, that represents a savings of over \$1,000 per year. Now, with Plan N, after you meet your Medicare deductible, you can be charged a \$20 co-pay per doctor visit, but I only go the doctor two or three times a year, so that is \$40 to \$60 dollars. Thus, I am saving a bunch of money with Plan N."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Appreciate you watching and saying that! Happy to help however we can. It is a lot of junk to wade through :("

"Excellent video. Do the cancer plans pay every year after cancer? My wife has been fighting cancer since 2007. Luckily we have a special employer provided Advantage plan with a max of \$150 or we would be broke. Year after year cancer treatment can be devastating."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgxzgQnSMP60oLR3IU4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "A few arrangements. Some are 1 and done. Some are the initial payout and then it builds back up again over time and will pay again if a 2nd, separate diagnosis happens."

"@t3angling575—First, Medicare is NOT mandatory for everyone. It is simply a medical insurance option—except for the free Part A (hospitalization) which I guess could be looked at as automatic when a person reaches age 65, or earlier in the event of disability. Medicare Part A is free, while Medicare Part B is not. You do not have to sign up for Medicare Part A, but you do have to sign up for Medicare Parts B if you want to those coverages of Parts B, C and D. Therefore, if you have adequate medical insurance and do not foresee a time when you would change your carrier, there is no problem NOT signing up and NOT paying for Medicare Part B. However, if at some time 30-years down-the-road you decide you want Medicare Part B, but did not sign up for it at age 65, the premiums will be higher. Some commentators like to call this a “penalty” to scare people into paying for something at age 65 that they probably do NOT require. Calculate the benefit for yourself. Tricare For Life is a wrap around coverage to Medicare, not a first line insurance. It requires one to first pay for Medicare Part B (to wrap around). Second: VA enrollment IS technically medical insurance, although rather than insurance benefits, the VA provides medical treatment for the price of a deductible. VA enrollment is not open to dependents. For those at the higher end of the “deductible” scale, the deductible is about \$25 for a primary care visit and \$50 for specialty visits, and about \$9 for a 90-day supply of medications. So the options seem something like pay a \$25+ deductible for medical services (insurance) when medical services are provided (and zero when not)—or pay up to thousands of dollars each month even when no services were provided. Third: Yes, a military retiree’s ID card “expires” at 65 unless they buy Medicare Part B, but how often does a valid retiree ID card provide a \$200+ per month benefit? And probably no one prohibits me from carrying an expired military retiree ID card—especially if my dependent has a “valid” card. Also, the lack of Medicare coverage has NO impact on my Social Security and it has no impact on military retirement pay. Fourth: the expiration of a sponsor’s ID card at 65 does not impacts the expiration of a dependent’s card. But, since TLF is only a wrap around policy to Medicare, I guess the spouse would first have a need for Medicare Part B anyway (VA enrollment does not extend to a dependent). So, one would have to decide whether a “valid” military ID card in one’s wallet provide over \$200 of benefits each month to cover the difference between VA medical treatments and Medicare or other medical insurance. At the age of 75 (sometimes earlier), the sponsor is then eligible to obtain a “permanent” DOD ID card, but again, for TFL one would then have to first buy Medicare Part B—otherwise, just opt for the free VA (the VA benefit for which you already paid by pledging your life). The dependent’s eligibility for TFL is not dependent on the “validity” of the sponsor’s ID card, and if the dependent had Medicare Part B, TFL would probably wrap it. Confused, yet?"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugwr4SA7dId9ed7_6d4AaABAg.AWfIlIS2vgcfAX2bZSqJWl

"Medicare Advantage is great for healthy people. Medicare Supplements are great for sick people. My wife recently racked up 200 grand in medical bills, multiple hospitals and specialists. Multiple ambulance trips between hospitals. Then nursing care and back into acute care, then rehab and months of in home PT, durable medical equipment etc. We have original Medicare and G supplement. Our total cost (after the Part B deductible of 200.00 bucks) ZERO, NADA, NOTHING! There was one piece of equipment that wasn't covered, but Medicare told us that since the provider didn't tell us that it wouldn't be covered, because they didn't take Medicare assignment, we didn't have to pay for it! And they contacted us and told us before we ever knew it wasn't covered!! Our case manager kept telling us how fortunate we were to have original Medicare and a supplement. She said people with Advantage Plans are constantly on the phone fighting for coverage, arguing with insurance. We were never on the phone arguing with anyone once. All we had to worry about was my wife getting better. The doctors ordered it, Medicare paid for it. Period."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyYD0Su0JT2-8sO63d4AaABAg.9VelwLFh7JA9e9hFhr1dEM>

"Baby I got a Medicare supplement ABC Andy got caught with my idol 18 it's OK I don't understand it but I understand believe me and that was the deal I have no problem with the mayor here in America my doctor takes care of me OK you know I was a nurse you know I have been on location was like this here I know that he was always getting my other insurance before temperature my husband died in the house my ex-husband two years whatever is the pay my insurance because he would've made it we made with with me so now I'm worried about the down the down the down"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyBkJtVKzVYVBMBq6B4AaABAg>

"At age's 69 and 68 for my Wife and I on original medicare were we had Medical at zero cost to us as our suppliment and then due to the 3% raise in Social Security Retirement we got switched from zero cost to a "share of cost" for Medical of \$1,779 per month? That would cover anything, (a million dollars?), and we would only pay that \$1,779. Can we keep the Medical "share of cost" and get a suppliment insurance to cover Medicare 20%. This all is very confusing and my Wife of 48 years is fighting endometrial cancer."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxcsesQN1B-1WWauU14AaABAg>

"I left my job in Fort Worth in 2002 and moved to the family farm in Gorman Texas My wife got sick with lung cancer in 2016 and Passed away late 2017.I had just turned 62 and started to draw my benefits unable to work so i could care for her.I got part at 62 could not afford part B trying to take 180 from my check each month. now i have signed up for part B what will that help me with moving forward.I will be seeing my doctor on a regular basis with mri and other test to be done how is part be gona help me"

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgzuxY0rXyE4IJQbQEN4AaABAg>

"I am 72 years old, working full time, and covered by my wife's Federal Government Retirement medical insurance which has covered all my needs. I do have Part A, do I need to apply for Part B? My wife's insurance will still cover me even if she passes before I do. So, since I am covered by my wife's policy, do I really need part B. If I do retire from full time work, will I be hit by the part B penalty because I'm still covered by my wife's plan?"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYl75xJnKg&lc=Ugx7IXqRgt5dIArqE-V4AaABAg>

"Well, I know more about health insurance than I care to. My husband passed away from cancer earlier this year, and i knew a lot beforehand, but I got a crash course in health insurance going through it. Part of the reason I am moving from an MAP to Original medicare is because I realize now we got lured in by the shiny objects that MAPs offered. One catastrophic illness is enough to tell me MA was a big mistake"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o4myrw/do_i_really_need_an_agent_to_buy_a_medigap_plan/nj3bkye/

"Years ago my wife died. I then signed up for Social Security survivors benefits. I was forced to enroll in Medicare part A. I didn't know that if I didn't immediately enroll in Parts B, D and Medigap that my Medigap premiums would be higher later when I did retire and enroll. I should have enrolled in parts B, D and Medigap immediately even though I had an employer health plan."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyirWbHJA4-xKH8Afd4AaABAg>

Watching a parent get denied or billed · 7 documents · 7 voices

"The information that you provided about Advantage plans was truly appreciated. After my father passed away a few years I can see the the true rhino's advantage for him. Dad had advantage. He was never sick in his life so it was a good plan for him. The disadvantage was when he did have a problem the choice of long term facilities was between two places, both of which I was not impressed with. Unfortunately, he did not come home. I blame the 'long term' facility they had a one size fits all approach. They ignored the information from the hospital. The last bills we received would have bankrupted my family. The advantage insurance company paid about 90%. Personally, I do not want to die the way he did. I would rather step in front of a train than to die the way he did. For myself I have about 7 months to decide and I can see that the Supplemental Option might be the best. I am not rich but. I do not care to have some dictating what I can and cannot have."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyIrD8QIO779A8NufB4AaABAg>

"Great video!! Have a known cost vs unknown. I have watched so many older family members literally blow \$100,000+ with Medicare fighting cancer with in-network and out of network drama and fighting for 4-5 years and still dying....For sure have a known cost per year with an advantage plan and a cancer policy vs unknown....It's just not worth it to have the risk of not having it.... My Mom died in 2021 and we are still getting bills-so much drama.... Hope your Mom makes a fully recovery!!!"

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=Ugx0gk1y0sGnSUi2Fwx4AaABAg>

"Sunburn This was a great video, thank you. My Dad who is now 81 had Plan N for YEARS, but decided this year to go with an Advantage Plan because he's relatively healthy and rarely to never uses medical facilities or providers. My uncle and all his friends constantly brag about being on an Advantage plan and the savings they're realizing. My mother, however, passed away from cancer and Plan N saved them financially. At 54, I'm just now beginning to look at all the options, but it looks like Plan N or Plan G are both great options that protect the family financially if something goes seriously off the rails with your health. I work in healthcare and see these patients every day that I'm working, unfortunately. I see many Network Providers and/or Facilities changing and aligning themselves with different Networks, as well, in an effort to gain better reimbursement. It looks like Plan G or Plan N may be the best option for someone like me who wants to cover their bases "just in case". Thanks again."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 90 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyjNvAAWfHsIX0ho5p4AaABAg>

↳ @Simsane (26): "I chose Plan G. It's not cheap (I pay \$224 a month) but when my husband ended up in the hospital for aspiration pneumonia and... something about an infection in the sack around his right lung, Plan G covered everything except the once a year deductible of only \$240 (that was in 2024) even though all kinds of things went wrong. He died on the 22nd day in the hospital 💔😭 but at least I didn't end up having to sell my house to pay hospital bills."

↳ @Therespea1652 (18): "I just worked with a client who needed to decide between MAdv. or a Med Supp....his wife, a hospital nurse, was with him and told him stories of the delays and outright denials with certain conditions.....he went with a Plan N!"

↳ @Mockduck2020 (14): "Thank you for your video, but please don't use light colored markers like the light blue one..."

"Don't let the Supplemental Plan G premium scare you. My dad passed away in January at Age 87 & his Plan G premium was \$259.00 a month & he had a lot of medical problems. We are in Ohio so that might vary but that Plan G was worth it. In 2024 Dad had 3 stays in the Hospital of 1 WEEK each stay & 1 Surgery with that. I was his POA & took care of his finances & I don't remember paying ANY hospital bills. Twice my sister called & said the hospital tucked a bill in with his stuff. I called the billing lady at the hospital & explained he had Medicare & Plan G & she said they weren't supposed to send that bill & I could shred it."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 13 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgzK-Y83ePaw5Otgo5p4AaABAg>

"CATS 🐱 are the coolest and I loved your video and learned a lot. My dad just passed away a week ago and thank goodness he had a supplement plan. I'm not so worried about my mom getting hit with bills she can't pay. Now I'm looking for a supplement plan for her. She never goes to the doctor for anything but she is turning 70 next month so it will most likely be inevitable that she needs to at some point. Before my dad passed he asked me to just transfer his supplemental insurance over to her but now that I'm learning more about this, I don't think that is how this works. His was 290.00 per month but that seemed really expensive to me so I wanted to shop around but from the sound of it that is probably a normal cost for a 77 year old man."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 1 likes · family member helping · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgyK2quSAF_PHMK-2up4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you for watching, and I'm sorry to hear about your dad. That is never easy. Depending on your state, that cost could be well within what's "normal" for a 77-year-old."

"That's why it's important to know that when you first become eligible to Medicare, you can choose a supplement and not have to go through underwriting - from what I understand, though, that's your only chance - I kind of knew what I should do from having helped take care of my parents - they had Plan F & never, ever got a bill"

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugz3yC55BWBZz1bxVFh4AaABAq.9T-k43UiJC19T8l-Glcq-u>

"Someone convinced my dad to switch from traditional medicare to medicare advantage. He also has a secondary insurance from private federal retiree benefit that he doesnt pay for (through my mom). Why would he switch and is there a way he can go back? Im concerned because he needs reoccurring medical services"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · family member helping · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugy884IJRiBaBHL7s_F4AaABAq

↳ @policyguides (2): "It happens a lot — people get talked into Medicare Advantage without realizing how it affects their care, especially when they already have solid retiree coverage. Your dad probably switched because MA plans are marketed as “all-in-one” with low premiums. But if he needs recurring medical care, MA can lead to network limits, prior authorizations, and higher out-of-pocket costs. Can he go back? Yes. If he's still within his first 12 months on Medicare Advantage, he has a trial right to return to Original Medicare and get a Supplement with no underwriting. If he's past 12 months, he can still return to Original Medicare, but getting a Supplement may require medical underwriting depending on the state. Since he has federal retiree benefits, those usually work best with Original Medicare — not MA — so it's definitely worth looking into. If you want help walking through his options, give us a call at 888-231-2465 and we'll clarify everything."

↳ @angiewoods9697 (0): "@policyguidesthanks so much. Ill call you. I appreciate this so much"

↳ @ppoonjr (0): "Why do you lump all the companies offering Medicare Advantage plans together and make them out to be so bad? You should be more truthful and acknowledge that some of these insurance companies offer both Medicare Advantage AND Medicare Supplement plans. What you are doing is very close to being unethical because you are misleading people about Medicare Advantage!"

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

'Advantage plans are a scam' · 48 documents · 20 voices

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"Should we just not mention Medicare Advantage plans here? Do you all see this group as solely about Medicare, only? Because if I say anything positive about Advantage plans, or heck, even mention them, I get downvoted. If Medicare Advantage plan discussions aren't welcome here, that's fine. But some clarity on this would be welcome."

— r/medicare · 82 upvotes · None

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAq>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgzhQ6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAq.AOmGYDg472zAOmUZITAtAk>

"I wanted expert advice before I went on Medicare. So I hired a consultant. She call Medicare Advantage Medicare Disadvantage and told me to stay away from it. Why? Because it isn't real Medicare. It's private insurance that can end up making you go bankrupt. So I went with traditional Medicare with Part G supplement. I've never spent a dime out of pocket. Im glad I rejected Advantage. Rye largest hospital in my area announce last year that they were dropping out of Advantage. So have more than half of the areas physicians. This has left a lot of people without good healthcare choices. And I don't live in podunk. I live in a major metropolitan area with a population of over 6 million."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugy-HagNdaMnA1ecAZ14AaABAq>

↳ @memyself9037 (4): "@gurnblanston5000 not if you buy part G. If pays all part A and B deductables."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (2): "Still pay deductibles."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (1): "@memyself9037got it...D was cheaper here even with deductibles."

"i advise NOONE to go with advantage plans. ive worked in dr office for 23 years and can tell you "stories" where the client was not educated on what they were getting. granted , there are probably a few clients that an advantage plan in "ok". ive had plan g for 5 yrs since turning 65 ive never seen a bill for anything outside of my premium every month. it is expensive but worth it in long run. you may think you dont need it today, but you never know what is coming "down the road""

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxRkoEC_Bnkc_By0L54AaABAq

"I switched to Medicare advantage when they lied to me on the phone and told me all the medications I was taking were covered. MULTIPLE WERE NOT! A year later I switched back to regular Medicare never looking back."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyqXuqZdiY16Hpur3J4AaABAq>

↳ @mscoyote50 (1): "You're lucky. Once you're padt a year, you really can't switch back without underwriting and most of us older people have underlying "conditions"..."

"This is definitely the best discussion I've seen regarding the cost-benefit differences of (Original Medicare + Medigap) vs Medicare Advantage I've ever seen. I wish the government would send this video out each year to new retirees since the later-years "switch-and-bait" of being denied a Medigap policy when your health fails you (intentional??) isn't that clear. Corporations are profit-scraping beasts and no way will "managed" healthcare ever be cheaper than Original Medicare in the long run. When I was 65, I told myself "Yes, it's cheaper now, but when you really need it, Medicare Advantage will take your home". I'm extremely comfortable with the knowledge today that my medical costs will not really increase much if and when my health declines. My mindset has always been to pay a little more now, to pay a lot less later and this has never failed me. EXCELLENT presentation."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz_U0ILpg-QVy8m6FR4AaABAg

"My dr told me to never get MA plan ever"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwH5qzkkOF25XSqRt4AaABAg>

"Just a caution about switching from an Advantage Plan to A supplement. Make sure your advantage plan is explicitly cancelled or you may end up with both a supplement plan and an advantage plan and no drug plan. This happened to me. United Health automatically enrolled me after I was enrolled in a supplement. But when I tried to enroll in a drug plan, I was denied on the last day of the enrollment period. By the. It was too late to fix. A quirk of the system. Ended up having to get ugly about cancelling the MA plan in January, pay for a month of it and start my drug plan Feb 1. I even had chat records where United Healthcare's reps, 3 of them, told me my MA plan was cancelled. Even had a screenshot one of them shared with me that showed it was cancelled. But come January 1, I was welcomed to a United Healthcare MA plan. I was livid. But there were no options to undo United Healthcare's actions."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgyEXYhFKfZjy5FJf2F4AaABAg>

↳ @afrocraft1 (0): "Sorry about your experience. What did your annual notice of change (ANOC) say? That's the document that matters, not chat logs."

↳ @techadsr (0): "@afrocraft1 The ANOC was received before the enrollment period and before I started enrollment into a Supplement plan away from the Advantage Plan. Why would that matter?"

↳ @lyndayoung8761 (0): "The letter from the Carrier that states they are pulling out of MA in your area is your Golden Ticket to medigap without underwriting. Other changes are business as usual as they morph and jockey about with Extra Benefits and copay costs to get your attention PICK ME, PICK ME"

"My broker told me that with Medigap (supplemental) the doc makes the decisions...Not the insurance company Medicare Advantage...Expect delays while the insurance company figures out how to screw you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_9pWXe1A8BazF6EI4AaABAg

"Avoid Sunburn as great risk for melanoma. I would like folks to check statistics for the average healthy 65 year old, which is the usual year that folks make their initial decisions. what percent are going to hospitalized? I believe far less than 1%. hence if you are healthy, medicare adv is great for the first few years after retirement. insurance companies reap huge profits off medicare supplement. I have worked as a physician and for both non-profit and for profit insurance. at the non profit, they know that they make much more \$\$ off medicare supplement and specifically told us not to promote medicare advantage. brokers make more money off med supplement too. your video was actually was very informed and very balanced. 99% better than most video and clearly unbiased. By the way, most folks that have cancer (unless the worst types) is much less than \$300k..more like \$100k for many standard breast or colon cancers. I also study high cost claimants so I see the worst of the worst but that is only for about 1-5% of seniors. thanks for your nice job."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwRYVtBbILppXE7clJ4AaABAg>

"A broker in Nashua, NH, told me several years ago that an Advantage plan is good unless you need it. The Advantage scheme is a scam. Its purpose is to move the country off Medicare and privatize all health insurance."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugz-kN-jQS9K-v2zAoJ4AaABAg>

↳ @billjones4986 (0): "Yep I have one it's fine if your healthy need it for something major another story."

"Over here in Puerto Rico 🇵🇷 , I'm in good health, but the advantage plan, tries forcing you to visit a network doctor, I tell them I'm in good health, I'll go to a doctor, when I'm feeling sick etc"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugzg7RmeU7o68Xo63FJ4AaABAg>

"This was very informative! I had seen commercials on Medicare Advantage during enrollment periods and it sounded good but now that you have explained it, not so good. As a matter of fact, I went to see my Orthopedic Doctor at HSS and on his door there was a big sign that said, as of September 2025 I will no longer be accepting Medicare Advantage Plans. I shared this with my Physical Therapist and he said, I don't blame him. He told me regular insurance pays \$80 max for PT per session but Medicare Advantage Plan only pay up to \$55 per patient/session. So I guess with that plan you won't get the best of the best. I had a top Orthopedic do a hip surgery for me in 2024 and the other in 2025 and everything was covered. I retired in 2023 at age 60 but still under my company insurance plan until I qualify for Medicare at 65."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugxk_hj5q44d4JgjsiR4AaABAg

↳ @nevergoquietly-v4y (3): "I knew years ago if they were trying to get you off original Medicare run by the government, and they wanted you to switch to a privately owned company you would be getting screwed. I've heard nothing but complaints from patients in the waiting room I've talked too in the last 5 years. Denied claims. Dr's waiting to get paid. And receptionist with a sign in the counter as of blah blah, we no longer except Medicare advantage plans. No thanks"

"I am 75. I did the math at 65, and every year since then. I have had triple bypass surgery and a knee replacement in that time, plus pain management and physical therapy. I have NEVER even come close to the cost of any Medicare Advantage premiums with my out-of-pocket costs after traditional Medicare pays most of my bills. These plans MAY make financial sense to SOME people, but for me, they make NO financial sense. I love traditional Medicare and my free choice of any doctors I want to see. At this point, I cannot even qualify for an Advantage plan, so it's a moot question in my case. Still, I advise healthy retirees to skip the Advantage plans. Just get Part B and D coverage. I have saved roughly \$60,000 in ten years by choosing NOT to have a Medicare Advantage plan. This, by the way, is a GREAT video. Perfect explanation. Superb examples. Thanks to the creator of this content."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxRMkd2TW-71CFSy0V4AaABAg>

↳ @TrippinWithTim (0): "@geraldarcuri9307 Not sure I understand your post. Most Advantage plans have \$0 cost to you. No premium. And many have a maximum out of pocket cost as low as \$900/year. So if your bills were \$20000 or 2 million dollars your total responsibility would be \$900 for the whole year in worst case. With no monthly premiums. Some have higher limits but most are less than \$5000 if your co pays were to ever reach that. Also, all Advantage plans are guaranteed issue every year. I think you are talking about Supplemental plans like plans N, F, G and all the other letters. Those have very high premiums and usually you have to qualify. Not guaranteed issue...."

↳ @SecondSources (0): "@geraldarcuri9307 I just went on MC and my wife and I pay 50 each for high deductible G."

"So glad I listened to friends who told me not to get an advantage plan when I turned 65. So glad."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugwsqy61fcc1W4xCgp4AaABAg>

↳ @nealkshah (0): "yes! I tell everyone i know the same thing!"

"@rickarmstrong9660 i'm glad you think you found the plan that would work best for you, but it doesn't sound like you had a very good advantage plan if it was going to cost you thousands of dollars. When I had my bypass I was in the hospital for 13 days and I only had to pay \$1,500 out of 13 days and hundreds of blood tests, the surgery, doctors, and all preparations for my surgery. This was way back in 2014 under a Humana plan. However, when I went through breast cancer I did have to pay quite a bit more because of my out of pocket cap was quite high. Then I switched to a better advantage plan with a much lower out-of-pocket max just for that reason. This is why you've got to do your research on all of these advantage plans and talk directly to that company - not a sales rep like they advertise on tv. I was in the hospital for one day this past year and only had to pay \$80 for several heart screening tests, labs, ER and this included the overnight stay. I pay no monthly premiums on hospital, doctor care or my part D drugs. All of my drugs so far are 100% covered for heart and cancer that I have to take. I have 100% coverage on antibiotics such as tetracycline (try finding a plan that covers that expensive drug!). My cap is \$2,900 at most for any out of pocket expense including if I were to get a new cancer and need treatment. As I said before, the only disadvantage to these advantage plans would be if you should have major hospitalization outside of your network. So if you are a person that travels or lives elsewhere outside of your hometown like a snowbird does, it may not be a very good plan for you especially if you're a sickly person. The advantage to an advantage plan is you don't pay a supplemental or Medigap fee that you may not use all year or even for years. So you might think you're covered, but if nothing happens, it's money wasted each month. To me it's like having a premium for medicare. It's kinda like these so called car insurance deals that you pay each month in case your car breaks down. How often does a car break down? (Unless you don't take care of it) It's better to have your money saved for these things. I make sure my hospital cap limit is saved, so I feel totally reassured and covered with my advantage plan."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgyCB7xZ-Cm83SApCA4AaABAg.9T0QVvqoXZa9USot7KatjL>

"I have Parkinson's. My anecdote is prior to Medicare I was restric^{ed} to a network that did not include the University that was recognized by the Parkinson's foundation at the center of excellence one of only 13 in the nation. Once I was eligible for Medicare the agent who was working with I'll bout which way I was going to go ask me if I was going to do original Medicare or an^{ed} advantage plan I said I wanted original Medicare because I was free to choose the doctors in the hospital that I wanted. Because I wanted to be able to choose the doctors in the hospital that specialize in Parkinson's and I couldn't have gotten that with Medicare advantage."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgzS7uqwNz_DLC1PW-94AaABAg

"I believe that it would have been helpful to discuss the ramifications of switching from an Advantage plan to a Supplement plan like the old elephant once told me."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxDIjqH8r8GX-lfW2B4AaABAg.A1x0c7c3FM-AO7LIRnyUnx>

'Get a supplement while you can' · 31 documents · 20 voices

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>

"My broker told me that with Medigap (supplemental) the doc makes the decisions...Not the insurance company Medicare Advantage...Expect delays while the insurance company figures out how to screw you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_9pWXe1A8BazF6EI4AaABAg

"Avoid Sunburn as great risk for melanoma. I would like folks to check statistics for the average healthy 65 year old, which is the usual year that folks make their initial decisions. what percent are going to hospitalized? I believe far less than 1%. hence if you are healthy, medicare adv is great for the first few years after retirement. insurance companies reap huge profits off medicare supplement. I have worked as a physician and for both non-profit and for profit insurance. at the non profit, they know that they make much more \$\$ off medicare supplement and specifically told us not to promote medicare advantage. brokers make more money off med supplement too. your video was actually was very informed and very balanced. 99% better than most video and clearly unbiased. By the way, most folks that have cancer (unless the worst types) is much less than \$300k..more like \$100k for many standard breast or colon cancers. I also study high cost claimants so I see the worst of the worst but that is only for about 1-5% of seniors. thanks for your nice job."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwRYVtBbILppXE7cIJ4AaABAg>

"My agent of 8 years was surprised when I told him my plan was ending and I was now eligible to buy a medigap plan. He said he would send my some plans to review, but he never did, and did not return my messages. Also, I called an agent I found online and he was so very helpful and nice, but when I explained I had been on Advantage for 8 years, he said oh, in that case, agents won't work with you, they won't get paid. He said I have to call each company to purchase the plan myself. Very strange...it sounds as if the companies are being compensated to take on "Advantage Returners" with the commission normally paid to agents..."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxCOhpK38o-jmdIJN4AaABAg.AOs_MoBrGwvAPdBK7fuYgn

"What I'm concerned about is that my oncologist told me that she has seen some patients, who are under original Medicare with a Supplement, denied a claim AFTER having a procedure done. Then the patient is responsible for the whole bill! That's really scary! Has anyone experienced that?"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugy-vuLlPswN_bzRLh4AaABAg

↳ @jonimarshall8313 (2): "Wow I was under the understanding the supplement plan would pick up the 20% that the Medicare's 80% of the bill leaving a 0 balance to patient? I don't understand that. I'm very interested finding out I'm in the middle of making big changes to my insurance plan. I'm absolutely saddened to hear these things happening it just sounds like a trap anyway you go 😞 nightmare"

↳ @luckylewy1628 (1): "If Medicare pays, the Supplement plan pays."

↳ @kirkp_nextguitar (0): "@jonimarshall8313The Medicare Supplement insurer can't deny coverage for a procedure, but CMS (the government office that administers Medicare) can if they decide the procedure wasn't necessary. In that case, the supplement insurer won't cover it either. In the past CMS has been much less aggressive about denying claims than most Medicare Advantage insurers. But that may soon change, as the Trump administration under huckster Dr. Oz have an initiative to increase denial of claims, with a pilot program in some states starting in 2026. <<https://www.cms.gov/priorities/innovation/innovation-models/wiser>>;

"What a great video! I have an older friend who was not wealthy for sure, and the one thing she told me was traditional Medicare/Medigap is the only way to go. The ability to see almost any doctor/specialist, and to avoid the wait for pre-auths and paperwork is worth every penny she paid up front. She was healthy at 65. Ten years later, she developed unexpected health issues, as older people do. Because of her choice at 65, she sees top specialists spread out over multiple health care systems and is sooo happy with the care they provide."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz5TYWE8dgZyaEpzeJ4AaABAg>

"I've lost track of how many know-it-all experts that have told me if I don't apply for Medicare Part A at 65, during the initial enrollment period, I'll be penalized for life. This even though a lot of them work with me at a company that has much more than 20 employees and full health care coverage. Red is the one."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugxa05HewPp-fhoWPYB4AaABAg>

↳ @Lbeemg35mlb (0): "I just turned 65. I was inundated with people saying that I must start Medicare Part A even though large company with full health ins. I finally gave in and just did it. I guess it doesn't matter since I don't have HSA"

"Plan N question about \$20 fees. Is there any fee for Blood work, Chest xray, MRI, PT per visit, etc? Someone told us Plan N could cost us up to 20% for Blood work, xrays, PT visits, etc. Thank you,"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgyF8GXOZDKSy-s0TvB4AaABAg>

↳ @lindawilliamson1661 (1): "For Plan N, the only copays are for certain office visits. (Copay max is \$20.) No copays for PT, X-rays, blood work, treatments, procedures, etc."

"I believe that it would have been helpful to discuss the ramifications of switching from an Advantage plan to a Supplement plan like the old elephant once told me."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxDIjqH8r8GX-lfW2B4AaABAg.A1x0c7c3FM-AO7LIRnyUnx>

"Hello Stephanie ..I wanted to take a moment to thank you for your excellent videos and informative materials on Medicare. They really helped me understand the difference between Medicare Advantage plans and Medicare Supplements. My wife and I have been enrolled in a Medicare Supplement plan from the very beginning, and your explanations helped confirm just how valuable that choice has been. We have real peace of mind whenever we need any medical procedure, knowing we won't run into unexpected costs or coverage issues. My advice to anyone considering their options: if you can afford it, a Medicare Supplement plan is well worth it. Thank you for making the differences so clear and easy to understand. With sincere gratitude, George"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugzbm402lc43PtYqHax4AaABAg>

"Forced as in regular Medicare ceases to exist? I'd guess not, but I have no qualifications to make you think I know anything. Forced, as in unable to afford a supplement? That doesn't seem so unusual. Find out the basis on which the cost of any supplement you are considering will raise its prices (it is a matter of how much, no a matter of whether). I know our agent told me she had a customer with a lot of issues who loved her supplement-- but it had gotten to be unaffordable, and of course by this time she has quite a bit wrong with her. The Advantage plan really was the only affordable option"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzPZB6VC5KBhdUGM5B4AaABAq.9YTcATdNCDS9Yh6VK6ddL5>

"Well I have a question for you OK they put me on Medicare when I was 55 I was still at the American United healthcare at the hospital that was my primary insurance when I went to the doctor so Mary Kay I've been getting money for me all these years taking out \$144 out of my money and telling me I have so much for dinner I need it now can you help me get it that's about it no OK the people since I've been using America the best since 2018 no they call me every time it's time to come get your teeth cleaned and asked me why because I wanted they want to get the money from you all I know you're gonna be amazed at the point where now sorry I finally put out anywhere you go you're nice lady I finally told the people I'm trying to just come to get my teeth clean I need my breeze don't fit no more OK cause I had leukemia pool so the reason fit normal and I need help OK I talk to the lady she's 50 years old she's a top Medicare person as I can get away at the moment and she told me to talk to the governor because I want him as it is the bottom line OK God bless you are you seem like a real nice lady but I miss you OK I have a BCND I called Medicare they give me a ride to the doctor they give me a ride to get my test I can finish the call me baby we're gonna do all the mamas gonna check for you if you ever want to wear a dress I want to say the mood for my teeth tell my want to eat it's so busy worry about my body it's going to get my quarterly check: Teknowledge the Pap smear because I have a 667578 OK but I don't want it is him so anyway can you help me get my money back with you we got a call the governor I talk to the medical lady she's 58 you gonna see what I feel but she said she had a complaint from people like talking to her she enjoy talking to me because I want to see what y'all got to face your fear OK God bless you pray for your help with Jesus is with 80 will you have reached we have you tell Ray but I have United Health Care supplement ABC D and I go for chronic and well now that's one way to get one of her chronic I don't know if they're on the way I say I will now where is the I got the best where is the damn list a problem tell the governor now they say so I got to talk to I want to money went OK tell him tell him one day it is I need 3000 I paid 15 is that for you OK with the 2000s yeah yeah I work with that word before I need 800 800 did I need 35 did you pay 50 and I paid 1500 for doing this why is he into the network OK God bless you and what is America they not bring up my day as she gets with me back to them OK but still they paid 2500 and why my previous 2000 talk to the governor they say the governor of your state country whatever I don't care where he got it that's all I wanna know where my money yet because I'm waiting to have a business charge me until I need it now but do you date "I feel very reasonable pretty good we're at Marti goes to her let you know what I do you know Heb has an omelette with raisins and ate my egg my day is the cosmetic on my two front teeth he's the want to tell me that they pull my God I'm open for that phrase go out for a ride my teeth and he made me go to pretty cosmetic tea anyway I didn't have medication and I pay for everything made my insurance to hear everything glad to talk to the right to talk if she's smart she's happy she's not ready I want to talk to us about a mile insurance lady she's nice to the neighbor silver now my doctor said that he had a pretend me to describe anything or whatever I'm not even sick but I guess he really is he's a good doctor and I like to Denises it's a big deal between the dogs and Denist you know that I'm a nurse and no no the doctor gonna take care you say you do then he get his money he doesn't yell at you any money I don't get my money OK God bless you oh she's not really she's nice to do OK"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAq.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7S-VZXiV>

"Thank you so much! If you want help choosing a specific plan (whether this is Medigap or MA) I recommend working with the company Chapter. They are a Medicare advisory platform with fully licensed advisors, who do not earn a commission, regardless of which plan you choose. Since they don't have that conflict, I find that people get plans that are best suited for them at a price point that works for them. Full disclosure, they are a partner on my channel, but I spent six months of researching them prior to signing up with them. And I do not regularly do sponsorships. For context, I've only ever done two. So when I say I like a company, it means I really like it. If you are interested in contacting them, here is their information. Phone number: 510-961-3329 or URL: askchapter.org/erin"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyKnXNbrSNMXtmw0yp4AaABAq.AZWAaxred6kAZZZfOh-MAa>

"sorry so sorry to hear I'm in the same place and very tired of the whole thing money money and more money it should be free but its not your paying for it areal joke on us since its hard for me to to pay for a supplement insurance so I do the best I can do to survive so far the advantage has worked for me what can I say even have to pay a monthly premiums 59.00 it still better for for me at this time I'm a veteran too not help there also I have a friend who can't afford the supplement put he finds a way to pay for it about 400.. a month crazy it since he is dealing with 2 cancers at the same time I should say and he went through a divorced a few years again but still remains in the same house because its the only way he can pay for the insurance crazy ...good luck"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=Ugw_IFm56q8n32Y3adx4AaABAq.APZX8DkN7XFAPq3KrIUEEa

"A few years ago my wife spent several months in several different hospitals as doctors worked first to figure out what was wrong, fixing it and then doing rehab and finally at home PT. Several case managers in different hospitals told us the same thing: "Thank God you have original Medicare and a G Supplement! I cannot tell you how often I am on the phone fighting with insurance companies to get preauthorizations for patients with Advantage Plans, and how often they are denied and we and family members have to get back on the phone! When people are sick, they and their family need to worry and concern themselves with that! Not fighting insurance companies!" It's more than just the monetary cost."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgyheLT-3gE_jOHS_014AaABAq

"It's been trending that way for a while. Just ran into it. I started with a new MA plan this year and was referred by my dentist to an oral surgeon for a biopsy, but after I called the referred surgeon's office they told me they no longer take Medicare, MA or supplements. So I called the BCBS to see who they have in-network. The only one they had was this office and gave me their names. BCBS rep called the OS and confirmed they are no longer accepting any flavor of Medicare. They then told me to start calling around. Instead I went to the Medicare site to see who they have listed. Not a single oral surgeon in a 200 mile radius. Closest one is nearly 300mi away."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1j9odhm/28_cut_to_medicare_payment_to_physicians_approved/mhhc5qf/

"My sister recently asked me about this and after reading this, I think I gave her the wrong info. She is still working at 73 and will retire soon. I told her to be sure to get in Plan G during open enrollment, and to not take the Advantage plan. She is taking SS and has been for years, but is insured by her workplace. She has many health issues, diabetes, high blood pressure, etc. Now if I understand you right...she won't be able to use the Medigap plan when she retires? I just did more research and think because she is not on Medicare yet, she will still qualify for Medigap during open enrollment?"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwyaDz83DuLaIOarpp4AaABAq_AZZgV5gcoe9AZbSWJTvRFw

"The MOOP for 2025 and 2026 is \$9350 for in-network and \$14000 for out-of-network. First, where did you get a \$5000 MOOP, and second, do you pay both of those if you use some inland some out, for a max total of \$23350 (not that I would ever let my husband go out of network and I clearly need a supplement). And the need for Part D, dental care, etc., is a huge factor, especially with old-age teeth. A Medicare "HELP" group convinced me to go with Plan N when the cheaper Plan F or G from 2024 wasn't available, and it cost me way more, though I told them how often I saw doctors."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwvQbWPHG-o7utyVt4AaABAq>

"@sharibrennan383 PS do your research. I talked to someone at Chapter last week and he presented 3 options. I emailed him last night asking him for a list of all options and prices. I will be getting that list this evening. There are 9 in Minnesota he said. I don't have to ask him why he didn't present the others to me. I am certain he will only present the ones he gets the best commission on. I would never do that to anyone. He also told me he recommends Plan N for me. Sure he does. Probably better for him."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=Ugwjm8cc5r1gWXRodcd4AaABAq_AVqLNkQiG7YAZD3OhK6EF-

'Check your doctors and drugs first' · 30 documents · 20 voices

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"I've had a Medicare plan and a Medicare supplement plan for about 8 years. And the supplement plan pays whatever Medicare doesn't. Minus whatever deductible you choose. Monthly premium has gone up over the years. In some years I may have paid more for the plan than I got in services, but there have been years when it's literally saved me thousands of dollars. So over the time frame I've had it. It's definitely paid for itself not only financially but in not having to worry about having a procedure done. And not needing a pre-authorization. If my doctor says go I go I can go to any doctor. I want anywhere in the nation. Medicare advantage plans are basically private insurance. High deductibles, high rejection of coverage. Pre-qualifications. Looks cheaper on the front end but you're going to lose on the back end. So listen to this man"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 60 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=Ugxfb9YPgrZZhd4mdaR4AaABAg>

↳ @samuelbutterworth4303 (10): "NEVER take advice from someone that makes money from the choices they recommend, like this guy. I have a degree in Economics specializing in social insurance, and an MBA. I've had Supplemental and Advantage insurance plans. I prefer Advantage plans in my area. Zero premium, zero cost family doctor, every medical profession in my city are in network, I've never had any surgery or treatment turned down, my medications are all free except for one high cost brand and that costs me \$45 per month, free dental care, free eye exams and glasses, free hearing and discounted hearing aids. They have a national network of doctors."

↳ @patriciayohn6136 (7): "Absolutely agree with you and my Husband and I did the same thing and not sorry, we went with Supplement G plan. I had to have an emergency major surgery three years ago, spent seven days in hospital and I only had to cover about \$200.00 dollars!!!"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (3): "Don't forget the bigger concern with chronic conditions and surgical needs. Quality of care. This is overlooked by almost everyone that signs up for Advantage Plans. They love the cost vs a supp plan until they need care. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these Advantage Plans."

"This is, hands down, the best video I have ever seen about Medicare insurance plans!! Fantastic job, and thank you! And I hope you recover quickly from your sunburn! BUT... I want to introduce a dimension that I was surprised you did not mention! That is, taking care of yourself! By that, I mean taking nutrition seriously for decades, maintaining an ideal weight, and working out regularly at a gym in old age so you never neglect your body's conditioning!! Now in our mid 70s, my wife and I have been "nutritarian" for 15 years. Nutritarian is a diet developed by Dr. Joel Fuhrman based on a 100% plant-based diet, only far more emphasis on nutrient-density at every meal. No added sugar, no animal products, no dairy, no alcohol, no bread, no added oil, no added salt. Just whatever comes naturally in the fruit, vegetables, nuts, grains, mushrooms, seeds, and sprouts (microgreens) that we eat at every meal. We go to our gym for a vigorous 60 to 80 minute resistance workout every 3 days (plus a 60-minute treadmill cardio workout on some off-days). We maintain ideal weight, take no medications, and my local doctor told me that I have the blood pressure of a healthy 18-year-old. MY POINT is that your own discipline over your peak nutrition and physical conditioning will have an enormous impact over your long-term health! We have a guy at our gym at age 95 still working out!! As Dr. Fuhrman says: "Your genes load the gun. But your diet and lifestyle pull the trigger!" As part of our Advantage plan, our gym enrollment is covered. That is \$100 a month savings for both my wife and myself. We do have a local insurance agent, but if we did not I would reach out to this agent with The Retirement Nerds! What an excellent explanation of all the insurance options! So, don't eat junk! Don't sit around in an easy chair drinking beer! Make peak nutrition your most serious hobby. Grow your own sprouts and microgreens like I do. Don't eat canned beans - instead eat beans you cook yourself from dry beans. We eat 18 kinds of beans I cook weekly in a pressure cooker. I plan to make it to 100+ unless I get hit by a truck! (And if that happens, insurance won't matter.) Best wishes!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 36 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzq9b4ySEEjBX1HcUh4AaABAg>

↳ @norsemythos1438 (4): "Interesting story. I tend to agree with the concept...but in practice... eating only rabbit food and living to 100? I wonder if im better off enjoying the simple things and dying at 88."

↳ @flyshacker (3): "@norsemythos1438 Your choice! Remember, nearly all the things people call "old age" are really just neglect. Get your cremation and other final expenses paid for, and you're all set! I'll keep exercising, living longer, and I'll collect the gov't benefits you would have received. Fine with me!"

↳ @frankhodge7654 (1): "@flyshacker No matter what you eat, old age effects are very real. We were born with a guarantee of death. No one can live forever except in fantasies. We don't usually know our end date, but we all have one. Rabbit food for life is not a very enjoyable option."

"I'm in Florida too and in my early years I didn't have health insurance. I had to go to the hospital for surgery and the bill came to nearly 100k. When I was being discharged, they were wheeling me towards the front door and suddenly veered off and went to the business office. They were demanding some sort of payment and also wanted me to sign papers saying I would pay the entire bill. I told them that I was still medicated and under doctors orders so I couldn't legally sign anything. My wife came in , very pissed off, and took me out of there. When they called a few days later I told them that I wanted an itemized bill. They argued with me and I told them that I knew that hospital bills are works of fiction and that I wanted the same discount that the insurance companies get. They knocked the bill down to \$6,000 and I told them I would send \$100 a month. After paying for 6 months I called them back and asked what it would take to pay it off. They agreed on \$1,500 and I sent them a check and they marked it paid in full. Of course now I'm on Medicare and have a supplement plan but anyone who's younger should remember that you can always negotiate."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgypslzdYHmZ7b1sgQJ4AaABAg.A8bQ-ZobSDuA8cVBGRqKWQ>

"Over here in Puerto Rico 🇵🇷 , I'm in good health, but the advantage plan, tries forcing you to visit a network doctor, I tell them I'm in good health, I'll go to a doctor, when I'm feeling sick etc"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugzg7RmeU7o68Xo63FJ4AaABAg>

"@rickarmstrong9660 i'm glad you think you found the plan that would work best for you, but it doesn't sound like you had a very good advantage plan if it was going to cost you thousands of dollars. When I had my bypass I was in the hospital for 13 days and I only had to pay \$1,500 out of 13 days and hundreds of blood tests, the surgery, doctors, and all preparations for my surgery. This was way back in 2014 under a Humana plan. However, when I went through breast cancer I did have to pay quite a bit more because of my out of pocket cap was quite high. Then I switched to a better advantage plan with a much lower out-of-pocket max just for that reason. This is why you've got to do your research on all of these advantage plans and talk directly to that company - not a sales rep like they advertise on tv. I was in the hospital for one day this past year and only had to pay \$80 for several heart screening tests, labs, ER and this included the overnight stay. I pay no monthly premiums on hospital, doctor care or my part D drugs. All of my drugs so far are 100% covered for heart and cancer that I have to take. I have 100% coverage on antibiotics such as tetracycline (try finding a plan that covers that expensive drug!). My cap is \$2,900 at most for any out of pocket expense including if I were to get a new cancer and need treatment. As I said before, the only disadvantage to these advantage plans would be if you should have major hospitalization outside of your network. So if you are a person that travels or lives elsewhere outside of your hometown like a snowbird does, it may not be a very good plan for you especially if you're a sickly person. The advantage to an advantage plan is you don't pay a supplemental or Medigap fee that you may not use all year or even for years. So you might think you're covered, but if nothing happens, it's money wasted each month. To me it's like having a premium for medicare. It's kinda like these so called car insurance deals that you pay each month in case your car breaks down. How often does a car break down? (Unless you don't take care of it) It's better to have your money saved for these things. I make sure my hospital cap limit is saved, so I feel totally reassured and covered with my advantage plan."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgyCB7xZ-Cm83SApCA4AaABAg.9T0QVvqoXZa9USot7KatjL>

"I have Parkinson's. My anecdote is prior to Medicare I was restricted 😞😞 to a network that did not include the University that was recognized by the Parkinson's foundation at the center of excellence one of only 13 in the nation. Once I was eligible for Medicare the agent who was working with I'll bout which way I was going to go ask me if I was going to do original Medicare or an 😞 advantage plan I said I wanted original Medicare because I was free to choose the doctors in the hospital that I wanted. Because I wanted to be able to choose the doctors in the hospital that specialize in Parkinson's and I couldn't have gotten that with Medicare advantage."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgzS7uqwNz_DLC1PW-94AaABAg

"Thanks! I have a Medicare Advantage plan that I love; but I missed the age 65 window to get Medigap with no underwriting. I have more than one health issue; but my doctor says I'm doing well compared to most people my age. I was thinking about moving near Hopkins but good to know they don't take Medicare Advantage. Medicare/Medigap is now so expensive and the economy so bad I can see why many if not most seniors are on Medicare Advantage. I love my plan. I'm not looking forward to paying 180.00 or more for Medigap, plus out of pocket vision and dental. That will be at least 300.00 out of pocket if not more. What's the point of Medicare then? Medicare is no deal for seniors. It just benefits the insurance companies."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzBDlw8S7yJJKnQKq54AaABAg>

"This 'medicare' racket, which I never wanted anything to do with, just yesterday tried to heist \$185 out of my social security deposit, and they are not going to get away with it. Measures are already underway, thanks to my congressman's office, to make them put it back and leave me alone. I don't want it now, and don't want it ever. The whole program is a ponzi-scheme, and leaves folks high and dry when they need it most. I recommend not going to 'doctors' to begin with. All those quacks do is make people sick and sell them drugs, to pay for their posh lifestyles without having to earn an honest living."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugz3_sq2RO5FRpJAsS14AaABAg

"Purple. Thank you for your guidance. I want to make sure others know that there are medications and therapies that Medicare won't cover or only cover for certain persons who meet criteria, but commercial insurance may cover them. For instance, parenteral nutrition coverage by Medicare has strict criteria. Persons who take meds, have chronic health conditions or are planning to have surgery should make sure Medicare will cover care. Not all agents know the criteria so I advise everyone to check with their doctors or pharmacies for their knowledge of Medicare coverage."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgxkxcAh3AmWYuUJsa14AaABAg>

"I have Medicare plan f and I have no problem but I pay a higher premium. Fired one doctor because he tried to charge me a deductible and he wanted to argue with me about it a week later his office called and told me I was right."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxUXjl3h2G6mn4uFI94AaABAg>

"Well I have a question for you OK they put me on Medicare when I was 55 I was still at the American United healthcare at the hospital that was my primary insurance when I went to the doctor so Mary Kay I've been getting money for me all these years taking out \$144 out of my money and telling me I have so much for dinner I need it now can you help me get it that's about it no OK the people since I've been using America the best since 2018 no they call me every time it's time to come get your teeth cleaned and asked me why because I wanted they want to get the money from you all I know you're gonna be amazed at the point where now sorry I finally put out anywhere you go you're nice lady I finally told the people I'm trying to just come to get my teeth clean I need my breeze don't fit no more OK cause I had leukemia pool so the reason fit normal and I need help OK I talk to the lady she's 50 years old she's a top Medicare person as I can get away at the moment and she told me to talk to the governor because I want him as it is the bottom line OK God bless you are you seem like a real nice lady but I miss you OK I have a BCND I called Medicare they give me a ride to the doctor they give me a ride to get my test I can finish the call me baby we're gonna do all the mamas gonna check for you if you ever want to wear a dress I want to say the mood for my teeth tell my want to eat it's so busy worry about my body it's going to get my quarterly check: Teknowledge the Pap smear because I have a 667578 OK but I don't want it is him so anyway can you help me get my money back with you we got a call the governor I talk to the medical lady she's 58 you gonna see what I feel but she said she had a complaint from people like talking to her she enjoy talking to me because I want to see what y'all got to face your fear OK God bless you pray for your help with Jesus is with 80 will you have reached we have you tell Ray but I have United Health Care supplement ABC D and I go for chronic and well now that's one way to get one of her chronic I don't know if they're on the way I say I will now where is the I got the best where is the damn list a problem tell the governor now they say so I got to talk to I want to money went OK tell him tell him one day it is I need 3000 I paid 15 is that for you OK with the 2000s yeah yeah I work with that word before I need 800 800 did I need 35 did you pay 50 and I paid 1500 for doing this why is he into the network OK God bless you and what is America they not bring up my day as she gets with me back to them OK but still they paid 2500 and why my previous 2000 talk to the governor they say the governor of your state country whatever I don't care where he got it that's all I wanna know where my money yet because I'm waiting to have a business charge me until I need it now but do you date "I feel very reasonable pretty good we're at Marti goes to her let you know what I do you know Heb has an omelette with raisins and ate my egg my day is the cosmetic on my two front teeth he's the want to tell me that they pull my God I'm open for that phrase go out for a ride my teeth and he made me go to pretty cosmetic tea anyway I didn't have medication and I pay for everything made my insurance to hear everything glad to talk to the right to talk if she's smart she's happy she's not ready I want to talk to us about a mile insurance lady she's nice to the neighbor silver now my doctor said that he had a pretend me to describe anything or whatever I'm not even sick but I guess he really is he's a good doctor and I like to Denises it's a big deal between the dogs and Denist you know that I'm a nurse and no no the doctor gonna take care you say you do then he get his money he doesn't yell at you any money I don't get my money OK God bless you oh she's not really she's nice to do OK"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7S-VZXiV>

"@dmariewriter6880 And most people don't know that while hospitals charge these prices to Medicare, Medicare won't pay them in full. I am not a wiz at this, but I know that in 2007 when my wife was on dialysis, the dialysis company was charging Medicare \$50,000 a month for the dialysis. Medicare only paid \$500 a session, or, depending on the calendar, \$6,000 to \$7,000 a month. Nevertheless while at this greatly reduced price, the dialysis company showed a billion dollar profit that year. It is good to note that Medicare and Medicaid covers the people that insurance companies don't view as profitable. The real definition of government waste and fraud is really private capitalism bountifully rewarded by government funds removed from the public by congressionally created rules and laws. Something else people should know is that private health care systems, meaning doctors firms and hospitals, are horribly inefficient due to a lack of scale. I lived in Philly, and in the year my wife had open heart surgery, there were 24 hospitals with heart surgeons in the region. Each hospital had an operating room equipped for heart surgery, associated staff and the surgeon and his team. Each surgeon averaged two heart operations, including stents, a week. Cleveland Clinic is much better organized. They have smaller hospitals all over Ohio and they have get a large out of state number of patients, including my wife at one point. At the time I was there, they had 12 heart surgeons doing two major open heart surgeries or organ transplants six days a week all year long. Cleveland flies people in from all around the country and Medicare is happy to pay for it because flying these people to Cleveland is cheaper than having less skillful surgeons work on them. Our local hospital desperately tried to get me to let them do the open heart surgery on my wife, but at 11:30 at night I called Cleveland to ask about air transport. They put me on hold as soon as I told them the situation, and five minutes later they came back on the line to tell me that the ambulance from the hospital where my wife was to the Philly airport, the medical flight from there to Cleveland and the ambulance from the Cleveland airport to the Clinic was all arranged. Medicare paid for it all so far as I know, but we also had a medigap policy which never charged us a dime either. Cleveland worked on two of my wife's valves and the operation was reported as 'very difficult' by the highest rated surgeon there. The surgeon in Philly was going to do three valves, one of which was unnecessary and I suspect that likely would have resulted in her death. We didn't really know what was going on at the time, and later I had doctors both in Philly and at John's Hopkins who told me that I have to be wrong about the operation because it was obviously an impossible one given my wife's other issues. Our surgeon in Philly, who was recommended to us by Cleveland for local support, was clearly very accomplished, but he just could not get the experience required to get a position as a heart surgeon in Cleveland. He ended up moving to Dubai to hospital where he could do two major operations a day six days a week until he could qualify to apply to Cleveland"

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgxmoD_g6zlx-kD900Z4AaABAq.APBQSeccit0ARHIEI8WAYB

"It's not that black and white. I have Medicare advantage with Kaiser and considering my options (over 65, have Multiple Sclerosis) it is quite good. There are two things I especially like: 1) No administrative take backs on procedures. When I first got MS I had a PPO and my doctor said to get expensive tests like MRIs. I would and then some a-hole bureaucrat would refuse it. For the only time in my life I was looking like a credit risk because I had unpaid bills for tens of thousands of dollars. God that was hell. Besides dealing the the trauma of no longer being able to walk normally, I had to deal with all the anxiety caused by administrative a-holes. 2) The doctors are in general quite good. Not just in that they know what they're doing but they actually talk to me and listen rather than just putting me into a box based on a 5 minute overview of the way I filled out some form. In my experience that's unfortunately very rare in the US because a for profit system pushes doctors to be more like efficient factory workers than empathic care givers. Luckily some doctors care enough to still listen to patients. Just to be clear: I agree that the whole for profit system is BS and Medicare Advantage is an example of that. Just saying given the broken system we have, Medicare advantage can provide decent options for some people in some locations."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgyfsluT2u6E9J_AQDt4AaABAq.APD2vBaWjr3A_3BpsHg1zW

"I agree. Even though I live in a state with excellent Medicare Advantage options, I chose Original Medicare Parts A & B, a Plan N supplement, and a \$0-premium Part D plan. For expensive procedures, my doctors submit prior authorizations directly to Medicare, and I've had approvals come through within days. That has included a \$16,000 eye surgery and monthly injections costing around \$3,000. I can't say how that experience would have been with a Medicare Advantage plan, but I've appreciated how straightforward Original Medicare has been. Every one of my doctors has told me they love seeing Original Medicare because it's generally simple to work with. My Plan N has consistently covered my share of the Medicare-approved costs, and my Part D plan has approved some very expensive medications. Occasionally I've had to try lower-cost medications first before a more expensive one was approved, but that's a process my doctors are very familiar with. Good health is one of the greatest assets you can have in retirement. It has a tremendous impact on your quality of life, independence, and the ability to truly enjoy the years you've worked so hard for. For me, the peace of mind and flexibility of Original Medicare have been well worth it."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1v936ye/medicare_advantage_or_original_medicare/p0atfe4/

"As with everything, what plan you should choose depends on your own circumstances. Many people are happy with their advantage plans, as all their doctors accept it and all their medications are covered, and they are usually cheaper than a medigap plan. But, there is always risks regardless of what you choose. My personal doctors told me they don't accept any advantage plan, and none of them available in my state covers all my meds. But it's always possible to get a separate part d. The risk of standard Medicare and medigap is that premiums increase to much. Technically that can happen with advantage as well, but it's more likely with medigap. The risks of advantage are many. Fewer supported doctors (this is just fact), and you hear stories all the time about doctors dropping ma plans. No ability for most people to go back to original Medicare without incurring that 20% and no max out of pocket (ie they won't pass underwriting). If you live in a guaranteed issue state, you have much less risk. And can easily choose the plan that fits your current state of healthcare. But if you don't it's a choose wisely situation because you can't go back for most people after a year. So you have to ask yourself, are you feeling lucky?"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ep6jo4/why_do_people_say_never_get_an_advantage_plan/hin754/

"I have Humana PFFS, and I can go to any doctor or any hospital. It pays to have an insurance broker familiar with your state. They know all kinds of insurance that's offered. They check your meds, etc. I told them I wanted to go to doctors out of network so I didn't want an HMO or PPO. I went to the hospital three weeks ago and I got a bill for \$32 and they did a CT scan. I hope you all have luck. Also, I found out you can change your plan one time a year on Medicare so don't settle if you aren't happy. I talked with Medicare, and they told me so I changed at the beginning of 2025 around February because it didn't cover all of my doctors out of network."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgzA7iMmoUW3jLnZpdV4AaABAg>

"I chose traditional Medicare A&B and I also have no cost (secondary) supplemental health care coverage with my retirement which covers prescriptions and office visits. My health is very good. My doctor said I chose the right choice. She also added that if you opt to take an advantage plan, you can (never) go back to traditional Medicare but if you take traditional, you can always change to an advantage plan. I personally don't want an insurance company to decide what I need or don't need in my health needs based on their bottom line profits. Do you have any further advice for me or do you also think I chose correctly?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgzPqv5KeKMW0npxgW54AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "Is the no cost secondary insurance 1. permanent? 2. with fixed benefits that never change (aka Guaranteed renewable) ? 3. can never be taken from you, canceled or modified by whoever provides it?"

↳ @evertmorse8518 (0): "@MedigapSeminars It is good till I pass away and it also covers my wife till she passes away. It's a UAW provided VEBA. As far as I know, it's very secure and will never be taken away. The VEBA is a trust. It's been in place since 2008."

↳ @Jkaye13 (0): "@evertmorse8518 What's VEBA?? Can anyone get that?"

"The MOOP for 2025 and 2026 is \$9350 for in-network and \$14000 for out-of-network. First, where did you get a \$5000 MOOP, and second, do you pay both of those if you use some in-network some out, for a max total of \$23350 (not that I would ever let my husband go out of network and I clearly need a supplement). And the need for Part D, dental care, etc., is a huge factor, especially with old-age teeth. A Medicare "HELP" group convinced me to go with Plan N when the cheaper Plan F or G from 2024 wasn't available, and it cost me way more, though I told them how often I saw doctors."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwvQbWPHG-o7utyVt4AaABAg>

"I was fortunate, because my wife is a retired Care Coordinator (She would educate patients in a hospital setting when they were getting ready to be discharged about their health care and insurance options). She knew when to sign up for Medicare and the Supplemental and Drug plan. She has had people argue with her about their Advantage plans, because their insurance AGENT told them that it would cover all these wonderful things, but neglected to mention that it had to be IN NETWORK (and in our area the nearest "in-network" care they could be given was hundreds of miles away!)"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzLfBrimnXkbGR5l2p4AaABAg>

'Use an independent broker' · 13 documents · 13 voices

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do, before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎🙏🙏🙏🕊️🕊️🕊️"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxdqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAg>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MAdvantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to delivery the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJJZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>

"My broker told me that with Medigap (supplemental) the doc makes the decisions...Not the insurance company Medicare Advantage..Expect delays while the insurance company figures out how to screw you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_9pWXe1A8BazF6EI4AaABAg

"A broker in Nashua, NH, told me several years ago that an Advantage plan is good unless you need it. The Advantage scheme is a scam. Its purpose is to move the country off Medicare and privatize all health insurance."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugz-kN-jQS9K-v2zAoJ4AaABAg>

↳ @billjones4986 (0): "Yep I have one it's fine if your healthy need it for something major another story."

"My agent of 8 years was surprised when I told him my plan was ending and I was now eligible to buy a medigap plan. He said he would send me some plans to review, but he never did, and did not return my messages. Also, I called an agent I found online and he was so very helpful and nice, but when I explained I had been on Advantage for 8 years, he said oh, in that case, agents won't work with you, they won't get paid. He said I have to call each company to purchase the plan myself. Very strange...it sounds as if the companies are being compensated to take on "Advantage Returners" with the commission normally paid to agents..."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxCOhpK38o-jmdIJN4AaABAg.AOs_MoBrGwvAPdBK7fuYgn

"Forced as in regular Medicare ceases to exist? I'd guess not, but I have no qualifications to make you think I know anything. Forced, as in unable to afford a supplement? That doesn't seem so unusual. Find out the basis on which the cost of any supplement you are considering will raise its prices (it is a matter of how much, not a matter of whether). I know our agent told me she had a customer with a lot of issues who loved her supplement--but it had gotten to be unaffordable, and of course by this time she has quite a bit wrong with her. The Advantage plan really was the only affordable option"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzPZB6VC5KBhdUGM5B4AaABAg.9YTcATdNCDS9Yh6VK6ddL5>

"Purple. Thank you for your guidance. I want to make sure others know that there are medications and therapies that Medicare won't cover or only cover for certain persons who meet criteria, but commercial insurance may cover them. For instance, parenteral nutrition coverage by Medicare has strict criteria. Persons who take meds, have chronic health conditions or are planning to have surgery should make sure Medicare will cover care. Not all agents know the criteria so I advise everyone to check with their doctors or pharmacies for their knowledge of Medicare coverage."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgxkxcAh3AmWYuUJsa14AaABAg>

"I'll chime in! Massage therapist here with lots of ortho, medical rehab experience. I have elderly clients and they almost universally love their G or N, or hate their Advantage but cannot switch to original w/supplemental because of poor health hx. A broker I know told me, "Advantage is NOT Medicare. Period." And I agree. I had hoped you'd discuss HD G."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugwhv-WrDaXqfUllnr54AaABAg>

"I know the first time I ever had a UTI and pull anything I want to go to the jazz festival down in Houston that afternoon when I first became a nurse and I knew this medical student he was going to school to be a dentist and he put it he told me a pull my name up I want to be out for a weekend he told me I need my full wisdom tooth so he pulled them off all went down there today and I have a knack with you but now I said now OK and the universe is yours that I called his people they tell me insurance for the agents to Shema started to say 123 pool OK now but I have I will get Medicare thing and she told me theyIt's nice that they told me they give me \$500 OK name and I'll go for the x-rays so yeah the 400 wouldn't want to eat she won't tell me what I did he wanted something he doesn't know kind of programs out there I got all the phone number babe relieve me a call around then as soon as I am afraid is calling that Medicaid they call it a boom boom boom boom boom they get everything they won't know they got my money or if I want my money from the time I was 55 on American you tell him you're my baby enough to pay the dentist do you think I need to get a lawyer that will leave you alone it was amazing that we are the same batch as governor they told me the governor's fault but now that my money roll over and I'll kind of stuff I had to put my foot down baby what is your name Stephanie know that I want to call me to clean with clean Mathis a possibility kind of stuff I told Medicare I'm at La Quinta marina Tato next week I don't know what I want to get real time ago that's why 3NNJEJ OK God bless you she's not sure she tried to go to"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7qE4D49X>

"That's all a lied I live in brockton Massachusetts and I spoke to Medicare a year ago and they said I couldn't get the allowance card to buy groceries pay bills well today it's october 23 spoke to 4 people and they transfer me to an agent I told each one all I want to know if where I live gives out allowance card the last one said they have it but it's only 35 dollars so I git mad and told him why waste my time again just hear that I don't qualify for 350 dollars allowance card I cursed them out because the 4 person I spoke to I told him all I want to know is about the allowance card he said let me look into this and what happened I can't get allowance I told him I wasted my time I knew it you all liars waste peoples time I said please put in the computer that in brockton Massachusetts they don't get allowance card and I hanged I feel bad for people that are 70 80s and they call im so pist off right now it was ridiculous and he kept saying let me see what I can do all that for nothing why do Medicare agents waste people's time im 59 yrs old"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzN9aXOwEERuMQimIB4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (3): "That's one heck of a run on sentence"

"I was fortunate, because my wife is a retired Care Coordinator (She would educate patients in a hospital setting when they were getting ready to be discharged about their health care and insurance options). She knew when to sign up for Medicare and the Supplemental and Drug plan. She has had people argue with her about their Advantage plans, because their insurance AGENT told them that it would cover all these wonderful things, but neglected to mention that it had to be IN NETWORK (and in our area the nearest "in-network" care they could be given was hundreds of miles away!)"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzLfBrimnXkbGR5l2p4AaABAg>

"I got sticker shock the first time we had to pay for my husband's meds through Part D. They were much less when he was covered by employer insurance ... group insurance. As our Medicare broker told us, that's the difference: group insurance vs. essentially individual coverage. Better negotiated rates, I guess. We get almost all his meds at Costco, where self-pay is cheaper than Part D (and Cost Plus doesn't carry all his meds)."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1w5n6j8/wellcare_wanted_110_for_one_generic_prescription/p7gob45/

"I am stuck on an Advantage plan that is working for me fine now at 61. When I looked at supplement plans they were extremely expensive and my agent told me they are until I turn 65. Curious to what you have to add though."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugy7ks226ls5AEKn8I54AaABAq>

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Too confusing to compare · 237 documents · 20 voices

"Glad I did my homework and chose traditional Medicare over Medicare Advantage. I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments. I would rather pay for the "peace of mind," and the CHOICE to go where I want, and see the doctor or specialist I need/want."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 264 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbjQyLYRyCYv54AaABAq>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (10): "@LisaKnobel Medicare covers most everything, so unless you have a rare never heard of disease that has holistic/experimental treatment...Medicare/Medigap will cover it."

↳ @aregee7121 (10): "It's way more than just choice or peace of mind. Advantage plans, all insurance co. based, are more like socialized medicine, i.e. less spending per patient. You get restrictive networks, forced diagnosis first with G.P. or P.A! with delayed referral to a specialist, possibly not the one you want. The end result is a delay of the proper treatment. Do you want this as you get older?"

↳ @maryequilter31 (7): "The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

"Erin, this is your best video ever! I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed. Thank you, thank you, thank you 🙏 "

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 234 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRlqEu63hvw4AaABAq>

↳ @BirdandDiz1957 (13): "My wife and I chose a Medigap Plan N plan four years ago. Literally 2 months after beginning my Medicare journey I had a really bad accident that required the trauma unit, two surgeries and a blood clot issue. My total bill for all that and two weeks in hospital was \$86 after meeting the Part B deductible. I could have argued \$50 off that amount because they charged me that amount for the ambulance even though I was admitted. It wasn't worth going through the hassle. My wife is a cancer survivor so our broker strongly advised her to stay away from an Advantage plan. If you do go that route and then have medical issues and expenses get out of hand then you will have to go through medical underwriting and probably will not be able to switch to Medigap. Keep that in mind."

↳ @geraldarcuri9307 (11): "So, you're NOT going to sign up for an Advantage plan, right? A waste of money, and no choice of physicians or hospitals."

↳ @trackguy4038 (9): "I agree!!! Best video ever!!!"

"The reason so many people default to Medicare Advantage is not just the marketing, it's the fact that it so much resembles the health insurance that people are accustomed to—with co-pays, but basically all-inclusive (except maybe vision and dental). Regular Medicare is a 1960s Major Medical plan with add-ons to bring it up to date, and even with part B and D you still need private insurance (the alphabet soup of Medigap plans) to make up the gaps. What we really need is an all-inclusive, up to date version of Medicare rather than people having to assemble all these disparate parts, which are especially confusing for people with less education."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 176 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugw7uVI2hc5qZkKoSBx4AaABAq>

↳ @EightyDeuce-x1d (7): "Yes, most definitely. If medigap plans would include the part D prescription and maybe some dental allowance, I for one, would have definitely started on OM."

↳ @franklopeziilmtmti603 (7): "@EightyDeuce-x1d The sad thing is many of us once we get to 80-85, more hospital and meds, income does not match inflation and now we're not able to make any kind of deductible but those that always made less get Medicaid. Totally unfair for us that hustled and tried to plan for inflation as well."

↳ @alansach8437 (4): "@franklopeziilmtmti603 You need to be rich or dirt poor. In the middle you are screwed. Of course, don't fool yourself in thinking the care is in any way equal. I've known folks on Medicaid. Everytime I have walked into a doctor's office with Original Medicare and my G Supplement I have been treated like royalty. Can't say the same for them."

"This video is by far the best explanation on the difference between original Medicare and Medicare Advantage without being confusing. Thank you so much for this. I will be 65 in 2026 and my employer is dropping my health coverage because he says I will be on Medicare. I have been bombarded with SOOOO much information. It's difficult to understand this whole thing. You have cleared up a lot of it for me in one video! So THANK YOU!!!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 146 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxLckexGeBnELXhfKZ4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (16): "Thank you! I completely understand how overwhelming it can be to sort through all the Medicare information. My goal is to simplify it so you can feel more confident about your choices. I'm glad this helped bring you some clarity!"

↳ @dickeys paz3222 (12): "That's some b.s. that your employer is going to drop your healthcare coverage once you become medicare eligible. Not sure if they can legally do that so I'd check into it. Furthermore if you're going to continue to work past 65 and have an employer sponsored health care plan you can put off going on medicare you just have to fill out a form that will allow you to not have to file for medicare until you retire from working. I'd definitely check into it as it sounds like your employer is trying to pull some b.s. Don't let them shysters get away with it !"

↳ @RG-hf4et (8): "@policyguides I agree, this is one of the best videos explaining the difference between Supplements vs. MA. I have become well versed in these Medicare choices. You used one very well descriptive word describing MA: CHAOS! Perfect description & it is going to be worse in 2026 with all of the cutbacks. More MD's will be dropping MA as time goes on."

"As someone turning 65 next month this type of information is very helpful. The way they have set everything up could not be more confusing and inefficient."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 129 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwddBLZOMhdw-fYFsl4AaABAg>

↳ @kimdagnillo8246 (9): "They do that on purpose, that's how they use their excuses on how you get penalized later on."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (6): "Agreed! Glad this was helpful."

↳ @irenegriego2446 (5): "That's cause there forcing people on this cause they want your money"

"I am a retiree already on Medicare. When I saw that this video was available, I wanted to take a look. And I want to say, this is one of the best videos I've seen for those not yet on Medicare. The speaker, Stephanie, is very well spoken on the matter. She speaks clearly on what you need to know but does not confuse you with more info than you need or with casual comments. (If this were available back when I was applying, it would have been an excellent resource)."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 116 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgxH8Oqj9qk1Muh4VMt4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (17): "Thank you so much for taking the time to leave this kind comment!"

↳ @pamelarose1834 (5): "So are you happy with your coverage??"

"GLP-1 Bridge Program Info As someone that works in a doctors office and submits PAs, I want to clear up some confusion about the GLP-1 bridge program. I want to start by saying I appreciate that this program will get these meds to many people that need it, but it leaves a lot of Medicare beneficiaries behind. If you have type 2 diabetes, moderate to severe obstructive sleep apnea, or MASH you do NOT qualify to use the program. You have to get a GLP-1 medication approved for those conditions through your Part D plan. Even if the Part D copay is astronomical, you still can't use the bridge program if you have any of those 3 diagnoses. It doesn't matter if the provider doesn't even use those diagnoses and only submits the PA for obesity, you still don't qualify. When we submit the PA, the provider has to attest that you do NOT have those conditions. If the provider selects that you DO have any of them, the system automatically denies it and kicks it back saying it has to go through Part D. You can't get around this if you have these conditions because that would be committing Medicare fraud. I submitted multiple of these PAs today and confirmed this is exactly how it's being processed. You do still qualify if you have mild obstructive sleep apnea and meet the other criteria, because mild OSA isn't covered under Part D, only moderate to severe. This is directly from the CMS website info for prescribers and the PA form that I've linked below. I recommend looking over these because this is exactly the guideline providers are following when submitting these PAs. <https://www.cms.gov/glp-1-bridge.pdf> <https://www.cms.gov/files/document/glp-1-prescribers-c-1.pdf> I hope this information is helpful."

— r/medicare · 74 upvotes · None

"After working in healthcare (I'm a psychologist) through the heyday of managed care, and knowing how important it is to me to be able to choose my own doctor (they aren't all the same!), I went straight to Traditional Medicare. I know that there are some great Medicare Advantage plans that people really like. But people often love their plan until they get very sick. Then the claims start getting denied. My best friend and I were seeing the same physical therapist. I could get as many sessions as my doctor would recommend. She had to beg for more sessions, haggle for a reasonable cost due to confusing payments from her Medicare Advantage plan, and end PT before she was better. It was appalling! You may believe you are saving money with a MA plan. But if you have to pay for physical therapy or some other service that isn't covered, you'll send up spending more. And God forbid you need prior authorization for something before getting much-needed treatment! There are horror stories of people who have died waiting for that prior authorization. Ever notice how many ads there are for MA plans? Guess where they get that money? It comes out of the premiums they collect. That's money that won't go to healthcare. This is just wrong."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 70 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwEXrTu6t2HMOVp_to14AaABAq

↳ @GAderly-fn5ly (8): "Most of these stories are made up by those selling those supplement plans. The MA plans MUST cover EVERYTHING that original Medicare does BY LAW! In more than 15 years on a MA plan we have NEVER been turned down for ANY care covered by Medicare or the .A plan! There are rules these plans MUST go by. Several times my MA plan has even gone out of network for me and paid the ENTIRE cost even though I would have had a copay in network. If you can't read your plan, please have someone else read a d explain it to you. I call CMS first if I expect a problem. If my MA plan doesn't have a supplier within a reasonable distance, they have gone out of network. At one point Walmart optical refused to sell me the transition lens for the plans agreed upon price so I purchased the glasses anyway but complained vigorously and they sent me out of network to purchase another complete glasses both frames and lenses and paid the entire 420 dollars!"

↳ @trumpetingangel (5): "@Rnjeepshoelver Right. They are making money off of those plans, and that's money that just doesn't go to healthcare. Plain and simple."

↳ @glw5166 (4): "@GAderly-fn5ly Nobody should have to complain that much to get what they need. Very glad that it worked out for you but it may be denied for another."

"I am a former Computer Programmer and think very logically. I agree, the entire American Medical Industry is 100% criminal along with medical insurance companies. After I was eligible for Medicare I thought my med insurance problems were over. I found out EVERYTHING is so confusing and unnecessarily complicated it is a complete nightmare. It started with the governments little rule about if you are born on the 1st of the month your initial enrollment period is different. Then it went to you have 12 months to avoid part B (in some specific instances LOL) and not get the lifetime penalty. It is very strange and not by accident that you have to pay the government for medical insurance and THEN need go out to buy more medical insurance."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxVVOM4Fb2X-xO5SGJ4AaABAg>

↳ @TomSpeaks-vw1zp (19): "Thank you marblox9300. I'm just a 12th grade educated everyday citizen. I came to that same conclusion years ago. Now at age 84 all this double talk & different plans for this & maybe not for that makes my mind shut down. It's typical lawyer & government BS. If we considered all the spending waste in this country, healthcare could be 100% free & still have money left over."

↳ @evelynmitchell2888 (2): "I found out about the first of the month rule too, the hard way. They should put this in the information when they give you your Medicare instructions, which is a joke too. I am having the same issues."

↳ @MarlizeClarke (2): "this is excellent thank you"

"Turning 65 next year and Medicare enrollment is way more confusing than I expected assumed I'd just sign up and be done. then found out about Parts A, B, C, D, Medigap, and enrollment windows with actual penalties if you miss them biggest surprise: the enrollment window isn't just your birthday month, it's seven months — and missing it can mean a permanent premium penalty. a free broker consultation helped untangle Advantage vs Supplement plans more than searching on my own."

— r/medicare · 62 upvotes · None

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"My wife turned 65 a few years ago and I thought I was a wise man with the ability to think and understand things. NOT WITH MEDICARE. It is so confusing to the average American"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 55 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=21lIpLq6moM&lc=UgwxSooBO1Y9mfd2BV94AaABAq>

↳ @anacolon1142 (3): "Indeed it is. There is so much information that gets thrown at you all at once before you turn 65. I'm still confused."

"As I neared that magic 65 number (working full time) I thought long and hard. I put in my resignation for a month after my 65th birthday - helped them find and train my replacement and said 'bye-bye'!! THE best decision I ever made. Zero regrets. One reason (not the primary reason) was my agent explained that if you do not take it at 65 there are penalty-dates (as mentioned in the video) - so many that I didn't want to get caught forgetting something and have that effect me 'for life'. Way too many 'gotchas' to have to worry about. Taking it when I'm supposed to was ez-pz. :-)"

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 53 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzohqbvhjsdY5sSAwB4AaABAq>

↳ @snave59 (7): "There is no penalties if you keep working past 65,with insurance."

↳ @gurujr (5): "Your penalty free window is six months. Three months before and three months after you sixty fifth birthday to apply for Medicare. Even I couldn't screw that up."

↳ @gracekarina7186 (3): "I'm happy for you. When you say agent, who exactly do you mean? Thank you."

"I went on to the retirement court with Plan G. No major complaints with the exception of the recent premium increase and the truly impossible task of finding my cost share prior to treatment. My bigger complaint with this whole racket is the development (or lack there of) a system structured for intentional confusion. One should not need PhDs in multiple disciplines to understand their health insurance. No luv in this game."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyV6bKd_Qtj9cUgC4x4AaABAq

↳ @peterfrank1572 (6): "I'm in my 60's, retired, and I'm literally planing to leave the country before I reach 65. This is complete madness. And when you add the manufactured wars and immigration crisis, I've concluded that the American government only intent is to hurt as many people as they can !"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (4): "They don't make it easy :("

"What are the most common Medicare mistakes people make when turning 65? I work with people who are turning 65, and I've noticed some recurring Medicare pitfalls — like enrolling late, overpaying for the wrong plan, or thinking Medigap and Advantage are the same. I've been pulling together a checklist of the most common questions and confusion points people have when starting Medicare. Just wondering what others here think are the most common or costly mistakes you've seen? Would love to hear from other agents, advisors, or anyone who's helped a parent or client through it."

— r/medicare · 44 upvotes · None

"All I can say is wow! I'm 66 and past the age of choosing. I went with good old Medicare and medigap, thank goodness. But the research required to make good decisions was overwhelming. I'm happy that moving forward people will have access to your complete and well explained tutorial on this most important decision as we approach retirement. You have provided an incredible service, Erin, and I'm sure your dad is very proud of his daughter."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 38 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugzrq2ND9UayBnM6cKx4AaABAg>

"Thank you SOOOO much. You have answered questions for me that I have been asking for years! You made the information about choice of doctors and coverage area simple to understand without double talk that confused me. After listening to you I now understand the difference and I will always stay with Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 38 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxUgNQdZ9jImq_CnhR4AaABAg

"NPR: Older Americans say they feel trapped in Medicare Advantage plans JANUARY 7, 2024 8:10 AM ET HEARD ON WEEKEND EDITION SUNDAY By Sarah Jane Tribble - Kaiser Health News 3-Minute Listen (Story first aired on All Things Considered on January 3, 2023.) UNIDENTIFIED NARRATOR: Right now is the Medicare annual enrollment period. 2024 Medicare Advantage plans are now available, so everyone on Medicare can call to see if a Medicare Advantage plan may be better for you. RASCOE: The plans are private insurance that Americans 65 and older can sign up for instead of traditional Medicare. And lots of Americans are signing up in this open enrollment period through March. Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News reports that some regret signing up and then have trouble getting out. SARAH JANE TRIBBLE: Back in 2016, when Richard Timmins first signed up for Medicare, he went to a free informational seminar with an insurance agent. RICHARD TIMMINS: Basically, he really promoted Medicare Advantage. He just said, well, look, it's less expensive. It's broader in coverage. TRIBBLE: For Timmins, it made economic sense to sign up for Medicare Advantage instead of traditional Medicare, and that worked out great - for a while. Then, he found a small bump on the back of his right ear. TIMMINS: I have a family history of melanoma, so I was kind of tuned into that and thinking about that. TRIBBLE: But it took him a long time to see the right specialist in his Medicare Advantage network, and getting the paperwork in order was confusing. TIMMINS: It was starting to - it started to grow and started to become rather painful. TRIBBLE: By the time Timmins finally saw an oncologist, the lesion had grown to the size of a dime. His right earlobe needed to be removed. He thinks getting care using traditional Medicare would have been faster and easier, and David Meyers at Brown University School of Public Health says he's probably right. DAVID MEYERS: You can see any provider you want. There are many less sort of restrictions on care. You get a lot more freedom with traditional Medicare. TRIBBLE: Timmins wishes he could switch, but there's a catch. TIMMINS: Would I go back to traditional Medicare if it was not cost prohibitive? Absolutely. TRIBBLE: Traditional Medicare premiums average about \$170 a month. And while enrollees on Medicare Advantage plans still pay that premium, the monthly cost can be more affordable. That's because plan enrollees often don't have to pay for extra prescription coverage. They also don't have to buy supplemental insurance, usually called Medigap. That supplemental insurance is needed because, unlike Medicare Advantage plans, traditional Medicare doesn't cap out-of-pocket cost. The thing is, Timmins might not be able to get a Medigap policy anymore. Here's David Lipschutz, associate director of the Center for Medicare Advocacy. DAVID LIPSCHUTZ: Medigap is one of the few types of insurance that can exclude you based upon preexisting conditions unless you enroll during certain designated times. TRIBBLE: That designated time is primarily when you first sign up for Medicare. But since Timmins enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan instead of traditional Medicare and he has a preexisting condition, he could be denied Medigap or charged a lot more for it. While federal law generally prohibits insurers from denying people coverage because of preexisting conditions, Medigap is an exception. Lipschutz again. LIPSCHUTZ: It's a lot easier to get and stay in a Medicare Advantage plan, but a lot harder to get out and pick up a Medigap plan, depending upon where you are. TRIBBLE: Only four states require Medigap insurers to cover applicants regardless of age or health. But Timmins lives in Washington state, which isn't one of them. He wants people to know. TIMMINS: You can get screwed if you're on Medicare Advantage. The advantage kind of disappears once you need them. TRIBBLE: In the meantime, Timmins worries. There's a chance that his cancer could come back, and he'll be trapped on Medicare Advantage if it does. So he's focusing on what he can control. TIMMINS: You know, I'm a vegetarian. I don't drink. I don't smoke. I try to get exercise as much as possible. TRIBBLE: But he knows it might not be enough. RASCOE: That was Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News. Copyright © 2024 NPR. All rights reserved. Visit our website terms of use and permissions pages at www.npr.org for further information."

— r/medicare · 35 upvotes · None

"New to Medicare This Year - More Confusing Than I Thought! I had helped my mother and my mother-in-law with their Medicare in the past. I also had worked in Human Resources early in my career and learned a lot about insurance. So I thought that signing up for Medicare would be easy for me. But, not having looked at this stuff in at least 10 years, I found it a lot more confusing than I had expected! I'm turning 65 in a few months. I'm in SF Bay area of California. I already know that I want traditional Medicare and not Medicare Advantage. I started taking Social Security at the beginning of this year (2025) so I automatically got a Medicare number and automatically got enrolled into Parts A & B. Now I need to pick a Plan D for drugs and a Medigap plan, which I already know will be a Plan G. In that regard, perhaps I'm ahead of the game. But picking a Plan D and a Plan G is turning out to be much harder than I'd thought it would be. I was glad to have watched a few YouTube videos about the process for signing up for each of these things -- that helped a lot, as well as reading the Medicare website and some info from AARP, etc. I found out that some of the Part D plans I was considering have limits on how many pills can be filled in 30 days for some meds. An SSRI that I take requires 90 10mg pills each month, because I take 25 mg per day and there is no 25 mg pill (nor is there a 50 mg that can be cut in half). So the plans that limit me to 30 10mg pills per month are a non-starter. (Sure, I could probably have my doctor try to appeal and get the 90 pills per month covered, but there is no guarantee that the insurance company would agree....and then I'd be stuck! Not worth the hassle!) This information was kinda buried at the bottom of each Part D plan on the Medicare website. It would have been a "bad surprise" to learn this after the fact! Regarding Part G -- this really surprised me -- the only Part G plan for my area that shows the premium and extra perks upfront is the AARP United Healthcare plan. ALL of the others don't even have a special page (or set of pages) about their Medigap plans! How are you supposed to compare the plans if you can't even see what you're paying for? I understand that all of the plans cover the exact same things; that's not what I want to know. I want to see rate tables (because most of them are Attained Age plans. The AARP one is Community based rates, and one other that I'm considering, Transamerica, is age at issue based rate). I also want to see if there are any perks beyond the regular plan coverage (like gym membership or whatever). I don't want to have to go through an agent or get a broker involved. I've had bad experiences with them in the past. I want to do this myself and sign up directly with the insurance companies. I truly don't understand why NONE of the Medigap providers in my area have ANY information on their websites about Medicare or their Medicare plans. When you click on the "company website" link on the Medicare website, it takes you to a general home page about the insurance company. I have tried searching these websites for "Medicare" or "Medigap" or "Plan G" but the searches come up blank. Why even offer a Medigap plan if you're not going to show your benefits to your clients online???? I don't want to have to waste my time calling 3 or 4 insurance companies! Only AARP seems to be upfront with any of this stuff. It's so weird, and I truly don't understand it! Am I missing something or misunderstanding something? Are the insurance companies deliberately making it hard for people to understand exactly what they're buying??"

— r/medicare · 33 upvotes · None

"Thanks for the thorough explanation. I've been asking Medicare questions well before the requirement age of 65. And now 6 years later. I am just as confused. To top it off, I worked at an agency that did not pay into social security. Which means I have to pay a larger Medicare premium. Nobody has given an explanation like this about the differences in this Overwhelmingly confusing process. I subscribed."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxY7Fsdm7cNK0RMdXx4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (4): "Thanks Connie! Sorry you'll have to pay more than you should."

↳ @Kim7-77 (2): "Its so uneccesarily difficult to understand. I still don't know what to do!! I live in Manhattan, NY , just got approved for disability and I feel there are no options that I can afford ."

↳ @rmhalili (1): "There are some employers (read school districts) that don't contribute to Social Security, however, there is a separate line item for Medicare. I would check you paystub. If there is a medicare line with a dollar amount, and it has been paid for 40 quarters or more then you will get no premium Part A. Part B cost \$170.10/month for most middle class"

'Free' benefits that are a rip-off · 130 documents · 20 voices

"What pisses me off is... I did not sign up for prescription drug plan when I signed up for Medicare at age 65 because I wasn't taking any drugs. Later I was convinced to take the part D coverage. Then I find out I will have to pay a monthly penalty amount of \$18.00 for the rest of my life to the drug companies because I did not enroll in part D when I signed up for Medicare. (I am now 82 years old, in good health, and still do not take prescription drugs). It's a rip-off."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 312 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwYnNkAm7dPfm_ViEZ4AaABAg

↳ @OLDGUY7301 (25): "People go talk to a medicare agent. ITS FREE."

↳ @flufwix (21): "I agree, the penalty is a rip off"

↳ @jimroscovius (13): "Why didn't you know that? You've got to research and find out those things. That was in the first mailing I got about Medicare. Also, if you're in good health, you should take Medicare Advantage, which includes a drug plan."

"I retired from health insurance processing about 50% because of this scam. I did not have a single person who had a "Medicare Advantage", who had any advantage. The only ones getting an advantage here is the insurance companies, and the feds."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 177 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugz5qyDIIBnU7-nFzc14AaABAg>

↳ @davidlang1125 (5): "Actually the government is getting ripped off too."

↳ @catserver8577 (4): "@davidlang1125 Oh yeah, poor government. So ripped off they throw good money after bad."

↳ @davidlang1125 (3): "@catserver8577so under your reply was an option to translate into English. Yep, that's appropriate."

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"I turn 65 this August. I work in IT my brain is super sharp I do 500 situps a day 20 minutes olyptical a day don't drink don't smoke and I'm still fin lost!!! So now I'm supposed to find some financial shark who just might steal me blind. And I'm one of the sharp ones! What about the poor old people that are scammed and taken advantage of every day? What has society come to? This is an outrage! I've watched video after video and I'm still not certain of my best path. And I'm certainly not going to pay for someone who may or may not help me."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=s5hK1P7qkoc&lc=Ugz2DNxO1qpi1X0xEkF4AaABAg>

↳ @BarryWeaver-pv6cz (7): "@KrissyQueens It's extremely confusing!! She only touched on the most basic points of parts ABCD. There are many videos that are hours long discussing it. Then you need to know the specifics of each part, how much is covered, what is and isn't covered. I have more health problems than I can count, and this is super overwhelming. Especially since the single insurance I have now covers almost everything for a LOT less money. I might better work forever! Maybe thats why so many do work til they die."

↳ @KrissyQueens (2): "It's not that confusing she just explained it"

↳ @LisaTheisen-j8j (2): "@KrissyQueensdo happy you feel it's ok to shame people 🤔 do you feel better now?"

""Better than nothing" until you develop a serious medical issue and start racking up denial of service for treatments that your doctor orders. A lot of health groups are no longer taking "Disadvantage Plans" for this reason. Their liabilities increase exponentially due to the sub par treatment they are limited by MA plans. It's becoming a huge issue in many areas. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these plans. Medicare Advantage isn't medicare.... It's privatized insurance that the companies are making double the profits vs Medigap plans. It's by far the biggest scam of all. The government is paying between \$1200 to \$1800 monthly per person on these plans. Guess whos supplementing this waste. Those of us on regular Medicare."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 51 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAg.9xSID3dQbFn9yaOJ1rwxAD>

"I have just applied for retirement online and it is one of the most difficult things I've had to do. I am looking to get part B when I retire in June you can't talk to no one at Social Security. They never call back to help. appointments take months to get to. It is the biggest scam I ever been through. I worked all my life and now I gotta figure this crap out or else I get penalized. I don't get it. they should be helping seniors not stealing from us."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 40 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugz-0xA7Pfwicnl4hzV4AaABAg>

↳ @daw7773 (13): "Thanks to T he fired most of the social security workers.....now no one answers the phone and the community social security offices are either closed or opened for a limited amount of time or only scheduled appointments."

↳ @arandomorales4007 (7): "@daw7773 OK so you're a liberal and you have Trump derangement I get it. This has been happening ever since you voted for Brandon it didn't just start six months ago or a year ago. It's been going on for the last four years or longer. but it's OK. You can blame Trump for the the country he inherited from the last president social Security office in my city are open eight hours a day every day I don't know where you live"

↳ @catsanddogs8983 (3): "Its horrible, I started out two months before 65, called the office, had to wait over a month to get appt, then they called the day before and said the office was closing early and they would have to reschedule for another month and a half away, lol"

"Got an unsolicited bill e-mail. I have Aetna/CVS health through the Marketplace, not Oscar Insurance. All links are from HiOscar. Is this a scam? I tried to call the HiOscar phone number from the website and verified the website is legit. But all I receive is an automatic phone menu and can't reach a live person to ask about this. I feel like I shouldn't try to "log in" to HiOscar with my details, considering I DON'T have an account with them, I DON'T have their insurance. **UPDATE:** I called them! As it turns out, the insurance I had ended their marketplace plans for 2026. For some reason, this automatically signed me up for Oscar. The "bill" was the premium to pay before January 1st 2026 if I want their coverage. I didn't receive a single notice from EITHER company telling me about this upcoming transfer to Oscar. This was their fault and a legendary failure of communication."

— r/HealthInsurance · 35 upvotes · None

"I've been bombarded over the last few years to switch to the medicare advantage plan. It always sounds too good to be true; after reading a little bit about it I resisted because I haven't trusted it. I was right not to trust it."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 33 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxmT865uNNBDGTwxqV4AaABAg>

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do,before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎🏠🩺🙏🕊️🕊️🕊️"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixg9Id0w9OA&lc=UqxdqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAq>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MA Advantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to deliver the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"Fired from my medicare advantage job After getting my 215 license I started working at an agency that sells mapd, supplement, and hospital indemnity plans. Things were going great compared to fast food jobs I started making 1k+ a week and I wasn't even closing yet. Things started going down hill when I started closing my own deals after the agency bought me a few states. Aep was over and during oep I noticed the callers became increasingly hard to deal with. Most of them were only calling about a flex card, some of them didn't want to switch providers, while others stayed on the line just to curse me out and ask to be under the do not call list. I tried my best to close more deals and had no idea how other agents were even managing 5 deals a day compared to the calls I was receiving. Eventually I got called in the office and they decided to let me go. My question is where should I go from here? This is the first job I got fired from and I still have my license so I should be able to find a new job but now my confidence is at an all time low. What if I get fired again? ldk"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/

"Dear "Medicare Specialist": How about addressing the elephant in the room? It is said that Medicare Advantage won't be there when we need it (and that's probably true), but traditional Medicare PLUS SUPPLEMENTAL is unaffordable for many Americans, (women in particular, because we were paid so much less than men throughout our 50 years of working). If my social security is less than \$1000 a month, how do you expect me to pay for a supplemental plan? What choice does a person have other than to accept United Healthcare's scam of "Medicare Advantage" (and quite possibly die because of it)? What choice? You're the expert. Can you answer that question?"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 17 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1lpLq6moM&lc=UgzLtuuOve_Da6wcrip4AaABAg

↳ @juliava605 (7): "@LeeCountySpeedShop Well, at least I've never made the life choice to be an asshole, so...I win."

↳ @LeeCountySpeedShop (4): "You made bad life choices, that is on you, Social Security was never meant to be a retirement plan, it was always only meant to be a supplemental income for your retirement. My social security pays for my original medicare, Plan G and my Plan D drug plan. My wife's social security will also pay for her original medicare, Plan G and Plan D drug plan. We were smart and made sure we had a retirement plan so our retirement plan pays nothing towards our health insurance. You should not have went though life in a daze thinking you would be taken care of."

↳ @juliava605 (3): "@SheLovesKnowledge Respectfully, you are misinformed. Or misinforming. Perhaps both. If you think most seniors haven't contacted every possible path of help with Medicare, you're sorely mistaken. This is how it is, and it is THE ENTIRE REASON why companies like United Health (and others) have been allowed to offer these "Medicare Advantage" plans -- because there are so many of us who can't afford anything else. They have a literal license to screw us. And indeed they are. Please forgive my bitter tone, but I worked HARD for more than 50 years and paid into Medicare for all that time, and I'm left in a place that excuses bitterness."

"One more thing, folks.... yes, Medicare is supposed to cover dental now, I think. But if they see the prefix "perio" on anything, you are NOT covered. As our gums deteriorate over the years, treatment for them in any way is not covered by anyone. I don't think there is such a thing as dental insurance anymore, and if there is, it is a pure ripoff because it will be capped at around \$2,000. Anything after that is all yours and it will be a lot. What they do have now are "dental discount plans." But no coverage for any periodontal work. If a dentist even LOOKS at your gums, be ready to cough up some major bucks. And even with a dental plan you will pay big, big bucks if you need any kind of major work, like a bridge or an extraction "by a specialist." You bet I'm angry. After working since 1971 full time in IT (information technology) and made good money, and maxed out my 401k contributions - guess what, after the big recession, what is left is not enough to live on. I am very surprised that our president, with all the tariffs, and everything else, has not done much for the everyday people. Along with huge rent and utility payments, with electricity and water going sky high for AI data centers, more people than ever will never be able to afford a good Medicare plan."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugy4dImjy8eYocHABU14AaABAg

↳ @bellaclyde (2): "Trump has trumped us all"

↳ @namllenum00 (1): "@bellaclyde better than Biden, just care to put money in his pocket and cover for his family. leave politic out please"

↳ @raulhodge3314 (0): "Quit watching the 6:00 news propaganda"

"I learned about medicare advantage in one of my college courses on public administration... glad LWT can share how much of a scam it is. Hopefully this reaches people who need to know this stuff."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCC&lc=Ugy2TXrYyqrI519dhm54AaABAg>

"Thank you for explaining this. When I get mailings soliciting my participation in a medical insurance plan, it's ALWAYS for an advantage plan. Until I watched your video, I didn't know why there are so many advantage plans looking to hook me up. They talk about free gym membership, vision and hearing test coverage...all kinds of tempting offerings. But I suspected, and your video confirmed this, there is big money to be made by companies offering advantage plans. Money for them, not medical coverage for me. I just toss these mailings. I have a Medicare Supplement plan, and I'm keeping it!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyZJY-LBhqJi3DjwOF4AaABAg>

↳ @EXPLOREWITHME. (1): "Do we get prescription and dental with original Medicare?"

↳ @janetbetts5159 (0): "@EXPLOREWITHME.NO.....Medicare does not pay for prescriptions or provide dental."

↳ @Jkaye13 (0): "@EXPLOREWITHME. No, part D needs to be added on for your drug coverage"

"I am on an advantage PPO plan even though I can afford a plan G. It works for me, but it may not work for others. Erik at The Retirement Nerds is very good at presenting the pros and cons of different choices. I like the one plan for all approach (medical, dental, vision, hearing, drugs, etc). With the free gym membership, I now work out in a gym at least once a week. Some people hate MA plans because they consider insurance companies monsters. Don't forget that insurance companies make money off your medigap plans too."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgygHOcla3eZluceAOZ4AaABAg>

↳ @jp107ms (3): "@SilverSergeantI'm happy that I don't have to pay for a medigap premium, a dental plan, a vision plan, a drug plan, and an annual physical. I don't worry about my doctors leaving the network next year. There are many doctors in the network and I don't have a must-see doctor."

↳ @SilverSergeant (1): "You are happy with putting your health care in the hands of someone other than yourself? Are you happy with the fact that your doctors might be out of network next year?"

"I turn 65 in about 8 months and still do not understand Medicare. Anything this utterly confusing has got to be some kind of scam. Of course, anything about government healthcare is a scam in the first place. I have watched at least 20 videos on medicare and have no more understanding of exactly what it is than before seeing the first one. It is just more people wanting another piece of my money as far as I am concerned."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211lpLq6moM&lc=Ugygro_vH19Oogf8kHN4AaABAg

↳ @lovingchange2761 (3): "I think they make it hard for us to understand on purpose."

↳ @LeeCountySpeedShop (0): "It is not complicated, I did this on my own no broker needed. I chose to go with original medicare and Plan G and picked a Plan D drug plan. What you need to look at is the fact as we all age the majority of us will need more medical care with that aging. To many people think because they feel good when they first sign up for medicare that they can pick an Advantage plan if when they get sick they will just switch over to original medicare and a Plan G and a Plan D drug plan, but that is not how it works, first you will have to under go a medical underwriting and because you are now sick you will more than likely be denied for original medicare with a Plan G. Choose smarty from the start, yes original Medicare and Plan G along with Plan D Drug will cost you more than an Advantage plan but the truth is Original Medicare with a Plan G is far better medical coverage in the end with the smallest out of pocket expense. Mine this year is \$283 dollars out of pocket."

↳ @SpicyLakeEffect (0): "It is not that complicated. There are plenty of materials to read online, and numerous services that provide help for free. Look in your area for organizations that support older people and ask them if they have an advisor (they have this in my area). Also, you have two choices when it comes to healthcare. Buy it, or go without. Simple. It is not a scam. It's just like going to a restaurant. Do you want the plain burger, or do you want fries, ketchup, pickles and onions. You're not going to walk into a restaurant and get a meal for free, so read the menu and decide what you're willing to pay for."

"This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAg.AQRDpjyFSLVATQZEF7w02m>

"NEVER take advice from someone that makes money from the choices they recommend, like this guy. I have a degree in Economics specializing in social insurance, and an MBA. I've had Supplemental and Advantage insurance plans. I prefer Advantage plans in my area. Zero premium, zero cost family doctor, every medical profession in my city are in network, I've never had any surgery or treatment turned down, my medications are all free except for one high cost brand and that costs me \$45 per month, free dental care, free eye exams and glasses, free hearing and discounted hearing aids. They have a national network of doctors."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugxfb9YPgrZZhd4mdaR4AaABAg.A39qIFzRM4eA6eCpDRLFek>

"I have medicare and a supplement - between the two I am recovered from a serious injury that I sustained when hit by a car. I would never buy into an advantage plan because I see them as scammy."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyIXDoI0zr7cScdO_Z4AaABAg

↳ @g0989 (1): "Good that you had that coverage. I take it the driver of the car that hit you did not have liability insurance?"

↳ @JaneDough-i2c (0): "My husband had cancer Medicare with supplements took the very best care of him. Nothing was denied."

"Thank you for this information. I just turned 66. I work part time because I dont get enough social security benefits to cover living expenses. I am single and even tho Ive worked since age 16, wages were much lower back in the 70s and 80s. I waitressed, so official pay was low. Medicare is \$175 a month. I only get enough socsec benefits to cover my rent, so all other bills are paid by my part time job. I honestly do not know how other single people are making it in these modern days of high prices. Is thete a better plan for people like me? I have parts A & B, not on meds and no major medical issues. What is that plan where they give you grocery money?"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=Ugw2fxNuJkiFe-i6onZ4AaABAg>

↳ @west8864 (1): "I definitely suggest you apply for Medicaid, to supplement your Medicare benefits and cover your coinsurances. Neither Medicare or Medicaid will cover your groceries but the two together should cover all your medical expenses."

Premiums that keep going up · 96 documents · 20 voices

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (19): "Thanks for sharing your experience. You're not alone — I've seen a lot of people face those same big increases on Plan G. Plan N usually ends up being the smarter long-term choice because of the lower premiums, and for most people the extra cost-sharing is pretty minimal compared to what they save each year. With how fast rates are climbing, especially going into 2026, your switch makes a lot of sense."

↳ @christinestephenson1742 (11): "I have Mutual of Omaha supplement since 2019. It's maybe 130 a month and has just gone up a bit each year."

↳ @jayes8191 (6): "@policyguides Could Plan N's extra cost sharing increase significantly if Medicare reimbursements decrease in 2026?"

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugxmqe1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAg

↳ @ls-aka-Pari (2): "What do you do if you really can't afford any extra payment, say if your SSI is very low?"

↳ @cristianbaluta1232 (1): "The government is composed of a bunch of careless irresponsible incompetent people who are there for one goal only - to get all the money from those outside the government. To expect these people to do their "job" is naive bordering stupidity."

↳ @rachelisnosy (1): "@ls-aka-Pari Definitely apply for Medicaid. Some people only get their part B premium paid for, but that's still \$200 that you don't have to spend each month. Regardless of what type of plan you have, you can apply for a social security program called Extra Help. It will cap your drug copays at \$12.65, even if the drug costs \$2000 normally. I would recommend anyone without Medicaid, to apply for it. Don't talk to any of those people who cold call you. I would ask your doctor's office who they work with, they'll know which companies work with them the best."

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · None

"I went on to the retirement court with Plan G. No major complaints with the exception of the recent premium increase and the truly impossible task of finding my cost share prior to treatment. My bigger complaint with this whole racket is the development (or lack there of) a system structured for intentional confusion. One should not need PhDs in multiple disciplines to understand their health insurance. No luv in this game."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyV6bKd_Qtj9cUgC4x4AaABAg

↳ @peterfrank1572 (6): "I'm in my 60's, retired, and I'm literally planing to leave the country before I reach 65. This is complete madness. And when you add the manufactured wars and immigration crisis, I've concluded that the American government only intent is to hurt as many people as they can !"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (4): "They don't make it easy :("

"I am a 78 yr old male. The Illinois Department of Insurance approved a 40% rate increase for Mutual of Omaha in 2025. My supplement plan G is costing me \$357.63 per month and will continue to go up every year. This is why people switch to medicare advantage plans even if they are not as good."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 44 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzuyd4qcwbDPIJZq6V4AaABAg

↳ @micheleyoungblood (8): "I don't think it'd be wise to go on Medicare advantage. Just get away from Mutual of Omaha. If you can medically underwrite go on to a plan N or G with another company. The worst case scenario go on a high-deductible plan g. That's much better than a advantage plan. It works basically the same where you have a max out of pocket which is the deductible. You still have all the benefit of a plan g plan where you have your choice of whatever doctor you want to go to no prior authorization and you just pay the 20% of all your bills until you get to the deductible. So if you are not hospitalized or having a major incident then you probably will never hit the deductible and you'll pay 20% of everything that you deal with medically. Medicare will pay its 80% Where I live high deductible G is around 40 to 45 dollars a month. I'm also looking at Transamerica as an option. You actually can only go straight to that company it's Transamerica Life insurance company you'll find their phone number on medicare.gov. They're in all 50 states. And they are the only company, at least in my state, that is an issue age company versus attained age that all the other ones are my state. My state insurance commissioner department gave me their increases over the past 15 years. Their plan N barely went up over a 15-year period of time and their plan G went up but nowhere near up as high as the attained age plans went up. In my state I'm being told that Mutual of Omaha is the least expensive plan and I'm very nervous to go with them after seeing everything they do in other states. There's several companies that have been in the state for less than 5 years and I'm not comfortable with that. So I'm heavily leaning on Transamerica Plan N."

↳ @policyguides (6): "Yes, I actually recall getting notice of that specific rate increase in illinois. And you're right, situations like that are what force people to Medicare Advantage. Have you tried to shop and compare your rate with other companies?"

↳ @lindashuman8510 (5): "Please shop around with other insurance companies. Monthly premiums vary with the exact coverage."

"It's ridiculous that the premium is going up 207.85 a month in Jan 26 . Yet I get bills owing money why give a cola when medicare takes it 😞 how are people supposed to live or afford a doctor this is so sad smh"

— YouTube · Medicare Explained in Plain English — Every Part, Every Cost, Every Decision · 38 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ooZKCnbXw-M&lc=Ugz87Y6z7EhfOX7mh-14AaABAg>

↳ @luisg6404 (9): "@harleygirlva it's like the cola is a gift to the insurance companies..."

↳ @kimfleury (9): "I think the COLA was enacted by Congress solely to benefit their insurance company donors."

↳ @hildanavarro8236 (7): "JUST SICKENING, HIWAY ROBBERY, IF THIS ISNT COMMUNISM, DONT KNOW WHAT IS. 🤔"

"I was diagnosed with cancer in 2022 at age 64, 1 year before qualifying for Medicare at age 65. Made the decision to purchase a Part G supplemental plan in 2023 (at which time cancer in remission) easy. Max. coverage and can see any doctor that accepts Medicare. Premiums are affordable, though they'll increase yearly both with inflation and age adjustments. But I already have a chart of the age adjustments, so that helps in planning. I did also have to buy a Part D drug plan, but wasn't a big deal. I'm paying less than \$20/mo. I pay more for pet food."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 37 likes · http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwcXvMjV0iLH5MErUd4AaABAg.A1KdKhnuifT3OzAu_SgQ

"@Theretirementnerds You mention "no penalties" for not taking Medicare. What about premium adjustments based on a physical health exam? I heard if you don't take Medicare at 65, when you take it later your premiums can be tied to / increased based on health status."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzvnWfn7UY4KMDm2dh4AaABAg.A2YTnw2aj9YA3EJGBvyDLb>

"Thanks again Erin! Yes, for my husband who has all kinds of chronic medical conditions, we missed the window for Medigap after he turned to 65. So we got Medicare advantage for him, and it has worked out. Then when I turned 65 a year ago, I hopped right on Medigap. I have no medical conditions, fairly healthy, and I am on one prescribed medication. I actually ended up paying far more than he did throughout the year and Medigap and part D were about to increase significantly. So I changed to Advantage and to save over \$3000 this year."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxkRafGlwGdwZhaAGt4AaABAg>

↳ @bozomonster (3): "Your experience is very common."

"I'm 73, had plan g since the beginning, been healthy, disappointed that my premium went up to 268 a month, thinking of switching to advantage plan. And I'm disappointed that my agent didn't help me understand about Medicare part D, which I did not sign up for, and now I have to pay penalties from now on. I am in Texas, and I hope I have a memory like an ELEPHANT for all that you have explained."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=Ugx1SAL00qKcb-uYy2t4AaABAq>

"We are in GA and are opting for Plan G High Ded. It saves us about \$250+ a month and rate increases are rare to low with most carriers. Every 10 months that is enough savings to pay our MOOP if needed. With the risings premiums of G and N, we think this is the only way to "future proof".

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgziynoPWfSkB_5Mcl4AaABAq

↳ @luckylewy1628 (0): "@medicare365Actually, it's a good plan."

"Everything you said is spot on! I I don't understand how this guy can generalize something as broad as a medicare into a little 16 minute video. There's so many other reasons why somebody would choose a Medicare Advantage plan as opposed to a supplement plan. Aside from your part B why would you pay a monthly premium for some thing that keeps going up for the most part every single year plus pay a separate premium for your part D drug plan plus pay copayment on top of that. You mentioned low income subsidy there's also state Medicaid and that comes along with a bunch of other benefits."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoROzLPt1BvWDah4AaABAq.9ddfYsCBVXV9ebV_Qoo0T5

"Your discussion while very informative, ignores the very real IRMAA adjustment to the Medicare Part B premium. I found out the hard way. While the 2026 Part B premium increases to \$202 per month, my Part B premium will increase by and additional \$324.60 per month for a total Part B premium of \$527.50 due to IRMAA (this is in addition to the premium I pay for my Medigap plan). This increase in my Part B premium is due to the fact that I withdrew monies from my 401(k) plan to maintain a fairly standard middle class lifestyle as I live in San Diego, which is a very high cost of living area. Moreover, the IRMAA adjustment must be paid regardless of whether one enrolls in a Medigap or an Advantage Plan. Many seniors are not aware of this time bomb when withdrawing from their 401(k)s. Perhaps a video focusing on IRMAA would benefit and alert seniors about this seemingly "hidden" Part B premium increase that is lying in wait."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxB-sft1CicsFwsf3B4AaABAq>

"@marblox9300 Exactly. It comes down to what you can afford, and the premiums keep going up as you age, but you are spending through your savings as you age also. Yes, we all want original Medicare with a Plan G! What we can afford as we age is the real question."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugyx2vSFo0pDKeUHZFZ4AaABAq.AKZo_sH5elVcALyXGwbuzxg

"The increase in premiums of my Plan G policy has increased by crazy amounts these past 2 years. I turned 73 this month and my Plan G premium rose to \$330 per month (from \$279)! Last year's increase was almost as bad. This is getting ridiculous. At this point my total cost for Medicare per year (Parts A, B, D and Plan G supplement) is over \$6,000!"

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyD0hm7qFko3Fd7ArB4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "It makes the supplement route hard for many. Supplement coverage amazing, but the cost can get prohibitive 😞 "

"I don't think it'd be wise to go on Medicare advantage. Just get away from Mutual of Omaha. If you can medically underwrite go on to a plan N or G with another company. The worst case scenario go on a high-deductible plan g. That's much better than a advantage plan. It works basically the same where you have a max out of pocket which is the deductible. You still have all the benefit of a plan g plan where you have your choice of whatever doctor you want to go to no prior authorization and you just pay the 20% of all your bills until you get to the deductible. So if you are not hospitalized or having a major incident then you probably will never hit the deductible and you'll pay 20% of everything that you deal with medically. Medicare will pay its 80% Where I live high deductible G is around 40 to 45 dollars a month. I'm also looking at Transamerica as an option. You actually can only go straight to that company it's Transamerica Life insurance company you'll find their phone number on medicare.gov. They're in all 50 states. And they are the only company, at least in my state, that is an issue age company versus attained age that all the other ones are my state. My state insurance commissioner department gave me their increases over the past 15 years. Their plan N barely went up over a 15-year period of time and their plan G went up but nowhere near up as high as the attained age plans went up. In my state I'm being told that Mutual of Omaha is the least expensive plan and I'm very nervous to go with them after seeing everything they do in other states. There's several companies that have been in the state for less than 5 years and I'm not comfortable with that. So I'm heavily leaning on Transamerica Plan N."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzuyd4qcwbDPIJZq6V4AaABAg.ANfoQUYAWLqANw7m6j3UX

"@FrazierMtnCheese I just googled this and yes, this is true. \$206.50 for monthly premium and \$288 for annual deductible for 2026. I will turn 65 next April and seeing the premiums, cost increases, the demand for Plan D premiums, then finding a plan N or G and those premiums... This is really starting to piss me off. This is so unfair to the USA elderly population. The amount of taxes we have paid through the years to federal and states, but the rich get the tax breaks. WTH?"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxMz1FhzbdIGI2FLL54AaABAg.AOISqHoCZQ5AOLHJis-lx6>

"Retired 3 years ago in August, Wife and I chose Supplemental. It is a great plan, and we like it so far, but Premiums have almost doubled in three years! Kind of makes me anxious to think they may continue to double every three years! That and SSA Retirement COLA..... (which BTW is a whole other conversation. How does a 2.8% Cola, benefit you when insurance rates, taxes, food and energy go up 30%?) is way less than Medicare Premium increase, and now talk of SSA cuts by 2032?!?! Getting old is not for the faint of heart."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugypbezb4wVhgE9eG754AaABAg>

"Thank you for this video. I've been covered by my employer's health plan and just this month got sucker-punched by skyrocketing premiums. I was going to go with a supplemental plan but I already know I can't absorb premiums that increase every year, so I either do an advantage plan or nothing except Part B. I don't have a lot of time to figure it out so I'm watching and will be making some inquiries to agents in the next few weeks. Wish me luck. We had to say goodbye to our canine furbaby almost exactly two years ago. We brought him home from the shelter when he was three years old and had him until he was sixteen and a half years old."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyetnMUQw0OxOpTsTI4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "Losing a pet is so hard. We had the same about a year and a half ago. Highly recommend using an agent. He or she can help take away a lot of stress for you."

↳ @rosemobley4978 (0): "🙏 Sorry for the loss of your pet."

Agents and callers who push or mislead · 24 documents · 20 voices

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. ** I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · None

"Also something you should know is that they call people to sell them a Medicare Advantage plan, and often are vague enough that people don't realize they're changing their current insurance; I have worked in Spanish-English for that and it's incredibly frustrating to see people getting fleeced and not being able to do anything about it"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 35 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyVJryCEy987oe5uYR4AaABAq.AOn7k8cHtlhAOnzLJF13Sx>

"I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgzxQ6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAq.AOmGYDg472zAOmUZITAtAk>

"This is really an individual decision. My husband refused part b because I was still working and covered him under my insurance. However, my insurance had a \$5500 deductible, but after that it paid 100%. At the time, part b cost \$105 per month. I honestly don't remember what I paid for "family" coverage but it was around \$250 per month, but remember that deductible! So my husband's claims (he was chronically ill) went to my insurance first and they applied the cost to deductible and paid nothing. But then it went to Medicare and the deductible at the time was \$147. Then they paid 80%. Long story short, Medicare paid until my insurance kicked in! We ended up paying a lot less and it was easier to manage because the \$1260 we paid over the year for Medicare was of course deducted from his check. You need to run your own numbers to see if it makes sense for you!"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugzxlb4vLpWJs1pshu54AaABAq>

"I switched to Medicare advantage when they lied to me on the phone and told me all the medications I was taking were covered. MULTIPLE WERE NOT! A year later I switched back to regular Medicare never looking back."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyqXuqZdiY16Hpur3J4AaABAq>

↳ @mscoyote50 (1): "You're lucky. Once you're padt a year, you really can't switch back without underwriting and most of us older people have underlying "conditions"..."

"They let them call their advantage plans Part C Medicare. I had a broker call me and asked if I had Part A and B, but informed me that I did not have Part C -which includes the vision and hearing. they can be very misleading, not informing you that you are moving off of original Medicare. My husband and I signed up for Original Medicare at the same time and got a 12% discount for life and we settled on the plan N supplement. It runs close to \$96-100 a month at this time. I studied for two years before getting a Medicare! I'm glad there's experts out there to guide people. I watched this YouTube channel a lot. Plus, I worked in healthcare, and most healthcare people would never get on an advantage plan. Another interesting fact, if you have even a small business LLC, and are not eligible under an employer plan, you can deduct all your Medicare premiums on your taxes. Good luck everyone ♥ Also, we must fight against the pre-approval thing for Original Medicare that they are trying in six states. Just let our doctors do their jobs without having an insurance company /AI control our healthcare."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugx8-SKsHLLxtx8pUx94AaABAq.AXCWq9hDlvoAXOLEpUQfht>

"Full disclosure: licensed agents are paid for every person they sign up for an Advantage plans and continue to receive a monthly commission for each Advantage plans sold. That's why 53% of Medicare members sign up for Advantage -- they were pressured into it."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxDS3kQ1AayVrq-grp4AaABAq>

↳ @gdogdennis6407 (0): "not correct- they are paid a one time fee annually of a max of 694 dollars, and half that if you renew the next year-- supplement plans earn them a monthly commission based on your premium"

↳ @tom-lt4zw (0): "They also receive a commission for G and N plans. Your price is no different than buying from insurance company directly. You just get an opinion on all the companies offering the plans at different prices."

"@herrickinman9303 You are in the minority! Enjoy it while it lasts. You are taking very big risks to save money because if and when they start denying care it could cost you your life! MA plans are notorious for denying expensive care and rehab. They are even using AI to do it. If your rehab is denied you can either pay out of pocket while you appeal which can take a year to hopefully win if you are still alive or go home and do without! People have died waiting for their appeal. NH rehab is around \$18K a month where I live in Milwaukee WI. Most people can't afford that. You are gambling on your health and bragging but if you lose it could be your life. Many MA plans have gone out of business. They are pushing HMO's now and less benefits. I'm curious who is the insurance company? A local or state non-profit? I'm taking the High deductible Medicare Plan G when I turn 65 so I'll be able to afford it hopefully for life since I live in a state with no anniversary or birthday rules to change even your medigap plan. God only knows what the future will be for MA plans, but I want nothing to do with them! I've had to fight with insurance companies most of my life. I can't wait till finally having Original Medicare where what my Dr says is done no questions asked, no prior authorizations or delays or denials!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugw5dC0g1BZMxjki_R54AaABAq.AXCcpco9qRzAZVanaVK69D

"I am 66 and get bombarded by these guys . I don't want to spend more money on Medicare advantage. Most of what I need is part A and B . Yes it is very complicated. I did not need advantage and yes they they do pressure all the time. And by the way John Oliver I think you are brilliant and funny I watch you all the time but you my friend will be a senior in a blink of time. And you were right on in your explanation of medicare and medicare advantage."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=Ugz6NdNt1zoY7vraE2R4AaABAq>

"Thank you Erin for so well explained these healthcare confusions! I wish this video would have came out a year ago. I'm 66 and I was confused by all these last year when I needed to enroll. My broker only pushed me to enroll in Medicare Advantage and it seems to be a better choice due to the lower cause. As you said, I'm lucky that I'm still healthy now but choosing Medigap may be a better choice down the road."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwZrnBS3BHQIMpP7-x4AaABAq>

"Be careful how you use a broker if you want a Medigap policy. Sure, they can help explain the differences between the various lettered plans, and that's very valuable, but brokers don't necessarily represent all of the possible insurers you can buy a plan from. In my opinion, once you know what type of Medigap plan you want, i.e., G, N, etc. , go on Medicare.gov and see which insurance companies are available in your area for that plan. That site will also give you the approximate premiums. You can then narrow it down by price a little, if you want, but some insurers might be better than others. That's when your state's SHIP office might be able to give you some insight. You can also research insurers on your own When you eventually contact a broker, ask them which of the insurance companies on your list they represent. I suggest that you do that upfront because they probably don't represent all of the insurers on your list that you are interested in. If they don't, then they may push you toward an insurer they represent, which might not be in your best interest. When I went through this last year, that was one of the initial questions I asked the first broker I spoke to. When I ultimately narrowed it down to an insurer that broker did not represent, I contacted a different broker which represented that company, because that company only sold through agents. YMMV"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1wksnot/turning_65_next_year_and_medicare_enrollment_is/patxmyj/

"It's a hoot but also sad. I went with a Medigap plan. When they tried to push me into an Advantage plan I called my primary's billing dept and asked, "do you take so and so? Because it's a PPO plan and they say they cover out of network." The woman I spoke to said "no, they don't even bother to submit claims anymore because they always get denied." And none of my providers were in network. None. I didn't want to have to change half a dozen doctors. And most of the new doctors weren't local to me. It appears that almost nobody in my county accepted that insurer's Advantage plan. And the whole reason I was looking at that particular insurer is because that's what was offered via my retiree benefits. I was thinking of going with a different insurer but my benefits reimburse me \$900+ on premiums. I can take that reimbursement and throw it at a plan D and dental insurance."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1oj9p5y/john_oliver_riffs_on_medicare_advantage/nm1g4kq/

"Great unbiased Advice for Medicare users. I was intrigued by the approach of askchapter -- provide unbiased advice for Medicare users, without an incentive to push a particular plan. They have no incentives to push plans that Chapter get paid for. The reps are incented to provide unbiased advice purely based on the best value for the Medicare subscriber. I decided to check them out and asked them: "What plan should I change to -- I am on Medicare with Tricare for Life as second payer." The rep asked me what Medicare I subscribed to (Parts A and B only) and advised me to continue with this plan configuration, but to NOT sign up for any additional plans (Medicare supplement plans, for example). Great advice, friendly and detailed interaction -- an exceptional experience!"

— TrustPilot · askchapter.org · 5★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69bc1c49c3dc4dc6a5dc11b8>

"I get tired of seeing these videos saying MA is not a good choice. Not everyone has the same health and income situation. For some people MA is a better choice. Not everyone can afford the supplement plans with regular Medicare especially if you have on going health issues. I've had serious neck and back issues and had a MA plan the last year and half. My doctors in my area are in network and I haven't had any issues either tests and procedures. Sure they pushed back on a prior approval but the surgeon got it approved"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=Ugz1mEIoCamEulRHNbJ4AaABAq>

"Thank you for this. I found it informative & helpful. I've been on regular Medicare plus a Supplemental (not Advantage) for the past few years. My agent has never tried to push me onto Advantage (even though he would get paid a commission for that), nor has he pushed Medicare-only (even though my expense have been thankfully minimal). I may choose the "HD" plan for next year after seeing your video... but will consider all options carefully. Thanks for shedding some SUNBURN... I mean, sunlight--- on these issues!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugwz6sk-OCmNb4s28VR4AaABAg>

"@AbtInsuranceAgency The payout to agents is almost triple from what I researched. I was not correct that agents aren't paid every year for Medigap plans, they are but it's generally 10% of the premium. The Medicare Advantage plans pay \$600-750 the first year with a much higher yearly payout. It's in the salesperson's best interest to sell an MA policy. I think that's something you should be exposing; there's a financial incentive for agents to push an MA policy. Source: The Commonwealth Fund"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgyMntrSGH2A9tiPQUh4AaABAg.A_I2YT78_TjA_J8E3hEv8a

"My biggest issue is when I was first eligible for Medicare none of the so called "experts" even mentioned the medigap plans. Seems many of your broker brethren were/are more interested in the bonus incentive they get from the Insurance Co's for pushing the advantage plans than really explaining them and the pros and cons of both. Never once did anyone of these people mention of the Advantage plan pit fall if you aren't happy with your decision."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxERpou5oyOxEiO8qd4AaABAg>

"Thanks for this! I am turning 65 in a few months. I talked to two brokers today, and both tried to push me towards a Medicare Advantage plan. I did my due diligence prior to the call and immediately came to the conclusion I did not want a Medicare Advantage plans due to out of pocket costs and more importantly the horror stories I have heard of denials and referral red tape."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyYUuvwB4My7vox9p14AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "call us - we are brokers that have your best interest in mind. We represent you. 800-847-9680"

"@AbtInsuranceAgency thank you for your reply From what I read, they consider my insurance through work as primary. Letting me drop my insurance, I don't know if they will allow that. They will help you transition to Medicare, but I'm afraid they will push an advantage plan. Having to pay 20% for my husband's oxygen would make an advantage plan a disadvantage plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgweocusRWHdzp3ZAZJ4AaABAg.9xrYmaO9yTH9xt-CZ6eD72>

"@ don fannin - read the comments above. There is a comment from an agent that states they make 3 times the commission to have you go with an Advantage plan. My agent "pushed me & assumed I wanted an Advantage plan" I chose a supplement - plan G. Now I know why I was pushed as I am new to Medicare. Her attitude changed when I decided on the supplement."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugzn2_uF65H8JzojVpt4AaABAg.9Sux7M1FTTh9WR12J3iarR

Prior authorization and insurers second-guessing doctors · 13 documents · 13 voices

"I am a nurse. I am amazed at how many people who have advantage plans actually think they have Medicare. They forget that those insurance companies are in this business to make money. There is only one way for them to do that. Pay out less than they take in. Those plans sound fabulous. However, don't get sick! Fighting for care, and still being denied is a nightmare as you mentioned. I remember a case that I was working on. The patient was threatening to stroke. They desperately needed to have a carotid surgery. The Dr was on the phone and the company would NOT give permission for this patient to have surgery that would prevent the stroke. I would never get an advantage plan. I'll pay for my own gym membership and toothpaste!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 160 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw3YwX-OW2erk9tJPN4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (20): "Smart move on your part. Unfortunately, marketing and gimmicks sell."

↳ @christinedaley5580 (17): "@medicare365don't need free q tips when you're dead.,😞😞😞 "

↳ @appaloosa42 (9): "It amazes me how poorly people value long term planning!"

"I call the plan Medicare Disadvantage. The plans are a nightmare. I learned while helping relatives. Had awful problems getting nursing home/rehabilitation approval which was week by week after brain aneurysm that burst surgery and heart surgery/pneumonia/cancer stage 4 diagnosis"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgykHw4XiDzhW4u-MZx4AaABAg>

"Thanks for sharing this information .Prior to my retirement 2 years ago I was an RN in an acute hospital.It was a nightmare sometimes getting approval from an Advantage Plan office for most things,patients would get upset as they had no clue this might happen."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwreA4fmD8KJzkui9p4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (3): "Hi Margaret. I understand. My wife was director of billing and Medicare analyst for a local medical center. The stories she has to tell were heartbreaking. Yes, the lack of transparency within the Medicare industry is harmful to consumers."

"I had moved from another state and develop some serious health problems after a lifetime a perfect health. When I signed up for Medicare I was not aware that I had to get medigap within the first 6 months. Needless to say, every year when I try to sign up for medigap, I am denied or will pay an outrageous monthly bill. If a person has had a heart stent within the last year, they are automatically denied. It needs to be very clear that a medigap program is absolutely needed, even if you don't completely need it. When you decide that you do, you are made to pay for pre-existing conditions or denied."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgykxBns009Os0UTIEp4AaABAg.9z5WnbWAMV1AMBMDnW2gFu>

"Hate to tell you this but prior approval and denial of services is coming to supplemental plans too in several states in 2026. Now 12 states (including mine) can deny claims and require prior authorization just like Advantage care does starting in 2026. If the supplemental insurance companies from other states see this as a success to make even more money, Congress will approve their state too. Better stop thinking that Supplemental is going to continue being immune to prior authorization and refusals of claims. And those 12 states changing supplemental to act like Advantage in 2026 are already petitioning congress to require networks for supplemental too. And in 2026 most PPO Advantage plans are being canceled and plans with part B give back premium benefits are going away too. And thanks to the BBB, Medicaide for those who cant afford their insurance are being cut in droves. Agents need to quit telling people that Supplemental policies are always the safety call, immune to the things Advantage has dealt with. The Republican party has for a long time been wanting to completely get rid of Medicare Supplemental and privatize all Medicare leading to its destruction. So for those agents spouting the same old BS about "just pay a PartB and a Supplemental premium and a Plan D premium (which most Americans cant afford) youd better pay attention to what is changing. In 2026, 12 states and in 2027 likely more, prior authorizations and AI refusal of claims starts in 2026. Youll find you are just paying ever increasing unaffordable premiums for the same crappy services or lack thereof that Advantage has been known for. Most Supplemental plans are increased now at least 10% or more per year, making them almost impossible to afford for Seniors that arent wealthy. Most Congressmen will continue passing whatever the insurance companies want them to. Many of them are financially tied to insurance company profits. Its not in their best interest to stop the insurance companies immoral and illegal behaviors. They're not cutting fraud at all like they want you to think. They want to help their rich insurance company buddies to become even richer at the seniors expense in cut benefits. You want to stop fraud really? Then go after the crooked insurance companies who constantly deny claims they shouldnt and those that are begging to change Supplemental plans to being as worthless as Advantage Care. And heavily penalize insurance companies upcoding and making false claims themselves. Most of fraud comes from the insurance companies, not individuals trying to scam the system. Remember when we thought reaching 65 would be the beginning of our wonderful Medicare benefits. Now youll have to fork out at least \$210 per month for almost worthless Advantage Care or \$350 to \$700 per month for Supplemental. Thats not right. Its not a choice of plan type for over 50% of Americans and not bad judgement as you seem to imply to choose not to pay \$500 per month when you cant afford to. Republican Congress is out to destroy Medicaide, Medicare and Social Security and almost every charitable organization. With Trump's BBB we've now taken a giant leap towards that with more forced privatization profiting of what should instead be people getting what they paid for for decades. Pick the plan you can afford is really the only choice. Well over 50% of this country cant afford the high supplemental premiums that just get even higher every year."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgzQCZPD50dE9tR7Crp4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (1): "I hear your concerns, and you're right about one thing: the Medicare landscape is always changing, and both Advantage and Supplements have their challenges. That's why it's so important for people to stay informed and not assume that any one type of plan is automatically immune from change. That said, here are a few key clarifications: Medicare Supplements today do not operate like Advantage plans. There's no prior authorization, no networks, and no denials for medically necessary care under Original Medicare. The prior authorization pilot program within Original Medicare is nothing like what you see in the Medicare Advantage landscape. It's limited to a very small handful of procedures that are both costly and shown not to benefit patients. It's something to be aware of and monitor, but it does not mean the whole system is shifting overnight. Premiums are rising, and I understand the frustration. But there are still many areas in the country where you can find a Plan N around \$100/month or a high-deductible Plan G for well under \$100/month. Those options still provide the flexibility and freedom people want at a more manageable cost. Looking ahead, it's true the market

will continue to evolve, but today Supplements remain very different from Advantage — and for many people, they're still the best option for nationwide access and avoiding the hoops of prior authorizations. My goal isn't to "sell" one side or the other — it's to make sure people understand the trade-offs clearly so they can make the choice that works best for them."

"I hate Networks and Pre-authorizations. Plan G and Part D for me."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyF2k6IPyMXNAImCGF4AaABAq>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "Many people would agree with you!"

"@MedicareonVideo I agree with you wholeheartedly on the preauthorization nightmare the insurance companies require on Advantage plans. I also suspect that MeatLoaf had other underlying conditions that caused his death, not Covid, although I did not know he could not get approvals for treatment. So very sad."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw1t5ehQ4ZmSk0lpF4AaABAq.9XeE0Qc-R1p9YQBMUR7SL2>

"This really explained it well. I have been advised by many people that supplement plan was "better", but this explains why. I hate that insurance companies have taken control of our health care, as I have been on employer plans with pre-authorizations for decades. My only issue with supplement will be the monthly extra cost, plus the Part D plan.... Now, onward to your 2024 Part D video. Thank you for these."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgwXIHpV0OC5Wa9QvqF4AaABAq>

"@tunaustunkaya7903i totally agree with you. I'm 67 when I was 64 I researched both for 6 months and stuck with traditional medicare with a medagap. I too worked in the health field, and so did my wife. And I have talked to people who are so frustrated with advantage plans because of prior authorizations. An example I had a friend of mine on a ppo plan see his doctor in a building and his visit was approved. And what he didn't know was that the building was not part of the advantage plan? He was getting bills because the building was out of network? And i'm thinking w t h? I have had 4 ER visits. 2 in my first year and one in my 2nd year on traditional medicare and medigap. Which, after meeting my deductibles, medicare and my supplement paid 100% Also, some insurance agents get a minimum bonus of \$626 per individual that they sign up. So needless to say if they sign up 10 people in 1 day. Well, everybody can do the math. Also, if those 10 people stay with the same insurance company. the following year, that Insurance agent gets a bonus from the insurance company of 50% Thanks for letting me vent."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyvkxZTQrEFv_Sdwrl4AaABAq.AOo2F1Ftsx2APTSRZWKcAF

"I work for a small rural hospital. We just love to have Traditional Medicare patients come to us because of the ease of care. No need to get preauth for treatments. We just hate to see Medicare Advantage plans, it is more costly to the hospital and more overhead to hire employees to get preauth for treatments. The fault is in the insurance company reps that talk them into "MCO's are a lot cheaper"..... it is refreshing to find your videos about the differences. Thank you for all your research on this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgztCgmrDAvnRMZEBLV4AaABAq>

"There are a bunch of articles out there on providers and hospitals dropping medicare advantage customers at an increasing rate. They are fed up with insurance companies' negotiating, payment and prior authorization tactics. I'm going to do everything I can to save and budget for Medigap and not miss the golden window for first enrollment. This video just strengthened my resolve to go that route if the choices remain as they are here today. Thank you Erin, amazing job on this one."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwZwtj9y_n1kQqao5Z4AaABAg

"I stopped Medicare and my stupid AARP Advantage plan. I am tired of a computer telling me what I need instead of my Dr."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugxl1g-kwjfRBHi2B4AaABAg>

"This was a very well researched video. The main reason I chose Medigap for my mother is because my father was on Medicare Advantage when he was diagnosed with a fast growing cancer. The zero monthly premium benefit was the main attraction. However, when you're short on time and you have to deal with the pre-auths and limited networks, it can get REALLY frustrating. With Medigap, you're paying for the peace of mind for your future self."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgykxVqwEjLWMbLQ-Nh4AaABAg>

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Chose Plan G or Plan N · 82 documents · 20 voices

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_l4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🙏 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌 🥰"

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAq

↳ @policyguides (19): "Thanks for sharing your experience. You're not alone — I've seen a lot of people face those same big increases on Plan G. Plan N usually ends up being the smarter long-term choice because of the lower premiums, and for most people the extra cost-sharing is pretty minimal compared to what they save each year. With how fast rates are climbing, especially going into 2026, your switch makes a lot of sense."

↳ @christinestephenson1742 (11): "I have Mutual of Omaha supplement since 2019. It's maybe 130 a month and has just gone up a bit each year."

↳ @jayes8191 (6): "@policyguides Could Plan N's extra cost sharing increase significantly if Medicare reimbursements decrease in 2026?"

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAq>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"YouTube algorithm showed me your video. Best explanation I have EVER seen (and no, I am not 'blind as a bat!') on this topic. So I have liked and subscribed. When I turned 65, I chose a Supplemental Plan G at the beginning as it did provide me with the peace of mind that are covered in the last three categories. I have also been one to try to persuade people away from Advantage plans because of some of the uncertainty you reference. However, rather than doing that going forward, I think I would be better to just share your video and channel with them. EXCELLENT! Thank You!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwliC-CtrJLNTVU49I4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much! Means a lot!! 🙏 "

"New to Medicare This Year - More Confusing Than I Thought! I had helped my mother and my mother-in-law with their Medicare in the past. I also had worked in Human Resources early in my career and learned a lot about insurance. So I thought that signing up for Medicare would be easy for me. But, not having looked at this stuff in at least 10 years, I found it a lot more confusing than I had expected! I'm turning 65 in a few months. I'm in SF Bay area of California. I already know that I want traditional Medicare and not Medicare Advantage. I started taking Social Security at the beginning of this year (2025) so I automatically got a Medicare number and automatically got enrolled into Parts A & B. Now I need to pick a Plan D for drugs and a Medigap plan, which I already know will be a Plan G. In that regard, perhaps I'm ahead of the game. But picking a Plan D and a Plan G is turning out to be much harder than I'd thought it would be. I was glad to have watched a few YouTube videos about the process for signing up for each of these things -- that helped a lot, as well as reading the Medicare website and some info from AARP, etc. I found out that some of the Part D plans I was considering have limits on how many pills can be filled in 30 days for some meds. An SSRI that I take requires 90 10mg pills each month, because I take 25 mg per day and there is no 25 mg pill (nor is there a 50 mg that can be cut in half). So the plans that limit me to 30 10mg pills per month are a non-starter. (Sure, I could probably have my doctor try to appeal and get the 90 pills per month covered, but there is no guarantee that the insurance company would agree....and then I'd be stuck! Not worth the hassle!) This information was kinda buried at the bottom of each Part D plan on the Medicare website. It would have been a "bad surprise" to learn this after the fact! Regarding Part G -- this really surprised me -- the only Part G plan for my area that shows the premium and extra perks upfront is the AARP United Healthcare plan. ALL of the others don't even have a special page (or set of pages) about their Medigap plans! How are you supposed to compare the plans if you can't even see what you're paying for? I understand that all of the plans cover the exact same things; that's not what I want to know. I want to see rate tables (because most of them are Attained Age plans. The AARP one is Community based rates, and one other that I'm considering, Transamerica, is age at issue based rate). I also want to see if there are any perks beyond the regular plan coverage (like gym membership or whatever). I don't want to have to go through an agent or get a broker involved. I've had bad experiences with them in the past. I want to do this myself and sign up directly with the insurance companies. I truly don't understand why NONE of the Medigap providers in my area have ANY information on their websites about Medicare or their Medicare plans. When you click on the "company website" link on the Medicare website, it takes you to a general home page about the insurance company. I have tried searching these websites for "Medicare" or "Medigap" or "Plan G" but the searches come up blank. Why even offer a Medigap plan if you're not going to show your benefits to your clients online???? I don't want to have to waste my time calling 3 or 4 insurance companies! Only AARP seems to be upfront with any of this stuff. It's so weird, and I truly don't understand it! Am I missing something or misunderstanding something? Are the insurance companies deliberately making it hard for people to understand exactly what they're buying??"

— r/medicare · 33 upvotes · None

"You're a tiger in this video. I bought a plan G supplement as a perfectly healthy person taking no meds. I liked the predictability of the out of pocket maximums. The next year, I hurt my wrist and developed prostate cancer that required treatment. I was able to get scans and radiation and visit specialists that I wanted without ever worrying about the costs. I am very happy with the choice I made. This video is very fair and unbiased and accurate. Well done."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxPjKemu-lqNJslszV4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you! 🐯 Glad you are doing well!"

"I turn 65 in January 2026 and I chose plan N and I live in a very expensive area (Northern Va.) and will only pay \$87 and the Part B so about total \$294 a month so I'm pretty happy. And I also purchased a zero payment part D premium. I don't go to the doctor much so not worried about \$20 copay visit."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg.AODI8bYlzmOAOE-L9QNWYq>

"I chose Plan G. It's not cheap (I pay \$224 a month) but when my husband ended up in the hospital for aspiration pneumonia and... something about an infection in the sack around his right lung, Plan G covered everything except the once a year deductible of only \$240 (that was in 2024) even though all kinds of things went wrong. He died on the 22nd day in the hospital ❤️😞 but at least I didn't end up having to sell my house to pay hospital bills."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 26 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyjNvAAWfHslX0ho5p4AaABAg.AGdx14bB8Z1AKDiwr_YwLo

"I chose a Plan N and have been very happy with it. Unless you are always at a doctor's office, it's about the best compromise of cost versus benefit."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 23 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwAOnhiDZKcRZHjTlt4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (5): "Glad to hear Plan N has been working well for you! You're right—it's a great balance between cost and coverage for many people, especially if they don't visit the doctor too often."

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (5): "I am on plan N. I consider it the "sweet spot" of supplement plans."

"My wife and I chose a Medigap Plan N plan four years ago. Literally 2 months after beginning my Medicare journey I had a really bad accident that required the trauma unit, two surgeries and a blood clot issue. My total bill for all that and two weeks in hospital was \$86 after meeting the Part B deductible. I could have argued \$50 off that amount because they charged me that amount for the ambulance even though I was admitted. It wasn't worth going through the hassle. My wife is a cancer survivor so our broker strongly advised her to stay away from an Advantage plan. If you do go that route and then have medical issues and expenses get out of hand then you will have to go through medical underwriting and probably will not be able to switch to Medigap. Keep that in mind."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRIqEu63hwvh4AaABAg.ATSYgYfhd1hATYml_KtCEw

"Just went through this process about a year ago. I decided on a supplement plan (plan G) for as long as I could afford it. It is fairly 'easy' to switch to an advantage plan at a later time. Moving from an advantage plan to a supplement plan MAY require medical underwriting and may not be possible. I prefer the freedom of choice the supplement plans offer."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzGOqWQSwRxqmXlZd4AaABAg>

"We tried to switch from BCBS plan G to United also plan G during open enrollment. We live in RI. They will NOT allow this due to a change in the RI medicare laws recently. We worked beyond 65 but signed up for medicare on time. We didn't take the supplement until we retired fully two years later as we were still fully insured. Because we didn't take the supplement at 65..while still on Employers insurance...RI allows insurance companies to use this as a loophole! The new insurance gets to underwrite us. Is this legal? Rates are going through the roof with BCBS G and now we have no place to go without being underwritten."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxpmEF8ypZNK6pIB9x4AaABAg>

↳ @guitarhillbilly1482 (4): "Are you aware of the Birthday Rule in Rhode Island.? " Effective in 2025, Medigap enrollees in Rhode Island who have been covered by a Medicare Supplement or Medicare Advantage plan (with no gap longer than 90 days) beginning from their Medicare Supplement Open Enrollment Period, will have a 30-day window starting on their birthday to switch to any available Medicare supplement plan without medical underwriting.""

"I started with Medicare Advantage plan 12 years ago. It was great , as you said in video. Last year company cancelled my great plan. Got the golden ticket as a result, but I still took couple of months going back and forth. Large nonprofit health system is headquartered where I live and I had their plan. They only offered only one basic Advantage plan so in the end I chose a Plan G to try for a year. Having been with same company I Neve experienced the sleazy side of Medicare insurance companies. I received a quick education and we should be ashamed as a country for it. BUYER BEWARE!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxNFvy4wyhR0eUq5xB4AaABAq.AXCFUUSTol8AXFdVw3NLU7>

"If you want medical coverage in retirement choose Original Medicare a Medigap Plan (we chose Plan N) and a Drug plan. If you do not want medical coverage as you age choose an Advantage Plan. We live near great medical facilities: Duke Medical Center, UNC Hospital and affiliated facilities. Even here Advantage Plans have been rejected from medical facilities. You may find yourself in a medical "desert" as more of these Advantage plans are rejected."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgzB7gTPsB7BmRmHYh94AaABAg>

↳ @gordonallen9095 (0): "Another "disadvantage" that Medicare Advantage plans don't want you to know. Many doctors, and health service providers are now REFUSING to treat people with Medicare Advantage plans because of the difficulty of having certain treatments and surgeries approved by doctors, & specialists."

"After a year of researching my Medicare options, I chose original Medicare with Plan N. Living in SW Florida, it was a close call between Plans N & High Deductible G, but because of underwriting requirements here, I had to pick the plan that would be best for the long-term. Initially, my HD-G's total costs would be cheaper (if I remain healthy). But after about 10 years, it's likely that my N's total costs would be cheaper as I need more medical services and HD-G's max out-of-pocket would keep getting higher. In the end my decision came down to my concern about HD-G's deductible increasing each year at an unpredictable rate of inflation versus the much more predictable & budgetable N monthly premiums."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyYhExgJdVDH1dnNpp4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (4): "You made a good choice. Pre- 2020 I would have chosen a G-HD myself. But now that inflation is back, it's not a risk I want to take."

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (3): "@robannmateja5000 HDG deductible has gone up 27 percent over 5 years. Having said that most people will not reach that deductible. Remember your paying only 20 percent of Medicare approved charges. Unless you have cancer you simply will not hit that deductible. NY you can switch back and forth so you can play that game. Of course that's why the regular G rates are so high."

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (0): "@MedigapSeminarschoose Plan N to avoid high rate increases of plan G, avoid HDG for inflation and EOB issues, avoid advantage plans and pay dental and vision with an HSA to avoid networks and denials."

"I watched and followed 3 individuals who educate on medicare for a year before turning 65. These three all promoted Supplements over Advantage even though they would earn 3 times more with selling Advantage plans. You are also on par with these other 3 reputable men. I also listened to others who "pushed" Advantage plans, but I was not convinced with them. I understand the Advantage plan for those who simply cannot afford the Supplemental premiums, so they are good for some people. After my many, many, many hours, days, and months spent in my research, I chose PLAN N, and very happy with my choice."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzhauihre7LcAj0qcF4AaABAg

↳ @vincentmaloney5835 (2): "I also have Plan N, and I'm pretty happy with it."

↳ @policyguides (1): "Thank you for sharing this — it really means a lot. I'm glad you took the time to do so much research before turning 65, because these are big decisions that affect your future healthcare. You're absolutely right, Medicare Advantage can work for some people who can't afford Supplement premiums, but when you can make it fit, a Supplement like Plan N offers solid coverage and flexibility. I'm glad to hear you're happy with your choice!"

↳ @RG-hf4et (0): "I had G & switched to N to save money & I am very happy with my decision."

"I have a plan G I went to meet my new PCP she billed 800 dollars for that office visit all she did was blood pressure and I asked for a referral for my hip specialist and a bone doctor. She coded it not Medicare approved I had to pay for the whole 800 with a plan G . The hospital in our area is hurting for money and they own all the doctors and they work for the same company. I have never had an experience like this with my insurance. So people with G and N plans are not safe . I've come to the conclusion they want us dead. It's pretty bad when you pay 500 a month out of you measly social security check and get no health care. I'm afraid it's only gonna get worse from here"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzUXCd8T0RKcOWYzDF4AaABAq>

↳ @RG-hf4et (6): "If you have Plan G, you don't need a referral to go to a hip doctor!! Something doesn't tight that you paid \$800.....Maybe part of that was your deductible for Part G ...???"

↳ @ggjr61 (4): "@RG-hf4eteven though Medicare doesn't require a referral a lot of doctors won't see you without one."

↳ @pattyhaby4796 (3): "I had an mri on both knees and didn't pay anything"

Agents and brokers (and the commission question) · 36 documents · 20 voices

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"Chartreuse. 67 and looking to retire that end of next year if they don't put me out to pasture before then. Been on part A since 65, with company health plans that change every year. The agent at my local SS office went above and beyond to explain everything to me when I signed up. He was extremely helpful."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzNY_JjDH7DleQpHbp4AaABAg

↳ @texaszag8748 (9): "I'm glad to hear that you had a positive experience with the people at SSA. I was also fortunate in that I had an agent who was as helpful as I could have hoped for. Government agencies get a bad rap and all too often it is people parroting the same refrains from the Reagan era (i.e., "...government IS the problem"). I have an older brother who has been on Social Security disability since the 1980's. They've NEVER failed him. He's not paid a dime for rent or health care since becoming disabled, yet he insists that the government can do NOTHING right! Amazing!"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "This is great! Glad they were helpful! 🟢🟡 Combine those two colors for yours 😊 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "@poolbump1234 do you have an HSA with your company plan? Part A doesn't cover the 20%. Part A is hospital coverage, has a deductible and daily copays for certain hospital and facility stays. Part B is the 80% coverage."

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do,before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎🏠👩🏻🙏🏻🕊️🕊️🕊️ "

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxdqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAg>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MAdvantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to delivery the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"Fired from my medicare advantage job After getting my 215 license I started working at an agency that sells mapd, supplement, and hospital indemnity plans. Things were going great compared to fast food jobs I started making 1k+ a week and I wasn't even closing yet. Things started going down hill when I started closing my own deals after the agency bought me a few states. Aep was over and during oep I noticed the callers became increasingly hard to deal with. Most of them were only calling about a flex card, some of them didn't want to switch providers, while others stayed on the line just to curse me out and ask to be under the do not call list. I tried my best to close more deals and had no idea how other agents were even managing 5 deals a day compared to the calls I was receiving. Eventually I got called in the office and they decided to let me go. My question is where should I go from here? This is the first job I got fired from and I still have my license so I should be able to find a new job but now my confidence is at an all time low. What if I get fired again? Idk"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/

"Thank you. I just met with a Medicare broker yesterday. He tried to tell me original Medicare with a supplement required pre authorizations just like advantage plans and he didn't know of any of his clients who had delayed or denied procedures. I said I had to review the plans before making a decision. But what I did is make an appointment with a different Medicare agent"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugw4aqKwlwxaQTzZ4nd4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (3): "Of course, you could call us. That is what we do for a living. I can assure you, I have more experience and knowledge than any local broker you can find. <https://medigapseminars.org/contact-us/> 800-847-9680 Even more, my team is trained to help you after the sale when you may have issues with billing or whatever can come up between your doctor and Medicare."

↳ @californiaslastgasp6847 (1): "Wow, what a liar. Did you confront him?"

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMp4AaABAg>

↳ @paulaberstler4449 (4): "I also have Original and AARP medigap plan. More than a year of cancer treatments and NO charges other than Medicare B deductible (\$283). I never considered an Advantage plan. (I am in remission.)"

↳ @anthonykobiec8569 (1): "My doctor had the broker come in, and ALL he tried to sell me was Advantage plans. He tried telling me that it was what people were interested in. It is what they make the MOST money on because the Insurance companies PUSH you towards a profit driven model."

↳ @sweetds1 (1): "How much do you have to pay monthly?"

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAq>

"One more thing I'd like to mention. I got my Medigap policy thought Abt Insurance Agency. They were not the first agent I called. I chose them because I felt they were telling me the truth and were not trying to steer my decision with no pressure. And any time I have any questions they always quick to reply to my emails. They have a great understanding of customer service."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxSAj3YtQY5wYQ5qDF4AaABAq>

↳ @3DWhispers (1): "@erosmyers While I agree Advantage plans are not a good deal. I feel it's rather harsh to refer to Stephanie as a pusher of those policies. In my experience they didn't appear to have any agenda. I knew from doing some homework that medigap was the way to go. And Carter, the agent I worked with, did not try to steer me in any direction really. I felt he was sincerely looking out for my best interest. I mean it sounds like I'm a fan, and I am, because in today's world good customer service can be a rare thing. I appreciate company who still have an understanding of what good customer service means."

↳ @erosmyers (0): "She is a pusher of corrupt Medicare disadvantage industry"

"My agent of 8 years was surprised when I told him my plan was ending and I was now eligible to buy a medigap plan. He said he would send me some plans to review, but he never did, and did not return my messages. Also, I called an agent I found online and he was so very helpful and nice, but when I explained I had been on Advantage for 8 years, he said oh, in that case, agents won't work with you, they won't get paid. He said I have to call each company to purchase the plan myself. Very strange...it sounds as if the companies are being compensated to take on "Advantage Returners" with the commission normally paid to agents..."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxCOhpK38o-_jmdIJN4AaABAq.AOs_MoBrGwvAPdBK7fuYgn

"Yes, you can get more of a catastrophic plan off the marketplace. It cut my premiums in half when I switch over a year ago \$1550 down to \$750 ish for a family of 3 monthly. They basically check prescription records for approval (so you need to be semi healthy to get approved) but if you can get approved it should cut your payments way down. Im guessing your talking about \$1000 per check every 2 weeks and hopefully not \$4000 a month because that would be crazy. I got a United Healthcare PPO with a \$3,000 max out of pocket per person. The broker I used was My Private Health Insurance . Try that"

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wggh2p/can_i_make_my_healthcare_any_more_affordable/pa2c5i5/

"A few years ago I talked to an agent about an advantage plan. Yeah, they paid my premium, but if I went into the hospital for anything, the total cost for the first 2 or 3 days was out of my pocket before they paid anything at all. I told them to forget it. I got a part D drug plan through Humana, called the Walmart plan. It just went up to \$22.70 a month, but it's the cheapest drug plan I could find, and it has good coverage, at least for my needs."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugzj4-m97h3tZJQGwy94AaABAq>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (0): "Yep - have to compare every year."

↳ @jjbud3124 (0): "You chose a poor agent and a poor plan. You need to research."

"My husband and I were on Medicare Advantage when I came across on my news feed senate hearings on Medicare advantage. I thought what is this about so I clicked on to watch. I was flooded by people's testimonies on the stories of people being denied coverage and many of them died fighting to get coverage on critical medical treatment they needed. It was extremely sad and truly horrific. I had no idea how bad Medicare Advantage plan was. We were healthy so it wasn't an issue for us YET! I immediately called our Medicare insurance agent to take us off and put us on regular Medicare coverage. He explained that we had to go through a medical review to see if we could switch. Long story short we were for now in good health and were approved to switch, thank goodness! Now we try to warn as many people as we possibly can to try to get off Medicare Advantage and for those trying to decide all I can say is don't do it and do research!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgyjkdqgsfHacR_hXfB4AaABAq

"With our retiree fully paid by us Medicare Advantage Group plans we are only offered a PPO MA or a HMO MA when we retire.. While it is expensive the coverage is excellent with a low deductible of \$400 PP on the PPO plan... When we talked to a broker they said we had a great plan if we can afford it..vs anything they could offer.."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxPsixig58WcZc_SS54AaABAq

↳ @pacmanc8103 (0): "There isn't a lot of information in your post. \$400 deductible for what?! What is the premium that you describe as 'expensive'? These are both Advantage plans."

↳ @July.4.1776 (0): "\$400 per person deductible annually on the Medicare Advantage PPO plan. It basically mimics our coverage we had when working. Prescription drugs are included..Our max out of pocket is \$2,000 dollars.. We never considered the HMO plan offered.."

"Great info! I just signed up for Medicare last Fall. Before I signed up for a plan I did a lot of research to learn how it works. Anytime a healthcare professional heard I was going on Medicare soon, they advised me NOT to go on an Advantage plan. My research told me the same. I Also met with a broker to go over my options and she advised me to choose a Medigap gap plan. She used to work for a nursing/assisted living home dealing with patient ins. She saw the end results of peoples coverage choices which is why she encourages Medigap plans. I signed up for a Medigap plan and pay 175.00 a mo for a non-smoker. Im healthy now but who knows what the future holds. My Mom has Tricare (sp?) as her Medicare supplement. Tricare pays for her copays but she has to have referrals from her pcp and prior approval for procedures and some tests. It can take months to get approvals."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugxukcqb3QAjo15s3P14AaABAq>

"@erosmyersWhile I agree Advantage plans are not a good deal. I feel it's rather harsh to refer to Stephanie as a pusher of those policies. In my experience they didn't appear to have any agenda. I knew from doing some homework that medigap was the way to go. And Carter, the agent I worked with, did not try to steer me in any direction really. I felt he was sincerely looking out for my best interest. I mean it sounds like I'm a fan, and I am, because in today's world good customer service can be a rare thing. I appreciate company who still have an understanding of what good customer service means."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxSAj3YtQY5wYQ5qDF4AaABAq.AOJgvpOu7WQAP_KU5DLfA2

"I have watched other Medicare videos. I even have an agent I have used for several years. I was watching this for someone else and I learned so much I was not aware of. This will help me a lot when I review for the coming year. I did forward this video. Thank you for being thorough and clear."

— YouTube · Medicare Explained in Plain English — Every Part, Every Cost, Every Decision · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ooZKCnbXw-M&lc=UgwtTj8zcRgLGhpQta54AaABAq>

""I'm in no way saying Medicare Advantage is bad." Proceeds to list a bunch of points in a negative light. Lol. Another day....another Medicare Advantage hit piece. What else is new? Kinda reads like an ad disguised as "help," but I'll give you the benefit of the doubt. Since I used to be a broker and offered both Medicare Advantage and supplements (with a roughly 70/30 split of those on Medicare Advantage to those on Supplements) I'll go ahead and break these down one-by-one. I think it's only fair. 1. You are not "walking away from Medicare" when you sign up for a Medicare Advantage plan. Yes, it is **semi-private**, but everything covered by original Medicare must be covered by Medicare Advantage. They also offer many other bonus services that original Medicare does not cover, particularly dental, vision, and prescription drugs. Those are the biggest, but there's a bunch more perks. 2. Mostly correct but many companies now don't perform medical underwriting for supplements. So, this is very much state specific. For instance, in the state I'm in, Blue Cross does not perform medical underwriting at all for supplements. 3. This is redundant to point #1. You're not selling anything. You're simply opting to go with a Medicare Advantage plan and are still in the Medicare ecosystem. 4. This is always explained in depth by any in house agent or independent broker. It's a key rule they all have to abide by and is a standard part of any standardized presentation. By rule/law they have to tell you this and they constantly get secret-shopped. 5. This part is a mess. Insurance brokers make roughly \$600 (it depends on the state...most are around \$600) if, and only if, it's the person's first time on a Medicare Advantage plan. The vast majority of people brokers enroll are **not** new to Medicare Advantage. That's also a one-time thing. Every year after that, that enrollee will be \$300 a year. The vast majority of enrollees will be half of that dollar amount, because that's what someone going from one Medicare Advantage plan to another Medicare Advantage plan mandates brokers are paid. That for an entire year...\$300. I know, rolling in dough! 🤔 There is no such thing as a broker "enrolling" you in original Medicare. For one, there's zero incentive for them to do that if you don't also get a Medicare Advantage plan or Supplement. And two, you age into Medicare in the vast majority of cases. It's automatic. Brokers deal with Medicare Advantage or Supplements only. 6. According to statistics, only 2% of people ever reach their maximum-out-of-pocket, and the last time I was a broker (roughly 1.5 years ago), the average maximum-out-of-pocket was around \$2,500. Keep in mind, copays on these plans are minimal. You need to try very hard to hit that number. After (if) someone hits their maximum-out-of-pocket, the insurance company pays 100% of your medical costs, by law. 7. Yes, you still pay the Part B premium, same goes for when you have a supplement or original Medicare. And on a supplement, you get to pay tons more per month with a monthly premium that most Medicare Advantage plans do not have. 8. Regardless of the Medicare Advantage plan, you will always have emergency coverage in all 50 states. Any emergency is always considered "in-network" regardless of state. With a PPO, they have enormous networks, and you are well-protected in any state. Original government Medicare might not have a network, but you know what it also doesn't have? A cap on consumer spending. That means that if you get really sick, those costs just keep going-and-going to infinity and beyond! 🚀 But hey, government loves us, right? 😊 . That's why people choose either a Medicare Advantage plan or a Supplement. It's to protect them from everything the government leaves them vulnerable to. 9. This is a myth. There are prior authorizations on original government Medicare. Not as many, but they very much exist. Medicare Advantage also has to cover everything original Medicare covers. They cannot arbitrarily decide to deny something that original Medicare deemed is covered. Also a very key thing to note, they're currently in the process of "auto-approving" everything covered by original Medicare, with no manual review, when it comes to prior authorizations. So, waiting a few days will soon become a thing of the past and prior authorizations will be a complete non-issue by next year. 10.And? Original government Medicare also leaves you vulnerable to many things that are covered by Medicare Advantage. 11. Correct, but you are still very much on Medicare. It's just administered by the insurance company and not the federal government. You must have original Medicare parts A and B to even have a Medicare Advantage plan. So it's not like you're "leaving Medicare" as some believe. 12. Dental and vision are included in most Medicare Advantage plans. I've yet to see one that doesn't have them. 13. Yes. Another key piece of information. Always make sure you deal with a broker that offers BOTH Medicare Advantage and Supplements. I

hate to bash anyone, but Chris Westfall is one of the biggest cons and shills there is. He doesn't offer Medicare Advantage and is constantly spreading fear about Medicare Advantage. Why? Because Supplements are very easy to sell and service....especially nationwide. Medicare Advantage is not easy to service and offer nationwide. In order to offer Medicare Advantage, brokers have to take yearly tests that they must get a 90% on. They must do this for Medicare as a whole, and then for each and every carrier they offer. Many agents simply don't want to do this. This is a very time-consuming and risky thing, because if you fail, all of your income is wiped away. Literally all of it. So, some agents would rather sit back and bash Medicare Advantage, while not coloring in the lines and fully explaining everything. Right, Chris? From my Medicare Advantage clients, I genuinely never had a complaint. Both of my parents have been on Medicare Advantage for 12 years and have never had an issue. Think of Medicare Advantage as "pay-as-you-use" with small copays, as opposed to guaranteeing them a large monthly premium every single month, regardless of whether or not you use it. Take that huge sum of money, save it, and invest it. Supplements are great, as well, as far as coverage, but they come at a huge monthly price, and they don't include dental/vision or prescription drugs. One final thing to keep in mind is, **Medicare Advantage polls unbelievably high in satisfaction rate by those that are on them.** That's for a reason."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/medicare_vs_medicare_advantage_my_findings_as_i/jn3vamz/

"@10speed4 Who do you trust? I trusted my doctor's Financial Office workers' opinions. They deal with Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage programs and supplemental coverages on a daily basis. I used their advice as a guide to help me find an insurance broker. That person told me the same as this speaker has related. Medicare is backed by the government. If your Dr decides you need a test, procedure, or surgery, you get it with original Medicare, no questions, no refusals. The amount Medicare does not cover is paid for by your supplemental insurance, no questioning. But, if you have Medicare Advantage, it is run by private insurance companies who: - can refuse coverage, even though your Dr has prescribed the test, procedure or surgery. - they (insurance companies that run Advantage plans) can go out of business, leaving you with no coverage. - The private insurance company that runs your Medicare Advantage plan can significantly increase your cost of coverage by increasing your premiums & deductibles, as much as they want, as many times as they want. Medicare does have increases in cost & deductibles, but not as much, or as often as Advantage Medicare's increases. - Original Medicare is the same coverage, no matter where you live in the US. If you have Medicare Advantage, the coverage can vary, depending on which state you are in. Private insurance companies do not have the same coverage in each state. So, if you move to another state, you may not get the same coverage that you had in the state you moved from. This experience shaped my decisions on choosing my Medicare coverage. Years ago, I was very ill (not on Medicare then, had private insurance policy). It was a long, serious illness. Long story short: though I had an insurance policy that was supposed to cover the care I needed- the insurance company continually refused tests, procedures, and surgery needed to save my life. They refused to pay for things that were supposed to be covered under my policy- that I continued to pay each month. They were trying to save money- at the risk of my life. Obviously, I survived. But- due to my previous experience with insurance companies, I was not about to go with Medicare Advantage when they could do the same thing to me again- deny coverage they had promised. This is my experience, my opinions & my conclusions from the info I was given. I suggest you research the differences in Medicare & Medicare Advantage carefully before you decide which to choose."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzWwWS0AHhr0uKESCh4AaABAg.9m27oMuAljh9rlgUBaZOqv>

"I know the first time I ever had a UTI and pull anything I want to go to the jazz festival down in Houston that afternoon when I first became a nurse and I knew this medical student he was going to school to be a dentist and he put it he told me a pull my name up I want to be out for a weekend he told me I need my full wisdom tooth so he pulled them off all went down there today and I have a knack with you but now I said now OK and the universe is yours that I called his people they tell me insurance for the agents to Shema started to say 123 pool OK now but I have I will get Medicare thing and she told me theylt's nice that they told me they give me \$500 OK name and I'll go for the x-rays so yeah the 400 wouldn't want to eat she won't tell me what I did he wanted something he doesn't know kind of programs out there I got all the phone number babe relieve me a call around then as soon as I am afraid is calling that Medicaid they call it a boom boom boom boom boom they get everything they won't know they got my money or if I want my money from the time I was 55 on American you tell him you're my baby enough to pay the dentist do you think I need to get a lawyer that will leave you alone it was amazing that we are the same batch as governor they told me the governor's fault but now that my money roll over and I'll kind of stuff I had to put my foot down baby what is your name Stephanie know that I want to call me to clean with clean Mathis a possibility kind of stuff I told Medicare I'm at La Quinta marina Tato next week I don't know what I want to get real time ago that's why 3NNJEJ OK God bless you she's not sure she tried to go to"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7qE4D49X>

"Be careful how you use a broker if you want a Medigap policy. Sure, they can help explain the differences between the various lettered plans, and that's very valuable, but brokers don't necessarily represent all of the possible insurers you can buy a plan from. In my opinion, once you know what type of Medigap plan you want, i.e., G, N, etc. , go on Medicare.gov and see which insurance companies are available in your area for that plan. That site will also give you the approximate premiums. You can then narrow it down by price a little, if you want, but some insurers might be better than others. That's when your state's SHIP office might be able to give you some insight. You can also research insurers on your own When you eventually contact a broker, ask them which of the insurance companies on your list they represent. I suggest that you do that upfront because they probably don't represent all of the insurers on your list that you are interested in. If they don't, then they may push you toward an insurer they represent, which might not be in your best interest. When I went through this last year, that was one of the initial questions I asked the first broker I spoke to. When I ultimately narrowed it down to an insurer that broker did not represent, I contacted a different broker which represented that company, because that company only sold through agents. YMMV"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1wksnot/turning_65_next_year_and_medicare_enrollment_is/patxmyj/

Switched from Advantage back to Original Medicare + Medigap · 15 documents · 15 voices

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_l4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🙏 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌 🙏"

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"Thanks for the excellent video. I am on AARP Medicare Advantage UnitedHealthcare PPO. My wife was on the same plan, but we kept hearing bad things about Advantage and we both attempted to switch back to traditional medicare in 2023. She was accepted, I was not. I was told I could not because I had received a couple of steroid shots in my spine due to arthritis. We are both 71 and in good health for the most part. I have had cancer (16 years ago), but my wife is in excellent health and always has been. We also full time RV's. We winter in Tucson Nov-April and the rest of the year we migrate with the birds. I have just subscribed. I wish health care in America was not such a game show, but it is."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxgkqFeVTXyGsSK5nV4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching and subscribing! Check out our recent videos because we are mid-48 state road trip 😊 In A mini van though... not an RV"

"I have continued feeling a great deal of relief that I wormed my way out of a mistaken choice to get an Advantage plan. I was hooked by the offer of a vision plan. But then I learned all the shady stuff various Advantage plans can do, and because I am in NC and on Medicaid, I had a 6 month period to change my mind,. I switched back to original Medicare the minute I got my new pair of glasses. And I learned about how messed up Advantage plans can be thanks to YouTube. Thank you for making this video!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwiVOAo3PYIG4-Wj54AaABAg>

↳ @ragtop326 (0): "My vision plan only covered \$100 towards glasses, and I had to pay for my own exam \$89. In Viet Nam, RX glasses only cost \$14. What's wrong with our country. They're money hungry, that's all."

"We tried to switch from BCBS plan G to United also plan G during open enrollment. We live in RI. They will NOT allow this due to a change in the RI medicare laws recently. We worked beyond 65 but signed up for medicare on time. We didn't take the supplement until we retired fully two years later as we were still fully insured. Because we didn't take the supplement at 65..while still on Employers insurance...RI allows insurance companies to use this as a loophole! The new insurance gets to underwrite us. Is this legal? Rates are going through the roof with BCBS G and now we have no place to go without being underwritten."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxpmEF8ypZNK6pIB9x4AaABAg>

↳ @guitarhillbilly1482 (4): "Are you aware of the Birthday Rule in Rhode Island.? " Effective in 2025, Medigap enrollees in Rhode Island who have been covered by a Medicare Supplement or Medicare Advantage plan (with no gap longer than 90 days) beginning from their Medicare Supplement Open Enrollment Period, will have a 30-day window starting on their birthday to switch to any available Medicare supplement plan without medical underwriting.""

"I switched from Advantage to the supplement plan at age 72. It was not an issue. I also got the Medigap."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugxlp1NR8QlwYKq-pH94AaABAg>

"My situation exactly. I switched from a medigap plan to an advantage plan. I was spending \$4,500 for the medigap plan and prescription drug plan plus a \$480 deductible on the drug plan. My advantage plan capped my max out-of-pocket at \$5,100. I got prescription drugs and \$1,000 dental in the MA plan at no extra cost. MA has been perfect for me."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugz57a5HtSvqIR5fU8l4AaABAg.9SjvKJxeBpO9UKMbF_TFcQ

"I love this type of video and you did a great job as usual. As an anecdote, this year (2024) I switched from a supplemental plan F to a MA plan and I couldn't be happier. I retired in 2015. Now, gone is my \$240 per month premium for supplement plan F, gone is my \$110 per month part d plan where the drugs also cost twice as much and present is my \$0 premium health plan, \$0 premium drug plan, and I still see the same doctors and hospitals that I was anyway. I now save enough in one year, that if I ever reach my maximum out of pocket (\$4100) I am still way ahead financially. Love my Advantage plan. Plus, I am 74 this year. I hate to think how much that supplemental will cost by the time I'm 80. (\$450 - \$500 per month?) I don't have to worry about it."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgyL90JITftyVjlvAnt4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! So glad to hear you are happy with your choice :)"

"Very good advise. I recently switched from a supplemental plan to a medicare advantage plan sponsored by my previous employer. The reasons I switched are simple, the company sponsored Advantage plan was cheaper, it is a PPO and not an HMO and the prescription drug part of the advantage plan is almost identical to the AARP supplemental drug plan I was on. So far I have been very pleased with my PPO Advantage plan. I can still see all my doctors without pre-approval and it pays without dispute, so far. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABAg>

↳ @CD-ek3iq (4): "I work with both MA and Supplements. While what you say is mostly accurate the sad fact is many seniors simply cannot afford the high premiums of Supplements AND and a PDP. Add in the monthly cost of dental, vision and hearing, which supps won't cover, and it's easy to be priced out completely. There's nothing wrong with MA. I work with people every day who LOVE their MA plans and wouldn't trade em for the world, lol. (It's my job to try!) Many also have much lower Max Out Of Pockets than mentioned that can end up being as much as the yearly premium you pay with Supps whether you use it or not. 🙌 If you travel, simply get a PPO. Easy. Everybody has different needs and means. Luckily there are multiple options to try and help people with their Heath Care."

"My husband switched from his Advantage plan to a supplement plan and went through medical underwriting. He was 71 at the time. He passed easily, but he didn't have any chronic illnesses that they cared about. He has chronic pain from multiple back problems but that wasn't one of the questions. They care about recent cancers, and big stuff like COPD, Parkinsons, uncontrolled diabetes, etc. Now we both have plan G-HD (high deductible) and it's perfect for us. We each pay \$48/mon."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugzp0Rovlgo24N6z8lF4AaABAg>

↳ @Hope-ot1xy (3): "How do you pay so little?"

↳ @chevelleflorida (0): "@Hope-ot1xy Standard Medigap Plan G and High Deductible Plan G (HDG) offer the exact same coverage. The difference is how you pay: Standard Plan G charges a higher monthly premium but covers almost everything once you meet the small annual Part B deductible. HDG charges a much lower premium but requires you to pay out-of-pocket up to a high annual deductible before coverage begins. \$2,950 deductible in 2026. You pay all out-of-pocket costs until you hit this amount. Standard G has only a \$285 Part B deductible."

"We switched from Advantage to Plan N just this year--didn't need underwriting because our Advantage plan was cancelled by the provider, Humana. Figured this was a good time to try Original Medicare with supplement. I'm going to be interested to see, at the end of the year, where we stand with the change. I really liked Advantage with Humana, but do understand that it may not always be the best thing to have. I'm happy that I've never had to go to the doctor for a SUNBURN, though I've had plenty in my youth (there was no such thing as sunblock)."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugwt3Ce84ztixeqt5Dh4AaABAg>

"Great video as always. I switched from an advantage plan back to Plan G last year. The allure of the Advantage Plans got me to switch. Now after getting a bad case of sunburn, I'm glad I went back to plan G. I will be sharing this with family and friends. Thanks again!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugz6p8rPz-f1q9Wrkph4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching and sharing! 😊 "

"I switched to Medicare advantage on January 1st. I switched back to a supplemental plan after watching this episode of John Oliver. I found a similar situation that John had described with my new Medicare advantage insurance plan. I had my primary doctor schedule (referral) a sleep study for me. The sleep center contacted me and told me they did not accept my insurance. I explained that the sleep center was listed on the insurance website as being in network, however, that was not correct. The sleep study center explained that they were not contracted with my insurance. As I found, the Medicare advantage insurance plan has a limited number of available doctors and facilities. Even though the financial incentives are very attractive, I don't want to sacrifice my health. The incentives for the advantage plan includes refunding my monthly Medicare premium, waived the deductible, and included dental and vision. At least now I can see any doctor I want without a referral."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgyVG9Ymah-dmbtFjRB4AaABAq>

"I tried a Medicare Advantage policy the first year I qualified for Medicare because I'm low income. After researching the horror stories, I decided to switch from Medicare DISadvantage to a supplement Plan G. In my state you had one year to switch with no insurance underwriting. That's important if you have preexisting conditions. My state also has community rated premiums which means the gap plan cannot charge you more due to age. (They can raise the premium because of inflation, etc). Even though it's a stretch financially, I'm very happy I did this. I never pay copays or out of pocket. I only pay the \$257 deductible for the year and then everything is covered. 😊 "

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgzakHIScd-MCBBYH-V4AaABAq>

"I switched from a Plan G to a Plan N after two years. My plan G monthly premium was going up significantly every year and was going to go up to \$168/month. Fortunately, I was able to switch to a Plan N with a monthly premium of \$78/month. Thus, that represents a savings of over \$1,000 per year. Now, with Plan N, after you meet your Medicare deductible, you can be charged a \$20 co-pay per doctor visit, but I only go the doctor two or three times a year, so that is \$40 to \$60 dollars. Thus, I am saving a bunch of money with Plan N."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=Ugy-W10bsIBFbmKJd6F4AaABAq.A9JX8tFFS0pA9Lm0JO6nhX>

"I am a retired RN who is disabled. I started on an advantage plan. It was awful! It paid very little of my procedures. I was lucky enough to be able to switch in the first 6 month period. I switched back to traditional with part G supplement. Yes, it's not cheap. But it's a fixed charge per month. And I've had multiple procedures and surgeries, not planned. They've paid almost 100% of everything. It has been so worth the cost. Advantage is a disadvantage."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzN1ZpnmHxOxEVmpoR4AaABAq>

Seminars, YouTube channels and doing it themselves · 11 documents · 11 voices

"I won't be 65 until June 2024, but have been doing a lot of research about this topic. I have watched several videos by others that explained the difference between the 2 ways to go, but had yet to find one that I felt comfortable passing on to my other 64 year old friends. My search has ended. Yours is the most even-handed, non-emotional one out there. You aren't just parroting the biased views of others."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 485 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAg>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (51): ""Better than nothing" until you develop a serious medical issue and start racking up denial of service for treatments that your doctor orders. A lot of health groups are no longer taking "Disadvantage Plans" for this reason. Their liabilities increase exponentially due to the sub par treatment they are limited by MA plans. It's becoming a huge issue in many areas. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these plans. Medicare Advantage isn't medicare.... It's privatized insurance that the companies are making double the profits vs Medigap plans. It's by far the biggest scam of all. The government is paying between \$1200 to \$1800 monthly per person on these plans. Guess whos supplementing this waste. Those of us on regular Medicare."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (22): "This means a lot! Thank you so much for taking the time to watch and share! 🦉 "

↳ @robertporter6659 (6): "Spike has given you 2 barks out of 3 , for your good work. 🐕 "

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAq>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMp4AaABAq>

↳ @paulaberstler4449 (4): "I also have Original and AARP medigap plan. More than a year of cancer treatments and NO charges other than Medicare B deductible (\$283). I never considered an Advantage plan. (I am in remission.)"

↳ @anthonykobiec8569 (1): "My doctor had the broker come in, and ALL he tried to sell me was Advantage plans. He tried telling me that it was what people were interested in. It is what they make the MOST money on because the Insurance companies PUSH you towards a profit driven model."

↳ @sweetds1 (1): "How much do you have to pay monthly?"

""Larry David" I have watched many videos on Medicare A, B, C, & D. Yours I believe have been the clearest of them all. When will we be able to see a video that is less historical and one that fully touches on what we face in 2026 and how to face it? Yes, I was sold on the benefits of the Advantage Plan from UnitedHealth Care. It now sounds like I may be punished for that decision. I thought holding Pre-existing conditions against a person was illegal when obtaining insurance?"

— YouTube · Medicare Explained in Plain English — Every Part, Every Cost, Every Decision · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ooZKCnbXw-M&lc=UgzeDgunrjjhNtSNO_B4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! 2026 numbers have not been officially released. Once they are, we can update 😊 "

"You helped me start to understand the maze that is Medicare as I turned 65 last year. I didn't get burned as I might have been had I not watched informative videos like yours. Sunburn comes from sitting idly in one place while your body passively takes a beating. I've been there many times going to the beach in my younger days in Hawaii. Thank you for telling us your bias as well because you explain it. Thank you for putting out quality content!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugw0Yxvix2Y6seDfzzx4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Makes me so happy to hear these have been helpful. Thank you so much for watching! 😊 "

"They let them call their advantage plans Part C Medicare. I had a broker call me and asked if I had Part A and B, but informed me that I did not have Part C -which includes the vision and hearing. they can be very misleading, not informing you that you are moving off of original Medicare. My husband and I signed up for Original Medicare at the same time and got a 12% discount for life and we settled on the plan N supplement. It runs close to \$96-100 a month at this time. I studied for two years before getting a Medicare! I'm glad there's experts out there to guide people. I watched this YouTube channel a lot. Plus, I worked in healthcare, and most healthcare people would never get on an advantage plan. Another interesting fact, if you have even a small business LLC, and are not eligible under an employer plan, you can deduct all your Medicare premiums on your taxes. Good luck everyone ♥ Also, we must fight against the pre-approval thing for Original Medicare that they are trying in six states. Just let our doctors do their jobs without having an insurance company /AI control our healthcare."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugx8-SKsHLLxtx8pUx94AaABAq.AXCWq9hDlvoAXOLEpUQfht>

"@MedigapSeminars I discovered this listening to some other videos here on YouTube. I decided to switch to original Medicare and got both a Part D and Part G (I was approved for both). I am so thankful that I watched these videos (and I'm impressed by yours as well)."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgyikFO_s_gj4oa98_B4AaABAq.9Vf655Qjk8I9wRTR-SH-Qh

"I am so grateful that I got to keep my federal health insurance into retirement! I kept it instead of having to deal with Medicare, except for Part A, which I don't have to pay for. Fortunately, I attended a local seminar in order to make that decision. I wish I had known about your channel back then!"

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgwHMRw17-ZdBXGBrMp4AaABAq>

↳ @raybin6873 (2): "You are of the lucky few to have federal health insurance....most of us don't."

↳ @BK-qp8zp (1): "@raybin6873 I know and I feel for those who don't. It's one of the perks that DC uses to get us to stay with our jobs. Otherwise, no one would put up with their shite. And I'm serious about that!"

↳ @nancyengle4656 (1): "Oh yeah, our taxes need to STOP Paying for Gov't. employees COMPLETELY DIFFERENT Healthcare ..."

"Holy Toledo! You know, I've watched a LOT of YouTube videos over the past decade or so. Thousands, I suspect. And yet I can't recall ever seeing a more polished and informative and yes, entertaining video, EVER... on ANYTHING! I attended two, free, in person seminars over the past couple of weeks, devoted to Medicare, each lasting one hour. I could have skipped those. I learned more in THIS 45 minute video than I did at both of those seminars combined! What I really liked was that Erin didn't seem to be pushing either choice, Medicare Advantage or Medigap. Instead, she simply laid it all on the line, and presented the pros and cons of each choice. GOOD WORK, ERIN! I've seen some of your videos before... your face was familiar to me... but I will now have to make it a point to check them out on a regular basis, especially if they are of the same quality as this one. I will be 65 years old in four months, hence my interest in the subject. Oh, for the record, I believe I am leaning towards a Medigap plan. The advantages of that plan seem to outweigh the one big disadvantage... the extra cost. NOW, of course, assuming I DO decide to choose a Medigap plan, I have to decide WHICH Medigap provider I want. Any chance you have a video on the best way to approach that task?"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyKnXNbrSNMXtmw0yp4AaABAq>

↳ @ErinTalksMoney (0): "Thank you so much! If you want help choosing a specific plan (whether this is Medigap or MA) I recommend working with the company Chapter. They are a Medicare advisory platform with fully licensed advisors, who do not earn a commission, regardless of which plan you choose. Since they don't have that conflict, I find that people get plans that are best suited for them at a price point that works for them. Full disclosure, they are a partner on my channel, but I spent six months of researching them prior to signing up with them. And I do not regularly do sponsorships. For context, I've only ever done two. So when I say I like a company, it means I really like it. If you are interested in contacting them, here is their information. Phone number: 510-961-3329 or URL: askchapter.org/erin"

"I retired in 2024 at age 59 and used COBRA to keep my employer's health care plan. I wasn't too concerned about going on an ACA plan until I attended a retirement seminar in 2025. At the seminar, they made a fairly convincing case for why tax rates will likely increase (approximately double) in the next decade or so. I have tax deferred retirement accounts that are vulnerable to such an increase, so I filled the 24% tax bracket for 2025 with a (partial) Roth conversion. My COBRA coverage ends in a few months. Now I have a decision to make each year until I turn 65: how much (if any) in distributions from tax deferred accounts to take (for Roth conversions or otherwise)? The decision is complicated by the fact that the income "cliff" is currently back in play for ACA subsidies, but so is the risk of higher tax rates on the tax deferred accounts."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgxdU2mNHFtoDCqWIGZ4AaABAq

"@MedigapSeminars I have watched several videos and most seem to imply that the standard of care is better with the original Part A and B plus Supplemental because the insurance decides and not the doctor about what treatment is necessary when you have Medicare Advantage. I can tell you that my father in law had the Medicare Advantage plan and when he got sick with many surgeries done to the tune of over a million dollars, he received the best care with no treatment denials. He would have been bankrupt if he had just original Medicare so I still can't see where Original Medicare is better. My current credible insurance plan from United Healthcare resembles the Medicare Advantage Plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · family member helping · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgwOdF_TeROMVFKi1IF4AaABAq.A0KoKnNqlaEA0LDkQS9eEp

Medicare.gov, SHIP counselors and Social Security · 8 documents · 8 voices

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"I went to the social security office to sign up for medicare when I turned 65 and I was told if I was still working and had health insurance I didn't need do do anything!! When I did sign up later I would need to have some forms signed to prove I had insurance! FYI!"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙋‍♂️ · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgyUwwwuGl6Z6y7n9IP94AaABAq>

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "Correct, you can delay if covered by a large employer's Group insurance."

↳ @sterlingmarshel6299 (0): "that's what he explained"

↳ @verbalwidget0919 (0): "@sterlingmarshel6299thank you Mr know it all"

"Since the Medicare comes out of my very small social security check (and nobody asked me if I wanted Medicare they just stole it from my SS) I chose the advantage plan because it was zero additional cost. I rarely use it as the "powers that be" have decided that only American Murder Association members get to participate in the theft. There are many people who have a different philosophy of life and how to be healthy but their rights are not recognized at all. The gov. needs to keep out of our health choices and give us back what we worked for all our lives."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxyxAKDf_jEYvgxgEt4AaABAq

"I am still working & over 65. I am on my employers health plan. I enrolled in social security at my full retirement age. I requested not to enroll in Medicare at that time. Social Security would not let me opt out of part A. They said you are automatically enrolled when you enroll in Social Security. I had to stop the contributions that I made to my HSA and my employers contributions had to stop as well."

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=Ugw7tcOwlalp9P3c7cx4AaABAq>

"I assume I'm like most people in most ways. I signed up for Medicare in the 7 month window around my 65th birthday (three months before, the month I turned 65, and three months after). I delayed starting the coverage and provided evidence of insurance since I was still working so I didn't get a penalty when I started it. I don't remember the exact process but it was very straightforward with some form that my employer had to provide. But I could have just done the Part B stuff at the same time if I were retiring then. When I formally retired 18 months later, I signed up for social security benefits, and indicated that I wanted Medicare part B to start, set up my automatic payment, etc. The only thing I found confusing is that I couldn't initiate the Part B coverage at the Medicare website, I had to do that at the Social Security website. But it was all very straightforward, everything was done online except some employer forms, and I had zero issues."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugx3qmlvwLN6NGDfhU94AaABAq>

"Well im on disability need a lung transplant do was on Medicaid w va im be 65 in this April i applied for to see if i could get both so i applied for ship program i make 1395 minus the 175 the state put me in a d plan though the state thou the plan with united healthcare 0 cost but like 11buck a script at200a yr is that deductible,4(waiting on the states decision i like to stay in original medcare dont need eye teeth gym a letter said from ssi i qualify csu u help me plesse likw yo keep advantage plans tout of my needs"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgxY_xmBnl6pYdpht054AaABAq

"At age's 69 and 68 for my Wife and I on original medicare were we had Medical at zero cost to us as our suppliment and then due to the 3% raise in Social Security Retirement we got switched from zero cost to a "share of cost" for Medical of \$1,779 per month? That would cover anything, (a million dollars?), and we would only pay that \$1,779. Can we keep the Medical "share of cost" and get a suppliment insurance to cover Medicare 20%. This all is very confusing and my Wife of 48 years is fighting endometrial cancer."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxcscsQN1B-1WWauU14AaABAq>

"Years ago my wife died. I then signed up for Social Security survivors benefits. I was forced to enroll in Medicare part A. I didn't know that if I didn't immediately enroll in Parts B, D and Medigap that my Medigap premiums would be higher later when I did retire and enroll. I should have enrolled in parts B, D and Medigap immediately even though I had an employer health plan."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyirWbHJA4-xKH8Afd4AaABAg>

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Should have enrolled or planned differently · 38 documents · 20 voices

"Thank you. I was directed to Medicare Advantage by my doctor when I retired. Fortunately I live in Washington State and I do not have a pre existing condition so I was able (after jumping through a million hoops) to get on traditional medicare Phew. I wish I had heard this video before."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwGNIGpqxvVGJJqZDZ4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (3): "Sounds like you're al good going forward."

↳ @pravinasings8254 (0): "@barnardcarbajal8506 Wha????"

↳ @barnardcarbajal8506 (0): "@pravinasings8254 if you want off Advantage call SS and tell them you vant to change your RX plan...."

"You have done such a great job of explaining Medicare and these plans. Wish I had found you last year -- I went crazy researching the Medicare trail which is crazy to follow. BTW, I have Plan N and went to ER -- my charge was \$35. I've had specialist charges of \$17.50-20.00, sometimes 0. No excess charges (yet)."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugz2BBZktJaPF4zkvJ94AaABAg>

↳ @Putytat (2): "We pay \$229.00 in WA each for UH plan N per month. They dont cover medicare deductible. \$20.00 co pay for any Dr visit. \$50.00 for ER \$1600.00 for admit to hospital. They cover all treatment from xrays,CT and MRI in full etc. BUT premium goes up and up. I have had medicare original and UH since 2017. They covered all of by cancer treatment between the 2 coverages. We would have lost our home paying the bills if I didnt have them both. Advantage plans scare me because they control what they will cover and its normally for specific area except ER. I can go anywhere in USA and be taken care of. Not switching."

↳ @medicare365 (1): "Appreciate you letting us know your copayments so far. Glad you're happy with your plan."

↳ @doc5701 (0): "That's an important point re Supplemental policies valid anywhere in the US whereas Advantage plans are typically regional in area where you live."

"Thanks Erin. This is a much-needed video for millions. I did my homework for a full 6 months before joining Medicare and learned what I needed to learn. I had to go to many resources in addition to Medicare site itself. I wish I had this video to simplify my life but I am going to forward to those reaching 65 soon. You, undoubtedly, did an outstanding job for the entire senior/Medicare community. On behalf of millions, thank you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzrY6wrecXKKs-U6oF4AaABAq>

"What a great informative video. I just retired and had to dig through what you are describing without help. It can be so overwhelming hoping you are making the correct choice. I am 61 so I had to find insurance on the marketplace for myself. My wife is 70 so I had to figure out Medicare for her. Luckily, I chose original Medicare B with a Medigap (G) for her. Sounds like I made the right call. Wish I had found you before I went through all of the headaches. Thanks so much for this information!!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugze9Vaxvbla8l2MeLV4AaABAq>

"I wish I could press the 'thumbs up' 100 times! Not only was this incredibly informative and really did teach me so much about Medicare and Mountain Chickens, using John's special brand of satire, but having "karen" and her real life husband hamming it up at the end was f'ing hysterical! I almost can't wait to turn 65!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgxeBV5dnxzmVYmmaiR4AaABAq>

"I wish I had educated myself when I turned 65. I chose to stay with my employers retiree health plan which we pay ourselves. This year the price has jumped dramatically and I am looking at marketplace. It looks like I missed out on medigap because I know I would now be turned down if underwritten. I could stay with my employers plan and if they discontinued it I could get medigap, but leaving voluntarily my only option is advantage. I will save 4000 a year by choosing advantage but fear the authorizations/denial process."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyNq-I5E9DgaRdfDEN4AaABAq>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (2): "As someone told me when I was turning 65. You can pay it now (traditional and supp) or pay it later (advantage) as far as costs. As far as quality of care there is no comparison. Advantage Plans kill seniors prematurely by the hundreds every day in the US. And thats a fact"

↳ @ahemphill44 (0): "@JohnJohn-wr1jo That's the most ignorant statement (of many) that I have read on this old post."

"Should have planned better. I'm 66 and still waiting on Social Security until 70. I have Medicare and a supplement plan N. Works great for me."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyAV3tjqqt6CYM6fF4AaABAq.AO0x6RVqTa7AQfwlJkad-A

"You are by far the biggest elephant of them all when it comes to explaining Medicare plans! I have been watching lots of videos recently and I have watched more of yours than anyone else, because they are just better! You do such a great job of explaining things in a way that is understandable! Thank you for the great work you do! I wish you could be my agent to help me make my decisions. I am 71 and have always had Advantage Plan, but, now am wanting to switch to Medigap Plan G. I wish I would have understood how difficult it was going to be later on to get a Medigap, due to the Underwriting process. Advantage has worked well for me so far, but, as I get older, I wish I would have gotten a Medigap during my OEP because I could have gotten one - no questions asked. Oh, well, live and learn. I don't think I will pass Underwriting, but, I may give it a shot just to see. If not, I guess I'm stuck with Advantage forever."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugx-H2gJtUrzWO7qf014AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch this video and others! Your kind words mean more than you know, and I've never been so honored to be called the biggest elephant :) 🐘 "

"I wish I had been given all this information when we first went on Medicare. Hoping to switch to G or N this time. No major medical issues but we are already 20 yers into this."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzLdYe9XiE8awGw1el4AaABAg>

"I wish I had seen this video earlier. I didn't know about signing up within that 7 month window until I was almost 66."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2I1lpLq6moM&lc=Ugz5bDb2p_mlayKbtO54AaABAg

↳ @SheLovesKnowledge (0): "Oh no! I think they include the information with each statement they send every year 😞 "

"at this time being retired military tricare for life covers eeverything that the adantage plan and the supplement plans cover for free for the rest of mine and my wifes lives. but i wish i had a dollar for every med sup and advantage sales letter we have recieved. hell we could go on a trip to anywhere."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgwtOIFioPFSELSi3p4AaABAg>

"I wish I could have kept my previous insurance plan. It was cheaper than what I have to pay with Medicare. I don't like the fact that the government forces us to do this when we turn 65."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=Ugzjrpxz5W1EEd8cVc94AaABAq>

↳ @youngtimer964 (2): "Seems more like the insurance companies doing the forcing. I could be wrong. For me, Medicare is much better/cheaper than my previous group coverage, especially when it comes to deductibles."

↳ @iamanempoweredone (1): "young timer, i am eligible for Obama care. My income determines what I pay. For my wife and I both we pay a total of 214.00 for really good insurance. Now I will pay for her insurance plus Medicare for myself till she turns 65 next year. I would rather keep the insurance that I have than go to Medicare."

↳ @iamanempoweredone (1): "M Detlef, they LIED to me??? Oh No!!!"

"From the land of the Loon. You are the BEST! 2 friends turning 65 Dec & Jan Mom 91 just lost her retiree group insurance when Ucare pulled out of MN She has 4 different offerings from school district HOWEVER only one is appealing... That advantage plan is \$272/m With her guaranteed issue rights wish she could apply for a Plan N ... but understand only what we call "Basic" with riders = "G" Minnesota expensive ~\$400/mo+Drugs (then add Dent,vis,hear...) Totally tough choices ... the plan she is losing with Ucare was \$177/m and she has loved it... Wish I had more time to research. Your videos are absolutely the best! even up agent the best of all your 6 mentioned other YouTube ers.... Yet to see you say incorrect information you didn't correct. Love your fact based, unbiased, get help from good sources, use an agent / broker.... AND your presentation.. clear, understandable, good tempo and fantastic throughout coverage of material. FYI im 65 in May"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=Ugz4dlmIOSAkezNccr94AaABAq>

"I wish I could buy a Medigap plan. I have Medicare, I'm 49 disabled with a spinal disease, and I can't even get a Medigap plan."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugwkagft2E0ioaUjIud4AaABAq>

↳ @b0borden437 (0): "I thought there are no pre-existing illnesses?"

"I had original Medicare when received two heart stents in 2009, Medicare paid the entire \$76,000. In 2019 I needed another two stents and at that time I had an advantage plan (United healthcare) of the 46,000 total cost UNC paid the hospital \$17,000. However, in addition to the \$100 co-pay, I received an additional bill from the surgeon for \$346 that was not covered by the plan. I should have stayed with original Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgxmTNNSQQtCSWb3N2B4AaABAq>

"I have black cats like a witch. I wish I had the powers of a witch and could see what the future would bring because that would make it easier to decide on Medicare plans for my husband and myself. Thank you for the unbiased presentation. It at least reassures me that I am thinking straight about the many variables. Without a crystal ball none of us will know if we made "the" right decision until it is probably too late."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgyQCJHpuPvVhqzNjJp4AaABAg>

"Great information. I'm only 60 so I have a few years before I have to make this decision but with the info you provided then I know I will NOT be selecting to receive medicare. My wife will still be working. I am on her plan and we have an HSA. I wish I had educated myself earlier about the benefits of an HSA since this is our first year with it. Thank you for this information."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgyzQPMfNf1App7UXbh4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "HSAs are amazing! Thank you so much for spending time with me!"

"Sure wish I had this info a couple years ago. Now, as I fight to get a referral to a cardiologist with my HMO Advantage Plan its very upsetting. I still test out healthy at (just) 76, hoping nothing major happens before I try getting a supplement. Thank you so much for putting out this info.a year ago!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgxY9XoigpPezcfZkBX4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "You are welcome. I hope the best for you. If you can't get a referral ASAP, at least change to a PPO plan where you can go to a Cardiologist without a referral. A few years ago a gentleman told me his tale of not getting a referral no matter how hard he tried. when he finally did, the specialist told him he needed a kidney. Then he went back to the Primary Care Dr (PCP) who told him straight up he would not allow that to happen. HMO PCPs are bonused to keep you from getting specialty care."

"I am so grateful that I got to keep my federal health insurance into retirement! I kept it instead of having to deal with Medicare, except for Part A, which I don't have to pay for. Fortunately, I attended a local seminar in order to make that decision. I wish I had known about your channel back then!"

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgwHMRw17-ZdBGXGBrMp4AaABAg>

↳ @raybin6873 (2): "You are of the lucky few to have federal health insurance....most of us don't."

↳ @BK-qp8zp (1): "@raybin6873 I know and I feel for those who don't. It's one of the perks that DC uses to get us to stay with our jobs. Otherwise, no one would put up with their shite. And I'm serious about that!"

↳ @nancyengle4656 (1): "Oh yeah, our taxes need to STOP Paying for Gov't. employees COMPLETELY DIFFERENT Healthcare ..."

"Elephant, rhino, fox... Excellent presentation, I wish I had heard it 3 years ago when I was signong up But I am happy with my plan G."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgzfSQKu7xAEPWWip694AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! Plan G is great!😊 "

Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines · 15 documents · 15 voices

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. \[As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).\] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every

policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · None

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · None

"You should have mentioned that there's no medical underwriting for supplements only in the first 6 months of eligibility. Without that info, the uneducated might think they're free to switch to a supplement when their health deteriorates—which generally happens with age. (yes, there are exceptions) . And, from experience with my older family members, I think you are downplaying the prior approval disadvantage of advantage plans, which is serious—ask the AMA! I truly believe most should get Plan N medigap if they can possibly afford it Wolverine."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwoZ8dAIHWMGIpY32l4AaABAg>

↳ @JeanPierreWhite (1): "Totally agree. While we all hope we will have good health we can't depend upon that. Choosing a medicare plan might be a fateful one, one you will need to live with for the rest of your life, quite literally."

↳ @kimwatson5886 (0): "Very useful information even though I have over a year yet to go before I need to make these choices. At that time I also will be sure to have my emotional support cat chosen as well."

"Great video. I wish all the Medicare Advantage ads were required to say "Medicare Advantage is not Medicare. It is Privatized Medicare, where the insurance company makes decisions for what treatment you get and who you can get to treat you; just like you have always complained about." This would greatly facilitate discussions with seniors who have gotten a very different perspective from the zillions of ads they have seen. You also make very good points that it isn't easy to switch that need to be required in these ads, because now they all make false statements like "It's easy to switch every year during open enrollment with no side effects." that encourage seniors to ask "Why not try it since it seems a lot cheaper?" Widespread communication that "Obamacare eliminated pre-existing conditions policies in insurance companies." turns out to not actually be true for seniors. A similar video comparing Medicare Part D with Medicare Advantage for drug coverage would be great."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwXD3i0Kqsak5ZsC5p4AaABAg>

"You are by far the biggest elephant of them all when it comes to explaining Medicare plans! I have been watching lots of videos recently and I have watched more of yours than anyone else, because they are just better! You do such a great job of explaining things in a way that is understandable! Thank you for the great work you do! I wish you could be my agent to help me make my decisions. I am 71 and have always had Advantage Plan, but, now am wanting to switch to Medigap Plan G. I wish I would have understood how difficult it was going to be later on to get a Medigap, due to the Underwriting process. Advantage has worked well for me so far, but, as I get older, I wish I would have gotten a Medigap during my OEP because I could have gotten one - no questions asked. Oh, well, live and learn. I don't think I will pass Underwriting, but, I may give it a shot just to see. If not, I guess I'm stuck with Advantage forever."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugx-H2gJtUrzWO7qf014AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch this video and others! Your kind words mean more than you know, and I've never been so honored to be called the biggest elephant :) 🐘 "

"I have a plan N and usually am not charged copay with physician visits. The reason I chose N is because healthier people choose N and so as far as underwriting goes over time that group of people should have lower price increases."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRlOxmSo&lc=Ugx1X9O5BEHK1u2ENmN4AaABAg

"I wish someone had told me that I could skip medical underwriting LAST year when my BCBS plan was dropped in my county - too late now. Being on a \$0 premium Advantage Plan since 2014 has saved me BIG money since I only see a doctor about once a year. Now getting older and on more drugs so I'm tempted to switch to Original. But the premiums for the supplemental plans go up and up outrageously as you get older and more likely to use them. Drug plans keep increasing too. Aren't the supplemental plans thru insurance companies too? So, you are spending more than the Advantage Plans and still dealing with insurance companies..."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxYhuDpMkCxP7b9DZ54AaABAg

"So, how high do you think IRMAA fees should be? My Medicare premiums are \$714.70 monthly for myself and also for my spouse in addition to \$155.00 and \$137.50, respectively, for our Medicare Supplement premiums. We pay the highest tax rate as well as the highest Medicare premiums."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lbo2mx/just_throwing_this_question_out_there_how_many_of/mxu8bl0/

"I'm 66 and get harassed by phone calls & mailings daily trying to get me to enroll into more than the Part A & B! Abuse of Power-Penalties should be called Medicare Pushers, that's Blackmail!"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgxaAftiutka2B4aVcB4AaABAg>

"@jrj90620 I should have linked some more information to clarify- this video explains more about Medigap medical underwriting and how it works - <https://youtu.be/XDXdPMMxIOo>";

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyDKB-OZ-sdU6mrzWh4AaABAg.9L57OrZLRpB9OTkgDgTjPr>

"I believe you have given a very balanced summary of the plans, however, I think you may have glossed-over the dollar value of the included options of the Advantage plans. At the very least (sunburn warning) you maybe should have covered the average monthly cost for the Part D drug cards that the government REQUIRES people to purchase or face penalties. With high cost pharmaceuticals on everyone's lips these days, those costs are too important to leave out. The dental, vision, hearing perks are important too but the drug card is a very real benefit."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwqBJtNMtXbk0FahxR4AaABAg>

"@Justin.King00 If you are new to Medicare you will have a 180-day period from the start of Medicare Part B to get any supplement plan available to you. However, under 65 is not easy in all states. there is no Federal mandate to offer supplements to people under 65 on SSDI. We can help look for you. that said, in your Medicare welcome packet you should have an "Opt Out" card to opt out of Part B and keep your private coverage, but you may face penalties if you do that. <https://medigapseminars.org/contact-us/>";

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugz_S5wLKvkZzIHmkAp4AaABAg.9yOTV5Abf89A8lhUsjlQoU

"SUNBURN - Great video and presentation I think most people would find it very clear. One thing I thought should be included, but might muck up the point, is when you turn 65 you have the one time 6 month window where you can get the Supplement without medical underwriting. Insurance companies know you want to come back because you have issues, they are not dumb. MANY trying to game the system will think they can save on advantage and switch later back to traditional, which you can but you likely will not get underwritten for a Supplement plan or if you are EXTREMELY expensive. The lessor point being if you try to save on the less expensive Supplement, N plan you can increase in coverage year to you, your locking into the one you started on or lowen G to N or High deductible but not the reverse direction. Thanks"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxlvbH44sxmbLCRpm94AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! 🌞 We have lots of videos that go over that idea :) This one was focused on comparing costs. Appreciate you watching!"

"Awesome! I guess it's time for me to die and be done. In 2026 I got my massive COLA increase that was less than Medicare increases and my net deposit is \$133 per month less now. The money the Government has stolen over the years needs to be returned with a huge penalty from their bank accounts. Otherwise, we would be paying for what is ours twice. No more free healthcare for ANY GOVERNMENT WORKERS! Despite their lies they are way overpaid. I worked in the credit industry and I SAW peoples income. The \$\$\$ some of these fools are paid for administrative jobs are insane. When you here "If I were in the working market, I would make way more" BFS!"

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgxGpteJuz-dx7nCWIJ4AaABAg>

"I have Traditional Medicare with a supplement but my husband doesn't. I would like him change to Traditional Medicare with a supplement but it's not worth the risk. I wish seniors were made more aware that if they don't sign up for traditional Medicare when they are first eligible, they could be subject to underwriting and being denied for preexisting conditions. This needs to change!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugxjkcnn3Fjm9oE-aWp4AaABAg>

Wishing the rules or the plans were honest · 10 documents · 10 voices

"I opted out of Medicare Part B since I have spent less than \$600 in ALL of my healthcare in total in 68 years and they want \$210 a month for this plan which is flatly absurd. And why would I reduce my SS by this much which is about 20% of my total. I firmly believe we all should get Medicare with 100% coverage for everything for free minus a small copay with no separate plans and all private insurance should be eliminated. Insurance has ruined healthcare!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwDRTFZcv8WfoYAGwt4AaABAg>

↳ @EdLee-r6k (2): "@Starfish2145 nah, he will just hide any assets, go on medicaid, and get the taxpayers to pay for all of it. pay nothing in, and take all they can. a 1k SS check tells you something about what level of taxes have been paid into the system...not much"

↳ @Starfish2145 (1): "Yeah, that's great until you get cancer or seriously ill. Then you're screwed."

↳ @MikeMbm-l3z (0): "The permanent penalty for not signing up for part B when first eligible is 10% per year. If you choose to sign up today, you won't be paying the 202.90 per month, you will be paying 30% more since you are now 68. Should you sign up now, every year going forward you will be paying 30% more than everyone who signed up when eligible. The penalty never gets waived. Wait another year and it will be 40% more than the going rate. Good luck!"

"Great video. I wish all the Medicare Advantage ads were required to say "Medicare Advantage is not Medicare. It is Privatized Medicare, where the insurance company makes decisions for what treatment you get and who you can get to treat you; just like you have always complained about." This would greatly facilitate discussions with seniors who have gotten a very different perspective from the zillions of ads they have seen. You also make very good points that it isn't easy to switch that need to be required in these ads, because now they all make false statements like "It's easy to switch every year during open enrollment with no side effects." that encourage seniors to ask "Why not try it since it seems a lot cheaper?" Widespread communication that "Obamacare eliminated pre-existing conditions policies in insurance companies." turns out to not actually be true for seniors. A similar video comparing Medicare Part D with Medicare Advantage for drug coverage would be great."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwXD3i0Kqsak5ZsC5p4AaABAg>

"I am currently with BC/BS Advantage Plan. I have had the coverage change mid year...my PCP was dropped. I have had regular Medicare prices change mid year by both Medigap and Part D. This should be illegal! NOTHING IS SAFE FOR THE ENTIRE YEAR...you are wrong!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwYWL0DsUCvKW7V6zt4AaABAq>

↳ @larrydalton2205 (3): "Medigap prices will very often change mid-year because they are based on the day the policy was started rather than a calendar year. The annual adjustment on these policies could only change at the beginning of the year on Medigap policies if they were started on January 1. My Medigap policy started on December 1st a couple of years ago so the premium changes on December 1 each year. Erik isn't wrong on this. His "book" for the family looks good."

↳ @Lookin4u2 (1): "It's going to get worse because these advantage companies know that nobody is going to stop them from this fraudulent behavior. This is serious and if someone doesn't stop these advantage plans, it's going to continue to get worse. Only vote for someone who will completely stop the fraud and cruelty in this country"

"Healthy 65 yr old and just learned I get to pay \$400+ in Irma tax. This is not a benefit, it is a penalty for being healthy at 65 and still working. Health insurance pricing based on income is a crappy idea, discriminatory and should be illegal."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzMxDZKI9U4RpWz0d94AaABAq>

"The problem is if you didn't sign up for supplemental insurance within the initial six month grace period (when you first turned 65 years old), when you get the guaranteed the lowest rates, they will take all your health problems and hold them against you and charge you a much higher rate for the same supplemental insurance. That's what happened to me. As a result this year I'll be paying almost \$600 a month for my plan G. My initial insurance agent never even explained the different types of health policies. She just pushed the advantage plan and that's the only one she explained. I found out later agents get a higher commission when they write advantage plans for people, so of course they have every incentive to leave out vitally important information you should know. That should be illegal, but even if it was, how would you ever prove they did it? I'm sure there must be some honest insurance agents out there somewhere, but I don't know where and I have no idea how to find one. Of course it's too late for me now, but I warn everybody approaching the age of 65 that I meet. I try to practice the do unto others others, even if others didn't do it unto me. 🙄"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugzc_CkfUiS7A8RGWs14AaABAq.AOIHGUuVOyHAPr5k4piC0a

"Don't go with UHP. Profiteers from the pain and suffering of humans. Major lawsuits and denials. It amazes me this country still has not gone to universal healthcare. I'm on the original Medicare ABG&D. G is with Anthem BC. No perks. Simple and easy with my Drs. No issues so far in 13 months. They are profiteers as well, but I think they are less evil than the rest. D plans are stupid. They all have their "formulary" lists and none are the same \$\$ for identical drugs. Tier 1/2/3/4 garbage. But it's better than nothing. I have Wellcare. Not great but cheap. I've heard from friends in the SF bay area that Kaiser advantage is excellent. Of course you have to use them. But they are well established there. I'm in an area where there are hardly any Kaiser facilities. The agents that "help" are paid to drive you to their plans. They make \$\$ on your payments. Agents should be eliminated. It's a parasite business."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ls9lyr/new_to_medicare_this_year_more_confusing_than_i_n1hta1w/

"OMG this was the best source of Medicare info I have seen. I chose and advantage plan for one reason only because after a bad accident I lost 20 years of earning income and could not afford a supplement plan. The good news is it's been great for me because I don't have a lot of medical problems. I only take two prescriptions one for GIRD and one for Thyroid. But if my medical situation changes I now feel better informed about my options. Thank you for this video because I didn't get any of this info when I first got Medicare and I can clearly see that what works for me might not work for a person with more complicated medical issues. Honestly, your video should be mandatory training for insurance providers. Thankyou! 👍"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugyqcp_0CPTviiYx3ol4AaABAg

"@MedigapSeminars One of videos at another channel I was watching a few days ago, they point out that they can make a lot more money selling Medicare Advantage plans than supplements. I am really glad that I started watching videos. I have learned a lot. I decided that I was not going with a Medicare Advantage plan this time. I have gotten both Plan G and Plan D for this next year, and I can't imagine going back to a Medicare Advantage Plan. I think that they should be required to tell the truth about Medicare Advantage Plans. Thank goodness there are people like you and some of the other channels that discuss this that are honest and tell the truth about them."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwGSGQq7L-y5kUO8ot4AaABAg.9Uobzmomv_m9wRWPuadhAn

"You omitted two serious disadvantages of traditional Medicare + supplements: 1) You guessed that supplementary plans would cost maybe \$100/month in premiums. My AARP supplementary plan at my age (76) has \$265/month premiums. Some difference! 2) Medicare Advantage, unlike traditional Medicare, covers some degree of dental care. A friend of mine had some major dental surgery which was partly covered to the tune of \$6,000 by Medicare Advantage. In my case, I need to replace crowns, and was quoted a cost of \$2,300 by a dentist for just one of them. I wish you had discussed this matter more thoroughly and honestly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugy1XkfW8raf1gOM_jV4AaABAg

"Mitch McConnell has been saying for years that original Medicare should be eliminated. And now, Dr. Oz, hostile to original Medicare is selected to lead CMS. That's another reason why I went with Advantage. I wasn't going to spend thousands in my healthy years only to have the rug pulled out from under at the point I could actually use original Medicare."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1gvawaz/doctor_oz_is_gonna_fuck_shit_up/ly0ohb7/

Wishing for one simple Medicare that covers everything · 6 documents · 6 voices

"I opted out of Medicare Part B since I have spent less than \$600 in ALL of my healthcare in total in 68 years and they want \$210 a month for this plan which is flatly absurd. And why would I reduce my SS by this much which is about 20% of my total. I firmly believe we all should get Medicare with 100% coverage for everything for free minus a small copay with no separate plans and all private insurance should be eliminated. Insurance has ruined healthcare!"

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↳ @EdLee-r6k (2): "@Starfish2145 nah, he will just hide any assets, go on medicaid, and get the taxpayers to pay for all of it. pay nothing in, and take all they can. a 1k SS check tells you something about what level of taxes have been paid into the system...not much"

↳ @Starfish2145 (1): "Yeah, that's great until you get cancer or seriously ill. Then you're screwed."

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"I'm 72 and I pay over \$200/month for the supplement coverage. The bottom line: I CAN'T AFFORD IT! So, I do not participate in these programs, wellness checks ect. We should have 100% coverage! This system is a racket!"

— YouTube · New changes could be coming to Medicare in 2027 · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7cDpJANnu2U&lc=UgyYM5IykNU2Zpo0XCR4AaABAg>

↳ @zrx4me1 (1): "You have a crappy plan."

"Supplements are too expensive and do Not want to pay when you need them. You work all your life and get screwed over for continuing to live after retirement. MEDICARE FOR ALL is what we need."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyuQrzYzibBWylq2GZ4AaABAq

↳ @policyguides (1): "I understand your frustration — healthcare costs in retirement can feel overwhelming. But just to clarify, I've personally never seen a Supplement plan refuse to pay as long as Original Medicare approves and pays first. That's how these policies are designed, period. As for Medicare-for-all, we already have a version of that in the form of Obamacare, and it has not worked well in practice. Premiums and deductibles have risen sharply, even with tax credits, and many families are struggling to afford coverage. So while I hear you, the reality is that no system is perfect — and right now, Supplements still remain the most reliable option for protecting against big medical bills."

↳ @billmulvihill8452 (1): "You are plain wrong!"

↳ @karencloskey7147 (0): "@policyguideswe should have free healthcare and no insurance agents"

"We should have Medicare for all, controlled by the government, where all profit goes back into the system, not to the shareholders, like all other developed countries, and it works. Why are we so far behind in health coverage for all American?"

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgyIFij5XWLvQUN4d2p4AaABAq>

↳ @calguy3838 (2): "@Prodigal1 We have all of that and more with our current system."

↳ @semalegacy (2): "The U.S. does spend more per person on healthcare than any other developed nation, yet leaves tens of millions uninsured or underinsured, so the frustration is completely understandable. The main reason we don't have a universal system isn't a mystery: private insurers, hospital networks, and pharmaceutical companies spend hundreds of millions a year lobbying against it, and that money has enormous influence in Congress. Medicare for All bills have been introduced repeatedly but never get a full floor vote. Countries like Canada and Germany got their systems in place before that lobbying infrastructure was as powerful as it is now. If you want to push this forward, contacting your specific House rep and both senators directly, not a generic petition, is what actually moves the needle on legislation."

↳ @Prodigal1 (1): "Sure it works 😂. High taxes, inefficiency, denied treatment for some due to age, long waits to get an appointment. The government does so well at managing our money😂😂😂"

"So you pay Medicare your whole life and now you want me to pay "extra" premium for services I get for free now? Oh and I have to be "approved" to be covered. Medicare should be 100% free for seniors! We are already paying \$2100 yr in Medicare A/B . Non citizens get 100% free Medicaid 🤔"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyR9WomSON-3IkIw54AaABAq

"If I am a 100% disabled veteran and also have Tricare for life, do I need to be enrolled in Medicare A & B?"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzAJ0Dj1lqjXvZpUKh4AaABAg>

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Peace of mind with a Medigap plan · 155 documents · 20 voices

"You explain the options very well in this video. I'm glad I picked the supplemental plan instead of advantage. I'm 69 and not a spring chicken anymore. Your priority has to be medical benefits as you get older. Go to the doctors and hospitals that you want. No referrals. Pay the supplemental premium, skip the new car payments and hang on to that older car."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 290 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugw1n1YjSCR0VLlkWUd4AaABAg

↳ @FollowScripture (0): "He was very informative...I agree with what you say here"

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

↳ @CB-vg1wq (17): "@miriamlandau1207 You pay into both. On a W-2 social security withhold is in box 4. Medicare tax is Box 5."

↳ @ighdesigns (14): "The insurance companies are always just trying to outlast the patients."

↳ @miriamlandau1207 (3): "You are paying into Social Security not into Medicare."

"Glad I did my homework and chose traditional Medicare over Medicare Advantage. I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments. I would rather pay for the "peace of mind," and the CHOICE to go where I want, and see the doctor or specialist I need/want."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 264 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbjQyLYRyCYv54AaABAg>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (10): "@LisaKnobel Medicare covers most everything, so unless you have a rare never heard of disease that has holistic/experimental treatment...Medicare/Medigap will cover it."

↳ @aregee7121 (10): "It's way more than just choice or peace of mind. Advantage plans, all insurance co. based, are more like socialized medicine, i.e. less spending per patient. You get restrictive networks, forced diagnosis first with G.P. or P.A! with delayed referral to a specialist, possibly not the one you want. The end result is a delay of the proper treatment. Do you want this as you get older?"

↳ @maryequilter31 (7): "The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg

↳ @sct4040 (24): "I too, am on AARP UHC and will be paying \$333/month in 2027. That is so much money."

↳ @nealkshah (18): "Sounds like that "blessing in disguise" really did work out. Thanks for sharing the whole story."

↳ @edwinrodeo (15): "@sct4040... me 2 🙄 . I'm in CT though.. open enrollment yr round. No underwriting required. Only 4 states has it."

"My anecdote story is that I don't want to ask anyone's permission to receive medical care or be told where to get it. I'm happy with Medicare, and my supplemental plan G."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 182 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgyhEyEGlpmFRi4hq8d4AaABAg>

↳ @Morris-Monet (23): "@les0101s But you do for non-emergency care from Advantage plans. Surgeries need to be pre-approved and performed in their plan facilities. More and more hospitals are leaving theses plans. Facts."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (17): "With that in mind, Supplement Plan G is perfect!"

↳ @les0101s (10): "You don't have to ask for permission to get treatment for a heart attack from any insurance plan."

"GREAT job, Erin! I'm a retired physician and I think you hit this out of the park. My wife and I started with an MC Advantage Plan but the unpredictability of out-of-network coverage, rapidly increasing max. out of pocket limits, increasing daily hospital copays, and pretty inadequate rehab coverage really began to make me rethink our decision. When our MC Advantage plan wasn't available in our area for 2026 we were so happy to be able to switch to a Medigap plan with guaranteed issue during a Special Enrollment Period (SEP). It's one of the few ways to be able to switch in that direction without underwriting. Yes the premiums are significant but the predictability of healthcare expenses, portability, and freedom of choice where to receive care made it worth it to us - priceless, in fact. I'm 67 and my wife is 72. Thank you for helping so many future decision-makers have such clarity."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 156 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugwn9lCoa-Qw7KmDdUp4AaABAg>

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (4): "Should have chose HDG, that way you would have all the benefits of traditional Medicare and not have the burden of an expensive supplement."

↳ @catchristo9406 (4): "@ChrisSadowski10372Thanks for the tip. I will look into this option!"

↳ @tnvqlqxz (3): "Thank you for sharing this information."

"You also have to ask yourself " How much does peace of mind mean to me?" For me, it means a great deal. For that reason...and all the points Keith made, I choose original Medicare and Plan G and a drug plan. Thanks, Keith. Awesome explanation."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 103 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxmsAjt88MzwvJ_Zop4AaABAg

↳ @Ron4885 (5): "Couldn't agree more. (I picked Plan N) :)"

↳ @local_treasures815 (0): "How much does that cost you?"

↳ @darlahouston4670 (0): "@local_treasures815 I'd like to know as well."

"I turned 65 while employed, and my company switched me to the "Medicare Version" of the standard employee plan. I then retired with an early retirement package covering my medical insurance at employee rates for three years. Guess what. I had been put on an Advantage version plan. Ugh. I decided to jump to a Medigap plan as soon as the employee rate ended and was fortunately able to still pass underwriting. Two years later, I got diagnosed with a chronic heart condition. I am so grateful to have been able to move to a Medigap plan when I did!!!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 74 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugz3XghK1-XGwM55ivZ4AaABAg>

↳ @grenloopy2969 (2): "Lucky you were able to afford the supplement plan because they're very expensive in many areas versus Medicare Advantage."

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (1): "Your decision likely saved your life and a whole lot of money. Advantage Plans likely kill thousands of seniors prematurely every week in this country."

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAg>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"At the time I was preparing to retire at age 66, I became ill with covid. I was still covered by my employer insurance. When I returned to work after covid, I became ill again. Due to being off so long my insurance lapsed. I officially retired and signed up for SSI and Medicare plan B. I had signed up for plan A as soon as it was available at age 65. The second illness was kidney cancer that was discovered while I was in my open enrollment period. I quickly selected a Supplemental plan, and was I ever happy! It covered everything including an additional year of follow up immunotherapy with Katruda. I saved thousands of dollars every 90 days of follow up therapy! My Supplemental plan cost me about \$95 a month! So don't gamble with your health or finances!"
— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 64 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgykxBns009Os0UTIEp4AaABAg>

↳ @sbee985 (7): "Wow! Someone upstairs was watching over for you! Glad you are doing well!"

↳ @kellegraff6626 (4): "I had moved from another state and develop some serious health problems after a lifetime a perfect health. When I signed up for Medicare I was not aware that I had to get medigap within the first 6 months. Needless to say, every year when I try to sign up for medigap, I am denied or will pay an outrageous monthly bill. If a person has had a heart stent within the last year, they are automatically denied. It needs to be very clear that a medigap program is absolutely needed, even if you don't completely need it. When you decide that you do, you are made to pay for pre-existing conditions or denied."

↳ @dewboy910 (3): "Jesus Christ! My mom is paying \$342 per month for B plus \$102 for part D! I have to admit that they have covered pretty much everything since I've been responsible for her, but I often wonder whether or not she needs so much insurance. She has the highest standard coverage available (not catastrophic). Too bad she doesn't have catastrophic insurance because she has dementia."

"So glad we were advised to take a supplement plan when we started Medicare. A few years later my spouse was diagnosed with cancer and was able to go to a hospital that specialized in that one. We never had to worry about being in plan or getting approvals. Paying more upfront meant we had no bills through the years of treatment. I continue using my supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 61 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwhJu-QYROdQEUKL_h4AaABAg

↳ @jimarnold7561 (3): "Can't speak of other advantage plans but I couldn't be happier with my Kaiser senior advantage plan. Low cost, good doctors, modern hospitals, etc."

↳ @txladywolf01 (1): "Same here. Straight Medicare and Medigap plan N...no issues and I travel USA"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (0): "@jimarnold7561 Dream on Jim. The data doesn't support your statement. When you need it most you will discover the mistake you made."

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>";

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"YouTube algorithm showed me your video. Best explanation I have EVER seen (and no, I am not 'blind as a bat!') on this topic. So I have liked and subscribed. When I turned 65, I chose a Supplemental Plan G at the beginning as it did provide me with the peace of mind that are covered in the last three categories. I have also been one to try to persuade people away from Advantage plans because of some of the uncertainty you reference. However, rather than doing that going forward, I think I would be better to just share your video and channel with them. EXCELLENT! Thank You!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwwliC-CtrJLNTVU49I4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much! Means a lot!! 🍷 "

"I live in Queens NYC. My UHC advantage plan is being discontinued for the second year in a row. I'm looking into supplements plans for peace of mind. I'm 76 years old and in good health. It's really stressful to have to do this every year. In addition I have a 97 year old mother who is in the same situation and I have to help her with choosing a plan also. These videos are very helpful. Thank you."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwNrKv-eoUWgAMGFzF4AaABAq>

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (0): "Good luck switching to supplement plans, your health better be good or you are never switching"

"I thought about getting one of these plans but found out the doctor I'd had for many years was not in the network. I worked in the Scheduling department in a hospital and We dealt with these insurance plans and some of them thought they knew more than the doctors. I'm glad I chose original Medicare and a supplement. I want my doctor and I to make the decisions."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Be bQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzMVDXyviom5xLUtIF4AaABAq>

↳ @nancybryant4325 (3): "@paul2019monte my neighbor has an advantage plan and is pleased with it. I don't think she pays for it. I pay \$144 a month for my supplement but it gives me some peace of mind that I will have good coverage if I become really sick. No matter how healthy we think we are, as we age things can happen to our bodies. I am not wealthy but I know a couple ladies who live on less than \$1000 a month and paying that premium might be hard or impossible for them."

↳ @paul2019monte (2): "@nancybryant4325 Thank you again for your response. I had been told by someone I trusted that I should be on Medicare. I do not have lots of expenses now but I can see that investing before I need it, which most of us definitely will, will give me more security if something major were to happen. I also find most of the so-called benefits of the advantage plan actually not that valuable when I try to use them. And no I don't use referrals because often when I have asked for a specific referral I have either been denied or the payment to the caregiver is denied even though a legitimate referral and I paid a copay. Here I am talking about physical therapy which now I pay out-of-pocket and don't even bother trying to get the referral. I negotiate for a cash price. Many won't take my plan anymore anyhow because of the endless denials, etc. Someone is paying for all those slick commercials bombarding us."

↳ @takearight. (2): "@paul2019monte indirectly being paid by....you guessed it... We do through our ins premiums..."

"I turn 65 in January 2026 and I chose plan N and I live in a very expensive area (Northern Va.) and will only pay \$87 and the Part B so about total \$294 a month so I'm pretty happy. And I also purchased a zero payment part D premium. I don't go to the doctor much so not worried about \$20 copay visit."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAq.AODI8bYIzmOAOE-L9QNWYq>

"I'm so sorry to hear about your husband's diagnosis. I'm glad Plan G has given you both peace of mind—that's exactly what a good supplement is meant to do, so you don't have to worry about bills on top of everything else. Wishing you and your husband strength and comfort during this time."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 27 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwgXbzqmZRcY_3kYNV4AaABAg.ANkFJcLXDfBANKOQb7mq_f

"Thank you for sharing clear, concise information. I have a Medicare Supplement plan in Iowa for \$147 per month, and I thought of switching to a Medicare Advantage during open enrollment. Listening to your content, I am going to stay with my current Medicare Supplement plan. Thanks again!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 24 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgzlMMoJixRb4-oHg_Z4AaABAg

↳ @harleygirl795able (7): ". Ummmm, as an insurance professional, he would probably make MORE selling folks a MA plan! He didn't do that. And he never said, hey, call me and I will sell you a plan. He gave professional advice. That's it! SMH!!!"

↳ @policyguides (4): "Glad to hear it! Agreed, don't do unless you are absolutely pushed to advantage because of affordability."

↳ @JohnDavis-yz9nq (1): "You do realize this man sells Medicare supplements and if you switch to Medicare advantage will be left out in the cold. Your supplement only has one place to go and that is up up up in premiums. No telling what you will be paying for your supplement in the future. Of course he doesn't want you to switch to Medicare advantage."

"I chose a Plan N and have been very happy with it. Unless you are always at a doctor's office, it's about the best compromise of cost versus benefit."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 23 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwAOnhiDZKcRZHjTlt4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (5): "Glad to hear Plan N has been working well for you! You're right—it's a great balance between cost and coverage for many people, especially if they don't visit the doctor too often."

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (5): "I am on plan N. I consider it the "sweet spot" of supplement plans."

Happy with an Advantage plan · 119 documents · 20 voices

"Thank you. I turned 65 this summer and I was inundated with Medicare Advantage paperwork. Intuitively after doing more research I decided to stick with regular Medicare and I'm so glad you covered this. I was led to believe I had to enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan and I'm soooo glad I didn't. The program is designed to deceive you into signing up with zero understanding of what the risks are especially since I'm disabled with a rare spinal cord disease. I feel like I dodged a bullet and I'm going to share this information everywhere. I believe you saved people's lives with this piece."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 895 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgzhQ6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAg>

↳ @sunflower9611 (31): "I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

↳ @ammalelie509 (31): "THANK YOU JOHN OLIVER! Medicare Advantage is a scam. Stick to traditional Medicare (with an extra Medigap program) if you can! At this time of year, watching "old people TV", every other commercial is about switching to Medicare Advantage, and some of these commercials are two minutes long, which seems like an eternity."

↳ @edg3048 (24): "Stay out of the Advantage stuff. BCBS has always been good as a supplement. Insurance in this country sucks."

"I'm so glad that when I first signed up for Medicare, I didn't go with the Advantage Plan."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 328 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwLHliq9v5_Sx1UGW14AaABAg

↳ @christinekoenig5669 (17): "Yes i WAS WARNED & took heed.. do you have to have discernment from God and not be looking for free discounts, great deals from the government etcetera .Be not Decieved!!"

↳ @davidclaycomb5496 (17): "Me also. I listened to my doctor at the time that warned me against the 'advantage' plans. It hurts when I have to pay full price for any prescriptions, but at least I'm not getting denied coverage. Which has happened to friends of mine. I admit, I was close to signing up once until I mentioned that to my doctor. He was adamant about running away from those plans."

↳ @ahb3296 (13): "I didn't either. Then BCBS sent something with an automatic sign up if you didn't respond. I was out of country. I'm getting ready to try and drop it. Some kind of advantage plan through BCBS. They are scammers!!"

"You explain the options very well in this video. I'm glad I picked the supplemental plan instead of advantage. I'm 69 and not a spring chicken anymore. Your priority has to be medical benefits as you get older. Go to the doctors and hospitals that you want. No referrals. Pay the supplemental premium, skip the new car payments and hang on to that older car."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 290 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugw1n1YjSCR0VLikwUd4AaABAg

↳ @FollowScripture (0): "He was very informative...I agree with what you say here"

"Glad I did my homework and chose traditional Medicare over Medicare Advantage. I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments. I would rather pay for the "peace of mind," and the CHOICE to go where I want, and see the doctor or specialist I need/want."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 264 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbjQyLYRyCYv54AaABAq>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (10): "@LisaKnobel Medicare covers most everything, so unless you have a rare never heard of disease that has holistic/experimental treatment...Medicare/Medigap will cover it."

↳ @aregee7121 (10): "It's way more than just choice or peace of mind. Advantage plans, all insurance co. based, are more like socialized medicine, i.e. less spending per patient. You get restrictive networks, forced diagnosis first with G.P. or P.A! with delayed referral to a specialist, possibly not the one you want. The end result is a delay of the proper treatment. Do you want this as you get older?"

↳ @maryequilter31 (7): "The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"GREAT job, Erin! I'm a retired physician and I think you hit this out of the park. My wife and I started with an MC Advantage Plan but the unpredictability of out-of-network coverage, rapidly increasing max. out of pocket limits, increasing daily hospital copays, and pretty inadequate rehab coverage really began to make me rethink our decision. When our MC Advantage plan wasn't available in our area for 2026 we were so happy to be able to switch to a Medigap plan with guaranteed issue during a Special Enrollment Period (SEP). It's one of the few ways to be able to switch in that direction without underwriting. Yes the premiums are significant but the predictability of healthcare expenses, portability, and freedom of choice where to receive care made it worth it to us - priceless, in fact. I'm 67 and my wife is 72. Thank you for helping so many future decision-makers have such clarity."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 156 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugwn9ICoa-Qw7KmDdUp4AaABAq>

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (4): "Should have chose HDG, that way you would have all the benefits of traditional Medicare and not have the burden of an expensive supplement."

↳ @catchristo9406 (4): "@ChrisSadowski10372Thanks for the tip. I will look into this option!"

↳ @tnvqflqxz (3): "Thank you for sharing this information."

"I'm 75 and have been Medicare covered for 10 years. I started out the first year with Plan C (Advantage). But I got lucky, my carrier cancelled the plan in my area of Minnesota which triggered a "Special Enrollment Period" during which time I was able to move to a MediGap plan just like it was day one of my eligibility. Guaranteed issue, no MIB etc. Due to cardiac bypass surgery and hip replacements in my medical history I would probably not have been able to switch to a Supplement without the SEP kicking in. Six months ago with \$70K of unexpected Mayo radiation treatments I am relieved that my Advantage carrier decided to leave the area 9 years ago. You didn't cover Special Enrollment Periods but that's what saved me from being trapped in a Part C plan. Nice job explaining how this all works in an objective fashion."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 88 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwO03YTuvFEg34QrmF4AaABAq>

↳ @perreward5152 (3): "I've been on Medicare since 2021 learned a lot about advantage plans in Medigap plans did not know that if a company canceled that you could go to a new company without underwriting."

"What a great and thorough explanation. Thank you, most sincerely. I, and a friend, are both seniors. She with Advantage Plan and I chose Supplemental. We both have the exact same diagnosis. Routine testing is required. Her coverage is approved for 1 time per year and has been denied for more frequent testing. My testing is approved for every time my doctor wants to do it (every 3 months). I will be pointing many to your video. Just to make the point: I have another friend, also a senior, that is older than me but very healthy. She's very happy with her no cost Advantage Plan. Thanks so much. Like an elephant, I'll never forget (God willing ☺)" — YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugwuu0qLpz1SPRsjnFd4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much!! 🐼 so glad it was helpful and thank you for sharing your experiences!"

↳ @logicalblueberry (0): "That's what makes choosing so very difficult. My husband and I are healthy and in our early sixties. We would hate to waste money on an expensive health plan that we will hopefully never use. However, two of his siblings have died from cancer so???"

↳ @judysouzaw2293 (0): "Before I retired 8 years ago, my employer paid most of my UnitedHealthcare supplemental plan F after I turned 65. Now I'm 79 and still in good health, thanks to the love and joy I receive from my cats Denny and Donny!! Every year I call UHC to see if there is a cheaper plan and why my plan has no perks at all. I hesitate to switch to an advantage plan and be under covered if I encounter a costly medical event. I pay separately for Plan D and also dental coverage. I can afford all the premiums, but it doesn't seem fair. I know I'm grandfathered into plan F, but should I at least think about switching to plan G? Thank you very much."

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAg>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"Not being able to go back to Medicare Part A&B after moving to an Advantage plan makes it clear to me which is the best decision. I will stick with the original and get a supplement so I can have health care choices. Thank you for the very informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 37 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyuOo68Os9Lx99IFF54AaABAg>

↳ @nhmooytis7058 (5): "You can drop the Advantage during open enrollment, if you move, and if you get Extra Help, at any time."

↳ @kathyneichoy9384 (4): "You can go back but getting a supplement may be harder. They now can ask health questions to see if they will approve you."

↳ @themedicarelife4939 (3): "@kathyneichoy9384 Depends on where you live. Some states have no underwriting."

"I was warned by everyone not to take Medicare Advantage-so glad I listened. It's next to impossible to switch back-I would encourage anyone just about to enter-don't do it. The premiums are very attractive to rope you in but like they say-lots of exceptions, some doctors won't accept the plan etc"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugxxi6snmCvpHtHoLXp4AaABAg>

↳ @Ingrid-h7x (0): "Nobody warned ME! Common sense told me when something sounds too good to be true ... It IS. Nobody warned me not to take the COVID shot(s) .. Common sense told me if something is EXPERIMENTAL .. it's not what I want in MY body. I don't go on vacations or get a new car every 5 years, etc etc ... I wanted a good medigap insurance and I accepted that it wasn't going to be cheap! It's all about where your priorities are .."

↳ @wisember (0): ""It's next to impossible to switch back" The same is true for the other direction. MA isn't guaranteed issue after your trial period. You may or may not qualify for one later."

↳ @marieberberich4445 (0): "Not only that, there are many hospitals in the south that have gone belly up because they can't get paid by Advantage. A lot of hospitals, hearing this, won't take Advantage plans."

"My 80 year old mother's advantage plan randomly dropped her, (even they couldn't tell us why when we called, and it was the best thing that ever happened to her."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 27 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgwZVjdBuzzAF2jX--x4AaABAg>

"I have continued feeling a great deal of relief that I wormed my way out of a mistaken choice to get an Advantage plan. I was hooked by the offer of a vision plan. But then I learned all the shady stuff various Advantage plans can do, and because I am in NC and on Medicaid, I had a 6 month period to change my mind,. I switched back to original Medicare the minute I got my new pair of glasses. And I learned about how messed up Advantage plans can be thanks to YouTube. Thank you for making this video!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwiVOAo3PYIG4-Wj54AaABAg>

↳ @ragtop326 (0): "My vision plan only covered \$100 towards glasses, and I had to pay for my own exam \$89. In Viet Nam, RX glasses only cost \$14. What's wrong with our country. They're money hungry, that's all."

"I almost signed up for a Medicare Advantage plan yesterday - I'm so glad Weekend Tonight did this episode with the truth about this crap. ❤️ 😊 🍵 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=Ugw17NVFCQsSFO3UDPZ4AaABAg>

↳ @ChopBassMan (3): "@salishseasno, but some of the plans do cover Part D (the prescription part). This is all so damn confusing - the whole thing with paying for years into Social Security so that you can basically afford to keep living - and then when you get the Social Security that you paid into for years, you have to pay for an insurance plan just to get the 80% coverage, and then you need to get another damn policy to cover what the first one doesn't pay - and these costs come out of your monthly Social Security money - What a f*cking scam!

😡 😡 😡 🍵 "

↳ @williamhicks558 (2): "Medigap plans on the other hand, can save your bank account if you have serious medical issues."

↳ @salishseas (1): "@williamhicks558Is medigap Part D?"

"I spent three weeks in the hospital with nursing home offered afterwards I had another ct scan after I got home along with two MRIs. I have not been turned down for any procedures and I'm very happy with getting extra money for over the counter drugs, 48 one way transportation to and from medical appointments and hospitals, dental work, eye exams and glasses and even gym membership. My friend has Medicare w a supplement and doesn't get any of the above and pays co-pays. I also don't have co pays Needless to say, I'm very happy with Medicare Advantage Dual healthcare with United."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyTKgkxtkTMhUiMNFN4AaABAg.9xlaj0ZoZYsA4ohb9f3HXt>

"I'm 78, I've always used a Medicare advantage, but I've changed companies many times. I've always been happy with advantage here in NM"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzklzMzHaqlttDEmmN4AaABAg>

↳ @TAM-bv2di (2): "Same in Oregon. Changed companies twice to stay with my primary care physician. Insurance companies are replaceable, good doctors, not so much. I've had referrals to excellent doctors from friends both in the Midwest and here in Oregon, and in all three cases, none of them accepted patients with traditional Medicare. Maybe that tells you something - if you're good, why accept less than you need to?"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (0): "@TAM-bv2di Dream on... Advantage Plans are great for people who remain healthy and die in their sleep. Any deviation from that and you run the risk of inferior care at higher costs. And as taxpayers were paying double for Advantage customers and the Insurance carriers in turn make twice the profit vs a supp plan. Advantage carriers bill the US government over 2K per month per insured. They pocket anything thats not spent that month which is why they push these policies so hard and deny claims at much higher rates than supplemental plans."

"I wanted expert advice before I went on Medicare. So I hired a consultant. She call Medicare Advantage Medicare Disadvantage and told me to stay away from it. Why? Because it isn't real Medicare. It's private insurance that can end up making you go bankrupt. So I went with traditional Medicare with Part G supplement. I've never spent a dime out of pocket. Im glad I rejected Advantage. Rye largest hospital in my area announce last year that they were dropping out of Advantage. So have more than half of the areas physicians. This has left a lot of people without good healthcare choices. And I don't live in podunk. I live in a major metropolitan area with a population of over 6 million."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugy-HagNdaMnA1ecAZ14AaABAg>

↳ @memyself9037 (4): "@gurnblanston5000 not if you buy part G. If pays all part A and B deductables."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (2): "Still pay deductibles."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (1): "@memyself9037got it...D was cheaper here even with deductibles."

"I have Medicare Advantage and I love it. I had it for ten years now and I did not have any major issues and did not pay more than few dollars at a time. I get free annual exam, and free vision and skin check. The doctors make me come in every few months for a blood check and it is free; I pay like \$20 copay for minor surgeries. This is the best insurance I ever had."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugx5jTx1F3z-R027ntB4AaABAg>

↳ @paul.rainwater (4): "What plan are you on why don't you name the company in the name of the plan so we can all look into it if it's so great?"

↳ @ronvandeusen6580 (3): "@paul.rainwater Naming the company probably won't help in your search, as plans can change by county and state. What someone else has may not work for you, in your area."

↳ @JanoMladonicky (0): "@paul.rainwater Certainly, here you go: Kelsey-Seybolt Clinic, it was a private hospital network in Houston until last year, then it was bought by UnitedHealthcare. Please let me know how it compares."

"When my husband's Medicare advantage plan was 10:11 discontinued, he was eligible to go back to original Medicare plus a supplement without any underwriting. Which is what we did. So it turned out to be a real blessing, because I never felt comfortable with the MA plan. We live in Illinois by the way. My understanding is that at least here, if your plan is discontinued, then you can go back on original Medicare and supplement without any underwriting. However, if a hospital drops the plan, that's probably a different story."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxmuuvjBsOF7FjUEON4AaABAg>

↳ @keithkinkelaar3334 (0): "2014 There is the reacharound."

↳ @franklingoodwin5797 (0): "Correct ... it's called the golden ticket....when your MA plan drops you. However the default supplement plan is a Supplement Plan For.... Supplement Plan G"

"Joy, that's great to know. I stayed on the original Medicare for a few years but finally switched to Medicare Advantage and am very pleased with it thus far. Seems much easier to me all the way around. I like my docs and the network."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxDaTzel73QcRBL0DF4AaABAg.9ZFr8rnbxpM9cVLpV7sACH>

Money saved · 38 documents · 20 voices

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"I'm 75 and have been Medicare covered for 10 years. I started out the first year with Plan C (Advantage). But I got lucky, my carrier cancelled the plan in my area of Minnesota which triggered a "Special Enrollment Period" during which time I was able to move to a MediGap plan just like it was day one of my eligibility. Guaranteed issue, no MIB etc. Due to cardiac bypass surgery and hip replacements in my medical history I would probably not have been able to switch to a Supplement without the SEP kicking in. Six months ago with \$70K of unexpected Mayo radiation treatments I am relieved that my Advantage carrier decided to leave the area 9 years ago. You didn't cover Special Enrollment Periods but that's what saved me from being trapped in a Part C plan. Nice job explaining how this all works in an objective fashion."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 88 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwO03YTuvFEg34QrmF4AaABAg>

↳ @perreward5152 (3): "I've been on Medicare since 2021 learned a lot about advantage plans in Medigap plans did not know that if a company canceled that you could go to a new company without underwriting."

"I turn 65 in January 2026 and I chose plan N and I live in a very expensive area (Northern Va.) and will only pay \$87 and the Part B so about total \$294 a month so I'm pretty happy. And I also purchased a zero payment part D premium. I don't go to the doctor much so not worried about \$20 copay visit."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg.AODI8bYIzmOAOE-L9QNWYq>

"In a blazing panic! Okay, I'm in panic mode. On 9/15/2025 I turned 65, and I did what I was supposed to do. I signed up for Medicare, online. That was easy enough. At the end of the application, before I signed, there was a space to write any questions or concerns I have, especially for the Part B premiums. I explained I have been out of work since June 2025, and I'm currently receiving unemployment benefits. Unemployment I get barely scratches my rent. I had to work for, and was approved for SNAP. So at least I won't go hungry. But that leaves nothing for power bill my car ins and my phone. I got my Medicare card, but there was no info in the letter addressing what happens if you cannot meet the Part B premium. Today I get a bill for \$740, which will cover until January 2026, and it says pay in full, not each month, (which I can't even do that), but to pay in full by 10/25/25! I'm freaking out! No job, I get \$378 week from unemployment, (the amount I was approved for was \$419. They take taxes out so it brings it to \$378). Thank goodness the management company has been and letting my rent go one extra week, with only an added \$5 late fee. My monthly rent takes every penny of the unemployment. What will I do? I can't find any concrete information to find where to get help. This is one of the most frightening things I can remember going through. If I can't find help I'm going to have no choice but to just check out. What else can I do? How ridiculous will it be to be homeless, list everything I ever worked for and all to pay Medicare part b? Which I told them in that little note they all you to write for any questions or concerns I have? I think I'm gonna be done on this earth soon. All my life I've been working hard, became a widow suddenly at 46 but I have been taking care of myself, raised a daughter, and asking nobody for help...with nothing to show for it, then to just be out in the street? Jesus, Joseph and Mary!"

— r/medicare · 26 upvotes · None

"OMG! Thank YOU! SO MUCH! I am turning 65 in 3 weeks - I had thought to myself UGH! I am never going on Medicare (I own a highly profitable company, without any plans of retiring, I just love too much what I do) I was resigned to, was happy to, can easily afford to, continue paying \$900+ (in NY) a month for my insurance - IF you hadn't told me that after 1 year I would have to undergo underwriting (not that I have any medical issues - Today, that is....) Your Video, I think it's fair to say - you've saved the rest of my Healthcare Medicare Life! (LOL!) Truly, I am SO very grateful to you for this invaluable info!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 24 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgzIcot7XJbOiGBGEZN4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (9): "Thank you so much for reaching out! I'm really glad the information was helpful to you. One important caveat with medical underwriting is that in New York, Connecticut, Maine, and Massachusetts, underwriting doesn't apply at all — but in most other states it does. In the video, I wanted to keep the focus on the bigger picture rather than breaking down each state individually, since that would have taken quite a while. I hope this clears things up and makes sense!"

↳ @mkneely4539 (6): "If you don't sign up you will have to pay a penalty."

↳ @harleygirl795able (0): "@mkneely4539 unless you are still working! Once you retire, you have a limited amount of time to sign up before the penalty kicks in."

"I'm in Florida too and in my early years I didn't have health insurance. I had to go to the hospital for surgery and the bill came to nearly 100k. When I was being discharged, they were wheeling me towards the front door and suddenly veered off and went to the business office. They were demanding some sort of payment and also wanted me to sign papers saying I would pay the entire bill. I told them that I was still medicated and under doctors orders so I couldn't legally sign anything. My wife came in , very pissed off, and took me out of there. When they called a few days later I told them that I wanted an itemized bill. They argued with me and I told them that I knew that hospital bills are works of fiction and that I wanted the same discount that the insurance companies get. They knocked the bill down to \$6,000 and I told them I would send \$100 a month. After paying for 6 months I called them back and asked what it would take to pay it off. They agreed on \$1,500 and I sent them a check and they marked it paid in full. Of course now I'm on Medicare and have a supplement plan but anyone who's younger should remember that you can always negotiate."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgypslzdYHmZ7b1sgQJ4AaABAg.A8bQ-ZobSDuA8cVBGRqKWQ>

"I bounced between plan G and Plan N and finally decided on Plan N to save \$50/month. Best medical decision ever. Reasonable rates for hassle free coverage now, and in the future."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugwjm8cc5r1gWXrOdc4AaABAg

↳ @sharibrennan383 (0): "I'm soon to be retired and very stressed... I did see a video on plan N and you saying you are happy helps me. So you have Medicare work plan N? May I ask how expensive for that. I live in Minnesota. Thanks for sharing your comment. :0)"

↳ @CocoPink44 (0): "@sharibrennan383 Hello I live in Minnesota and am trying to pick between Plan G and N right now. I have not made the final decision but am thinking of going with Plan G. Plan N sounds good and cheaper but I am skeptical about it in the long run. I have to decide by September. Doing more research but think I will go with G"

↳ @CocoPink44 (0): "@sharibrennan383 PS do your research. I talked to someone at Chapter last week and he presented 3 options. I emailed him last night asking him for a list of all options and prices. I will be getting that list this evening. There are 9 in Minnesota he said. I don't have to ask him why he didn't present the others to me. I am certain he will only present the ones he gets the best commission on. I would never do that to anyone. He also told me he recommends Plan N for me. Sure he does. Probably better for him."

"Actually my wife finally goes on Medicare and we will save \$600 dollars a month for premiums alone, due to my skyrocketing retirement medical insurance costs I got when I retired. Thanks to Obamacare anyone working has had their health insurance skyrocket."

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgzpbceDI6FIxyCBkh54AaABAg.AaX57ux5uocAaXoWI35Qiu>

"Excellent explanation. I have done all my due diligence over the past year and made my choices already, as I'm turning 65 next month. I'm going with traditional Medicare parts A and B, taking part D drug supplement and selecting part G high-deductible as my supplement. I live in Washington State, so I can change this to regular G anytime if I have serious medical issues coming up. Right now, I'm on Obamacare paying \$75 a month. When I transition to Medicare on February 1st, I'll be paying \$275 (including part B). My social security increased by \$100 this month, so I'm really only losing a grand total of \$100 a month. Luckily, I worked in corporate America for 30 years and sold my old home, so I'll simply ask Fidelity to transfer that \$100 to my bank account each month. All that hard work and saving money since the creation of the 401k in 1986 has finally blessed me. I hope everyone else is as fortunate."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=Ugwzet3CgDAD5RGvakt4AaABAg>

↳ @EXPLOREWITHME. (0): "May i ask why increase? Was it caz where u live?"

↳ @michaelarnold2728 (0): "@EXPLOREWITHME. yearly USA cost of living increase"

↳ @WakeUpAmerican000s (0): "@EXPLOREWITHME. - The Medicare Supplement (Medigap) plans are a no-brainer for those who are chronically ill (e.g. diabetic, HIV, Cancer etc.), but what these presentations don't tell you is that the Medigap insurance providers raise their premiums by 3-5% EVERY YEAR. So in 10 years or so, your premiums are 2x what they are today. And there are lifetime maximum coverage limits on nearly all of the medigap plans (some as low as \$1 million). So us 'patients' need to read the detailed Evidence of Coverage contracts very carefully. That goes for the separate Part D drug insurance you must buy (\$25 / month or more). The reason that Medicare Part C (Advantage) programs were put in place is because over half of the Medicare qualified population can't afford Medigap insurance, which for a retire couple, can amount to \$1000 / month plus whatever you spend on dental and vision care."

"This is thought provoking. Thanks. As someone very grateful to pay \$4000 - 5000 a year for excellent ACA insurance, I think paying in the same range for Medicare with G or N makes sense. Heck, I have had home insurance and never needed it, but my body stands a much greater chance of breaking down each year after hitting 65 next year."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgybzOxoJwim3lhyD9h4AaABAg>

"Good basic coverage of Medicare and supplement plans. Not too tough to understand when I went on the Medicare website 3 years ago and also watched a few of your and other independent insurance broker's videos. When looking at the Advantage plans I noticed the variations in costs based on covered services, and by the time I found a few plans with the coverage I was comfortable with they were as expensive as regular Medicare with a supplement plan and a Part D plan. Since retirement is kind of a 'spend your accumulated savings/wealth on what benefits you' I decided to spend a bit extra on regular Medicare plan, a supplement, and Part D, and I'm happy with it. I also have a separate dental & vision plan (the Advantage dental and vision is a joke!). Cheers."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgyJgBRgrCnwTLEcTRV4AaABAg>

"Great question. One of the biggest issues when it comes to the 20% that you would be responsible for without a Medigap plan is a cancer diagnosis and treatment. 20% of the cost of one chemotherapy treatment can be up to or above \$3,000 (the full cost of a single treatment is estimated to be \$1,000-\$15,000). Data shows that one out of every 2 people will get diagnosed with cancer in their lifetime. In my opinion this is the biggest financial risk on going without a Medigap plan."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgzbuS2dCWzr8-FCBw54AaABAq.9qQ9mFHBMQW9qQcwKxnc7J>

"I just had to declare turning 65 in a month. I went with the supplement plan just because I have seen several people chose advantage and then see the 20% charge hit them when they become very ill. Peace of mind for my wife and myself is more important than saving a few bucks now."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwbfdhdOhlpoU5w1Cp4AaABAq>

"My premium on Plan G that I got at 65 continued to rise a little each year. I am now 83 and I finally had to go to N because my premium was going to over \$300. I am happy with N although they also go up. I am 83 now and it renews in March and I'm worried of how much it will be. My health is good and don't have any serious issues. I also have part D. In Jan. It rose \$30 to \$227 per month even though I take less meds than 2 years ago. With all the talk about the rise in other insurances at the first of the year because the government wouldn't pay part of it. I never heard anyone comment on Medigap policies. Does that affect us too because if it does, I don't know what I will do. I definitely do not get enough SS and small retirement."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgyDpXDF-sx7LHwB0T14AaABAq>

↳ @medicare365 (4): "You should be asking a family member to help you get a login to Medicare.gov and look at your drug plan (and other drug plans) every year from November 1st- November 30 to see if your plan is going up in price. This way you can switch your plan right on Medicare.gov. Contact a broker or local Medicare agent in your state and see if they will help you also. There are also free resources like local senior centers and SHIP which is a non-profit that helps people on Medicare. I would recommend getting familiar with the senior center and go there often for help. If you can, stay on a Medigap plan N because in the long run, the coverage will be the best thing you could get. Hope this helps."

"@paul2019monte my neighbor has an advantage plan and is pleased with it. I don't think she pays for it. I pay \$144 a month for my supplement but it gives me some peace of mind that I will have good coverage if I become really sick. No matter how healthy we think we are, as we age things can happen to our bodies. I am not wealthy but I know a couple ladies who live on less than \$1000 a month and paying that premium might be hard or impossible for them."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzMVDXyviom5xLUtIF4AaABAq.9TDdw-WtTCC9TtLm-p8QGG>

"From the land of the Loon. You are the BEST! 2 friends turning 65 Dec & Jan Mom 91 just lost her retiree group insurance when Ucare pulled out of MN She has 4 different offerings from school district HOWEVER only one is appealing... That advantage plan is \$272/m With her guaranteed issue rights wish she could apply for a Plan N ... but understand only what we call "Basic" with riders = "G" Minnesota expensive ~\$400/mo+Drugs (then add Dent,vis,hear..) Totally tough choices ... the plan she is loosing with Ucare was \$177/m and she has loved it... Wish I had more time to research. Your videos are absolutely the best! even up agent the best of all your 6 mentioned other YouTube ers.... Yet to see you say incorrect information you didn't correct. Love your fact based, unbiased, get help from good sources, use an agent / broker.... AND your presentation.. clear, understandable, good tempo and fantastic throughout coverage of material. FYI im 65 in May"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=Ugz4dlmlOSakezNccr94AaABAg>

"@codydriver6413 I agree, my first year I went with Original, just fine. Second year I decided to try an Advantage. With the one I was leaning towards all my current docs are in network, my two meds are covered at \$2 per refill, and in addition they also give me \$40 quarterly in over the counter meds, a paid in full annual vision exam, \$100 towards frames, 2 annual dental exams, and if needed it they will pay some towards hearing aides. All this for the (current) \$170 Pt B premium. Now, I am healthy and the situation might change if something medical occurs. But so far (second year in) I'm very satisfied with my Advantage plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugy7giHmgfpQS0R9PLJ4AaABAg.9Z9YeUZeq9ZEUSfF_2lY

"I have supplemental plan F. I do not mind the increased premiums. This year with breast cancer my plan has paid 100% of all bills to date six six more chemo months to go. Over \$500,000 paid in full. What do I care if supplement price increase double digits. My suggestion to everyone is to buy the most expensive supplement plan offered. This video does us a disservice. But the one with highest premiums!"

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugzamt44Birdf6dHuEt4AaABAg

↳ @1ladybug558 (2): "I disagree. Your viewpoint is unrealistic if you look at national average of social security income for retirees is roughly 25,000 per year with no additional income. yes many may have additional sources but most cant afford anything other than medicare advantage. I personally started with A B and plan G but realistically can not do that for very long. You obviously speak from a platform of you can afford it, you do not make the choice each month between rent, groceries etc. This is an informational video for those who can not imagine or thinks to do this depth of planning or even know that the costs need to be thought out to this degree. He is giving the info that one needs to begin thinking for themselves with real life scenarios to imagine the possibilities. You could take 2 people and do an anaylisis in 20 years with all the same coverage , one possible could have gone the cheaper? route and the other the most expensive and both have been wrong on their choices. I LOVE these videos and real life applications."

↳ @2023Red (0): "@1ladybug558 Yes. People without additional income to social security cannot afford to eat or pay rent many times. So advantage is their only choice. I get that. I do not know the stats to which you refer. But I do know there is a consequence to choice. In my world, you get what you earned. Good luck to you."

"Thanks for this information. Im 68, still working and have excellent medical through my job thats primary to Medicare Part A. Glad i had both when i had my total hysterectomy as I paid zero out of pocket for the hospital (\$56k for an overnight stay). I saved a lot of GREEN!"

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzXVv7d7RuFqhwb1p4AaABAq>

"@whyme5024 I think you mean, “formerly clueless” as, speaking from personal experience, as one of the “responsible spouses” referenced in this video, I found “the retirement nerds” while I was sitting next to my husband’s ICU bed during the first couple of weeks of his unexpected illness. (Married for 38 years, 3 kids and 7 grandkids and we started a business together.) Minor annoying knee pain from a cyst turned into full on sepsis and a series of unfortunate sequela for my man which resulted in his checking into the health care theme park with multiple “fun rides” punctuated by some fairly random “side shows” including a couple of return visits to the ICU in between weeks on the med/surg floor and multiple weeks at a rehab hospital due to some paralysis, several months of IV antibiotics, complex PT and OT services and then finally home after installing chair lifts and an access wheelchair ramp in our home that is now, absolutely for sure, our final resting place. I’m thrilled to be able to report that the husband is not only fully recovered, but is back working again with me in the company we started years ago. I had to pull a chunk of funds from my own retirement account for the longer term PT and the “durable medical equipment,” the stair chair lift(s) and wheel chair ramp and the ongoing PT/specialized strength and endurance trainer from, fortunately, our expert credentialed neighbor across the street after the initial PT coverage on our original corporate health insurance ran out and when he lit the limit of what we moved him too with his Medicare finally becoming primary. (Note, many very good quality corporate health insurance plans have limited days for rehab stays which, until this happened, I was not aware of.) Both the husband and I are now on Medicare (primary) with supplement plans I carefully chose for each of us based on your guidance and the many videos I watched both from the my husband’s bedside and from my hotel/Airbnb room at night while he was hospitalized. (Tertiary care hospital is an hour plus away from our home and the rehab hospital that our insurance covered was 1.5 hours away. I’ve spent nearly 16 weeks dealing with bills and insurance billing errors during my husband’s convalescence which meant more lost time from work for me and further need to use some of my own savings. I was raised in a medical family and worked in public health before starting the company my husband and I own and run together. I can imagine, but don’t wish to, how awful this must be for people who don’t know how “medical care billing” and insurance companies work/or don’t. Our plan to be fully retired by the end of this coming July is now on hold again as our long term employees who are taking over ownership of our company have to wait a bit longer until there is less economic uncertainty and I’m grateful that we’re healthy enough to be able to continue to work with them for another year or so until the economic outlook improves and I’m also grateful, especially after last Friday and, likely, after tomorrow, Monday, that I pulled some funds from my savings to pay for the stuff that insurance and Medicare didn’t cover. Just trying to say that your information was extremely helpful and has saved our family from a ton of additional hardship and worry. My husband’s last surgery was at the end of last August after the theme park event began last March. Even though we live near the ocean and have some of the best beaches on earth near us, I didn’t have a chance to get any kind of sunburn last summer, but this summer, I’ll be making up for that, but will still be using a proper sunscreen. (If you know the risk, you can mitigate the risk if you plan ahead and make it easier to have the tools needed in hand/easily available when needed. Risk mgmt is also one of the components of public health work.) Thanks to you and your crew for the invaluable service you provide."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzNfG0dtPVPcNyTvF4AaABAq.AGYUS018ZMFAGbFs7POJen>

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Calls, mail and ads every day · 170 documents · 20 voices

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"As a physician, I'd highly recommend going Traditional Medicare route if you can afford it... You are >65, this is time people start to get sick. Many hospitals are dropping Medicare Advantage plans, and we CONSTANTLY see prior authorization on Advantage plans on drugs that actually matter. Not mentioning the prior auths for surgeries. It is concerning that she undersells how much denials MA plans do compared to Traditional Medicare. Life is precious, this is not an arena to go cheap as an elderly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 258 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyvkxZTQrEFv_Sdwrl4AaABAg

↳ @MrHaighahatta (17): "@OnlineMD That's great, as long as you're not one of the 37% of US households (and likely a higher percentage of the 65+ population) who would struggle to pay a \$400. unexpected expense and needed that procedure or diagnostic denied by your Medicare advantage insurer. As a former DNS of a 48-bed residential care facility, not a week went by when I did not have to battle with some advantage insurer over a prior authorization, spending my time and/or having to contact the MD's office to additionally spend their time justifying an MD's (and possibly an internist's) orders to a profit-driven, impersonal corporation. Imagine the seniors with no advocate getting that insurance denial or demand for prior auth's."

↳ @tunaustunkaya7903 (17): "@OnlineMD Sure that works until you are healthy enough to see your PCP twice a year and take generic drugs. Difference becomes obvious when you need specialty drugs which can be life altering i.e Chemos, GLP1s, PCSK9inh etc. and you don't know when that is going to happen after 65. We don't mind doing PA, heck even appeals as you pointed out we have people to do that. They flat out deny most of the disease changing drugs. Let alone if you need a specific surgery and would like to get that done by a specific surgeon, or an advanced imaging/diagnostics and you'll realize that your Medicare Advantage plan may not be accepted at that hospital. I still stand behind not cheaping out on health insurance."

↳ @JAC-c9v (6): "When you say afford it, is going for an Advantage plan that gives back not a good idea? Only need a plan that pays medical/ dental cleaning/vision/prescription generic drug cost. That's it and grateful. Any suggestions would be helpful. I hate it when it comes to insurance.."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"GREAT job, Erin! I'm a retired physician and I think you hit this out of the park. My wife and I started with an MC Advantage Plan but the unpredictability of out-of-network coverage, rapidly increasing max. out of pocket limits, increasing daily hospital copays, and pretty inadequate rehab coverage really began to make me rethink our decision. When our MC Advantage plan wasn't available in our area for 2026 we were so happy to be able to switch to a Medigap plan with guaranteed issue during a Special Enrollment Period (SEP). It's one of the few ways to be able to switch in that direction without underwriting. Yes the premiums are significant but the predictability of healthcare expenses, portability, and freedom of choice where to receive care made it worth it to us - priceless, in fact. I'm 67 and my wife is 72. Thank you for helping so many future decision-makers have such clarity."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 156 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugwn9ICoa-Qw7KmDdUp4AaABAg>

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (4): "Should have chose HDG, that way you would have all the benefits of traditional Medicare and not have the burden of an expensive supplement."

↳ @catchristo9406 (4): "@ChrisSadowski10372Thanks for the tip. I will look into this option!"

↳ @tnvqlqxz (3): "Thank you for sharing this information."

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"Humana screwed me over I have a heart condition and have been waiting three months to have an echocardiogram. Recently, Humana changed my PCP from someone I've been seeing for years and years to a stranger and didn't let me know if they changed it. My doctor reached out to let me know and I called and had him changed back but then they sent a new card that didn't list my doctor's name and I had to request it again from them. Then I showed up from my appointment yesterday and they still hadn't adjusted their records. Now they decided they needed prior approval for something that was already approved and I had already received a co-pay notification. Then the hospital, which is supposed to care for people and is another point of how the US healthcare system is fucked up, turned me away. They turned away a heart patient because the insurance was being difficult. They're supposed to take care of patients, but if money isn't forthcoming, they turn them away, even if they're at risk of dying. I'm sorry I just needed a place to express this and I hope others will agree with me that Medicare and the health system in general need a major overhaul."

— r/medicare · 87 upvotes · None

"Clover Health is defying expectations in the BEST way possible I just wanted to brag a little. I've had very little reason to do so in regards to anything health insurance related...ever. I've been a Clover health, first time on Medicare, patient for 1 month a 5 days. I have special needs (14 hrs/day IV infusions in the home for past 2.5 years) which prior to having Medicare were met by commercial insurance without a problem. Apparently infusions in the home are very rarely a covered thing under medicare. They are although covered in Hospice and the Hospital. Obviously I don't want to live in either. I am in my 30s. Clover Health quickly recognized that this is a complex situation that requires delicacy. A small specialty pharmacy might not agree to a drawn out process to get meds covered for this one patient on Medicare after all...and others aren't taking new patients in my area due to IV fluids still being somewhat impacted (shortage) from last year's hurricane. Anyway, Clover Health assigns a team on this that calls me every night. Also, gets me the most tenacious, amazing nurse advocate and they all begin a 2 week long talk with my pharmacy culminating in a single patient agreement going forward. I am relieved and grateful to say the least."

— r/medicare · 73 upvotes · None

"i have been researching Medicare supplement plans versus Advantage plans and discovered so many negatives with Advantage plans. Your video confirms for me that supplemental plans are the way to go. I hope more people will educate themselves and not be suckered in by the has-been celebrities who are touting Advantage plans in non-stop commercials. Thanks for the very informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 66 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugxi-BJ7WpxJLsFGVvV4AaABAg>

↳ @LarryKelly (7): "I doubt the celebrity hawkers for Medicare Advantage plans really have one themselves. I bet Joe Namath, William Shatner, and the dynamite guy all have supplemental plans. The only reason not to is if you can't afford the premiums and these guys can."

↳ @eugeneallison7457 (3): "Well let's see what I have I have United Healthcare Advantage plan I have zero monthly premium I have dental insurance I have vision insurance later on in life if I need hearing aids they are covered my drug plan also known as part d is covered at zero cost my monthly premium is zero cost I get up to a maximum benefit of \$375 toward any eyeglasses I get a additional \$350 every quarter on over the counter medication including medical equipment blood pressure monitor shower chairs raised toilet seat vitamins I paid 0 I can go to any doctor in and out of network without a doctor referral I have zero specialist 0 doctor copay if I go to the emergency room I pay 0 if I am admitted into any Hospital I pay zero my drugs are 3.50 prescription I have not had to pay any medication co-pays since August because at August my prescription drug costs so far was 25.000 bucks I also get free transportation to and from my doctor I get a free pair of diabetic shoes every year now you tell me what Medicare Plan can beat that??? I'll be waiting"

↳ @LarryKelly (2): "@eugeneallison7457 just don't get sick or injured"

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAq>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"I turn 65 this August. I work in IT my brain is super sharp I do 500 situps a day 20 minutes olyptical a day don't drink don't smoke and I'm still fin lost!!! So now I'm supposed to find some financial shark who just might steal me blind. And I'm one of the sharp ones! What about the poor old people that are scammed and taken advantage of every day? What has society come to? This is an outrage! I've watched video after video and I'm still not certain of my best path. And I'm certainly not going to pay for someone who may or may not help me."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=Ugz2DNxO1qpi1X0xEkF4AaABAq>

↳ @BarryWeaver-pv6cz (7): "@KrissyQueens It's extremely confusing!! She only touched on the most basic points of parts ABCD. There are many videos that are hours long discussing it. Then you need to know the specifics of each part, how much is covered, what is and isn't covered. I have more health problems than I can count, and this is super overwhelming. Especially since the single insurance I have now covers almost everything for a LOT less money. I might better work forever! Maybe thats why so many do work til they die."

↳ @KrissyQueens (2): "It's not that confusing she just explained it"

↳ @LisaTheisen-j8j (2): "@KrissyQueensdo happy you feel it's ok to shame people 🤔 do you feel better now?"

"I really like my Advantage plan! Haven't had any problems, never denied coverage never any monthly output, always had complete coverage."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 56 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgzgM7tL9bIQNKyO7ix4AaABAq>

↳ @meditation6054 (5): "I don't know which Advantage plan you have but I'm a physical therapist and every patient that has an advantage plan have consistently been cut short on coverage for services! Every Advantage plan cuts services!"

↳ @mrsatire9475 (1): "Wellcare was not accepted at enough facilities and they refused to cover scripts and diagnostics ordered by Doctors not in their plan"

↳ @akita96th (0): "Have you been really sick yet? The kind of sick that cost over a \$100K I have..Thats when you will hate that advantage plan...Did you buy that advantage plan because Donald Trump and the GOP supports them?"

"Thanks Mr. Monaghan. I'm a physician who lives in an area where the hospital and most of the doctors are owned by a closed panel HMO (Geisinger), and I've tried to tell patients the truth about Medicare Advantage plans not always being cheaper, being less convenient and sometimes limiting newer treatments. Your video spells out the financial issues as plain as day. Would it be ok if I show your video when discussing this with patients? I also wanted to point out that Medicare advantage programs often require that the patient has to travel to find a paneled specialist which can add to the cost and inconvenience and that Medicare advantage plans often consider well established modern treatments and surgeries as non-covered "experimental" procedures"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 54 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwSxRGEZp3GIB2izeJ4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (13): "Absolutely, that would be an honor for you to show my video to your patients. Thank you for the comment!"

↳ @PJN61 (6): "Interesting. My momma lives in very rural North Central Pa and Geisinger it all there is up there but she's 89 and has a Medigap G plan so she's good."

↳ @karen-r1e4w (0): "my DR/boss also has always "shyed away from telling his patients some of the ins/OUTS of advantage plans. not always the best decision. in fact ,usually not."

"The biggest benefit I see going with a supplement plan is it gives you options for the future. You always have the option to switch to advantage plan, that never goes away. Once you go on an advantage plan, you may never have the option of going with a supplement plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 54 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwYL3-dH3X5dHW2UHH4AaABAg>

↳ @lisamay4376 (4): "In some states you can switch more easily."

↳ @dawnocceanside7300 (1): "It took me 3 long YEARS! I did it!!!"

↳ @3DWhispers (0): "@lisamay4376 In my state they have a birthday rule. It only provides the ability to switch your Medigap plan to a different company. It does not give you the ability to switch from Advantage to a Medigap plan. Just be mindful of these types of things."

"New Medicare sales tactic It must be the season when unscrupulous Medicare brokers can make big money switching people to Medicare Advantage plans. I'm getting multiple spam calls a day trying to get me to switch. Today I got an especially sleazy one that called himself a "Medicare Adviser" and started by demanding my Medicare number to "verify" what new benefits I would get. At first he denied he was signing people up for Medicare Advantage but later let that slip when I asked how all the new benefits were paid. Reminiscent of old-time phone service slamming when phone companies would try to switch your long distance carrier without your knowledge. Sleazy tactics. Beware."

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"sunburn. I wonder if people are aware that Advantage plan companies are owned by private equity firms that place profits over people always. This is my biggest concern about these plans. I haven't chosen one yet, but I am very concerned about the Advantage plans."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 33 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyrQ0RNoaOb4etaX-54AaABAg.AKZ72nI1qOIAL2KD1OJvGt>

"I've been bombarded over the last few years to switch to the medicare advantage plan. It always sounds too good to be true; after reading a little bit about it I resisted because I haven't trusted it. I was right not to trust it."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 33 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxmT865uNNBDGTwxqV4AaABAg>

"I am 76 and my phone has been ringing all day since last Thanksgiving with different people from different states trying to sell me Medicare Advantage. I am happy to hear what you've said."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgztAt-OUHVVW8yJkjot4AaABAg.9XPA5Vuw7so9Xdr2wiKa82>

"Oh, you are a wonderful man and your Mom is proud! Great presentation 👍 At 69 yrs of age, I was diagnosed with cancer. Five weeks of daily radiation and weekly chemo, followed by 5 sessions of internal radiation which included anesthesia. Throw in 4 ER visits, plus a few bags of blood and platelets. I'm on Medicare with Plan G Supplement. My total treatments and hospitalization? Out of pocket \$190 — whew, I am amazed! We ALL deserve adequate healthcare! ❤️ May God bless every one of you fighting cancer. 🙏 Thank you for your video!"

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgwIDLobCk7-ZUEbrXd4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "Thank you so much! Glad to hear you are doing well. Quite the treatment plan!"

↳ @joannc147 (0): "👍 Indeed! @Theretirementnerds"

↳ @SP-ro7tb (0): "@joannc147 do you have a prescription plan?"

Still working past 65 · 42 documents · 20 voices

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · None

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"OMG! Thank YOU! SO MUCH! I am turning 65 in 3 weeks - I had thought to myself UGH! I am never going on Medicare (I own a highly profitable company, without any plans of retiring, I just love too much what I do) I was resigned to, was happy to, can easily afford to, continue paying \$900+ (in NY) a month for my insurance - IF you hadn't told me that after 1 year I would have to undergo underwriting (not that I have any medical issues - Today, that is....) Your Video, I think it's fair to say - you've saved the rest of my Healthcare Medicare Life! (LOL!) Truly, I am SO very grateful to you for this invaluable info!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 24 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzlcot7XJbOiGBGEZN4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (9): "Thank you so much for reaching out! I'm really glad the information was helpful to you. One important caveat with medical underwriting is that in New York, Connecticut, Maine, and Massachusetts, underwriting doesn't apply at all — but in most other states it does. In the video, I wanted to keep the focus on the bigger picture rather than breaking down each state individually, since that would have taken quite a while. I hope this clears things up and makes sense!"

↳ @mkneely4539 (6): "If you don't sign up you will have to pay a penalty."

↳ @harleygirl795able (0): "@mkneely4539unless you are still working! Once you retire, you have a limited amount of time to sign up before the penalty kicks in."

"My name is Mike and I highly recommend Abt insurance agency to anyone getting ready to retire or considering changing providers. They have taken great care of me and my insurance needs. I retired in 2022 and Stephanie and her staff have always been dependable and reliable when I've needed any kind of help. They are all friendly and very knowledgeable about all the different coverages. You can count on them when Medicare or SSA gives you the run around. They know what's up. Thanks to Stephanie and her entire staff for the great job they do, they take all the stress out of choosing the right plan. I will personally vouch for Plan G coverage. It's worth the price."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwLw7QrCM3wl-BjRhZ4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (4): "Thank you Mike! This means a lot. We're grateful for you. 😊 "

"I'm almost 83, and only using holistic medicine , no meds, no tests, no vaccines. In the event I get cancer I'll not do chemo or extensive surgery. I'd rather live out my life with my hair, my appetite and as normal activity as possible. I walk every day, use a vibration machine for additional "workout". Is just original Medicare the best bet for me? I'm tired of paying for "advantages" I never use."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugx20mG1V7LA31YrlsN4AaABAg>

↳ @bridgetbecker8589 (5): "Good for you! Several of my family members lived into their mid-90's. Grandma (who lived to 100) had surgery at 93. I also do natural health care, but if my head falls off, I don't want a bargain basement surgeon to sew it back on. Worse yet, I don't want to be denied treatment!"

↳ @thunderbird3694 (5): "Stay healthy! My sister developed cancer in her late 50's and she refused to go under the knife. Needless to say she did not live too long after that."

↳ @h-man2561 (3): "My dad felt he would pass in the early 80's at the end he just missed 97. He had prostate cancer in his middle 60's. His PSA levels spiked again in early 90's. He went on a chemo pill that gave him 5 extra quality years, so no losing hair or any other side effects. His PSA stayed low but his kidneys became the issue at the end. Before he passed he said he achieved 15 extra years than planned but he said he would like to live to 200 now. Life is precious so keep an open mind, treatment may not be as bad as in the past. Medicine should be looked at if needed. Steve Jobs with Apple went against medicine & failed quickly. Good luck! 🍀 "

"I am turning 65 shortly and am as healthy as a powerful rhino. I work out daily and have never taken a prescription drug in my life. Not even an antibiotic, nor aspirin! I have been watching a LOT of videos, and prior to yours, thought I was going to be taking the Supplement Plan N. Because of your breakdown at the end, I realize I am a wise elephant because I check all the boxes you explained that would motivate someone to choose an Advantage plan, so thank you."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugx3XQcuy_hT1U1Jskd4AaABAg

↳ @RichardSalyer-i6y (0): "We saved a ton of money not paying premiums from age 74-79 on a \$0.00 Premium, Medicare Premium PPO from UHC in San Antonio, TX. Just like us; 1.) Know yourselves and your health situations, 3.) Do you research - then buy. Prior to that we had UHC as a HMO and were only marginally happy with it. Love the PPO - like night and day, even though same company. With an HMO, they can keep trying things to save money, putting off the treatment, that you need for 2--3 months. But, unfortunately a PPO in a big Metropolitan can cost a lot of money per month of NON existant - like in So. California."

"At age 70, I was diagnosed with throat cancer (despite never having smoked, used other tobacco products, had any work environmental exposures, or drank alcohol) and would need radiation therapy. The radiation oncologist was very pleased that I had traditional medicare. She said that I could receive proton therapy, a more advanced type of radiation therapy that causes less collateral damage. She said that with a Medicare advantage plan it would have been a fight to get it approved and I would probably would have needed to get photon therapy, a previous generation technology, instead. I'd always recommend original Medicare if it is at all affordable since it provides many more choices and no restrictive networks."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwV2iipA07jfNxqQEV4AaABAg>

"As someone who works in hospital billing, I ALWAYS advise to stick with traditional Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyN2LB7cUOLVsv9jJF4AaABAg>

"Very interesting. I am a former hospital RN & had to suddenly retire early due to permanent disability. I also had a bit of experience working with a major insurance company as a care manager. I mention being put on disability, because I acquired a medical team consisting of several specialists due to my diagnoses. It was my first experience as a patient on Medicare at age 55. My mom's MC plan was always an original MC plan with a supplement (from the same major ins co I had worked for!). At 55 in AZ, I could choose orig MC, but was not allowed to have a supplement because of my younger age. I was highly upset...because I knew two things..#1 was that I did not want an Advantage plan. #2 was, I couldn't take the financial gamble to go without a supplement with an original plan... so I went with the Advantage plan. That was 8 years ago, and I've had Advantage plans in 2 states now. I couldn't be happier. I was expecting a lot of stress, having to fight for things that my doctor's wanted me to have, etc. I did my research and selected terrific doctors, and have had extremely thorough care. My mom could not believe the care I received, and at very little cost to me. Even when I couldn't tolerate meds on my formulary (has only happened twice), they made exceptions, and approved coverage for meds not on my formulary. Last year I paid a total of \$23 for my meds. It was for an IV infusion because I can't take the oral, or injectable forms. My mom is now 92, and for years has chosen the same plan as I have. Her meds were \$0 last year. We each have approx \$108 for our MC premium's withdrawn from our social security distributions prior to our direct deposits. Otherwise my mom has paid \$0 for her care, meds, supplies. We have \$500/yr each on a flex card to put toward our expenses for dental/hearing/vision. I had thousands of dollars of work done on my teeth last year, and I didn't have to pay a cent. We also get \$198 each per quarter for over the counter items. It covers deodorant, toothpaste, incontinent briefs, bandaids, mouthwash, shower chairs, antibiotic cream, vitamins, supplements, electric toothbrushes, TENS units, the list goes on. Last year one of my specialists wanted me to have a CT cardiac angiogram done at the hospital. It was approved in no time, and completed without a hitch, at \$0. I totally respect if someone isn't on the same page as I, and that they are passionate about what they believe. I would simply like to encourage everyone to do their own thorough research, and don't just believe what you are viewing in videos, or by reading viewer comments such as mine. There is a ton of info out there that I found really beneficial. Good luck as you gain new knowledge based on your own needs. 💕 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwjLjct_Q2GfEy-bmJ4AaABAq

↳ @deeparsley8614 (1): "I would love to know what MC Advantage plan you have, would you share please."

↳ @kimbo500 (1): "@deeparsley8614 Sure.....it's a Wellcare plan. (I'm in FL)"

↳ @mcclungfarm7965 (1): "I think the key is you are in FL. My parents have switch to a MA plan and for the past 12 years have been thrilled with level of care. My father had a major heart blockage. From auth of test to auth of emergency surgery all the way to in house rehab took less than 4 days. In parts of FL all the hospitals and/or DRs are in the HMO. Mainly because of the size of the MC community here. I think where MA has issues is in states where there just are not as many seniors."

"I work with both MA and Supplements. While what you say is mostly accurate the sad fact is many seniors simply cannot afford the high premiums of Supplements AND a PDP. Add in the monthly cost of dental, vision and hearing, which supps won't cover, and it's easy to be priced out completely. There's nothing wrong with MA. I work with people every day who LOVE their MA plans and wouldn't trade em for the world, lol. (It's my job to try!) Many also have much lower Max Out Of Pockets than mentioned that can end up being as much as the yearly premium you pay with Supps whether you use it or not. 🙌 If you travel, simply get a PPO. Easy. Everybody has different needs and means. Luckily there are multiple options to try and help people with their Health Care."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABA9.9ZKG5-KW4OV9ZNkSpJgaXx>

"You made bad life choices, that is on you, Social Security was never meant to be a retirement plan, it was always only meant to be a supplemental income for your retirement. My social security pays for my original medicare, Plan G and my Plan D drug plan. My wife's social security will also pay for her original medicare, Plan G and Plan D drug plan. We were smart and made sure we had a retirement plan so our retirement plan pays nothing towards our health insurance. You should not have went though life in a daze thinking you would be taken care of."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211pLq6moM&lc=UgzLtuuOve_Da6wcrip4AaABA9.ATHoSZSKnmHAWVxm3nWfol

"I'm in the same boat. I hate our healthcare system. As always you only survive if you have a high paying government job or a wealthy person the rest of us lose everything if we get sick and even if you don't get sick right away the copays on these advantage plans are not affordable. We are screwed and that's why so many millions of people die needlessly in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugwcgxlchxqa2pLRBYx4AaABA9.A2F9VGzRc_2A4dRaswiJ1d

"I live in Texas and I help these people all the time get their bills covered until they can get to another, more legitimate health insurance option. How they do is click bait, advertisements, and just typing into their search engine health insurance and accepting what they find. What I also see all the time is brokers who commonly say lies. They lie about network coverage. A good example is one lady causes everybody to be afraid of Healthcare Marketplace and only accept her off marketplace plans, because she misinforms them about insurance coverage for their children's care. She lies and says the hospital does not accept any, when they do accept one (I get it - not a wide variety...) but the one further away takes four, and etc. It makes parents panic into the cheap plans, and then the worst happens; no spending caps, exceptions, exemptions, etc. Then we also get a lot of, "We just retired before 65, so we aren't Medicare, but we don't have the money to spend on a health insurance plan from the Healthcare Marketplace; what is available?" or "We just moved from another state that had their own exchange website (many do), but I guess Texas doesn't?" and it's always the cheap plans with spending caps, exemptions, exclusions, and it's so unfortunate that the buzzards go for these people. In great summary, it's commonly fear mongering and word of mouth that get people to take other plans. "Oh, Janet, you pay \$1,000 a month?! I pay \$100 a month. I know a guy.""

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1whfg16/how_do_people_usually_get_health_insurance/pa2jzsu/

"sunburn - worked well past 70 years old to avoid government health insurance. When looking for work I always wanted to get a job with a plan where you could pick almost any doctor and that also had uncomplicated co-pay scheme and had a simple to understand 'out of pocket' max clause so you had an idea what you had to absorb at worst each year. After looking at what was deducted from your pay for that plan and adding your estimated co-pays and adding the out of pocket max you had an idea what you might have to 'self insure' each year. Which of the government schemes is closest to that model ? Sounds like I should hope to be able to afford plan G so will dig into that. AND -- thanks for the comments pointing out that Advantage plans might not be worth 'fighting' with. That is what I really want to avoid."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzCJOqh3yyYXbR7EIB4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching 🌞 Plan G has the least amount of administrative hurdles and is the most expensive from a monthly premium perspective compared to the plans in this video 😊 "

"Thank You. This was the easiest breakdown I have found on Youtube. I am lost on all this. I have always had insurance through my employer. I had a stroke due to an injury. I have not been able to get released to go back to work. I am currently on a private Blue/Cross My blue HMO. plan which has cheap monthly rates and low deductible etc. I will be forced in a few months since I am on SSDI to take the switch? So if I am hearing correctly I will only be allowed either Part A&B or The Advantage plan?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugz_S5wLKvkZzIHmkAp4AaABAg.9yOTV5Abf89A8GC_Q_jy4P

"Similar scenario, early retirement from federal job kept my medical insurance, receive a pension and started ss at 62. I'd always heard I wouldn't need to pay into Medicare in retirement if I kept my health insurance. Finding out part A is mandatory was news to me."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugw88-Fwi2OKdnOYP4t4AaABAg.AWS2oYsYNjEAWTg5-DVWN>

"Great video! About your "anecdotal" example of a \$66 Medicare-approved amount for an ultrasound, I am wondering if such a cap applies to costs that a MAPPO would pay to an "out of network" provider for medically necessary care. I am wondering this because the MAPPO plan I am looking at has pretty high coinsurance percentages for some categories of out-of-network care, so I am wondering if that percentage will always be calculated based on the Medicare-approved amount for a service rather than on the "billed" amount from the out-of-network provider."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgwyLLi0_jT6SD4IY254AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "For advantage plans, it'll be based on the Advantage plan insurance company's negotiated rate, not Medicare's. Some hospitals take advantage of this and practice predatory billing. Others will work with the insurance company."

↳ @PB-xy8ox (0): "Well, an "out of network" provider would necessarily not have an agreed rate with an Advantage PPO, right? And I think you are saying that there is no cap on the amount that an out-of-network provider can charge a MA plan for providing service to a MA plan member. So the MA plan could potentially have to cover the full amount of a \$500k hospital bill (after the member pays his MOOP) Even though traditional Medicare would only pay \$20,000 for that service? I don't see how a MA PPO could afford to do that for out of network services provided to its members. Which makes me think that I am not understanding this correctly. Am I?"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "@PB-xy8ox emergencies are different. Emergencies are covered as in network for you as the person on the plan. If you go to an out of network provider for a non-emergency, then yes, the hospital can jack up the billed amount, refuse to negotiate much with the insurance company, and your coinsurance would be a lot. You have a max out of pocket, so your risk isn't unlimited, but it is higher."

"I'm not yet on Medicare. Have a year before retirement. But I am in an employer health insurance plan that uses networks (Aetna). My fear has always been that I might be taken to a hospital and someone who is out of network treats me, giving me a bill that might cost me thousands or tens of thousands. Then I lose my house."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgxZR3bWgLfHj6zcfgR4AaABAg>

""I'm in no way saying Medicare Advantage is bad." Proceeds to list a bunch of points in a negative light. Lol. Another day....another Medicare Advantage hit piece. What else is new? Kinda reads like an ad disguised as "help," but I'll give you the benefit of the doubt. Since I used to be a broker and offered both Medicare Advantage and supplements (with a roughly 70/30 split of those on Medicare Advantage to those on Supplements) I'll go ahead and break these down one-by-one. I think it's only fair. 1. You are not "walking away from Medicare" when you sign up for a Medicare Advantage plan. Yes, it is **semi-private**, but everything covered by original Medicare must be covered by Medicare Advantage. They also offer many other bonus services that original Medicare does not cover, particularly dental, vision, and prescription drugs. Those are the biggest, but there's a bunch more perks. 2. Mostly correct but many companies now don't perform medical underwriting for supplements. So, this is very much state specific. For instance, in the state I'm in, Blue Cross does not perform medical underwriting at all for supplements. 3. This is redundant to point #1. You're not selling anything. You're simply opting to go with a Medicare Advantage plan and are still in the Medicare ecosystem. 4. This is always explained in depth by any in house agent or independent broker. It's a key rule they all have to abide by and is a standard part of any standardized presentation. By rule/law they have to tell you this and they constantly get secret-shopped. 5. This part is a mess. Insurance brokers make roughly \$600 (it depends on the state...most are around \$600) if, and only if, it's the person's first time on a Medicare Advantage plan. The vast majority of people brokers enroll are **not** new to Medicare Advantage. That's also a one-time thing. Every year after that, that enrollee will be \$300 a year. The vast majority of enrollees will be half of that dollar amount, because that's what someone going from one Medicare Advantage plan to another Medicare Advantage plan mandates brokers are paid. That for an entire year...\$300. I know, rolling in dough! 🤔 There is no such thing as a broker "enrolling" you in original Medicare. For one, there's zero incentive for them to do that if you don't also get a Medicare Advantage plan or Supplement. And two, you age into Medicare in the vast majority of cases. It's automatic. Brokers deal with Medicare Advantage or Supplements only. 6. According to statistics, only 2% of people ever reach their maximum-out-of-pocket, and the last time I was a broker (roughly 1.5 years ago), the average maximum-out-of-pocket was around \$2,500. Keep in mind, copays on these plans are minimal. You need to try very hard to hit that number. After (if) someone hits their maximum-out-of-pocket, the insurance company pays 100% of your medical costs, by law. 7. Yes, you still pay the Part B premium, same goes for when you have a supplement or original Medicare. And on a supplement, you get to pay tons more per month with a monthly premium that most Medicare Advantage plans do not have. 8. Regardless of the Medicare Advantage plan, you will always have emergency coverage in all 50 states. Any emergency is always considered "in-network" regardless of state. With a PPO, they have enormous networks, and you are well-protected in any state. Original government Medicare might not have a network, but you know what it also doesn't have? A cap on consumer spending. That means that if you get really sick, those costs just keep going-and-going to infinity and beyond! 🚀 But hey, government loves us, right? 🤔 . That's why people choose either a Medicare Advantage plan or a Supplement. It's to protect them from everything the government leaves them vulnerable to. 9. This is a myth. There are prior authorizations on original government Medicare. Not as many, but they very much exist. Medicare Advantage also has to cover everything original Medicare covers. They cannot arbitrarily decide to deny something that original Medicare deemed is covered. Also a very key thing to note, they're currently in the process of "auto-approving" everything covered by original Medicare, with no manual review, when it comes to prior authorizations. So, waiting a few days will soon become a thing of the past and prior authorizations will be a complete non-issue by next year. 10.And? Original government Medicare also leaves you vulnerable to many things that are covered by Medicare Advantage. 11. Correct, but you are still very much on Medicare. It's just administered by the insurance company and not the federal government. You must have original Medicare parts A and B to even have a Medicare Advantage plan. So it's not like you're "leaving Medicare" as some believe. 12. Dental and vision are included in most Medicare Advantage plans. I've yet to see one that doesn't have them. 13. Yes. Another key piece of information. Always make sure you deal with a broker that offers BOTH Medicare Advantage and Supplements. I

hate to bash anyone, but Chris Westfall is one of the biggest cons and shills there is. He doesn't offer Medicare Advantage and is constantly spreading fear about Medicare Advantage. Why? Because Supplements are very easy to sell and service....especially nationwide. Medicare Advantage is not easy to service and offer nationwide. In order to offer Medicare Advantage, brokers have to take yearly tests that they must get a 90% on. They must do this for Medicare as a whole, and then for each and every carrier they offer. Many agents simply don't want to do this. This is a very time-consuming and risky thing, because if you fail, all of your income is wiped away. Literally all of it. So, some agents would rather sit back and bash Medicare Advantage, while not coloring in the lines and fully explaining everything. Right, Chris? From my Medicare Advantage clients, I genuinely never had a complaint. Both of my parents have been on Medicare Advantage for 12 years and have never had an issue. Think of Medicare Advantage as "pay-as-you-use" with small copays, as opposed to guaranteeing them a large monthly premium every single month, regardless of whether or not you use it. Take that huge sum of money, save it, and invest it. Supplements are great, as well, as far as coverage, but they come at a huge monthly price, and they don't include dental/vision or prescription drugs. One final thing to keep in mind is, **Medicare Advantage polls unbelievably high in satisfaction rate by those that are on them.** That's for a reason."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/medicare_vs_medicare_advantage_my_findings_as_i/jn3vamz/

Appointments, prescriptions and pharmacy runs · 36 documents · 20 voices

"Wellcare wanted \$110 for one generic prescription — Cost Plus Drugs was \$16.85 delivered I wanted to share this because Medicare drug pricing has gotten ridiculous enough that it really pays to check cash prices instead of automatically using your Part D insurance. I have Wellcare for my Medicare prescription coverage. My PCP recently sent in a 90-day prescription for generic aripiprazole (Abilify), 2 mg tablets. My copay through Wellcare was going to be **\$110**. I checked Mark Cuban Cost Plus Drug Company instead. Their price for the same 90-day prescription was: * Medication: **\$10.90** * Shipping: **\$5.95** * Total: **\$16.85** So I saved about **\$93** by simply not using my Medicare drug insurance. This isn't the first time I've run into this. Wellcare also recently dropped the main pharmacy in my town as a **preferred pharmacy**, which makes things even more inconvenient. I had another experience at Safeway where I was picking up **two generic medications**. Using my Wellcare insurance, Safeway wanted about **\$75**. The pharmacy employee checked another option, bypassed my insurance, and used a prescription discount code instead. The price dropped to **\$23**. That really opened my eyes. We're told Medicare Part D is supposed to help lower prescription costs, but in some cases I'm finding that the cash price or a discount program is dramatically cheaper than using the insurance I'm already paying for. My takeaway is simple: **Before paying your Medicare prescription copay, ask the pharmacy what the cash price is and check places like Cost Plus Drugs or prescription discount programs.** Especially with generics, the difference can apparently be huge. I'm not saying Wellcare is always more expensive, and obviously everyone's plan and medications are different. But after seeing \$110 become \$16.85, and \$75 become \$23, I'm going to compare prices every time from now on. Hopefully this saves somebody else a few bucks — or in my case, nearly a hundred."

— r/medicare · 129 upvotes · None

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"Humana screwed me over I have a heart condition and have been waiting three months to have an echocardiogram. Recently, Humana changed my PCP from someone I've been seeing for years and years to a stranger and didn't let me know if they changed it. My doctor reached out to let me know and I called and had him changed back but then they sent a new card that didn't list my doctor's name and I had to request it again from them. Then I showed up from my appointment yesterday and they still hadn't adjusted their records. Now they decided they needed prior approval for something that was already approved and I had already received a co-pay notification. Then the hospital, which is supposed to care for people and is another point of how the US healthcare system is fucked up, turned me away. They turned away a heart patient because the insurance was being difficult. They're supposed to take care of patients, but if money isn't forthcoming, they turn them away, even if they're at risk of dying. I'm sorry I just needed a place to express this and I hope others will agree with me that Medicare and the health system in general need a major overhaul."

— r/medicare · 87 upvotes · None

"Thanks Mr. Monaghan. I'm a physician who lives in an area where the hospital and most of the doctors are owned by a closed panel HMO (Geisinger), and I've tried to tell patients the truth about Medicare Advantage plans not always being cheaper, being less convenient and sometimes limiting newer treatments. Your video spells out the financial issues as plain as day. Would it be ok if I show your video when discussing this with patients? I also wanted to point out that Medicare advantage programs often require that the patient has to travel to find a paneled specialist which can add to the cost and inconvenience and that Medicare advantage plans often consider well established modern treatments and surgeries as non-covered "experimental" procedures" — YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 54 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwSxRGEZp3GIB2izeJ4AaABAq>

↳ @medicare365 (13): "Absolutely, that would be an honor for you to show my video to your patients. Thank you for the comment!"

↳ @PJN61 (6): "Interesting. My momma lives in very rural North Central Pa and Geisinger it all there is up there but she's 89 and has a Medigap G plan so she's good."

↳ @karen-r1e4w (0): "my DR/boss also has always "shyed away from telling his patients some of the ins/OUTS of advantage plans. not always the best decision. in fact ,usually not."

"You are 100% correct. I have plan F, which I chose because I had a serious illness shortly before I became Medicare eligible. It was an easy decision because I knew I was going to be seeing specialists, having tests, procedures etc. and did not want to be in a network. Also, the benefits for each Medicare supplements are clearly spelled out , while the Advantage plans are murky. I have had tons of imaging, bloodwork, see lots of specialists (who I did not have to get a referral to see), have had surgeries and have NEVER got a bill. I know that not everything is covered , and eventually I might need something Medicare does not fully cover. But I ALWAYS ask if it's covered by Medicare, and so far have never found anything a doctor ordered to not be covered. So, the supplement picks up the rest. Plan F is excellent."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwurRgkwXclXrOQrGV4AaABAq>

↳ @neilwhiteaker53 (1): "@debbhelms4106 Plan F and Plan G have no office visit or ER fees at all. Ever. Make sure of what you are signing up for. You want a Medigap Supplement, not Medicare Advantage."

↳ @debbhelms4106 (0): "I'm going on plan F he said I would have copays every time I go to the dr!! Wonder why you don't have copayments?"

↳ @maytrang671 (0): "@debbhelms4106 You need to check your plan. Plan F cover all deductible copay."

"I chose a Plan N and have been very happy with it. Unless you are always at a doctor's office, it's about the best compromise of cost versus benefit."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 23 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwAOnhiDZKcRZHjTlt4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (5): "Glad to hear Plan N has been working well for you! You're right—it's a great balance between cost and coverage for many people, especially if they don't visit the doctor too often."

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (5): "I am on plan N. I consider it the "sweet spot" of supplement plans."

"Medicare doesn't always pay for what doctors recommend. I had to have minor oral surgery to remove a growth from my pallet for biopsy and Medicare refused to pay anything. Never got an explanation why. Because Medicare refused to cover the biopsy my supplemental insurance refused to pay anything. I got stuck for the entire cost. Submitted Medicare a review petition. Called several times after the date Medicare was obligated to respond. I was repeatedly told my petition was still under review. Medicare never responded to my petition. It just disappeared. Never rely on Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgztAt-OUHVW8yJkjt4AaABAg.9XPA5Vuw7so9Yh-cMgzjGO>

"I'm 64. Will turn 65 in May 2027. For years I have seen a naturopath out of pocket for real health care, also I am on disability for chronic Lyme's that I manage on my own mostly no meds, but some supplements I pay for. I joined an Advantage plan for the extra perks food card because rent is so high. I'm trying to figure out what plan I should go with if anything. Honestly if I got seriously ill I'd rather die at home in my own bed like all of my ancestors before me if I get that ill if need be than to be in the hospital in the hands of doctors today using you as a dollar sign either way or just not giving the real care you need. If I get real bad I'll go see my naturopath for a couple hundred dollars out of pocket. At least I know I'll get better."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyxGushsgVyhDf20l4AaABAg>

↳ @qur4334 (2): "be well and be encouraged"

"I'm on a Medicare Advantage Plan and I've NEVER waited a month or longer for a pre-authorization. When choosing a plan I always verify my doctors accept such plan and that my medications are included. So far the only downside is when traveling one must seek care through the ER to be covered. Of course if relocating then one can immediately change back to original Medicare and pay for a Supplemental Plan (if one's available based on one's pre-existing conditions or can afford such) or simply select another Advantage Plan. I'm 100% covered, absolutely no out-of-pocket expenses as I'm on a Humana Gold Special Needs Plan due to a chronic condition. I'm thankfully blessed for such coverage as I seem to recall a Supplemental Plan would not be available to me under original Medicare due to a pre-existing condition."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugxy5ygsjGUNTl2sthZ4AaABAg>

↳ @lindagolden9892 (0): "@maryg1338 - I was born in NY, family throughout NY."

"These two people obviously don't need all their money. I change Advantage plans to the one that is going to save me the most money , I'm not married to any doctor and I have always found good ones. 100 per month for groceries 110 per month for OTC plus 185 subtracted from my Medicare monthly cost, free dental and glasses. I'm sorry but I get great care and save thousands . In my area there are dozens of plans available , I'm on dialysis and it's the same facility with every plan. Plus no monthly premiums. So you can make your own choices but for me it's Medicare Advantage an it has been over 7 years..."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgzNyoIhFY-DIvflTYN4AaABAq_A_TFcoS-l4PA_YEHluf3D0

"I am turning 65 shortly and am as healthy as a powerful rhino. I work out daily and have never taken a prescription drug in my life. Not even an antibiotic, nor aspirin! I have been watching a LOT of videos, and prior to yours, thought I was going to be taking the Supplement Plan N. Because of your breakdown at the end, I realize I am a wise elephant because I check all the boxes you explained that would motivate someone to choose an Advantage plan, so thank you."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugx3XQcuy_hT1U1Jskd4AaABAq

↳ @RichardSalayer-i6y (0): "We saved a ton of money not paying premiums from age 74-79 on a \$0.00 Premium, Medicare Premium PPO from UHC in San Antonio, TX. Just like us; 1.) Know yourselves and your health situations, 3.) Do you research - then buy. Prior to that we had UHC as a HMO and were only marginally happy with it. Love the PPO - like night and day, even though same company. With an HMO, they can keep trying things to save money, putting off the treatment, that you need for 2--3 months. But, unfortunately a PPO in a big Metropolitan can cost a lot of money per month of NON existant - like in So. California."

"When I signed up I looked at the Advantage plans as HMOs and Original Medicare as PPOs. Having dealt with HMOs in the past & locked into using "their" doctors, I knew I'd always stick with Original Medicare & have the freedom to choose whoever I wanted to see. It's worked great for me & having a supplemental plan was worth it in the grand scheme of things."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgytyZ4B6tLT9DQgtDJ4AaABAq>

"The only thing that I wish is that they would remove is the 1% per month penalty for not signing up. I can buy the medications for about \$30/Qtr and the minimum part D plan today is 25/Mth. A 1% penalty per month is ridiculous and almost criminal."

— YouTube · UPDATE: Medicare Part D Subsidy Program ENDS - What Happens Next? · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7l_bhhxH9w&lc=Ugw-9xbeggmH8D4CzpR4AaABAq

"I just turned 65 in May. I'm in California and very healthy. In my area, suburbs northeast of Sacramento it's very hard to find doctors on regular Medicare because we've had sooooo many retirees move here from San Francisco Bay Area. I tried plain Medicare at first with a goal to add Medigap this month, but I had a hard time finding a doctor I wanted to see - most are "not accepting new patients". So I went to Kaiser which started in Northern California (I had them growing up because my mom worked for the State). The advantage plan is \$44 and includes onepass gym membership which I like. I've always hated Kaiser but it's easy to get in to see a doctor that I want to see. If it were easier to find a doctor with Medigap, I'd prefer that. I would have chosen the high deductible Medigap plan and just kept the deductible \$\$ in a HYSA. I'm still in that window though one Medigap agent said my window closed for their plan at two months! It's frustrating that so much complexity is pushed on you when you first become eligible because there are many factors to consider outside of what you pointed out- another one is what if I moved to a state that doesn't have Kaiser? Frustrating because I don't have a crystal ball."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzKP_qUdKDXUUdwWp14AaABAg

"What you were saying doesn't fit with my Medicare advantage plan. I have a Medicare advantage plan through the university I retired from and United healthcare. You talked about Medicare advantage plans having very low premiums. My Medicare advantage plan has a pretty high premium. (actually there were two choices, one with a fairly low premium, and one with a high premium.). I really like my Medicare advantage plan because, although the premium is fairly high, it pays 100% of absolutely everything(except prescription meds). As the patient my charge is always zero dollars for everything from hospitalizations to labs to diagnostic testing to radiology to specialist visits to PCP visits to sick visits in the doctors office to ER visits to urgent care visits.. Also, all medications that are given in the doctors office or hospital (chemo, other infusions, subcutaneous injections for osteoporosis, etc.) are covered 100%. So mine seems to be the exact opposite of what you were saying. You were saying that Medicare advantage plans often have a very low premium but high charges if you start having chronic illnesses and many doctor or hospital visits. But my Medicare advantage plan has a high premium, but then the charge to me is always as low as you can get, zero dollars!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugy-0hI4aY91YM6lri54AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "Retiree Medicare Advantage plans fall into a different category altogether!"

↳ @richardpetty9159 (0): "Kind of like social benefit programs that go with you after you retire from the military maybe... not available to people who were never in the service."

"sunburn - worked well past 70 years old to avoid government health insurance. When looking for work I always wanted to get a job with a plan where you could pick almost any doctor and that also had uncomplicated co-pay scheme and had a simple to understand 'out of pocket' max clause so you had an idea what you had to absorb at worst each year. After looking at what was deducted from your pay for that plan and adding your estimated co-pays and adding the out of pocket max you had an idea what you might have to 'self insure' each year. Which of the government schemes is closest to that model ? Sounds like I should hope to be able to afford plan G so will dig into that. AND -- thanks for the comments pointing out that Advantage plans might not be worth 'fighting' with. That is what I really want to avoid."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzCJOqh3yyYXbR7EIB4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching 🌞 Plan G has the least amount of administrative hurdles and is the most expensive from a monthly premium perspective compared to the plans in this video 😊 "

"I agree with you, the insurance I have with my employer sounds exactly like a Medicare advantage plan she describes, And the argument that you can go to any doctor is maybe true but while working who has ever just picked up the phone and called heart doctor A or brain surgeon B. And get treatment, you always need your doctor to refer you,"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxNhI0Xbq8UUVEq8UR4AaABAg.AOL9WRnlzOtAOLbpAHx0B7>

"I worked with medicare for 3 years. There needs to be improvements for sure especially with part C. I've worked for the biggest companies to a small brokerage for insurance and there's issues. I've always approached it being extremely cautiousness with medicare advantage because some people really do need a lot of care and they can't qualify/can't afford a medigap and they need to be with their doctors. My calls were long because I would check news letters on medical group/ clinics websites to view if they were actively changing carriers or dropping some carriers. Most of the time I would go as far as calling the doctors offices to make sure docs are covered. A lot of agents don't do that and it's not encouraged in the industry. A lot of information is outdated in one way or another. When the new year is around the corner and it's Oct.15 you know someone's shit is about to fucked up with and leadership around me would be drooling knowing that more people would be confused and that would lead to more sale opportunity. The system is already confusing and corrupt. Plus, every year it changes in little ways (which isn't so little) like docs to the whole costs and responsibilities of part C (medicare advantage). Not looking forward to retiring. please if you can set aside 150-300 month in retirement for a medigap policy. There's calculators out there to help calculate how much you'll get from social security."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugyt_SsDnz1JtXfyZzF4AaABAg

"Think very carefully even about Medigap. I had my appendix out in 2021 and was in hospital for 30 hours. The hospital billed Medicare \$44,000. Medicare said great, but we'll give you \$4000 (80%) and the patient will give you \$1000 (20%). I did not have a Medigap policy at that time as I had dropped it. When I had the policy it was costing me \$1500 per annum so I would have lost money with it. Latterly I've had a prostate procedure for cancer and my contributions were significantly less than \$1500. I think over time even Medigap will cost you money. As mentioned below Medicare is key because it sets the price not the doctor or the hospital and its prices are ALWAYS less than the providers want to charge by a significant amount."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugwo5v_rWgRcJ5Pv-354AaABAg

"Why don't you include Medicare part D and the fact that all of the Advantage plans include part D coverage. The typical person age 65 is taking 2-3 daily pills to maintain chronic conditions, if they are diabetic and or have a serious condition they can easily have medications that add up to over \$3000 per month at retail prices. In my case I have been taking maintenance medication for multiple chronic conditions for over 20 years, which includes the entire time that I have been Medicare eligible. Only in the last 8 years has the monthly retail cost of my medications dropped to below \$5000; while at its peak the monthly cost was over \$12,000 for a period of 5 years."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgxENSSGxh_RC_Ir9xh4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching! We have right around 83 videos on our channel. 25 of them discuss Part D and the standalone route vs the included-in-an-Advantage plan route. You just happened to catch one of the videos that wasn't made to dive into that topic. But it is an important one!"

Private Worries

Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental · 153 documents

"My wife and I signed up for Medicare plus the G supplement plus Medicare D. At First it was fine, but after 3- 4 years it was costing us 700 dollars a MONTH. We kept it when we were traveling. It did pay claims, but we did have to pay some stuff. It just became too expensive to keep. So, we changed to the Advantage type after moving to a higher population area. Referrals are not a problem most of the time. Now our max out-of-pocket is 700 dollars a YEAR. My drug copays were 25 bucks for the YEAR, no deductible. True, we have to stay within the provider groups, but we have quite a few to pick from. Original Medicare is great, if you're rich or can go to wherever you have the money to afford to seek out expensive care. Not so much if you live in a backward state or a medical wasteland. Either way you go, you're screwed. Insurance companies, PBMs, hospitals, medical groups, drug companies, crooks who cheat Medicare at every turn are what we Americans are stuck with at this point. The ruling rich overlords will never change it. Congress and the courts have been bought, and YOU AND I have been stuck with the bill."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 722 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxAXzFMBaU_-X7O2GZ4AaABAg

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAq>

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.])(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— medicare · 88 upvotes · None

"I'm a dentist and I just dropped my Medicare Advantage in network participation. They decided to offer reimbursement rates lower than the numbers from 2017. Sorry I can't afford to pay to see Medicare Advantage patients."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 74 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=Ugxon36nbcDg9yeXQCp4AaABAq>

"Unfortunately, many of us can't afford anything else. We have had a Medicare Advantage plan for the last 10 years and it has delivered excellent care for us. It all depends on which plan you choose. Do some research and compare the different companies for their customer satisfaction ratings, and get input from friends who have these plans."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 63 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwLWpl68A_Gul46akN4AaABAq

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"COLA INCREASE GONE. Huge jump in Medicare has my mom/dad receiving less than before. I'm in Florida. My parents recently made a series of bad decisions this year. They sold their home, instead of filing bankruptcy, got 10k, and are now broke. They moved 3 states in as many months, until I said to come back here. It's easier to help them when they're down the street. The problem is, they're flat broke. They live in a nasty 2/1 trailer for 850/month they could barely cover before. They've been there 2 months. They got a shock this month when their SS checks were less. IDK how much less my mom's was, but my dad's was 170 less. I thought they were getting an increase. Either way, they already couldn't afford anything. They can't afford their meds. They can't afford their Medicare, and I had to come out of pocket \$500 to cover some basic needs of theirs. Is there a way to apply for Medicaid? Food stamps? My mother had to get inhaler samples from her doctor because she couldn't pay the \$30 to get them from the pharmacy. I gave her \$50, but by the time I got to their house, they'd gotten the samples free. That was before this loss of SS. They'll be short on rent and literally everything every single month. They have no money for food, expenses, healthcare, prescriptions... gas, insurance, you name it. What are their options? I'm sad I didn't get involved last year when they started making their bad financial decisions. I should have taken over. In less than 6 months they went from stable to unstable and broke living in a rather shifty mon to mon tenancy agreement. I want them to be stable. I can't afford to pay these monthly shortfalls, but they'll be short. I'm also not understanding why their checks are so much less, and they don't know why, either."

— medicare · 57 upvotes · family member helping · None

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— medicare · 51 upvotes · None

"I went on to the retirement court with Plan G. No major complaints with the exception of the recent premium increase and the truly impossible task of finding my cost share prior to treatment. My bigger complaint with this whole racket is the development (or lack there of) a system structured for intentional confusion. One should not need PhDs in multiple disciplines to understand their health insurance. No luv in this game."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyV6bKd_Qtj9cUgC4x4AaABAg

"IF you can afford it! We have a supplement, but I can see it pricing us right out and into Advantage just because we can't afford the monthly cost! A neighbor friend was just forced into an Advantage plan because her supplement cost was over \$400 monthly!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 36 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzozvbm6d2TPJIXMV4AaABAq

"I was working with an employer but I covered by my wife's insurance where she worked. It got so expensive like about \$600 a month at 66 I signed up for A & B and a G Plan as well and saved \$300 a month switching to Medicare for myself. I worked till 69 to get the most money of SS. I was not penalized for anything! It was best decision for us."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgyR73hvpzWy4668p-B4AaABAq>

"What you say may be true for some, but if you have a Kaiser HMO everything is different. I love Kaiser. I worked at Kaiser for years and I know it from the inside and out. When I hit 65 I opted for Kaiser's Medicare Senior Advantage. Nothing has changed for me except that I have more durable medical equipment options and things extended care and like that. My office visits cost \$5 instead of \$25. I did have to sign up for Plan B which I wouldn't have had to if I just continued Kaiser, but I could see that it could become a big cost saver down the road when I get really old. But who knows what the future will bring? That's the thing with any kind of insurance. It's a crapshoot. And let's face it, with medical care, the less you need it, the better. It's much better to pay into it not use it then not have it when you do need it. And my Kaiser Senior Advantage is always there if I need it, something that as I get older is going to become more important. A lot of people like to bash Kaiser, but it's the best HMO out there. I can tell you that if you need something, you will get it. For-profit insurance plans make money by doling expensive care. Kaiser is a not-for-profit and their goal is to keep you healthy so you don't need the expensive care down the road. But if you do, it is there. My husband needed a heart transplant. He checked into Stanford Hospital and was billed the Kaiser hospital admission co-pay of \$250. He walked out with no more charges. Zero. He had a heart transplant, something that cost anywhere from a \$half million to over \$1 million for \$250. And despite the huge cost of the immunosuppressive drugs, he has only a \$20 co-pay with no cap. Kaiser decided that there's no point in paying for a heart transplant if they won't pay for the drugs that you need to keep yourself alive. Most people can't afford a couple thousand dollars a month for medicines. So we're fans of Kaiser and I'm a fan of Senior Advantage. I kept my original benefits except that they've been expanded now."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyGOoPOpnz833X5Yo54AaABAq>

"I'm 73, had plan g since the beginning, been healthy, disappointed that my premium went up to 268 a month, thinking of switching to advantage plan. And I'm disappointed that my agent didn't help me understand about Medicare part D, which I did not sign up for, and now I have to pay penalties from now on. I am in Texas, and I hope I have a memory like an ELEPHANT for all that you have explained."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=Ugx1SAL00qKcb-uYy2t4AaABAq>

"I cant afford a supplement plan."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxNGiKqY0j5kl2nE0B4AaABAq

"I prefer Supplement plans but I can't afford the premiums. I have had an Advantage plan every year for more than 10 years, and never had a problem--no delays, no denials--despite inpatient and outpatient surgeries about every year, and various other medical problems. The Return On Investment (ROI) for my Advantage plan--i.e., premiums and cost-sharing I invested, versus medical costs returned to me by my insurance--has been about 20X. (I wish my Golden Retriever's health insurance was that good!)"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgxZYygOWN9H86YMuQh4AaABAg>

"Medigap plans +drug + dental are just too expensive for the majority of people. Of Course we all would love to be on one. However i have been on a Advantage plan for the last 2 years and it has been very good at covering all my health care. Last year i spent a total of \$90.00 out of pocket for over \$7000.00 worth of medical and dental care. My advantage plan saves me upwards of \$2500.00 a year just in initial cost over a Plan G or N. So in 3 short years that is \$7500.00! That's a lot of money. Even this year if i do get very sick and have to use all my MOOP of \$3500.00 i still will be far ahead of if i had a traditional medigap plan. Also my advantage plan does not have a deductible in medical and my dental. No prior authorizations, no referrals needed by my PCP, and coverage is great in my state for all doctors and hospitals that i use. No need to go elsewhere. Even as a HMO its good in 3 other states if i choose to go and stay in one of them for like say the winter time."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugyr2g2bFmEO2AGajcJ4AaABAg>

"I have a very good Advantage plan thru BCN advantage for 2025. I sure hope it doesn't change much for 2026. As for a supplement plan they are just to costly to have. Sure they may be better but whats the difference if you can't afford it?"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzoe6aXeweQX2JV13d4AaABAg

"Your discussion while very informative, ignores the very real IRMAA adjustment to the Medicare Part B premium. I found out the hard way. While the 2026 Part B premium increases to \$202 per month, my Part B premium will increase by and additional \$324.60 per month for a total Part B premium of \$527.50 due to IRMAA (this is in addition to the premium I pay for my Medigap plan). This increase in my Part B premium is due to the fact that I withdrew monies from my 401(k) plan to maintain a fairly standard middle class lifestyle as I live in San Diego, which is a very high cost of living area. Moreover, the IRMAA adjustment must be paid regardless of whether one enrolls in a Medigap or an Advantage Plan. Many seniors are not aware of this time bomb when withdrawing from their 401(k)s. Perhaps a video focusing on IRMAA would benefit and alert seniors about this seemingly "hidden" Part B premium increase that is lying in wait."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxB-sft1CicsFwsf3B4AaABAg>

"Many of us cannot afford straight Medicare, we are stuck with an advantage plans, I'm in a buy back plan, I can't afford 300 a month for Medicare"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugxi-TicJtS9XvWxJCV4AaABAg>

"Supplements are too expensive and do Not want to pay when you need them. You work all your life and get screwed over for continuing to live after retirement. MEDICARE FOR ALL is what we need."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyuQrzYzibBWylq2GZ4AaABAg

Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later · 128 documents

"The ACA in a death spiral? Everyone seems to forget: the original ACA had (1) a requirement that everyone had to participate or they would pay a tax penalty, and (2) states had to opt into expanded ~Medicare~ Medicaid . These two provisions were later removed, and thus began the spiraling death of the ACA. As predicted. Once you understand that universal health care is essential if you want to control costs while making sure everyone is covered (including people with pre-existing conditions), its obvious it only works if either (a) everyone must pay into it, regardless of their current needs, or (b) if you don't pay into it, you are not eligible for the benefit. Look, it is INSURANCE, similar to car insurance: you pay your car insurance monthly hoping you never get into an accident which requires you to use it. You pay more, or less, according to your risk factors. Health insurance is similar. You hope YOU are not that 30 year old who gets cancer that costs \$1m to treat (or that 60 year old who has a massive heart attack) but if you are, you are glad you are covered. But if it is optional, people play the odds game against insurance: I am healthy right now, I don't think I personally will get back what I am paying in so I am NOT buying insurance. Leaving mostly unhealthy 30 or 60 year olds in their rate group, requiring prices to rise because unhealthy people cost more because they consume more (doctor care, emergency visits, medicines, therapy, etc.) Spiral, spiral and spiral. And what are we, as a nation, willing to do with people without means of obtaining medical care? Lock the emergency room door when someone bleeding approaches without insurance or money? Well, this will soon be the case anyway, as emergency departments already see the writing on the wall and are shuttering before they go bankrupt. If you truly believe in the American trickle down theory (wherein rich business people, getting huge tax breaks, provide people with good paying jobs with health insurance), great! Let's see when that starts happening! I guess you are saying we just need to ignore wealth inequality (even though a small number of the wealthiest billionaires combined hold more wealth than the bottom 50% of the entire U.S. population.) I, for one, will be voting for the next person running for president (from whatever party) who runs on implementing true health care reform in the form of universal health care. I don't care what we call it: Gold Health Plans, Medicare for All, ACA v 2.0, whatever. Why can't WE get it done, just like every other civilized country has figured out how to accomplish? Help me understand."

— HealthInsurance · 804 upvotes · None

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. \[As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).\] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every

policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · None

"GREAT job, Erin! I'm a retired physician and I think you hit this out of the park. My wife and I started with an MC Advantage Plan but the unpredictability of out-of-network coverage, rapidly increasing max. out of pocket limits, increasing daily hospital copays, and pretty inadequate rehab coverage really began to make me rethink our decision. When our MC Advantage plan wasn't available in our area for 2026 we were so happy to be able to switch to a Medigap plan with guaranteed issue during a Special Enrollment Period (SEP). It's one of the few ways to be able to switch in that direction without underwriting. Yes the premiums are significant but the predictability of healthcare expenses, portability, and freedom of choice where to receive care made it worth it to us - priceless, in fact. I'm 67 and my wife is 72. Thank you for helping so many future decision-makers have such clarity."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 156 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugwn9ICoa-Qw7KmDdUp4AaABAq>

"What decisions as you near retirement are "time-sensitive"? As you near retirement (say, 65) what decisions are "time-sensitive"? We had a close call with almost being unable to get a Medicare supplement (Medigap). Was not aware you get a *one-time* 6 month window when you first get Medicare that insurance/supplement companies are *required* to allow you to enroll and cannot deny you (or charge a higher rate). Individual here was pressured to take Medicare Advantage and lost their guaranteed issue timeframe and had to go through medical underwriting and was initially denied and had to appeal to get approved. This makes me wonder, what other decisions regarding retirement are "time-sensitive" or something individuals may not think about and/or realize before it's too late?"

— retirement · 121 upvotes · None

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAq

"I'm 75 and have been Medicare covered for 10 years. I started out the first year with Plan C (Advantage). But I got lucky, my carrier cancelled the plan in my area of Minnesota which triggered a "Special Enrollment Period" during which time I was able to move to a MediGap plan just like it was day one of my eligibility. Guaranteed issue, no MIB etc. Due to cardiac bypass surgery and hip replacements in my medical history I would probably not have been able to switch to a Supplement without the SEP kicking in. Six months ago with \$70K of unexpected Mayo radiation treatments I am relieved that my Advantage carrier decided to leave the area 9 years ago. You didn't cover Special Enrollment Periods but that's what saved me from being trapped in a Part C plan. Nice job explaining how this all works in an objective fashion."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 88 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwO03YTuvFEg34QrmF4AaABAg>

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— medicare · 81 upvotes · None

"Thank you. One of the most professional and knowledgeable presentations that I have heard about the pros and cons of Advantage Plans vs. Supplement Plans. Medical underwriting was explained to me using an airport analogy: I've gotten off the plane and I'm free to walk around the airport, go to the news stand, get a cup of coffee, etc. When I leave that secure area (like leaving my original, one-time-only enrollment period), I walk through doors with signs that say "exit only, no returning through these doors". If I want to go back into the airport, I have to go through security (i.e. underwriting) again. It's a time-consuming hassle for folks who take that route. And there's no guarantee that a person will get through medical underwriting successfully."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 59 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxclzjxWRhhykzbdwp4AaABAg

"You are the GIRAFFE of all the YouTubers guiding seniors on Medicare, meaning you stick out and have a greater vista above the rest. Very grateful to you. My spouse and I were on his employer's Group Medicare Advantage for years, and this large (well-known) employer decided to unload all their retirees beginning Jan 1, 2026. Beginning the first of next calendar year, the only Medicare Advantage in our area (this time the individual, not Group as that is no longer available through the mentioned employer) were dumped by most of our trusted doctors as well as the local hospitals 😞. In short, we had no choice but to go on a supplement plan. Because of said "dumping," we have guaranteed issue, (though we likely would have passed medical assignment being in good health) so we are about to find out how much we like being on a supplement plan starting the first of next year. Medicare Group Advantage has served us nicely for four years, but we had to change. So much "dumping" is happening out there on the Advantage side."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgzbA2EY3Kzx6LQjVqJ4AaABAg>

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>";

— medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"Doctors Or Medical People Ever since I went on Medicare, my doctor seems to think I'm on the verge of total collapse. I went in for a routine physical. I felt fine. I still feel fine. But now I have appointments for: • A cardiologist, even though I've never had heart issues. • A CT scan of my lungs because I used to smoke — 15 years ago. • A breast sonogram because the mammogram showed a "slight deviation," which last time turned out to be nothing at all. • A liver scan, in case the fatty liver I had a decade ago has staged a dramatic comeback. When I had commercial insurance at 64, none of this came up. At 65, on Medicare, I apparently became a collection of pre-existing conditions waiting to happen. Is this standard? Do they think I'm fragile now? Or is the system just trying to squeeze every possible test out of me because Medicare pays less?"

— medicare · 41 upvotes · None

"Hi Dr Ed! My mom is 82 and had dropped her Medicare Supplement in Illinois because her partner wanted Medicare Advantage plans with an OTC benefit! Moving in with me created an SEP so we called Chapter her first day here! Mom just passed medical underwriting and has a Plan F effective June 1st! You rock and I so appreciate the education provided in your videos ! Thank you thank you thank you! Cheers, Michael Albuquerque NM USA"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 39 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugz1hp93qJO8o52NhrR4AaABAg>

"NPR: Older Americans say they feel trapped in Medicare Advantage plans JANUARY 7, 2024 8:10 AM ET HEARD ON WEEKEND EDITION SUNDAY By Sarah Jane Tribble - Kaiser Health News 3-Minute Listen (Story first aired on All Things Considered on January 3, 2023.) UNIDENTIFIED NARRATOR: Right now is the Medicare annual enrollment period. 2024 Medicare Advantage plans are now available, so everyone on Medicare can call to see if a Medicare Advantage plan may be better for you. RASCOE: The plans are private insurance that Americans 65 and older can sign up for instead of traditional Medicare. And lots of Americans are signing up in this open enrollment period through March. Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News reports that some regret signing up and then have trouble getting out. SARAH JANE TRIBBLE: Back in 2016, when Richard Timmins first signed up for Medicare, he went to a free informational seminar with an insurance agent. RICHARD TIMMINS: Basically, he really promoted Medicare Advantage. He just said, well, look, it's less expensive. It's broader in coverage. TRIBBLE: For Timmins, it made economic sense to sign up for Medicare Advantage instead of traditional Medicare, and that worked out great - for a while. Then, he found a small bump on the back of his right ear. TIMMINS: I have a family history of melanoma, so I was kind of tuned into that and thinking about that. TRIBBLE: But it took him a long time to see the right specialist in his Medicare Advantage network, and getting the paperwork in order was confusing. TIMMINS: It was starting to - it started to grow and started to become rather painful. TRIBBLE: By the time Timmins finally saw an oncologist, the lesion had grown to the size of a dime. His right earlobe needed to be removed. He thinks getting care using traditional Medicare would have been faster and easier, and David Meyers at Brown University School of Public Health says he's probably right. DAVID MEYERS: You can see any provider you want. There are many less sort of restrictions on care. You get a lot more freedom with traditional Medicare. TRIBBLE: Timmins wishes he could switch, but there's a catch. TIMMINS: Would I go back to traditional Medicare if it was not cost prohibitive? Absolutely. TRIBBLE: Traditional Medicare premiums average about \$170 a month. And while enrollees on Medicare Advantage plans still pay that premium, the monthly cost can be more affordable. That's because plan enrollees often don't have to pay for extra prescription coverage. They also don't have to buy supplemental insurance, usually called Medigap. That supplemental insurance is needed because, unlike Medicare Advantage plans, traditional Medicare doesn't cap out-of-pocket cost. The thing is, Timmins might not be able to get a Medigap policy anymore. Here's David Lipschutz, associate director of the Center for Medicare Advocacy. DAVID LIPSCHUTZ: Medigap is one of the few types of insurance that can exclude you based upon preexisting conditions unless you enroll during certain designated times. TRIBBLE: That designated time is primarily when you first sign up for Medicare. But since Timmins enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan instead of traditional Medicare and he has a preexisting condition, he could be denied Medigap or charged a lot more for it. While federal law generally prohibits insurers from denying people coverage because of preexisting conditions, Medigap is an exception. Lipschutz again. LIPSCHUTZ: It's a lot easier to get and stay in a Medicare Advantage plan, but a lot harder to get out and pick up a Medigap plan, depending upon where you are. TRIBBLE: Only four states require Medigap insurers to cover applicants regardless of age or health. But Timmins lives in Washington state, which isn't one of them. He wants people to know. TIMMINS: You can get screwed if you're on Medicare Advantage. The advantage kind of disappears once you need them. TRIBBLE: In the meantime, Timmins worries. There's a chance that his cancer could come back, and he'll be trapped on Medicare Advantage if it does. So he's focusing on what he can control. TIMMINS: You know, I'm a vegetarian. I don't drink. I don't smoke. I try to get exercise as much as possible. TRIBBLE: But he knows it might not be enough. RASCOE: That was Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News. Copyright © 2024 NPR. All rights reserved. Visit our website terms of use and permissions pages at www.npr.org for further information."

— medicare · 35 upvotes · None

"Just went through this process about a year ago. I decided on a supplement plan (plan G) for as long as I could afford it. It is fairly 'easy' to switch to an advantage plan at a later time. Moving from an advantage plan to a supplement plan MAY require medical underwriting and may not be possible. I prefer the freedom of choice the supplement plans offer."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzGOqWQSwRxqmXlzZd4AaABAq>

"You should have mentioned that there's no medical underwriting for supplements only in the first 6 months of eligibility. Without that info, the uneducated might think they're free to switch to a supplement when their health deteriorates—which generally happens with age. (yes, there are exceptions) . And, from experience with my older family members, I think you are downplaying the prior approval disadvantage of advantage plans, which is serious—ask the AMA! I truly believe most should get Plan N medigap if they can possibly afford it Wolverine."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwoZ8dAIHWMGlpY32l4AaABAq>

"Many of us cannot afford straight Medicare, we are stuck with an advantage plans, I'm in a buy back plan, I can't afford 300 a month for Medicare"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugxi-TicJtS9XvWxJCV4AaABAq>

Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks · 161 documents

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAq>

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAq

"As a physician, I'd highly recommend going Traditional Medicare route if you can afford it... You are >65, this is time people start to get sick. Many hospitals are dropping Medicare Advantage plans, and we CONSTANTLY see prior authorization on Advantage plans on drugs that actually matter. Not mentioning the prior auths for surgeries. It is concerning that she undersells how much denials MA plans do compared to Traditional Medicare. Life is precious, this is not an arena to go cheap as an elderly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 258 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyvkvxZTQrEFv_Sdwrl4AaABAg

"As an Oncology provider for over 40 years I will tell you that there are other issues to consider which in my opinion make a G plan even more helpful. One of these issues is that G plans allow you to seek expert care outside of an Advantage plan PPO list of providers and institutions. I practice in a rural community and often send my patient to larger Comprehensive Cancer Centers around the country where they can get the best care for their unique situation. As I understand it, some Advantage plans may not pay as well in these situations. The other issue is prior approvals. If I order a diagnostic study such as a PET scan or MRI, or an IV chemotherapy medication agent, with a G plan there is no authorization process and these items will be paid for (assuming I am practicing within accepted guidelines). An Advantage plan may require a prior authorization before the test or medication can be ordered. These prior authorizations are a huge burden to providers and staff. Indeed, at many large institutions they will not spend any time on these and that means a less than ideal test or drug may need to be substituted."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 164 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=Ugyjp1bQgNodSTf4TMd4AaABAg>

"My husband was given the sales pitch about how great an advantage plan was. So he switched to Humana and the first two years were good. He was never sick. Then Covid came and he was diagnosed with cancer. We live in NH and the ER put him in an ambulance to go to Dana Farber in Boston (an hour away). Well guess what, the ambulance and hospital was out of network. Ambulance was \$5000. After he was diagnosed he passed away 72 days later. He was laying in the hospital bed stressed out about how I was going to pay all the medical bills when he dies. Sucks pretty bad when you're on your death bed and the only thing you think about is how your surviving spouse is going to pay the medical bills! Needless to say, when I signed up for Medicare I took a supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 92 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgztwkgUWWxR35VyLN4AaABAg>

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.])(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— medicare · 88 upvotes · None

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. ** I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— medicare · 81 upvotes · None

"Prior authorization for Medicare Beginning in January 2026 people on traditional Medicare (not Medicare Advantage) in 6 states-Arizona, New Jersey, Oklahoma, Ohio, Washington state and Texas-will have to prior authorizations for spine surgery and some other types of care. This is a 6 year pilot program. They will use an AI algorithm. This seems dangerous to me when you consider the disruption in healthcare by insurance companies who already use AI algorithms to ration healthcare. There is a lot of incentive for AI companies to deny care. The AI companies will share in "savings" they create."

— medicare · 80 upvotes · None

"Watching my uncle struggle actually made me appreciate Medicare more He's 68 and chose a \$0 Medicare Advantage plan last year because, honestly, it looked amazing on paper. Then real life showed up. His longtime doctor was suddenly out of network, a medication he's been on for years jumped in price, and the copays started adding up. Even traveling out of state became a headache he didn't expect. What really stood out to me wasn't that Medicare "failed" him. It was that the choices within Medicare matter more than people realize. Medicare itself gives you options, but the details of those options can seriously shape your experience. Watching this play out actually made me appreciate how Medicare is structured. You're not locked in forever. You can review your coverage, make changes during enrollment, and pivot to something that better fits your doctors, prescriptions, and lifestyle as things change. That flexibility is huge, especially as health needs evolve. It's not perfect, but having options, protections, and the ability to adjust over time is something I didn't know I'd value this much. Anyone else learn the ins and outs of Medicare the hard way? :))"

— medicare · 79 upvotes · family member helping · None

"Love this. I was an RN Case Manager for a large hospital and had to deal with prior authorization for the Advantage plans, we called them the Disadvantage plans. It would add days to the patient's hospital stay trying to get approval for a needed procedure."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 73 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCC&lc=UgxrElvhRnQoTCCEjXR4AaABAq>

"After working in healthcare (I'm a psychologist) through the heyday of managed care, and knowing how important it is to me to be able to choose my own doctor (they aren't all the same!), I went straight to Traditional Medicare. I know that there are some great Medicare Advantage plans that people really like. But people often love their plan until they get very sick. Then the claims start getting denied. My best friend and I were seeing the same physical therapist. I could get as many sessions as my doctor would recommend. She had to beg for more sessions, haggle for a reasonable cost due to confusing payments from her Medicare Advantage plan, and end PT before she was better. It was appalling! You may believe you are saving money with a MA plan. But if you have to pay for physical therapy or some other service that isn't covered, you'll end up spending more. And God forbid you need prior authorization for something before getting much-needed treatment! There are horror stories of people who have died waiting for that prior authorization. Ever notice how many ads there are for MA plans? Guess where they get that money? It comes out of the premiums they collect. That's money that won't go to healthcare. This is just wrong."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 70 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwEXrTu6t2HmVp_to14AaABAq

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAg>

"Recently retired from a Health Insurance Company, got a really good look behind the curtain. NO WAY I'm going to trust them with my Medicare for the remainder of my life. Prior Auth's alone are enough to make me say HELL NO to one of their Medicare Advantage plans. I prefer to let the Dr's make my medical decisions, not the Insurance Companies."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 67 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyLUAA0M5nVQVpgFd14AaABAg

"I really like my Advantage plan! Haven't had any problems, never denied coverage never any monthly output, always had complete coverage."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 56 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzgM7tL9blQNKyO7ix4AaABAg>

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>;

— medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"My wife and I have been on Medicare advantage for many years now. The money we've saved in not paying premiums for supplemental way more than offsets, even a maximum out-of-pocket in a given year for major surgery or hospitalization. If you were generally healthy but say every four or five years you might have to have surgery or something unexpected you're probably better off with advantage you'll save tens of thousands and you can go out of network for an additional thousand dollar out-of-pocket so the network issue has not bothered us"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 40 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyHu02Kqwc4UAErMmp4AaABAg

"I changed from an Advantage plan three years ago, even though it had some "perks," because I was moving around the country and didn't want to be out of network if I needed to go to a doctor. For me, original Medicare just made sense."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 34 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyVJryCEy987oe5uYR4AaABAg.AOn7k8cHtlhAOnIQDgzl7b>

"His advice is predicated entirely on the need for expensive supplement insurance, which assumes that you're going to have a pricey hospitalization every year if the insurance is going to pay for itself. I have a relative who paid (5 yrs ago) over 10,000 a year in various premiums for him and his wife. They're wealthy so afford the 20% for rare illness so it's a stupid decision in my opinion. We switched to an Advantage plan because it provided a maximum out of pocket for protection in the event of a expensive illness. He also said out of network doctors can charge whatever they want because there's no negotiated price but that's not true in practice. There are usual and customary charges (a range) that doctors charge. I don't agree with most of what he says."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgySokilkUmuGTmizjR4AaABAg.9ZiM-DHINrO9ZI_5iJrDtw

"At 39:53, you say, "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, lean towards Medicare Advantage." I feel the unspoken part of that sentence should be: "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, *AND MUCH MORE LIKELY TO BE DENIED COVERAGE* lean towards Medicare Advantage." With Medigap, your doctor and Medicare determine what procedures you can get. With Medicare Advantage, the Corporate Healthcare Provider determines what procedures you can get. The Advantage Plan Provider's incentive is to maximize profits. How do they do that? Deny coverage for procedures that they don't want to pay for."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwU_3aKoZJXMaRelzI4AaABAg

"For me, being able to see the doctor of my choice is priceless. I had a bad experience when I was young and had an HMO that used a specialist that said I could not be sick anymore after two weeks of antibiotics and that any continuing problem was in my head. I had to pay \$800 a visit to go to a real (out of network) specialist that treated me until I was well. So choosing Medigap was an easy choice for me when I turned 65."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyLkPPrjwHLUM7ZRd4AaABAg>

Flooded with Medicare calls and texts · 5 documents

"Happened to me, I have Medicare advanced plan they denied my tooth inplant after so many calls with no help to me end Paying over a \$1000 to have y implant. Thank you for this information 🙌 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxuCsVVSEwv17QPSop4AaABAg.9hFaZEgdHjE9hvWYk3W0ct>

"Fired from my medicare advantage job After getting my 215 license I started working at an agency that sells mapd, supplement, and hospital indemnity plans. Things were going great compared to fast food jobs I started making 1k+ a week and I wasn't even closing yet. Things started going down hill when I started closing my own deals after the agency bought me a few states. Aep was over and during oep I noticed the callers became increasingly hard to deal with. Most of them were only calling about a flex card, some of them didn't want to switch providers, while others stayed on the line just to curse me out and ask to be under the do not call list. I tried my best to close more deals and had no idea how other agents were even managing 5 deals a day compared to the calls I was receiving. Eventually I got called in the office and they decided to let me go. My question is where should I go from here? This is the first job I got fired from and I still have my license so I should be able to find a new job but now my confidence is at an all time low. What if I get fired again? Idk"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/

"If you've been a Medicare agent in 17 states for over a decade, you would know exactly what I'm talking about. You are well aware of the changes our industry is facing, so please do not call this an unfair, fear-based claim. And you're right—I forgot to provide proof and evidence—so here they are. Feel free to look up any of these news outlets to see exactly what I'm referring to if you're not aware of that. Medicare Advantage – The Hidden Risks (2024 Sources) Insurers Dropping Members Millions at risk as carriers pull back—over 1 million patients had to shop for new health plans as insurers and hospitals dropped MA coverage (Stateline, Oct 2024). Hospitals Dropping Contracts 15 health systems ended MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., Aultman, Scripps, WellSpan, etc.) due to denials and slow payments (TheStreet, 2024). 32 health systems dropped or declined to renew MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., CommonSpirit, Vanderbilt Health, Avera Health, etc.) (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). 17 health systems across multiple states did the same—citing administrative burdens—in a Becker's list updated August 2024 (Strategic Healthcare, 2024). HealthPartners left UnitedHealthcare MA network, citing denial rates up to 10x higher than with other insurers (Center for Medicare Advocacy, 2024). Hospitals are dropping MA plans "left and right"—Scripps Health terminated MA contracts affecting 30k seniors; many more followed suit across the country (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). JustCare lists 2024 cancellations (e.g., ECU Health, Comanche Regional, Genesis, Brookings, Memorial Hermann, etc.) (JustCare USA, 2024)."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyfN02DFY0-5fva9L94AaABAq_AMAJEJokT6yAMAm2VxdHH8

"It's shocking to me how this whole Medicare Advantage environment operates. IMO it is elder abuse plain and simple. Constant phone calls, agents making one plan sound better than another when they are damn near identical. Doing enrollments with dubious 'special enrollment periods'. Health insurance should not exist. Get all these people doing jobs that matter. Myself included."

— medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o36cqd/psa_avoid_calls_with_new_iphone_feature/nit1tdd/

"I have gotten two prices for Plan G from Blue Cross and Mutual of Omaha. there is a \$30 price difference per month. I am in Idaho. I get endless calls I do not know if scam or not. how do I get prices from all Idaho providers? without being placed on hold or calling lists?"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzucdwZmITYRiq9x9x4AaABAq>

Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias · 60 documents

"I won't be 65 until June 2024, but have been doing a lot of research about this topic. I have watched several videos by others that explained the difference between the 2 ways to go, but had yet to find one that I felt comfortable passing on to my other 64 year old friends. My search has ended. Yours is the most even-handed, non-emotional one out there. You aren't just parroting the biased views of others."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 485 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAq>

"I'm 67 and still working but planing to retire at 70. I've watched countless of your competitor videos on YT and through this process educated myself about the choices of Medicare. But your video was the BEST, most comprehensive and unbiased I've ever seen and your youthful looks belie your wise old owl wisdom."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 178 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugzce3UIINwJWth1qP14AaABAq>

"This is the ONLY unbiased YouTube on both options. This gentleman is an agent and that's very rare. I can name two, no three agencies that do nothing but flood this site with constant negative videos about Medicare Advantage Plans. The one guy always has a thumbnail with his eyes wide open and his hand over his mouth. Scare tactic, nothing more. Supplements are great, but millions of Americans have advantage plans that do what they are designed to do without issue. I personally have experience using both for more than a decade. Original Medicare should be requiring more pre-authorizations and in the coming years this will happen. The government has been getting ripped off for decades. Oh, we like cats!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 171 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgxT0a_1CgP1_SKsFld4AaABAg

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. ** I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— medicare · 81 upvotes · None

"For free and unbiased Medicare help, dial 510-961-3329 to speak with my trusted partner, Chapter, or go to <https://askchapter.org/erin>";

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 52 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwlskiY8nYFKdQ53uR4AaABAq>

"You're a tiger in this video. I bought a plan G supplement as a perfectly healthy person taking no meds. I liked the predictability of the out of pocket maximums. The next year, I hurt my wrist and developed prostate cancer that required treatment. I was able to get scans and radiation and visit specialists that I wanted without ever worrying about the costs. I am very happy with the choice I made. This video is very fair and unbiased and accurate. Well done."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxPjKemu-lqNJsIszV4AaABAg>

"Very good, informative video on this horribly complicated subject of deciding on a Medicare Plan. I have watched a few Medicare videos and really liked your unbiased explanations! Now, I can go back to my cat nap after all this thinking!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugyn_GEAgMY12VJu2kl4AaABAg

"Avoid Sunburn as great risk for melanoma. I would like folks to check statistics for the average healthy 65 year old, which is the usual year that folks make their initial decisions. what percent are going to hospitalized? I believe far less than 1%. hence if you are healthy, medicare adv is great for the first few years after retirement. insurance companies reap huge profits off medicare supplement. I have worked as a physician and for both non-profit and for profit insurance. at the non profit, they know that they make much more \$\$ off medicare supplement and specifically told us not to promote medicare advantage. brokers make more money off med supplement too. your video was actually was very informed and very balanced. 99% better than most video and clearly unbiased. By the way, most folks that have cancer (unless the worst types) is much less than \$300k..more like \$100k for many standard breast or colon cancers. I also study high cost claimants so I see the worst of the worst but that is only for about 1-5% of seniors. thanks for your nice job."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwRYVtBbILppXE7clJ4AaABAg>

"I am 77 years old and I love animals, especially Rhinos. I really appreciated your unbiased evaluations of supplements vs advantage plans. I have had a supplement because I am a retired Tennessee state employee. I have had two cancers and paid very little for great service."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugy2yEhwvfZGAYp1K_p4AaABAg

"I really like your video and feel it's the unbiased one I have watched. My dog sits with me as I watch videos. My husband has had 2 outpatient procedures this year along with a 5 day hospital stay. I don't love his premiums on the supplemental plan but have been grateful for the coverage he has had. I find it peace of mind having the supplemental plan. I do have an agent I trust but always feel the need to understand Medicare coverage. Thank you for your help."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugxf3T2UxQEzrFGrafV4AaABAg>

"Just turned 65. My broker tried to present all options and easy to understand. Very confusing. I appreciate your videos especially when I just watched one of those portraying this business as a DOG eat dog world. Having said that I hope my agent and I made the best choice. I really hate the whole thing. But thnx again for your unbiased presentation"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgycU_NhzSwAnS6aKMI4AaABAq

"Your channel is awesome and is the most unbiased healthcare channel I've come across so far. I've seen so many channels just bashing the Advantage Plan but not everyone can afford supplement plans. Also just original Medicare is not the safest option."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwusLtigJ0Pig0uPN94AaABAq>

"Your video are very informative and unbiased..and I listened till the end.. than you. I am on advantage plan and I been doing my own research on plans, deductibles, out of pocket etc and my plan still the best for me.. I am just worried about news that doctors and facilities are signing out of adv plans,, hopefully not in my plan 🐶"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxC0rHIJenu2qzwdXZ4AaABAq.9wSVEy-xFcQ9wTyTcBarS7>

"Very biased presentation. Many of us are going to be very strapped financially when we retire, since we don't have a pension and we were not very highly paid when working. I'm retiring at 74 and a plan G will cost me \$3204 a year plus \$1980 for plan B. Plan N is \$2532. I've been on Blue Cross HMOs all my life, like probably most people and have had zero problems. You act like an extra \$3k is irrelevant because you only sell supplements. You should be ashamed of your one sided presentation, deceiving people to benefit yourself 15:22. I'm planning on joining a Blue Cross advantage plan with a great network for 0 premium."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzE8b2F6cQrJ2qNHmp4AaABAq>

"Erik - MAHALO (thanks) for providing a comprehensive and unbiased comparison/explanation between Advantage and Supplement plans, including the pros and cons. After my brother was declined a cardiac procedure pre-authorization, even after his doctor appealed the decline, he switched to a Supplement Plan. Subsequently, he had triple by-pass surgery. Because I don't want to be subject to stricter pre-authorizations, I will opt to select a Supplement Plan. Thankfully, I can afford this option. I was planning to use a local Medicare consultant/insurance broker, I'm now leaning toward using your firm simply because of your unbiased and trusted education."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgwhNRa14NsfQk0KePZ4AaABAq>

"Good advice. I will be 67 this year and have been on Medicare for a couple of years. We found an independent broker who was very helpful. I had a major surgery or two 5 years before so we asked the broker what coverage would we have if that event happened under the various plans we looked at. I have been on advantage plan but it pays to keep up year to year as coverage varies from year to year. Follow the money"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1pLq6moM&lc=UgyXq1_X5jcvfx6wDwZ4AaABAq

"[Ask Insurance] What's the best way to find and evaluate insurance agents? (Medicare, Home, etc.) How do you find and evaluate an insurance agent and ensure they will provide good service and provide thoughtful recommendations? Are there any particular questions or resources you find helpful in separating great agents from the pack? Are reference calls useful? Do you lean towards working with independent agents or are captive agents ok? Is Profit vs. non-profit a factor when evaluating insurance providers? Sorry if this is overly broad, I'm looking for any and all good tips and lessons you've picked up. I'm in the process of helping my parents get Medicare coverage and while I've done all my homework to probably set them up with their initial coverages, but I'd rather work with a good agent long-term to make sure someone stays on top of pricing, plan changes (i.e. medigap or advantage makes more sense), part d formulary coverage, etc. Since I'm looking for a medicare agent, I figure it might be good to review all their insurance coverage and agents."

— Insurance · 3 upvotes · family member helping · https://www.reddit.com/r/Insurance/comments/461799/ask_in_surance_whats_the_best_way_to_find_and/

"I'm a recently retired Medicare Specialist. This is a good, informative, balanced look at Medicare options. I would add that Advantage plan availability is on a county by county basis and Supplement G Pricing varies by state and in-state region. Moral of the story, you need, need, need a local independent agent representing many different companies and options before you decide. While this was a great presentation, it is too complex a topic to be covered on YouTube. Again, good job on this. And uhhh, anecdote or anecdotal... whatever."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgwCyTeTMOKOBvZgcnR4AaABAg>

"Do you have any suggestions where to get this type of unbiased information for people in the few states that do allow us to change from Advantage to Traditional Medicare (NY state)? I understand the majority don't have that option, but I'd love to find someone on YouTube advising for people in those states that do allow it. Thank you for any help!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyY6Ucu6S9twltceRF4AaABAg>

"Dog-gone it Erik, you really outdid yourself on this video! Like your parents, my wife and I each have a different type of plan in our retirement; my wife has a long list of specialists and has had heart and cancer procedures -- so she has the Supplement Plan G! With my slightly elevated blood pressure as my only chronic ailment -- I am on an Advantage plan. Thank you for your continued efforts to remain unbiased and to deliver fair, data-based information to the retirement population! Keep up the great work; wishing you and your family a blessed Thanksgiving and upcoming holiday season!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgzgJRF1pw4qWnXGZv14AaABAg>

'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money · 197 documents

"I am 64 and received my medicare card. As a senior citizen trying to go through the maze of medicare plans is enough stress to kill anyone. One must ask themselves why is medicare so hard to navigate that private insurers send out their so called medicare advisors to steal our money? I have decided to decline Part B and I will definitely not sign up for the Advantage Plan that I know all too well it will kill you in the end. I will cancel my Federal blue Cross Blue Shield insurance that is almost \$400 a month now that I have only used on four occasions in 21 years. I'd rather die than give one more cent to a broken health care system. When property insurance, health care insurance and auto insurance takes over 50% of a retired citizen income, I call that a crime. The only reason we are the wealthiest country in the world is due to the fact that private companies have been stealing money from the hard working middle class folks and became richer with the money they stole from us because the law makers got their kick back money and we got kicked in the back."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 811 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwoFkaXMEaOiRM1oYh4AaABAg>

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"I live in Ohio . I am on plan N with the wife . I pay \$91 a month at 69. I had stage 3 cancer last year and paid very little out of my pocket .Very happy as I could pick my doctors and hospitals I wanted ! Every bill was paid fast !! No denying services too !! Original medicare works like a charm !!!! Dont fall into the Medicare Advange trap !!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 194 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwvfURn5XXCLWCAGlp4AaABAg

"I retired from health insurance processing about 50% because of this scam. I did not have a single person who had a "Medicare Advantage", who had any advantage. The only ones getting an advantage here is the insurance companies, and the feds."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 177 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugz5qyDIIBnU7-nFzc14AaABAg>

"I was paying \$235 a month for my medicare supplement. I am relatively healthy, take no prescription drugs, pay out of pocket for dental and eye care. I just cancelled my supplement and signed on to a highly rated medicare advantage program. I think this was a good move for me."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 173 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw9Bpq7gL9tXCMBZaN4AaABAg>

"My dad washes paper plates to save money, but Medicare finally got him to see a doctor My dad is the cheapest man alive. He avoided doctors for 40 years because he was convinced they were all "scammers" trying to steal his hard-earned cash. When he turned 65, I basically dragged him to the computer to sign up. He grumbled the whole time about the premiums for his Part B and the Supplement plan we picked. I thought it was a waste of breath. Then he took a nasty spill in the garage last month. He needed a partial hip replacement. He was literally sweating in the hospital bed. It wasn't from the pain. It was because he was mentally calculating the bill. When the statement finally came, he went quiet. The surgery, the anesthesia, and the hospital stay were all covered after he met a small deductible. He didn't lose his life savings."

— medicare · 102 upvotes · family member helping · None

"Last July, I spent one week in the hospital which included two ambulance rides, specialists, many tests, etc. The bill was \$30,000 and going up. I paid ZERO dollars because I have a good plan. If you buy cheap, you will end up paying for it. I have original Medicare A & B with an AARP United Health Care supplement plan for \$410 a month. Just one trip to the hospital is worth the cost. I'm 80 and just getting by financially by the grace of God."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 102 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzhW03ErdB2Dq8ZcXI4AaABAg>

"I can't believe how much more I will have to pay going on Medicare. I was on an Obamacare plan paying \$175 a month with no drug copays and occasional \$20 doctor visit copays. So maybe \$2,200 a year. On Medicare I will pay \$202 a month for the basic coverage, around \$150 for a plan N supplement, around \$100 for plan D drug coverage and \$100 for the few current drugs I'm taking now. So about \$6,600 a year. That is triple the cost. Is this normal? Isn't part D just a discount plan?"

— medicare · 95 upvotes · None

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

"Do not leave the original Medicare for any advantage replacement policy With Medicare open enrollment upon us. I don't know who needs to hear this, but if you're out searching for Medicare plans for yourself or your parents and it's getting confusing as it does for everybody. I want to provide you with a cautionary word of advise from our failed experience. First off never leave the original Medicare. Just don't. When my mom became Medicare age, we did not know which plan to put her on and we blindly trusted a very close family friend who sold insurance to pick that plan for her, not knowing any different. I didn't find out until later that my mom was put on a Medicare "replacement" plan through United, which is not actually Medicare. If you're helping someone pick a Medicare plan, just add a "supplement" to their plan. Do not make any changes to their original Medicare plan and never ever switch over to any of the advantage plans where they try to lure you into their insurance plans by giving you extra cash / groceries / gym memberships / benefits because it's not the real original Medicare. Does replacements work, yes, and they are great until they aren't. The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. That's when the real issues can rise up to the top. I personally call it a scam bc I think few are told what is actually occurring when you sign up for a advantage replacement. If you already left the original Medicare, you have 1 year to go back to it otherwise you have to take a medical examination to be approved. If you have real health issues, your rates will likely skyrocket and make it impossible to return. Keep the original bc the cost stays the same for the most part and it's protected far more than any other insurance policy out there. Disclosure: I can only speak from our personal experience. On a side note: insurance agents make more money on the replacement plans than they do on a supplement plan. So take it for what it's worth. **The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. I am ultimately making this post to help, but also to see if anyone else has any ideas on how I could get my mom back on the original Medicare, it looks hopeless but I thought its worth pushing it out to Reddit and pray someone has had a way of reversing this mess Thank you."

— medicare · 89 upvotes · family member helping · None

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugxmge1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAg

"My husband and I were paying over \$700 a month for premiums alone with Medicare and a Supplement plan, so we changed to Medicare advantage plan Preferred Care with UHC and here in Miami it works fairly well. We never had any issues to go to specialists. Even though my husband takes a lot of medications, at the end of the year we end up saving money."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 67 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwRHs4R8-hbL8liv_R4AaABAg

"At the time I was preparing to retire at age 66, I became ill with covid. I was still covered by my employer insurance. When I returned to work after covid, I became ill again. Due to being off so long my insurance lapsed. I officially retired and signed up for SSI and Medicare plan B. I had signed up for plan A as soon as it was available at age 65. The second illness was kidney cancer that was discovered while I was in my open enrollment period. I quickly selected a Supplemental plan, and was I ever happy! It covered everything including an additional year of follow up immunotherapy with Katruda. I saved thousands of dollars every 90 days of follow up therapy! My Supplemental plan cost me about \$95 a month! So don't gamble with your health or finances!"

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 64 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgykxBns009Os0UTIEp4AaABAg>

"I turn 65 this August. I work in IT my brain is super sharp I do 500 situps a day 20 minutes olyptical a day don't drink don't smoke and I'm still fin lost!!! So now I'm supposed to find some financial shark who just might steal me blind. And I'm one of the sharp ones! What about the poor old people that are scammed and taken advantage of every day? What has society come to? This is an outrage! I've watched video after video and I'm still not certain of my best path. And I'm certainly not going to pay for someone who may or may not help me."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=Ugz2DNxO1qpi1X0xEkF4AaABAg>

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— medicare · 51 upvotes · None

""Better than nothing" until you develop a serious medical issue and start racking up denial of service for treatments that your doctor orders. A lot of health groups are no longer taking "Disadvantage Plans" for this reason. Their liabilities increase exponentially due to the sub par treatment they are limited by MA plans. It's becoming a huge issue in many areas. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these plans. Medicare Advantage isn't medicare.... It's privatized insurance that the companies are making double the profits vs Medigap plans. It's by far the biggest scam of all. The government is paying between \$1200 to \$1800 monthly per person on these plans. Guess whos supplementing this waste. Those of us on regular Medicare."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 51 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAg.9xSID3dQbFn9yaOJ1rwxAD>

"My mother didn't want to hear it when I told her Medicare (Dis)Advantage was a scam. Then she broke her leg and needed 6 weeks inpatient rehab and the insurance company booted her in less than 2 weeks. Now she agrees with me. And my brother and I are getting TRADITIONAL MEDICARE!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 45 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=Ugxpn0JGpHTMbEgSZ2V4AaABAg>

"I have just applied for retirement online and it is one of the most difficult things I've had to do. I am looking to get part B when I retire in June you can't talk to no one at Social Security. They never call back to help. appointments take months to get to. It is the biggest scam I ever been through. I worked all my life and now I gotta figure this crap out or else I get penalized. I don't get it. they should be helping seniors not stealing from us."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 40 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugz-0xA7Pfwicnl4hzV4AaABAg>

"This is, hands down, the best video I have ever seen about Medicare insurance plans!! Fantastic job, and thank you! And I hope you recover quickly from your sunburn! BUT... I want to introduce a dimension that I was surprised you did not mention! That is, taking care of yourself! By that, I mean taking nutrition seriously for decades, maintaining an ideal weight, and working out regularly at a gym in old age so you never neglect your body's conditioning!! Now in our mid 70s, my wife and I have been "nutritarian" for 15 years. Nutritarian is a diet developed by Dr. Joel Fuhrman based on a 100% plant-based diet, only far more emphasis on nutrient-density at every meal. No added sugar, no animal products, no dairy, no alcohol, no bread, no added oil, no added salt. Just whatever comes naturally in the fruit, vegetables, nuts, grains, mushrooms, seeds, and sprouts (microgreens) that we eat at every meal. We go to our gym for a vigorous 60 to 80 minute resistance workout every 3 days (plus a 60-minute treadmill cardio workout on some off-days). We maintain ideal weight, take no medications, and my local doctor told me that I have the blood pressure of a healthy 18-year-old. MY POINT is that your own discipline over your peak nutrition and physical conditioning will have an enormous impact over your long-term health! We have a guy at our gym at age 95 still working out!! As Dr. Fuhrman says: "Your genes load the gun. But your diet and lifestyle pull the trigger!" As part of our Advantage plan, our gym enrollment is covered. That is \$100 a month savings for both my wife and myself. We do have a local insurance agent, but if we did not I would reach out to this agent with The Retirement Nerds! What an excellent explanation of all the insurance options! So, don't eat junk! Don't sit around in an easy chair drinking beer! Make peak nutrition your most serious hobby. Grow your own sprouts and microgreens like I do. Don't eat canned beans - instead eat beans you cook yourself from dry beans. We eat 18 kinds of beans I cook weekly in a pressure cooker. I plan to make it to 100+ unless I get hit by a truck! (And if that happens, insurance won't matter.) Best wishes!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 36 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzq9b4ySEEjBX1HcUh4AaABAg>

"Got an unsolicited bill e-mail. I have Aetna/CVS health through the Marketplace, not Oscar Insurance. All links are from HiOscar. Is this a scam? I tried to call the HiOscar phone number from the website and verified the website is legit. But all I receive is an automatic phone menu and can't reach a live person to ask about this. I feel like I shouldn't try to "log in" to HiOscar with my details, considering I DON'T have an account with them, I DON'T have their insurance. **UPDATE:** I called them! As it turns out, the insurance I had ended their marketplace plans for 2026. For some reason, this automatically signed me up for Oscar. The "bill" was the premium to pay before January 1st 2026 if I want their coverage. I didn't receive a single notice from EITHER company telling me about this upcoming transfer to Oscar. This was their fault and a legendary failure of communication."

— HealthInsurance · 35 upvotes · None

Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline · 275 documents

"Erin, this is your best video ever! I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed. Thank you, thank you, thank you 🙏 "

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 234 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRlqEu63hwvh4AaABAg>

"The reason so many people default to Medicare Advantage is not just the marketing, it's the fact that it so much resembles the health insurance that people are accustomed to—with co-pays, but basically all-inclusive (except maybe vision and dental). Regular Medicare is a 1960s Major Medical plan with add-ons to bring it up to date, and even with part B and D you still need private insurance (the alphabet soup of Medigap plans) to make up the gaps. What we really need is an all-inclusive, up to date version of Medicare rather than people having to assemble all these disparate parts, which are especially confusing for people with less education."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 176 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugw7uVI2hc5qZkKoSBx4AaABAg>

"This video is by far the best explanation on the difference between original Medicare and Medicare Advantage without being confusing. Thank you so much for this. I will be 65 in 2026 and my employer is dropping my health coverage because he says I will be on Medicare. I have been bombarded with SOOOO much information. It's difficult to understand this whole thing. You have cleared up a lot of it for me in one video! So THANK YOU!!!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 146 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxLckexGeBnELXhfKZ4AaABAg

"As someone turning 65 next month this type of information is very helpful. The way they have set everything up could not be more confusing and inefficient."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 129 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwddBLZOMhdw-fYFsl4AaABAg>

"I am a retiree already on Medicare. When I saw that this video was available, I wanted to take a look. And I want to say, this is one of the best videos I've seen for those not yet on Medicare. The speaker, Stephanie, is very well spoken on the matter. She speaks clearly on what you need to know but does not confuse you with more info than you need or with casual comments. (If this were available back when I was applying, it would have been an excellent resource)."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 116 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgxH8Oqj9qk1Muh4VMt4AaABAg>

"Do not leave the original Medicare for any advantage replacement policy With Medicare open enrollment upon us. I don't know who needs to hear this, but if you're out searching for Medicare plans for yourself or your parents and it's getting confusing as it does for everybody. I want to provide you with a cautionary word of advise from our failed experience. First off never leave the original Medicare. Just don't. When my mom became Medicare age, we did not know which plan to put her on and we blindly trusted a very close family friend who sold insurance to pick that plan for her, not knowing any different. I didn't find out until later that my mom was put on a Medicare "replacement" plan through United, which is not actually Medicare. If you're helping someone pick a Medicare plan, just add a "supplement" to their plan. Do not make any changes to their original Medicare plan and never ever switch over to any of the advantage plans where they try to lure you into their insurance plans by giving you extra cash / groceries / gym memberships / benefits because it's not the real original Medicare. Does replacements work, yes, and they are great until they aren't. The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. That's when the real issues can rise up to the top. I personally call it a scam bc I think few are told what is actually occurring when you sign up for a advantage replacement. If you already left the original Medicare, you have 1 year to go back to it otherwise you have to take a medical examination to be approved. If you have real health issues, your rates will likely skyrocket and make it impossible to return. Keep the original bc the cost stays the same for the most part and it's protected far more than any other insurance policy out there. Disclosure: I can only speak from our personal experience. On a side note: insurance agents make more money on the replacement plans than they do on a supplement plan. So take it for what it's worth. **The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. I am ultimately making this post to help, but also to see if anyone else has any ideas on how I could get my mom back on the original Medicare, it looks hopeless but I thought its worth pushing it out to Reddit and pray someone has had a way of reversing this mess Thank you."

— medicare · 89 upvotes · family member helping · None

"My husband has an Advantage plan has not had any problems with it. Been on it 5 years. Finding a dentist in our area has been an issue though. What I don't understand is why there are separate Plans (A,B,C,D) and you have to pay for those. Medicare should be one plan and it's all covered as we paid for it from our working wages."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 79 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugzj1Rb6ZQ40dwn_bcl4AaABAg

"I don't understand why there is not just one medicare plan for everyone instead of this mess. This indicates what a sad state our government is in."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 75 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgxTJeKHAJFXuDjtgyt4AaABAg>

"GLP-1 Bridge Program Info As someone that works in a doctors office and submits PAs, I want to clear up some confusion about the GLP-1 bridge program. I want to start by saying I appreciate that this program will get these meds to many people that need it, but it leaves a lot of Medicare beneficiaries behind. If you have type 2 diabetes, moderate to severe obstructive sleep apnea, or MASH you do NOT qualify to use the program. You have to get a GLP-1 medication approved for those conditions through your Part D plan. Even if the Part D copay is astronomical, you still can't use the bridge program if you have any of those 3 diagnoses. It doesn't matter if the provider doesn't even use those diagnoses and only submits the PA for obesity, you still don't qualify. When we submit the PA, the provider has to attest that you do NOT have those conditions. If the provider selects that you DO have any of them, the system automatically denies it and kicks it back saying it has to go through Part D. You can't get around this if you have these conditions because that would be committing Medicare fraud. I submitted multiple of these PAs today and confirmed this is exactly how it's being processed. You do still qualify if you have mild obstructive sleep apnea and meet the other criteria, because mild OSA isn't covered under Part D, only moderate to severe. This is directly from the CMS website info for prescribers and the PA form that I've linked below. I recommend looking over these because this is exactly the guideline providers are following when submitting these PAs. <https://www.cms.gov/glp-1-bridge.pdf> <https://www.cms.gov/files/document/glp-1-prescribers-c-1.pdf> I hope this information is helpful."

— medicare · 74 upvotes · None

"After working in healthcare (I'm a psychologist) through the heyday of managed care, and knowing how important it is to me to be able to choose my own doctor (they aren't all the same!), I went straight to Traditional Medicare. I know that there are some great Medicare Advantage plans that people really like. But people often love their plan until they get very sick. Then the claims start getting denied. My best friend and I were seeing the same physical therapist. I could get as many sessions as my doctor would recommend. She had to beg for more sessions, haggle for a reasonable cost due to confusing payments from her Medicare Advantage plan, and end PT before she was better. It was appalling! You may believe you are saving money with a MA plan. But if you have to pay for physical therapy or some other service that isn't covered, you'll send up spending more. And God forbid you need prior authorization for something before getting much-needed treatment! There are horror stories of people who have died waiting for that prior authorization. Ever notice how many ads there are for MA plans? Guess where they get that money? It comes out of the premiums they collect. That's money that won't go to healthcare. This is just wrong."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 70 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwEXrTu6t2HmVp_to14AaABAg

"I am a former Computer Programmer and think very logically. I agree, the entire American Medical Industry is 100% criminal along with medical insurance companies. After I was eligible for Medicare I thought my med insurance problems were over. I found out EVERYTHING is so confusing and unnecessarily complicated it is a complete nightmare. It started with the governments little rule about if you are born on the 1st of the month your initial enrollment period is different. Then it went to you have 12 months to avoid part B (in some specific instances LOL) and not get the lifetime penalty. It is very strange and not by accident that you have to pay the government for medical insurance and THEN need go out to buy more medical insurance."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxVVOM4Fb2X-xO5SGJ4AaABAg>

"Turning 65 next year and Medicare enrollment is way more confusing than I expected assumed I'd just sign up and be done. then found out about Parts A, B, C, D, Medigap, and enrollment windows with actual penalties if you miss them biggest surprise: the enrollment window isn't just your birthday month, it's seven months — and missing it can mean a permanent premium penalty. a free broker consultation helped untangle Advantage vs Supplement plans more than searching on my own."

— medicare · 62 upvotes · None

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"My wife turned 65 a few years ago and I thought I was a wise man with the ability to think and understand things. NOT WITH MEDICARE. It is so confusing to the average American"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 55 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211IpLq6moM&lc=UgwxSooBO1Y9mfd2BV94AaABAq>

"I went on to the retirement court with Plan G. No major complaints with the exception of the recent premium increase and the truly impossible task of finding my cost share prior to treatment. My bigger complaint with this whole racket is the development (or lack there of) a system structured for intentional confusion. One should not need PhDs in multiple disciplines to understand their health insurance. No luv in this game."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyV6bKd_Qtj9cUgC4x4AaABAq

"What are the most common Medicare mistakes people make when turning 65? I work with people who are turning 65, and I've noticed some recurring Medicare pitfalls — like enrolling late, overpaying for the wrong plan, or thinking Medigap and Advantage are the same. I've been pulling together a checklist of the most common questions and confusion points people have when starting Medicare. Just wondering what others here think are the most common or costly mistakes you've seen? Would love to hear from other agents, advisors, or anyone who's helped a parent or client through it."

— medicare · 44 upvotes · None

"Thank you SOOOO much. You have answered questions for me that I have been asking for years! You made the information about choice of doctors and coverage area simple to understand without double talk that confused me. After listening to you I now understand the difference and I will always stay with Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 38 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxUgNQdZ9jImq_CnhR4AaABAg

"All I can say is wow! I'm 66 and past the age of choosing. I went with good old Medicare and medigap, thank goodness. But the research required to make good decisions was overwhelming. I'm happy that moving forward people will have access to your complete and well explained tutorial on this most important decision as we approach retirement. You have provided an incredible service, Erin, and I'm sure your dad is very proud of his daughter."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 38 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugzrq2ND9UayBnM6cKx4AaABAg>

"NPR: Older Americans say they feel trapped in Medicare Advantage plans JANUARY 7, 2024 8:10 AM ET HEARD ON WEEKEND EDITION SUNDAY By Sarah Jane Tribble - Kaiser Health News 3-Minute Listen (Story first aired on All Things Considered on January 3, 2023.) UNIDENTIFIED NARRATOR: Right now is the Medicare annual enrollment period. 2024 Medicare Advantage plans are now available, so everyone on Medicare can call to see if a Medicare Advantage plan may be better for you. RASCOE: The plans are private insurance that Americans 65 and older can sign up for instead of traditional Medicare. And lots of Americans are signing up in this open enrollment period through March. Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News reports that some regret signing up and then have trouble getting out. SARAH JANE TRIBBLE: Back in 2016, when Richard Timmins first signed up for Medicare, he went to a free informational seminar with an insurance agent. RICHARD TIMMINS: Basically, he really promoted Medicare Advantage. He just said, well, look, it's less expensive. It's broader in coverage. TRIBBLE: For Timmins, it made economic sense to sign up for Medicare Advantage instead of traditional Medicare, and that worked out great - for a while. Then, he found a small bump on the back of his right ear. TIMMINS: I have a family history of melanoma, so I was kind of tuned into that and thinking about that. TRIBBLE: But it took him a long time to see the right specialist in his Medicare Advantage network, and getting the paperwork in order was confusing. TIMMINS: It was starting to - it started to grow and started to become rather painful. TRIBBLE: By the time Timmins finally saw an oncologist, the lesion had grown to the size of a dime. His right earlobe needed to be removed. He thinks getting care using traditional Medicare would have been faster and easier, and David Meyers at Brown University School of Public Health says he's probably right. DAVID MEYERS: You can see any provider you want. There are many less sort of restrictions on care. You get a lot more freedom with traditional Medicare. TRIBBLE: Timmins wishes he could switch, but there's a catch. TIMMINS: Would I go back to traditional Medicare if it was not cost prohibitive? Absolutely. TRIBBLE: Traditional Medicare premiums average about \$170 a month. And while enrollees on Medicare Advantage plans still pay that premium, the monthly cost can be more affordable. That's because plan enrollees often don't have to pay for extra prescription coverage. They also don't have to buy supplemental insurance, usually called Medigap. That supplemental insurance is needed because, unlike Medicare Advantage plans, traditional Medicare doesn't cap out-of-pocket cost. The thing is, Timmins might not be able to get a Medigap policy anymore. Here's David Lipschutz, associate director of the Center for Medicare Advocacy. DAVID LIPSCHUTZ: Medigap is one of the few types of insurance that can exclude you based upon preexisting conditions unless you enroll during certain designated times. TRIBBLE: That designated time is primarily when you first sign up for Medicare. But since Timmins enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan instead of traditional Medicare and he has a preexisting condition, he could be denied Medigap or charged a lot more for it. While federal law generally prohibits insurers from denying people coverage because of preexisting conditions, Medigap is an exception. Lipschutz again. LIPSCHUTZ: It's a lot easier to get and stay in a Medicare Advantage plan, but a lot harder to get out and pick up a Medigap plan, depending upon where you are. TRIBBLE: Only four states require Medigap insurers to cover applicants regardless of age or health. But Timmins lives in Washington state, which isn't one of them. He wants people to know. TIMMINS: You can get screwed if you're on Medicare Advantage. The advantage kind of disappears once you need them. TRIBBLE: In the meantime, Timmins worries. There's a chance that his cancer could come back, and he'll be trapped on Medicare Advantage if it does. So he's focusing on what he can control. TIMMINS: You know, I'm a vegetarian. I don't drink. I don't smoke. I try to get exercise as much as possible. TRIBBLE: But he knows it might not be enough. RASCOE: That was Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News. Copyright © 2024 NPR. All rights reserved. Visit our website terms of use and permissions pages at www.npr.org for further information."

— medicare · 35 upvotes · None

"New to Medicare This Year - More Confusing Than I Thought! I had helped my mother and my mother-in-law with their Medicare in the past. I also had worked in Human Resources early in my career and learned a lot about insurance. So I thought that signing up for Medicare would be easy for me. But, not having looked at this stuff in at least 10 years, I found it a lot more confusing than I had expected! I'm turning 65 in a few months. I'm in SF Bay area of California. I already know that I want traditional Medicare and not Medicare Advantage. I started taking Social Security at the beginning of this year (2025) so I automatically got a Medicare number and automatically got enrolled into Parts A & B. Now I need to pick a Plan D for drugs and a Medigap plan, which I already know will be a Plan G. In that regard, perhaps I'm ahead of the game. But picking a Plan D and a Plan G is turning out to be much harder than I'd thought it would be. I was glad to have watched a few YouTube videos about the process for signing up for each of these things -- that helped a lot, as well as reading the Medicare website and some info from AARP, etc. I found out that some of the Part D plans I was considering have limits on how many pills can be filled in 30 days for some meds. An SSRI that I take requires 90 10mg pills each month, because I take 25 mg per day and there is no 25 mg pill (nor is there a 50 mg that can be cut in half). So the plans that limit me to 30 10mg pills per month are a non-starter. (Sure, I could probably have my doctor try to appeal and get the 90 pills per month covered, but there is no guarantee that the insurance company would agree....and then I'd be stuck! Not worth the hassle!) This information was kinda buried at the bottom of each Part D plan on the Medicare website. It would have been a "bad surprise" to learn this after the fact! Regarding Part G -- this really surprised me -- the only Part G plan for my area that shows the premium and extra perks upfront is the AARP United Healthcare plan. ALL of the others don't even have a special page (or set of pages) about their Medigap plans! How are you supposed to compare the plans if you can't even see what you're paying for? I understand that all of the plans cover the exact same things; that's not what I want to know. I want to see rate tables (because most of them are Attained Age plans. The AARP one is Community based rates, and one other that I'm considering, Transamerica, is age at issue based rate). I also want to see if there are any perks beyond the regular plan coverage (like gym membership or whatever). I don't want to have to go through an agent or get a broker involved. I've had bad experiences with them in the past. I want to do this myself and sign up directly with the insurance companies. I truly don't understand why NONE of the Medigap providers in my area have ANY information on their websites about Medicare or their Medicare plans. When you click on the "company website" link on the Medicare website, it takes you to a general home page about the insurance company. I have tried searching these websites for "Medicare" or "Medigap" or "Plan G" but the searches come up blank. Why even offer a Medigap plan if you're not going to show your benefits to your clients online???? I don't want to have to waste my time calling 3 or 4 insurance companies! Only AARP seems to be upfront with any of this stuff. It's so weird, and I truly don't understand it! Am I missing something or misunderstanding something? Are the insurance companies deliberately making it hard for people to understand exactly what they're buying??"

— medicare · 33 upvotes · None

Lead Sources

An independent agent or broker · 56 documents

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"Chartreuse. 67 and looking to retire that end of next year if they don't put me out to pasture before then. Been on part A since 65, with company health plans that change every year. The agent at my local SS office went above and beyond to explain everything to me when I signed up. He was extremely helpful."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2qoGwp4Co8&lc=UgzNY_JjDH7DleQpHbp4AaABAq

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do,before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎🏠🩺🙏🕊️🕊️🕊️"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UqxdqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAq>

"Thank you. I just met with a Medicare broker yesterday. He tried to tell me original Medicare with a supplement required pre authorizations just like advantage plans and he didn't know of any of his clients who had delayed or denied procedures. I said I had to review the plans before making a decision. But what I did is make an appointment with a different Medicare agent"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJJes9o&lc=Ugw4aqKwIwxaQTzZ4nd4AaABAq>

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMp4AaABAq>

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJJes9o&lc=UgyOgJsaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAq>

"One more thing I'd like to mention. I got my Medigap policy through Abt Insurance Agency. They were not the first agent I called. I chose them because I felt they were telling me the truth and were not trying to steer my decision with no pressure. And any time I have any questions they always quick to reply to my emails. They have a great understanding of customer service."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxSAj3YtQY5wYQ5qDF4AaABAq>

"Sunburn - What an incredibly great and needed video! I must admit, as you alluded to towards the end of this video, I came into this video, after reading the title, full of fury and anger yet curiosity about what would be in this video. I'm a relatively new Medicare Broker, only 7 months in, and found this video, after watching all the way through, to be one that I am saving and studying and that I will actually use in presentations exactly as you presented it. This is an absolutely phenomenal video! I'm so glad I subscribed to your channel a few months ago!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyE4sstjquSQCLZcqV4AaABAq>

"Good basic coverage of Medicare and supplement plans. Not too tough to understand when I went on the Medicare website 3 years ago and also watched a few of your and other independent insurance broker's videos. When looking at the Advantage plans I noticed the variations in costs based on covered services, and by the time I found a few plans with the coverage I was comfortable with they were as expensive as regular Medicare with a supplement plan and a Part D plan. Since retirement is kind of a 'spend your accumulated savings/wealth on what benefits you' I decided to spend a bit extra on regular Medicare plan, a supplement, and Part D, and I'm happy with it. I also have a separate dental & vision plan (the Advantage dental and vision is a joke!). Cheers."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgyJgBRgrCnwTLEcTRV4AaABAq>

"My agent of 8 years was surprised when I told him my plan was ending and I was now eligible to buy a medigap plan. He said he would send me some plans to review, but he never did, and did not return my messages. Also, I called an agent I found online and he was so very helpful and nice, but when I explained I had been on Advantage for 8 years, he said oh, in that case, agents won't work with you, they won't get paid. He said I have to call each company to purchase the plan myself. Very strange...it sounds as if the companies are being compensated to take on "Advantage Returners" with the commission normally paid to agents..."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxCOhpK38o-jmdlJN4AaABAq.AOs_MoBrGwvAPdBK7fuYgn

"Yes, you can get more of a catastrophic plan off the marketplace. It cut my premiums in half when I switch over a year ago \$1550 down to \$750 ish for a family of 3 monthly. They basically check prescription records for approval (so you need to be semi healthy to get approved) but if you can get approved it should cut your payments way down. I'm guessing you're talking about \$1000 per check every 2 weeks and hopefully not \$4000 a month because that would be crazy. I got a United Healthcare PPO with a \$3,000 max out of pocket per person. The broker I used was My Private Health Insurance. Try that"

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wggh2p/can_i_make_my_healthcare_any_more_affordable/pa2c5i5/

"A few years ago I talked to an agent about an advantage plan. Yeah, they paid my premium, but if I went into the hospital for anything, the total cost for the first 2 or 3 days was out of my pocket before they paid anything at all. I told them to forget it. I got a part D drug plan through Humana, called the Walmart plan. It just went up to \$22.70 a month, but it's the cheapest drug plan I could find, and it has good coverage, at least for my needs."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugzj4-m97h3tZJQGwy94AaABAq>

YouTube channels and seminars · 42 documents

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"I was enrolled very briefly in an advantage plan. I was in between an emergency appendectomy and a scheduled cataract surgery. I was advised by the doctors and medical staff that an advantage plan would make it harder to get services covered and I would have to pay more out of pocket. I dropped the advantage plan like a hot potato! I was in no position to pay out extra cash as I'm on disability. I'm glad I found a couple of videos on this matter. Makes me feel more confident in my Medicare and Medicaid programs. Thank you for posting this!



— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwpJ9tT2yIndb6B0sV4AaABAg>

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMP4AaABAg>

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>

"I've been researching Medicare for the past few months as I am getting ready to have to make some decisions.. I found this video very helpful and informative... I have been so stressed as I don't want to make the wrong decision. This was a great overview and just helped calm my mind a bit. Nothing is easy or straight forward for sure...Thank You!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1lpLq6moM&lc=UgzdEe01DRkZ7syX6od4AaABAg>

"Thank you for the fantastic and super helpful video! I'm currently in my initial enrollment for Medicare and I have had multiple conversations regarding Advantage vs Supplemental. You really helped me understand that 1) Advantage isn't a villain or a wild boar ;-) and 2) there are pluses and minuses to both. Your delivery is succinct, on point, and appreciated. I'm so glad I found your channel and look forward to more of your insightful videos."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugxmdaeaj3vmGOtzfbFd4AaABAg>

"Sunburn - What an incredibly great and needed video! I must admit, as you alluded to towards the end of this video, I came into this video, after reading the title, full of fury and anger yet curiosity about what would be in this video. I'm a relatively new Medicare Broker, only 7 months in, and found this video, after watching all the way through, to be one that I am saving and studying and that I will actually use in presentations exactly as you presented it. This is an absolutely phenomenal video! I'm so glad I subscribed to your channel a few months ago!"

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"I have to make a decision like "today". I am on disability and barely have money to pay my regular bills. I guess advantage plans are not for me. I am 52 and pretty healthy. I haven't been sick in over 22 years. I tried to do the research and found these videos. They helped to realize that i am too poor to afford ANY coverage that will actually help me. No advantage plans and supplement plans are almost as bad for OKLAHOMA. I don't know what TF to do.."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgzsY_cID1lv9rIDTdI4AaABAg

"Good basic coverage of Medicare and supplement plans. Not too tough to understand when I went on the Medicare website 3 years ago and also watched a few of your and other independent insurance broker's videos. When looking at the Advantage plans I noticed the variations in costs based on covered services, and by the time I found a few plans with the coverage I was comfortable with they were as expensive as regular Medicare with a supplement plan and a Part D plan. Since retirement is kind of a 'spend your accumulated savings/wealth on what benefits you' I decided to spend a bit extra on regular Medicare plan, a supplement, and Part D, and I'm happy with it. I also have a separate dental & vision plan (the Advantage dental and vision is a joke!). Cheers."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgyJgBRgrCnwTLEcTRV4AaABAg>

"Thank you for the great info . I will be 65 yr old this June and from your video I found some of the answers that I have been looking for ! It is truly a great help."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgyoizKiH9Gf0Kd8bcZ4AaABAg>

"Back when I retired I found selecting a MediCare insurance plan the most complex and confusing project I had ever undertaken! I spent endless hours reading all the info and most often felt that the more I studied the less I understood. Finally in desperation I opted to receive counseling from a volunteer organization. Imagine my horror when the councilor told me that I already knew more than he did about Medicare options! I finally sought help from a Medicare broker like yourself who heartily recommended that my wife and I opt for a Medicare Advantage plan. At that time I suffered from Type 1 diabetes, Rheumatoid Arthritis, Hypothyroidism and several other chronic illnesses. Watching your video today made painfully clear that I was given bad advice and clearly as I am currently 76 years old my future does not look bright on an Advantage plan! Up until now I thought that at the beginning of every year you could switch the type of plan you were on. From what you say in this video given my various ailments I am now stuck forever in my Advantage plan and it will probably cost me a fortune. Is there any way whatever for me to switch over to a traditional Medicare plan? Also my wife is in good health at age 75 should she switch from her Advantage plan before it's too late? Thank you for your wonderful , highly detailed videos...I just wish I'd known about them when I first signed up for Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugwjdi9kKIGbrstxXQ54AaABAq>

"Another great video, I have watched so many and have learned so much. I contacted Medigap Seminars and received my first quote this fall. I made a phone appointment with Vondrea and she was so helpful. Because I had watched so many videos I felt like an informed consumer. Vondrea answered my questions and helped me through the process. I said "are you going to be my girl, the one I ask for to answer my questions?" She said yes and I have been very happy to have her support and knowledge throughout the process. Matthew you do a great job with your videos and Vondrea is excellent at explaining and helping people like me through the process! I have plan N and I am very happy with it. I would highly recommend Medigap Seminars to anyone that is contemplating medicare coverage."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugw0YtiYtIrl7PSseeB4AaABAq>

Employer or retiree plan / HR · 31 documents

"Anecdote: I switched from my employer insurance plan to medicare advantage plan from the same insurer when I turned 65 15 years ago. My bills have been small until this year. My primary detected that I had a heart murmur. The results is an echo to verify the murmur, and angiogram to tell if I could have a TAVR. Followed by a TAVR procedure. I was in the 30% of patients that needed a pacemaker. 2 more echos and 2 CT scans. 9 days in the hospital, 5 for the TAVR mostly because my platelets "crashed". After release, my pulse rate dropped so it was to the ER with what turned out to be a Heart Block necessitating the pacemaker. 4 more days in the hospital with an accompanying ambulance from the ER to the Cardiac unit. I still have 11 days of zero cost in the hospital this year. After 20 days, it will be \$100 / day for an additional 80 days. I have zero copays for doctors and specialists. Also zero for labs and x-rays. I just got my August statement for the year. The hospital billed approx \$300,000 and the insurer agreed to a little more than \$100,000. My costs were \$30 copay for the 2 CT scans. I did have to pay for parking for my wife. My meds accounting will come in a few days but most of my meds are zero copay with a few \$5 copays. In addition to the medicare premium, I pay zero premium for the advantage plan. I guess my non-profit HMO is a bargain. I must emphasize that it's a NON-PROFIT."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 25 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=Ugxwqe13wFaaz_XOged4AaABAq

"I am still working for a large company but chose to sign up for traditional Medicare during open enrollment as I get much better coverage than my 80/20 employer PPO plan for the same price. I don't have the health insurance deduction pre-tax so while I did see an increase in my paycheck, I am also paying a slightly higher amount in tax."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgzXSahV7erUznWYmlN4AaABAg>

"I wish I had educated myself when I turned 65. I chose to stay with my employers retiree health plan which we pay ourselves. This year the price has jumped dramatically and I am looking at marketplace. It looks like I missed out on medigap because I know I would now be turned down if underwritten. I could stay with my employers plan and if they discontinued it I could get medigap, but leaving voluntarily my only option is advantage. I will save 4000 a year by choosing advantage but fear the authorizations/denial process."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyNq-I5E9DgaRdfDEN4AaABAg>

"Very good advise. I recently switched from a supplemental plan to a medicare advantage plan sponsored by my previous employer. The reasons I switched are simple, the company sponsored Advantage plan was cheaper, it is a PPO and not an HMO and the prescription drug part of the advantage plan is almost identical to the AARP supplemental drug plan I was on. So far I have been very pleased with my PPO Advantage plan. I can still see all my doctors without pre-approval and it pays without dispute, so far. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABAg>

"We were on COBRA when George turned 65 and he had to sign up at 65, a few months after he got a permanent job. I didn't sign up when I turned 65, when I found out I could be penalized for not signing up at 65, I called the SSA told the the SS worker why I didn't sign up for Medicare, she told me what form I needed and to have George's HR Department fill out their part. I liked having dual medical coverage, no co-pay for prescriptions and Dr.' the most we paid while on medical from work and Medicare was 8 cents for a prescription to get ready for a test."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgyqlQkmWCg0hfEdEiV4AaABAg>

"Thank you, Stephanie. Last September I turned 65, had no idea where to start, and your videos helped me a lot. I don't collect social security yet, have health insurance from my wife's employer and applied for Medicare part "A" only. When my wife retires we both will need help to make a wise decision. My guess is that you can help with that regardless of the state we live in. Is it correct?"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgzPyjkNGMyxYcNMzcl4AaABAg>

"The last 5 years I worked before actually retiring I had to provide my own health insurance the first year where I worked. I used the subsidies like you and paid approximately what you are. In my case it was 180 dollars per month since I'm single. I was earning 15 dollars an hour. I was working 2 jobs. I also had really cheap places to live. We were unionized too thank goodness. When the year was up I got the union healthcare for \$5 a week plus I was on part a of Medicare. The employer had a huge amount of employees so you can do what I'm talking about. I am a retired paralegal and nurse. In addition I have vision problems that caused me to have cataract issues. I had to have them removed from both eyes in my late 50s. I also went completely blind in both eyes for 6 weeks. Some vision came back in 1 eye. I was disqualified from disability because 1 eye functions pretty well. At any rate my vision problems are considered a medical condition. The good news is my doctor tells me my condition has stabilized and I now qualify for low vision benefits. Most of those I would have to pay for out of pocket so I just go along the best I can with what I have. I'm allowed to drive and restrict myself to daytime driving. I go to discount eyeglass providers and pay about 50% less than I would if I went to my doctor for eyeglasses. When I retired I went from health insurance plus pt A Medicare to Medicare and a high deductible medigap plan. I was able to keep health insurance plus pt A Medicare until 67 because my store had a huge amount of employees and had somewhat decent health insurance thru the union. Because of this loophole I was entitled to keep my \$5 dollar a week health insurance until I retired at 67. I am now 73. My retirement age was 66. I eventually added dental insurance I figure if I need implants I can be a dental tourist and get them done abroad if I need to. So far my blood pressure has come down into the normal range now that I'm not working as well. And I've not had to take any medication for my blood pressure. Yay! I'm just taking care of myself. Now mind you this is also because I'm exceptionally frugal. I live on 21k and save 5k a year. Furthermore at the age of 72 I came into a nestegg of 325k from 2 individuals in my life and my own savings. My family left me the 325k. I've not had to touch a nickel of it. And since the 21k is technically my only source of income I owe zero dollars in taxes. Bonus for me 😊😊 . I pay 825 dollars a month in rent and have a small 20 pound dog. My best friend bought my house outright and rents it to me. It is 850 sq ft of heaven. I live in a home built in 1950 that is constantly undergoing renovations. And I live a very simple modest lifestyle. My neighborhood is a working class neighborhood in a downtown area. I live in a wealthy county outside a large metropolitan city. My city has a population of 100k approximately. It is peaceful and quiet. Yes when you are pricing out your healthcare check out both federal and state laws."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugz860t4k73bl5uGt_x4AaABAg_AazTRSBtvmuAazs91Tvqjh

"Unknowingly Had Other Health Insurance For One Month I feel like I'm in a bit of a pickle. Full story here, tl;dr at end: Last year I aged out of my parents' insurance (TRICARE) and began to pay out of pocket for a separate "Young Adult" plan they offer. I have been using this insurance regularly to help diagnose and treat a few different issues, and up until now there hasn't been much issue. A few weeks ago one of my providers urgently reached out to me because TRICARE began denying claims and trying to recoup payments with the belief that I had an undeclared OHI. After some conflicting phone calls, I found out they thought I had Aetna - which my Father (same name and address) has under his employer, but which I am NOT covered under - so I asked TRICARE to remove it and they said "sure thing, everything should be cleaned up after ten business days" (paraphrasing of course). The bad coverage showed up in the portal, but it was lacking an expiration date while saying it was expired, *and* some of the phone agents couldn't see it, so it looked like a bug or an erroneous record they'd need to clean up. Problem solved. In the meantime, my various providers kept receiving letters about recoupment and thus kept reaching out to me, and I'd tell them it was taken care of already and that I just needed to wait those ten days. Well... one of those providers dug deeper and reached out to Aetna directly, who told them that I had coverage from January to end of June (!). I discovered that my Dad had accidentally enrolled the family in Aetna in January when he had meant to enroll one family member in a dental plan; when he got billed for it in February, he realized his mistake and canceled the plan. I seem to have been automatically included in that plan because I am under 26, and Aetna seemingly didn't officially end my coverage until end of June. So now I have no idea how to navigate this. I don't know the terms of the Aetna coverage, who I would talk to on their end, or if they'll accept the claims, *or* if they'll try to bill my Dad for March-June if I DO try to file with them. And now that I do know I technically had Aetna, I don't know if TRICARE will honor the claims from that period, which is particularly frustrating to potentially have to pay for a mistake that I did not make and did not know about until a few weeks ago (if the roles were reversed, TRICARE almost assuredly would not refund me for the months I paid them). If neither plan pays, then by my estimate I might owe one provider almost \$2600 for service from March-June. If Aetna is able to correct their date to match end of coverage with my Dad terminating the plan it would be *very* convenient, but I have no idea if this is possible or who I would talk to. Any ideas? Am I overthinking it? tl;dr Dad accidentally enrolled me in one month of his work insurance, which did not officially end for six months, and now my primary insurance wants to recoup as many claims as possible"

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wm5b4u/unknowingly_had_other_health_insurance_for_one/

"My wife is on the group plan for retirees with Medicare which mimics my retiree plan without Medicare. We met with an advisor and yes the original plan with a part D may have been cheaper we decided to stay on our large group retiree plan. As we were leaving the advisor did say a group plan is a great way to go."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgxMpGQzqopwW1qr39x4AaABAq.9xB53XTV_4oAA-QLHZoZhH

"We were Just (3 days ago) switched from Medicare to Medicare Blue AAdvantage by my wife's former employer (a county). Your video sounds fairly gloomy but does not mention the impact of another layer of coverage (i.e., our Tricare For Life coverage). Thanks"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=Ugw_EbjVOmYpOxNvQld4AaABAq

"This was an excellent discussion and explanation of the nuances of this topic. I am sure this will be very helpful for your listeners in this position. Thankfully I was able to take advantage of an employer offered plan after I retired at 62 until we got on Medicare. I appreciate all your excellent videos Eric, thank you. Have a blessed weekend and I'll see you on the next one. Larry, central Valley, Ca."

— YouTube · Healthcare Before 65: In-Depth ACA vs. Roth Conversion Analysis · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gUjrNm-VLF8&lc=Ugz9OpEjF5WBFP9LcTB4AaABAg>

"So, I was enrolled in Parts A and B at 65, and an Advantage plan with Part D, but then went off B and the Advantage plan because I had access to a creditable employer plan. Now that job is ending so I need to enroll in Part B again (without penalty). Do I get another special enrollment period in which I can join a Medigap plan rather than an Advantage Plan?"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgyKCT9_5eCBLDv6cvl4AaABAg

AARP · 16 documents

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdlDwf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg

"I had to learn all of this in my late 20s and early 30s. My parents were in their 60's when I was in my late 20s. I am also a CPA, and turned to me for advice. I knew nothing about this. Also, Medicare Advantage programs were almost nonexistent. I got my parents enrolled in AARP Medicare Supplement. As Medicare Advantage programs became more prevalent and my parents would get invited to a free lunch or early dinner, I would get asked for advice. I did research, and I told stay with the Supplement. Financially they could handle the premium. They never had a medical bill and went to a specialist when they needed to. There was never an issue with any medical bill. My parents passed away at 93. I was glad they stayed with the Supplement. I am now retired, at 62, and will do the same."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 77 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxKUc1bXwM24WrrWiR4AaABAg>

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"Thanks, think I've completed everything and will be on medicare on wednesday I signed up for trad Medicare A + B . I signed up AARP/UHC for part D because all my drugs are covered in their formulary. I signed up State Farm for Medigap because I didn't need a fitness pass. I cancelled my marketplace insurance effective Sept 30 with all the above plans going into effect Oct 1. I spoke to my pharmacist and picked up enough refills to last through the next month in case of any hiccup. I confirmed all my doctors will take Medicare and electronically upload my Medicare card into their patient portals. I will need to sign up for part D plan (or stay with AARP/UHC) for Jan 2026. I am in CA and can switch part G providers without underwriting on my birthday month next year. This has all been a huge amount of anxiety, hope I did everything right, and sincerely have no idea how I would have done without all your advice."

— r/medicare · 47 upvotes · None

"We went with original Medicare + Medigap Plan "N" + Part "D" Prescription + AARP Delta Dental PPO. No regrets, whatsoever.... Thank you Stephanie & your team!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211IpLq6moM&lc=UgxRN81uNI8NB_BZ0f14AaABAg

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMP4AaABAg>

"I am so very happy I went with AARP UHC Advantage Plan. Most of my drugs are completely free, zero cost to see my PCP, free Y membership, vision and dental coverage. Going with a supplement Plan or straight Medicare would cost my wife and I so much more than \$19 a month."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyW90LDk8lyNz2tgB14AaABAg>

"Not sure where you are but I got a letter that my Medicare Advantage - AARP thru UHC is not going to be available next year so good luck. I had to switch to a regular supplement plan costing 5x as much for not as much coverage plus I still have to buy Rx, Dental & Vision."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzhW03ErdB2Dq8ZcXI4AaABAg.AOMNMOdPETqAOQeXC3efoG>

"Very good advise. I recently switched from a supplemental plan to a medicare advantage plan sponsored by my previous employer. The reasons I switched are simple, the company sponsored Advantage plan was cheaper, it is a PPO and not an HMO and the prescription drug part of the advantage plan is almost identical to the AARP supplemental drug plan I was on. So far I have been very pleased with my PPO Advantage plan. I can still see all my doctors without pre-approval and it pays without dispute, so far. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABAg>

"Actually I just turned 65 and went with AARP United healthcare PPO. I like having dental coverage (plus \$750 towards cavities, caps, etc.) Most drugs are covered free, eye exams (\$150 towards eyeglasses, contacts), \$50 every quarter for vitamins, health products, etc, free gym membership, all for \$0 per month. My doctor and dentist were on the list. \$0 to visit primary doctor, \$30 for specialist. Doubt I'll ever hit the \$5,000 out of pocket limit unless I have cancer or something bad, but I definitely know I'll be putting out \$240 a month for gap insurance and \$1,000 a year for dental and \$40 a month for part d, if I go with traditional Medicare insurance."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyskpeYCd9tIUgclPt4AaABAg>

"When I retired in 2003 I asked my drs billing clerk what is the best plan she told me AARP I picked plan F I've had two knee replacements with rehab for a week following in a beautiful facility no bill had foot surgery no bill recently week in hospital and week of in house rehab again no bill including ambulances in between all normal dr visits x rays etc I make my payment once a month and yes it goes up every year but as you get older you need the security of your plan. I also use their drug plan optim x same good service shipped next day delivery no bills unless you get 3rd tier or higher drugs my plan isn't available anymore so go for plan G"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugz9u00vrfogLYM9Hph4AaABAg>

TV ads and people who called them · 8 documents

"16:58 Yep, this happened to me. I was seeing an endocrinologist who was about 30 minutes away, and as I can't drive I was getting transport from my advantage plan, only one day the insurance decided that while the doctor was still in-network, the building his *office* was in wasn't anymore so I couldn't get rides to that office anymore. Well, I switched over to doing telehealth with them and that was fine, but then one day a month before my next appointment my insurance called me up to tell me the doctor was no longer in-network either. The next closest in-network endocrinologist (it turns out it's really hard to find ones that do telehealth) is an hour and a half away. Mind you, there are 3 endocrinologists in the town I live in, less than 3 miles from me, but none of them are in-network so I'd have to see them out of pocket, which you might imagine isn't practical for a disabled person on medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyeCcGVi9213jttCkZ4AaABAg>

"I thought it was obvious it was called medicare advantage because it takes advantage of you"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugx4mqxmjKsNbzkXwMN4AaABAg>

"I don't know what number you called because I called and made a reservation for a call back to register and when they called me back they never even mentioned advantage plans. They just verified that I was eligible and signed me up for Part A and B and I got them to set up automatic billing. It sounds like you didn't call the actual Medicare number."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwspuuSLr0lwSAb2np4AaABAg.AOTq8utKNuzAQfxw-oc20k

"Well I have a question for you OK they put me on Medicare when I was 55 I was still at the American United healthcare at the hospital that was my primary insurance when I went to the doctor so Mary Kay I've been getting money for me all these years taking out \$144 out of my money and telling me I have so much for dinner I need it now can you help me get it that's about it no OK the people since I've been using America the best since 2018 no they call me every time it's time to come get your teeth cleaned and asked me why because I wanted they want to get the money from you all I know you're gonna be amazed at the point where now sorry I finally put out anywhere you go you're nice lady I finally told the people I'm trying to just come to get my teeth clean I need my breeze don't fit no more OK cause I had leukemia pool so the reason fit normal and I need help OK I talk to the lady she's 50 years old she's a top Medicare person as I can get away at the moment and she told me to talk to the governor because I want him as it is the bottom line OK God bless you are you seem like a real nice lady but I miss you OK I have a BCND I called Medicare they give me a ride to the doctor they give me a ride to get my test I can finish the call me baby we're gonna do all the mamas gonna check for you if you ever want to wear a dress I want to say the mood for my teeth tell my want to eat it's so busy worry about my body it's going to get my quarterly check: Teknowledge the Pap smear because I have a 667578 OK but I don't want it is him so anyway can you help me get my money back with you we got a call the governor I talk to the medical lady she's 58 you gonna see what I feel but she said she had a complaint from people like talking to her she enjoy talking to me because I want to see what y'all got to face your fear OK God bless you pray for your help with Jesus is with 80 will you have reached we have you tell Ray but I have United Health Care supplement ABC D and I go for chronic and well now that's one way to get one of her chronic I don't know if they're on the way I say I will now where is the I got the best where is the damn list a problem tell the governor now they say so I got to talk to I want to money went OK tell him tell him one day it is I need 3000 I paid 15 is that for you OK with the 2000s yeah yeah I work with that word before I need 800 800 did I need 35 did you pay 50 and I paid 1500 for doing this why is he into the network OK God bless you and what is America they not bring up my day as she gets with me back to them OK but still they paid 2500 and why my previous 2000 talk to the governor they say the governor of your state country whatever I don't care where he got it that's all I wanna know where my money yet because I'm waiting to have a business charge me until I need it now but do you date "I feel very reasonable pretty good we're at Marti goes to her let you know what I do you know Heb has an omelette with raisins and ate my egg my day is the cosmetic on my two front teeth he's the want to tell me that they pull my God I'm open for that phrase go out for a ride my teeth and he made me go to pretty cosmetic tea anyway I didn't have medication and I pay for everything made my insurance to hear everything glad to talk to the right to talk if she's smart she's happy she's not ready I want to talk to us about a mile insurance lady she's nice to the neighbor silver now my doctor said that he had a pretend me to describe anything or whatever I'm not even sick but I guess he really is he's a good doctor and I like to Denises it's a big deal between the dogs and Denist you know that I'm a nurse and no no the doctor gonna take care you say you do then he get his money he doesn't yell at you any money I don't get my money OK God bless you oh she's not really she's nice to do OK"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7S-VZXiV>

"I am 65 years old and I'm kind of surprised i am still alive. I am going to change my Part D as they won't cover certain medications but I am happy with my Medicare and Plan G. I have three dogs and a pet centipede. He loves spiders 🕷️ he thinks they're delicious 😊 I was in the process of moving from Michigan to West Virginia. I got a "cold call" from an agent whilst I was heavily involved in the hassle of moving and packing. I attempted to blow her off but she gave me great advice. Unfortunately I didn't accurately get her name and number, but I am happy."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugw_sXiwlunmlpNfLd4AaABAg

"My husband is seeing a VA doctor but when he got sick and went to the hospital the VA didnt pay for any of it even tho the VA doctor told him to go to the hospital. I checked on the VA website. VA said if you have an Advantage or other health plan then they wont pay anything. The VA hospital is over 2 hours away so couldnt go there in an emergency and they wouldnt transport him. I am considering just turning off his advantage plan so the VA covers his next hospital stay, when I called Medicare and said this they thot that was a terrible idea."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=Ugy89EFB3r9Q4KlqEop4AaABAg.9OE1a3Ewvrh9V7laB3szCy>

"I want to let everyone know that I called Medicare to see if they have that allowance where you can get toothpaste shampoo etc she said Aetna does so I said wow ok could you believe she said the allowance Aetna has is 20 dollars every 3 months are yiu kidding me so I hanged up and before I did I told her they can keep that money from Massachusetts"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwLz7XcCsleXo-Nm9l4AaABAg>

"I just got my Medicare quarterly and Sunshine Senior Solutions made 4 claims on my Medicare amounting to \$26,997. I called Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgzA4BJyqjFk8w1J8Rp4AaABAg>

Friends, family, neighbors · 8 documents

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAg>

"The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbJQyLYRyCYv54AaABAg.AXFFtsLMytJAZXHpUtXFuU>

"I am beginning to wonder about my BCBS advantage plan. When I got medicare I had no health issues and the sales person said this would be the best for me so I got it. On the second year of having the plan I got stage 1 breast cancer. They pretty much covered everything except they disagreed with my doctor on the number of radiation treatments. They said for my stage of breast cancer I only needed 4 instead of 5 or 6 treatments. So I got the 4. Turns out so far they paid all but 6000+ of my treatment. When I had to have another biopsy done they only covered \$208. of the procedure. They are both still pending and I'm worried I am going to be stuck with the bill totalling over \$10,000."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugynw5nW7W69BUVLOqV4AaABAg>

"Well I have a question for you OK they put me on Medicare when I was 55 I was still at the American United healthcare at the hospital that was my primary insurance when I went to the doctor so Mary Kay I've been getting money for me all these years taking out \$144 out of my money and telling me I have so much for dinner I need it now can you help me get it that's about it no OK the people since I've been using America the best since 2018 no they call me every time it's time to come get your teeth cleaned and asked me why because I wanted they want to get the money from you all I know you're gonna be amazed at the point where now sorry I finally put out anywhere you go you're nice lady I finally told the people I'm trying to just come to get my teeth clean I need my breeze don't fit no more OK cause I had leukemia pool so the reason fit normal and I need help OK I talk to the lady she's 50 years old she's a top Medicare person as I can get away at the moment and she told me to talk to the governor because I want him as it is the bottom line OK God bless you are you seem like a real nice lady but I miss you OK I have a BCND I called Medicare they give me a ride to the doctor they give me a ride to get my test I can finish the call me baby we're gonna do all the mamas gonna check for you if you ever want to wear a dress I want to say the mood for my teeth tell my want to eat it's so busy worry about my body it's going to get my quarterly check: Teknowledge the Pap smear because I have a 667578 OK but I don't want it is him so anyway can you help me get my money back with you we got a call the governor I talk to the medical lady she's 58 you gonna see what I feel but she said she had a complaint from people like talking to her she enjoy talking to me because I want to see what y'all got to face your fear OK God bless you pray for your help with Jesus is with 80 will you have reached we have you tell Ray but I have United Health Care supplement ABC D and I go for chronic and well now that's one way to get one of her chronic I don't know if they're on the way I say I will now where is the I got the best where is the damn list a problem tell the governor now they say so I got to talk to I want to money went OK tell him tell him one day it is I need 3000 I paid 15 is that for you OK with the 2000s yeah yeah I work with that word before I need 800 800 did I need 35 did you pay 50 and I paid 1500 for doing this why is he into the network OK God bless you and what is America they not bring up my day as she gets with me back to them OK but still they paid 2500 and why my previous 2000 talk to the governor they say the governor of your state country whatever I don't care where he got it that's all I wanna know where my money yet because I'm waiting to have a business charge me until I need it now but do you date "I feel very reasonable pretty good we're at Marti goes to her let you know what I do you know Heb has an omelette with raisins and ate my egg my day is the cosmetic on my two front teeth he's the want to tell me that they pull my God I'm open for that phrase go out for a ride my teeth and he made me go to pretty cosmetic tea anyway I didn't have medication and I pay for everything made my insurance to hear everything glad to talk to the right to talk if she's smart she's happy she's not ready I want to talk to us about a mile insurance lady she's nice to the neighbor silver now my doctor said that he had a pretend me to describe anything or whatever I'm not even sick but I guess he really is he's a good doctor and I like to Denises it's a big deal between the dogs and Denist you know that I'm a nurse and no no the doctor gonna take care you say you do then he get his money he doesn't yell at you any money I don't get my money OK God bless you oh she's not really she's nice to do OK"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7S-VZXiV>

"That's all a lied I live in brockton Massachusetts and I spoke to Medicare a year ago and they said I couldn't get the allowance card to buy groceries pay bills well today it's october 23 spoke to 4 people and they transfer me to an agent I told each one all I want to know if where I live gives out allowance card the last one said they have it but it's only 35 dollars so I git mad and told him why waste my time again just hear that I don't qualify for 350 dollars allowance card I cursed them out because the 4 person I spoke to I told him all I want to know is about the allowance card he said let me look into this and what happened I can't get allowance I told him I wasted my time I knew it you all liars waste peoples time I said please put in the computer that in brockton Massachusetts they don't get allowance card and I hanged I feel bad for people that are 70 80s and they call im so pist off right now it was ridiculous and he kept saying let me see what I can do all that for nothing why do Medicare agents waste people's time im 59 yrs old"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzN9aXOwEERuMQimIB4AaABAg>

"My brother in law just had nine fusions in his back. He has Medicare advantage through CIGNA I think it's called CIGNA preferred my sister said all they have had to pay for his surgery which included five days in intensive care and a total of 13 days in the hospital, is \$113. They have no deductible no monthly premium and \$113 is all they had to pay for his surgery I am very confused can you explain how this works? Thank you for your time."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgykzZjKz6ivau3jJnl4AaABAg>

"I check for visits and what was billed. Got charged for a few hundred catheters last time. Never needed one, called Medicare because I wasn't sure if that was a billing error or not. Person I talked to said it is fraud and they have been receiving a lot of these."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1t16245/most_people_throw_away_their_medicare_summary/ojf8oad/

"I have Medicare A&B and I have Tricare for life I actually spoke to an honest Medicare Advantage salesperson and he told me to stay with what I had and never change it"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw8rxnCeiyAUN4TMkt4AaABAg>

SHIP counselors · 5 documents

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"Yes, I am aware of that, thank you. And thank you for your videos. My state allows me to switch to any other plan except Plan A (no longer sold?) and Plan F (don't qualify for that one due to my age) , so I can switch to a Plan N later, if that makes more sense. Right now, this is the path that works best for me. I have done extensive research and also discussed and got assistance from my SHIP representative. I had to get some Medigap plan within the bounds of my SEP (because, although my state - not NY btw- has better guaranteed issue rights than many others, I am still bound by the SEP timing or I lose guaranteed issue. HD-G premiums in my state are lower than Plan N, I am healthy right now (thank God!) and have few doctor's visits, so this seemed like a good choice for me. Am I taking advantage of the system, well, just doing what is right for me. I wish everyone the best. This is much more convoluted than it should be, and as I mentioned, your videos are very helpful in finding the way through the maze."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyYhExgJdVDH1dnNpp4AaABAg.9yNfosgcxRg9zWuaSDKqCd>

"Well im on disability need a lung transplant do was on Medicaid w va im be 65 in this April i applied for to see if i could get both so i applied for ship program i make 1395 minus the 175 the state put me in a d plan though the state thou the plan with united healthcare 0 cost but like 11buck a script at200a yr is that deductible,4(waiting on the states decision i like to stay in original medcare dont need eye teeth gym a letter said from ssi i qualify csu help me plesse likw yo keep advantage plans tout of my needs"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgxY_xmBnl6pYdpht054AaABAg

"Your right i got on a ship program pays my 175 got a plan d 4.50 to 11.dollars like 200 a yr my medgap is 125 but they take part b out regardless so its like less than the 175 and im in reg original medcare with the best benefits"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyoIKt33N2vq3KppCR4AaABAg>

"I just got my Medicare quarterly and Sunshine Senior Solutions made 4 claims on my Medicare amounting to \$26,997. I called Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgzA4BJyqjFk8w1J8Rp4AaABAg>

Doctor's office · 4 documents

"Well I have a question for you OK they put me on Medicare when I was 55 I was still at the American United healthcare at the hospital that was my primary insurance when I went to the doctor so Mary Kay I've been getting money for me all these years taking out \$144 out of my money and telling me I have so much for dinner I need it now can you help me get it that's about it no OK the people since I've been using America the best since 2018 no they call me every time it's time to come get your teeth cleaned and asked me why because I wanted they want to get the money from you all I know you're gonna be amazed at the point where now sorry I finally put out anywhere you go you're nice lady I finally told the people I'm trying to just come to get my teeth clean I need my breeze don't fit no more OK cause I had leukemia pool so the reason fit normal and I need help OK I talk to the lady she's 50 years old she's a top Medicare person as I can get away at the moment and she told me to talk to the governor because I want him as it is the bottom line OK God bless you are you seem like a real nice lady but I miss you OK I have a BCND I called Medicare they give me a ride to the doctor they give me a ride to get my test I can finish the call me baby we're gonna do all the mamas gonna check for you if you ever want to wear a dress I want to say the mood for my teeth tell my want to eat it's so busy worry about my body it's going to get my quarterly check: Teknowledge the Pap smear because I have a 667578 OK but I don't want it is him so anyway can you help me get my money back with you we got a call the governor I talk to the medical lady she's 58 you gonna see what I feel but she said she had a complaint from people like talking to her she enjoy talking to me because I want to see what y'all got to face your fear OK God bless you pray for your help with Jesus is with 80 will you have reached we have you tell Ray but I have United Health Care supplement ABC D and I go for chronic and well now that's one way to get one of her chronic I don't know if they're on the way I say I will now where is the I got the best where is the damn list a problem tell the governor now they say so I got to talk to I want to money went OK tell him tell him one day it is I need 3000 I paid 15 is that for you OK with the 2000s yeah yeah I work with that word before I need 800 800 did I need 35 did you pay 50 and I paid 1500 for doing this why is he into the network OK God bless you and what is America they not bring up my day as she gets with me back to them OK but still they paid 2500 and why my previous 2000 talk to the governor they say the governor of your state country whatever I don't care where he got it that's all I wanna know where my money yet because I'm waiting to have a business charge me until I need it now but do you date "I feel very reasonable pretty good we're at Marti goes to her let you know what I do you know Heb has an omelette with raisins and ate my egg my day is the cosmetic on my two front teeth he's the want to tell me that they pull my God I'm open for that phrase go out for a ride my teeth and he made me go to pretty cosmetic tea anyway I didn't have medication and I pay for everything made my insurance to hear everything glad to talk to the right to talk if she's smart she's happy she's not ready I want to talk to us about a mile insurance lady she's nice to the neighbor silver now my doctor said that he had a pretend me to describe anything or whatever I'm not even sick but I guess he really is he's a good doctor and I like to Denises it's a big deal between the dogs and Denist you know that I'm a nurse and no no the doctor gonna take care you say you do then he get his money he doesn't yell at you any money I don't get my money OK God bless you oh she's not really she's nice to do OK"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7S-VZXiV>

"It's not that black and white. I have Medicare advantage with Kaiser and considering my options (over 65, have Multiple Sclerosis) it is quite good. There are two things I especially like: 1) No administrative take backs on procedures. When I first got MS I had a PPO and my doctor said to get expensive tests like MRIs. I would and then some a-hole bureaucrat would refuse it. For the only time in my life I was looking like a credit risk because I had unpaid bills for tens of thousands of dollars. God that was hell. Besides dealing the the trauma of no longer being able to walk normally, I had to deal with all the anxiety caused by administrative a-holes. 2) The doctors are in general quite good. Not just in that they know what they're doing but they actually talk to me and listen rather than just putting me into a box based on a 5 minute overview of the way I filled out some form. In my experience that's unfortunately very rare in the US because a for profit system pushes doctors to be more like efficient factory workers than empathic care givers. Luckily some doctors care enough to still listen to patients. Just to be clear: I agree that the whole for profit system is BS and Medicare Advantage is an example of that. Just saying given the broken system we have, Medicare advantage can provide decent options for some people in some locations."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgyfsluT2u6E9J_AQDt4AaABAg.APD2vBaWjr3A_3BpsHg1zW

"I chose traditional medicare A&B and I also have no cost (secondary) supplemental health care coverage with my retirement which covers prescriptions and office visits. My health is very good. My doctor said I chose the right choice. She also added that if you opt to take an advantage plan, you can (never) go back to traditional medicare but if you take traditional, you can always change to an advantage plan. I personally don't want an ins company to decide what I need or don't need in my health needs based on their bottom line profits. Do you have any further advice for me or do you also think I chose correctly?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgzPqv5KeKMW0npxgW54AaABAg>

"My mother cancelled Parts B and D and then got a heart attack. I was asked to pay for her doctors office bills and medications. There was a drug she needed that was \$350/month. So I called every pharmacy to see what they charged for it. Costco charged \$30 for it while all of the rest were in the hundreds of dollars. So I joined Costco and bought it there for her until she was able to get back on Part D."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1m9w1fe/rant_just_found_out_my_95_year_old_father_doesnt/n5ajgyb/

The carrier directly (Humana, UHC, Aetna...) · 3 documents

"I signed up for Humana dental for 2026.... I signed up for Humana dental for 2026 and have regretted it ever since. When signing up in marketplace it seemed like it was the best option. They had my current dentist in-network(with no locations listed). First dentist appointment was in February, the submitted a claim and I then received a bill for almost the full amount minus \$19 and change, for an out-of-network dentist. I went to Humana's website and Dr.Lockney is still listed as in network. They have him listed in 4 locations, 3 being in network and 1 being out. Fact: Dr.Lockney only works at ONE family owned practice, he does NOT work or has ever worked at any other practice or location . I called Humana with my findings.They informed me that my information is correct and his location is out of network, no solution. As I explained again my situation they informed me they actually do not have any in network dentists in my city. They said I should file an appeal which I had already done and was denied. Customer service said they would contact Dr.Lockney to see if he would like to join their network, I ask if they would back date my claims if he did, she said "I don't know". I explained again that this is not user error and they are at fault and my claims should be paid. She again stated I should file an appeal and they will fix the misinformation on their website. By this time (August 2026) I have seen Dr.Lockney twice and my daughter once with a cost of \$840.80. I have paid Humana \$566.37 with an outstanding bill of \$161.82 = \$728.19 total YTD. So basically I will have paid \$1,568.99 for dental YTD. Humana is a total scam. They basically make up the "in network" doctors list. And never pay any of your claims with the excuse of "location". The outcome I would like to see is a full refund for all the money I have given them to be insured, pay for the dentist for my troubles and cancel. I'd like to mention I have proof of all of this. Lockney Dental (704) 324-8521 Kelley Burren 7047013087 Concord, NC Claim# 202602116380321"

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a873579330d94cb96c65de3>

"@reneeblack8940Sorry that person didn't respond to your question. Everyone I know has AARP United supplement Health Plan including myself and I'm very happy with it. My mother was stubborn and joined Humana HC which is really Medicare Advantage. Leery I called Humana to find out if they were legit medicare. They hid that they were medicare advantage plan. She had to pay co-pays, and paid huge amounts to radiology for scans. She was on a fixed income and her medical costs kept rising. To the day she died she was hounded by the radiology place to pay her bill. She was so stressed, they demanded a cc and they pulled money from her card. With a supplement you pay premiums. Whatever medicare doesn't pay, the supplement pays the rest. After my mom passed the radiology place called me many times despite telling them she passed and had no estate. I helped supplement her so she could have food. The radiology place had to eat the cost. That's what they deserve for treating an elderly person that way."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · family member helping · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugx5CVy8MAo_bxfGmzd4AaABAg.AMXLcgwE_I_ANBIXLBQ7tK

"I also had trouble finding a dentist to accept my MA plan. Then I called Aetna and asked them to find a dentist in my area that would accept my plan, and they called the dentist to explain how it works. My benefit was for a fixed amount of money, around \$2000 per year. The first year, I had to pay cash to the dentist, then file a claim. Aetna always paid it. But after that the dentist billed directly. Paid all for exams, cleanings, even deep cleanings and fillings. But then I discovered there was a tier system, so for more complicated work like crowns they would only pay a percentage of the cost, even though I had money left in my benefit amount."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwPZFcv6WpB3KEM1cl4AaABAg.AOXzQff4AvqAPd9eo0qQ5P>

Dislikes

Denied care, prior authorization, rehab cut short

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"Sunburn. My mother chose an advantage plan. She found they can deny anything they want to deny for any of no reason. They "delayed" her dental coverage until she was to frail to have the dental work done. She had colon cancer that could be treated with laparoscopic surgery my sister had to fight the insurance company to provide after care. They denied colon cancer screening after that because "she would likely die of something else first". She got another tumor that couldn't be treated with laparoscopic surgery. After the surgery the "hospitalist" repeated 8 or 9 times that because she was over 80 going forward she would only receive "palliative" care for such a major event. My brother was wisely recording the conversation and told the "hospitalist" if he mentioned "palliative" care one more time he would sue him for elder abuse. During her after care she had sores in her mouth and could barely eat. The only thing insurance would allow was a test for thrush, which came up negative so no further action. Her surgery wound wasn't healing for lack of her eating enough protein due to the sores in her mouth. She quickly ended up in hospice and I flew down and became aware of the whole situation. I asked the hospice nurse if there was a medicated mouthwash that might solve the problem and could she get me a script for it. She said yes and I went out and bought it. In one day she was eating normally. Her wound started to heal and her 30 days after care was up, insurance wouldn't pay for more even with her still unhealed surgical wound. We kids chipped in and paid. She lived on for several years. My point is with advantage care you give up all your rights under part A and B and put them in the hands of the insurance company. That is the biggest risk of all. Your experience could be great or deadly, and there's no way of knowing beforehand."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 333 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyrQ0RNoaOb4etaX-54AaABAg>

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

"As a physician, I'd highly recommend going Traditional Medicare route if you can afford it... You are >65, this is time people start to get sick. Many hospitals are dropping Medicare Advantage plans, and we CONSTANTLY see prior authorization on Advantage plans on drugs that actually matter. Not mentioning the prior auths for surgeries. It is concerning that she undersells how much denials MA plans do compared to Traditional Medicare. Life is precious, this is not an arena to go cheap as an elderly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 258 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyvKxZTQrEFv_Sdwrl4AaABAq

"I spent the last half of my career working in the billing office for a medical specialist group. I dealt with everything from private insurance, worker's compensation, medicare, medicaid, etc. By a large margin, the problems I encountered with payment denials came from Medicare Advantage plans. And most of those happened because people did not understand the rules of their plans. Thanks for the informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 232 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwMop0zRDK1CKkLhJ14AaABAq>

"United Healthcare denied my mother healthcare. I made my decision to not select a Medicare Advantage plan based on the poor care my mother received from United healthcare. Do not purchase insurance from them. They actively work to deny patient care."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 213 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgytHQMnqQ3ZiB6A5Wp4AaABAq>

"Medicare advantage is shit. In the long run, I don't know if it would've made a difference, but my uncle was 65 and on an advantage plan covered by his union, which he felt was the best option at the time because it was essentially free and he hadn't run into any problems, even with his cancer treatment. Advantage denied him a kind of Hail Mary chemo drug. He went thru appeals, was denied, and eventually got it through a manufacturer program. But all that back and forth took like, 6 months. He is no longer with us, and maybe it wouldn't have worked regardless, but there's always that, what if? As someone who works in insurance, I tried to help and encourage him to switch to regular Medicare, because this wouldn't have been a problem if he had regular Medicare. But they sell people so hard on these advantage plans, and it's absolute BS."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 203 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgwyEdLvhJXglO4cteJ4AaABAq>

"This is the ONLY unbiased YouTube on both options. This gentleman is an agent and that's very rare. I can name two, no three agencies that do nothing but flood this site with constant negative videos about Medicare Advantage Plans. The one guy always has a thumbnail with his eyes wide open and his hand over his mouth. Scare tactic, nothing more. Supplements are great, but millions of Americans have advantage plans that do what they are designed to do without issue. I personally have experience using both for more than a decade. Original Medicare should be requiring more pre-authorizations and in the coming years this will happen. The government has been getting ripped off for decades. Oh, we like cats!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 171 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxT0a_1CgP1_SKsFld4AaABAq

"As an Oncology provider for over 40 years I will tell you that there are other issues to consider which in my opinion make a G plan even more helpful. One of these issues is that G plans allow you to seek expert care outside of an Advantage plan PPO list of providers and institutions. I practice in a rural community and often send my patient to larger Comprehensive Cancer Centers around the country where they can get the best care for their unique situation. As I understand it, some Advantage plans may not pay as well in these situations. The other issue is prior approvals. If I order a diagnostic study such as a PET scan or MRI, or an IV chemotherapy medication agent, with a G plan there is no authorization process and these items will be paid for (assuming I am practicing within accepted guidelines). An Advantage plan may require a prior authorization before the test or medication can be ordered. These prior authorizations are a huge burden to providers and staff. Indeed, at many large institutions they will not spend any time on these and that means a less than ideal test or drug may need to be substituted."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 164 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=Ugyjp1bQqNodSTf4TMd4AaABAg>

"I am a nurse. I am amazed at how many people who have advantage plans actually think they have Medicare. They forget that those insurance companies are in this business to make money. There is only one way for them to do that. Pay out less than they take in. Those plans sound fabulous. However, don't get sick! Fighting for care, and still being denied is a nightmare as you mentioned. I remember a case that I was working on. The patient was threatening to stroke. They desperately needed to have a carotid surgery. The Dr was on the phone and the company would NOT give permission for this patient to have surgery that would prevent the stroke. I would never get an advantage plan. I'll pay for my own gym membership and toothpaste!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 160 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw3YwX-OW2erk9tJPN4AaABAg>

"What decisions as you near retirement are "time-sensitive"? As you near retirement (say, 65) what decisions are "time-sensitive"? We had a close call with almost being unable to get a Medicare supplement (Medigap). Was not aware you get a *one-time* 6 month window when you first get Medicare that insurance/supplement companies are *required* to allow you to enroll and cannot deny you (or charge a higher rate). Individual here was pressured to take Medicare Advantage and lost their guaranteed issue timeframe and had to go through medical underwriting and was initially denied and had to appeal to get approved. This makes me wonder, what other decisions regarding retirement are "time-sensitive" or something individuals may not think about and/or realize before it's too late?"

— r/retirement · 121 upvotes · None

"This video was so informative. My late husband was blessed to have a Supplement Plan G. Prior to beginning Medicare he began having neurological problems and was diagnosed with ALS. Thankfully we were able to receive the treatments he needed without the stress of co-pays, referrals, or pre authorizations. Instead of the healthcare process being a bear to deal with, it seemed more like leading a lamb."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 98 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxnPLA_JdSH8Od-IRF4AaABAg

"Careless eHealth employees. Took an Advantage plan with eHealth Simply in 2024. Canceled via phone call (at least 4 verified calls, Nov through Dec) to update to a Cigna Medicare Plan N. Have been paying on this plan for 6 months and was denied Cataract surgery because Medicare still lists eHealth Simply Advantage as my insurance. They failed to remove me from Medicare. Their negligence has cost me 6 months of payments to Cigna and will again need to reapply in Oct. Surgery canceled. Medicare needs a serious reform and eHealth should be penalized. Once again, seniors are at harm."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/686039989bd2e83a6d370986>

"Hate mongrel company. Hate mongrel company. Denied a job because of my Jewish last name. Not a surprise. scammy woke Cali company. Tell these bozos to take a hike if they call you!"

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6621a171d7ba26b5e33ef431>

"I spoke with an agent on 12/01/2020.... I spoke with an agent on 12/01/2020 inquiring about replacing my current Medicare Supplement Plan N, I gave her my medical history, explained my current coverage, & we completed my application online. She advised me that based on all the information available I should be able to qualify for an AARP Plan N, even though I had CML. Three days later I received an email advising me that my application had been denied without an explanation, I'm assuming that I was declined because of the CML even though that was discussed at the time of my original application, so I am being denied due to a pre-existing condition!!! Ron Canniff"

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5fcea53c755dc1076896fa2a>

"We've filled out the questionnaire. We've filled out the questionnaire, talked to the guy for almost an hour on the phone and did another questionnaire and still haven't heard from anyone. At least tell us if coverage was denied also the amount you said we could get was half for double the price. And my husband is a healthy man."

— TrustPilot · SelectQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a7788dce23e62cc3ada21b9>

"Warning, do not use Boomer Benefits . Boomer Benefits signed me up for supplement plans without my authority. This was an obvious way to get their commission. Jan 2024, I signed up through Boomer for my Wife and I to start us each on plan G, part D and Dental. I gave them my bank account for payments. So, January there was a first charge to open my accounts. Soon after, my retirement was delayed, I emailed my Boomer rep, Kate to let her know I was delaying signing up for Medicare so I would also delay starting my supplements. Around August, my retirement was delayed again so I let Boomer know I would let them know when I would need the supplements to start, most likely in early 2026. A couple months later, checking my bank account, I found a total of 5 months of charges totaling approximately \$1,600 gone from my account. I immediately emailed Boomer requesting refunds. It has taken 3 months, many emails back and forth and over 30 hours of phone conversations with Cigna to finally receive refunds on our plan G. But, Cigna will not refund the \$500 for dental plans. When i requested that refund from Boomer, since this was their fault, they denied the request. Boomer also claims they tried to help me get all refunds but Cigna never received any request from Boomer for my refunds. So all they did was steal my money. They took my money before they had my approval to do so, and before I was on Medicare. They are responsible for me losing \$500 and all my lost time. This is a warning. Find another Medicare broker. Do not use Boomer Benefits."

— TrustPilot · Boomer Benefits · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/697bcd76fd8e6be8eaa1ef9>

"I tried to get a policy for 2020.. I tried to get a policy for 2020.. uploaded all the required documents and also sent them to you by certified mail...then after several weeks I call and get told that I was denied coverage because I didn't submit documents by the required date even though I hade a return receipt proving I did... representative told me in a very rude manner that I was basically SOL.... nothing I could do... I called the agent and he said that my experience wasn't abnormal and there was no use in filing a appeal as I was just 4 weeks from the 2021 policy being active... have you people have no understanding of the term "customer service" ? As a 2 time cancer survivor knowing that it can come back at a moments notice it is quite unnerving living without health insurance due to incompetence... I find this irresponsible Obama program to be completely ridiculous and unfair... I have submitted the required information and documents for 2021 so let's see if y'all want to play games with that... I'm told I'm not alone with this battle and I do know where Kentucky is.... get it together people..."

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5fceaaa7755dc105f02d0564>

"CS very hard to understand. CS very hard to understand. Authorization process is set to delay care. Care delayed is care denied"

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aab0c816f8d8b97207c424f>

"Demand to See the Ultra Fine Print. I have a Humana Medicare Advantage plan. The plan I was sold specifically states that an annual dental allowance of \$1000 is included. This year, I needed a crown. Denied. When I asked why, they directed me to a website that had hundreds of pages of fine print. Somewhere on this site, it stated that everything else in Dental was included, EXCEPT CROWNS. I appealed, asking what the difference was and why a measly \$1000 could not be used on any preventative dental care. They took four months to 'process my appeal', then sent an email that said nothing more than Appeal Denied. No explanation and no way to contact anyone who was part of the process. Do not trust this company."

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aa2ccb091801eedb07a8e07>

Stuck: can't switch back to a Medigap

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg

"my best friend who is older than me was sold an advantage plan when she retired and didn't even know it. She thought she had "Medicare" After educating herself she was denied supplemental due to a medical condition. However, her advantage plan got canceled and she became eligible for no underwriting supplemental, she is happily on a medigap plan now."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 65 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugw5dC0g1BZMxjki_R54AaABAg

"Thank you. One of the most professional and knowledgeable presentations that I have heard about the pros and cons of Advantage Plans vs. Supplement Plans. Medical underwriting was explained to me using an airport analogy: I've gotten off the plane and I'm free to walk around the airport, go to the news stand, get a cup of coffee, etc. When I leave that secure area (like leaving my original, one-time-only enrollment period), I walk through doors with signs that say "exit only, no returning through these doors". If I want to go back into the airport, I have to go through security (i.e. underwriting) again. It's a time-consuming hassle for folks who take that route. And there's no guarantee that a person will get through medical underwriting successfully."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 59 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxclzjxWRhhykzbdwp4AaABAg

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>";

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · None

"Hi Dr Ed! My mom is 82 and had dropped her Medicare Supplement in Illinois because her partner wanted Medicare Advantage plans with an OTC benefit! Moving in with me created an SEP so we called Chapter her first day here! Mom just passed medical underwriting and has a Plan F effective June 1st! You rock and I so appreciate the education provided in your videos ! Thank you thank you thank you! Cheers, Michael Albuquerque NM USA"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 39 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugz1hp93qJO8o52NhrR4AaABAg>

"NPR: Older Americans say they feel trapped in Medicare Advantage plans JANUARY 7, 2024 8:10 AM ET HEARD ON WEEKEND EDITION SUNDAY By Sarah Jane Tribble - Kaiser Health News 3-Minute Listen (Story first aired on All Things Considered on January 3, 2023.) UNIDENTIFIED NARRATOR: Right now is the Medicare annual enrollment period. 2024 Medicare Advantage plans are now available, so everyone on Medicare can call to see if a Medicare Advantage plan may be better for you. RASCOE: The plans are private insurance that Americans 65 and older can sign up for instead of traditional Medicare. And lots of Americans are signing up in this open enrollment period through March. Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News reports that some regret signing up and then have trouble getting out. SARAH JANE TRIBBLE: Back in 2016, when Richard Timmins first signed up for Medicare, he went to a free informational seminar with an insurance agent. RICHARD TIMMINS: Basically, he really promoted Medicare Advantage. He just said, well, look, it's less expensive. It's broader in coverage. TRIBBLE: For Timmins, it made economic sense to sign up for Medicare Advantage instead of traditional Medicare, and that worked out great - for a while. Then, he found a small bump on the back of his right ear. TIMMINS: I have a family history of melanoma, so I was kind of tuned into that and thinking about that. TRIBBLE: But it took him a long time to see the right specialist in his Medicare Advantage network, and getting the paperwork in order was confusing. TIMMINS: It was starting to - it started to grow and started to become rather painful. TRIBBLE: By the time Timmins finally saw an oncologist, the lesion had grown to the size of a dime. His right earlobe needed to be removed. He thinks getting care using traditional Medicare would have been faster and easier, and David Meyers at Brown University School of Public Health says he's probably right. DAVID MEYERS: You can see any provider you want. There are many less sort of restrictions on care. You get a lot more freedom with traditional Medicare. TRIBBLE: Timmins wishes he could switch, but there's a catch. TIMMINS: Would I go back to traditional Medicare if it was not cost prohibitive? Absolutely. TRIBBLE: Traditional Medicare premiums average about \$170 a month. And while enrollees on Medicare Advantage plans still pay that premium, the monthly cost can be more affordable. That's because plan enrollees often don't have to pay for extra prescription coverage. They also don't have to buy supplemental insurance, usually called Medigap. That supplemental insurance is needed because, unlike Medicare Advantage plans, traditional Medicare doesn't cap out-of-pocket cost. The thing is, Timmins might not be able to get a Medigap policy anymore. Here's David Lipschutz, associate director of the Center for Medicare Advocacy. DAVID LIPSCHUTZ: Medigap is one of the few types of insurance that can exclude you based upon preexisting conditions unless you enroll during certain designated times. TRIBBLE: That designated time is primarily when you first sign up for Medicare. But since Timmins enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan instead of traditional Medicare and he has a preexisting condition, he could be denied Medigap or charged a lot more for it. While federal law generally prohibits insurers from denying people coverage because of preexisting conditions, Medigap is an exception. Lipschutz again. LIPSCHUTZ: It's a lot easier to get and stay in a Medicare Advantage plan, but a lot harder to get out and pick up a Medigap plan, depending upon where you are. TRIBBLE: Only four states require Medigap insurers to cover applicants regardless of age or health. But Timmins lives in Washington state, which isn't one of them. He wants people to know. TIMMINS: You can get screwed if you're on Medicare Advantage. The advantage kind of disappears once you need them. TRIBBLE: In the meantime, Timmins worries. There's a chance that his cancer could come back, and he'll be trapped on Medicare Advantage if it does. So he's focusing on what he can control. TIMMINS: You know, I'm a vegetarian. I don't drink. I don't smoke. I try to get exercise as much as possible. TRIBBLE: But he knows it might not be enough. RASCOE: That was Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News. Copyright © 2024 NPR. All rights reserved. Visit our website terms of use and permissions pages at www.npr.org for further information."

— r/medicare · 35 upvotes · None

"I LOVE books so much! I picked an advantage plan because I'm not rich and I couldn't afford a supplement plan. I'm happy with my choice. The plan I chose, Network Health, gets good reviews. I'm in Wisconsin. My cousin tried to convince me to get a supplement plan but when I looked at the price, I opted to keep my money. I hate going to doctors so I haven't had any problems."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwccFI0ErZH2JjwKEt4AaABAg>

"I can't afford a supplement plan."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxNGiKqY0j5kl2nE0B4AaABAg

"My wife and I chose a Medigap Plan N plan four years ago. Literally 2 months after beginning my Medicare journey I had a really bad accident that required the trauma unit, two surgeries and a blood clot issue. My total bill for all that and two weeks in hospital was \$86 after meeting the Part B deductible. I could have argued \$50 off that amount because they charged me that amount for the ambulance even though I was admitted. It wasn't worth going through the hassle. My wife is a cancer survivor so our broker strongly advised her to stay away from an Advantage plan. If you do go that route and then have medical issues and expenses get out of hand then you will have to go through medical underwriting and probably will not be able to switch to Medigap. Keep that in mind."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRIqEu63hvwv4AaABAg.ATSYgYfhd1hATYml_KtCEw

"Just went through this process about a year ago. I decided on a supplement plan (plan G) for as long as I could afford it. It is fairly 'easy' to switch to an advantage plan at a later time. Moving from an advantage plan to a supplement plan MAY require medical underwriting and may not be possible. I prefer the freedom of choice the supplement plans offer."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzGOqWQSwRxqmXlzZd4AaABAg>

"So I stayed with my company plan at \$800 a month which was cheaper than ACA which was 1600 and I'm single! But I'm afraid to leave my company plan because they said if I do I can't come back and use their Medicare supplement when I turn 65. So I feel forced to stay. 😞"

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyz5Ac7pA&lc=UgxhvxK09UxP7VuTUNR4AaABAg>

"You should have mentioned that there's no medical underwriting for supplements only in the first 6 months of eligibility. Without that info, the uneducated might think they're free to switch to a supplement when their health deteriorates—which generally happens with age. (yes, there are exceptions) . And, from experience with my older family members, I think you are downplaying the prior approval disadvantage of advantage plans, which is serious—ask the AMA! I truly believe most should get Plan N medigap if they can possibly afford it Wolverine."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think | Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwoZ8dAIHWMGlpY32l4AaABAg>

"Both customer and medical experience with United Healthcare. I am a customer of United Healthcare as well as a Medical Biller and they are the worst scam company out there. I work for a Doctors office and have been a Medical Biller for over 20 years. I have been trying to get the Doctor to drop them, but he is a good, caring Dr and doesnt want it all about the money, because he is not getting paid from United Healthcare as he should. He states that would cause many patients to not get the Medical care they need as he is a Specialist, he doesnt want to do that to them. I wish everyone would get together and get a class action lawsuit against them. Since money is all they care about, hit them where it hurts. I have AARP supplement and its the only good thing about United except every year it goes up, I am now paying \$250.00 a month for an insurance that only pays 20% after Medicare. I cant switch because the other supplements wont take me due to my heart issues. But all of the other United Healthcare plans that are primary plans as well as the Medicare Advantage Plans are HORRIBLE. I have been dealing with them for all of my 20 years experience, since 2022 at the office I currently work for. Just spent the entire day so far trying to get payment for services rendered to patients."

— TrustPilot · UnitedHealthcare · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a7ca94fdb6fa88ddd249877>

Premium increases

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=Ugxmqqe1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAg

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · None

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · None

"I went on to the retirement court with Plan G. No major complaints with the exception of the recent premium increase and the truly impossible task of finding my cost share prior to treatment. My bigger complaint with this whole racket is the development (or lack there of) a system structured for intentional confusion. One should not need PhDs in multiple disciplines to understand their health insurance. No luv in this game."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyV6bKd_Qtj9cUgC4x4AaABAg

"I am a 78 yr old male. The Illinois Department of Insurance approved a 40% rate increase for Mutual of Omaha in 2025. My supplement plan G is costing me \$357.63 per month and will continue to go up every year. This is why people switch to medicare advantage plans even if they are not as good."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 44 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzuyd4qcwbDPIJZq6V4AaABAg

"I was diagnosed with cancer in 2022 at age 64, 1 year before qualifying for Medicare at age 65. Made the decision to purchase a Part G supplemental plan in 2023 (at which time cancer in remission) easy. Max. coverage and can see any doctor that accepts Medicare. Premiums are affordable, though they'll increase yearly both with inflation and age adjustments. But I already have a chart of the age adjustments, so that helps in planning. I did also have to buy a Part D drug plan, but wasn't a big deal. I'm paying less than \$20/mo. I pay more for pet food."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 37 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwcXvMjV0iLH5MErUd4AaABAg_A1KdKhnuifA3OzAu_SgQ

"@Theretirementnerds You mention "no penalties" for not taking Medicare. What about premium adjustments based on a physical health exam? I heard if you don't take Medicare at 65, when you take it later your premiums can be tied to / increased based on health status."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzvnWfn7UY4KMDm2dh4AaABAg_A2YTnw2aj9_YA3EJGBvyDLb

"I'm 73, had plan g since the beginning, been healthy, disappointed that my premium went up to 268 a month, thinking of switching to advantage plan. And I'm disappointed that my agent didn't help me understand about Medicare part D, which I did not sign up for, and now I have to pay penalties from now on. I am in Texas, and I hope I have a memory like an ELEPHANT for all that you have explained."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=Ugx1SAL00qKcb-uYy2t4AaABAg>

"We are in GA and are opting for Plan G High Ded. It saves us about \$250+ a month and rate increases are rare to low with most carriers. Every 10 months that is enough savings to pay our MOOP if needed. With the risings premiums of G and N, we think this is the only way to "future proof".

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgziynoPWyfSkB_5Mcl4AaABAg

"Your discussion while very informative, ignores the very real IRMAA adjustment to the Medicare Part B premium. I found out the hard way. While the 2026 Part B premium increases to \$202 per month, my Part B premium will increase by and additional \$324.60 per month for a total Part B premium of \$527.50 due to IRMAA (this is in addition to the premium I pay for my Medigap plan). This increase in my Part B premium is due to the fact that I withdrew monies from my 401(k) plan to maintain a fairly standard middle class lifestyle as I live in San Diego, which is a very high cost of living area. Moreover, the IRMAA adjustment must be paid regardless of whether one enrolls in a Medigap or an Advantage Plan. Many seniors are not aware of this time bomb when withdrawing from their 401(k)s. Perhaps a video focusing on IRMAA would benefit and alert seniors about this seemingly "hidden" Part B premium increase that is lying in wait."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxB-sft1CicsFwsf3B4AaABAg>

"The increase in premiums of my Plan G policy has increased by crazy amounts these past 2 years. I turned 73 this month and my Plan G premium rose to \$330 per month (from \$279)! Last year's increase was almost as bad. This is getting ridiculous. At this point my total cost for Medicare per year (Parts A, B, D and Plan G supplement) is over \$6,000!"

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyD0hm7qFko3Fd7ArB4AaABAg

"Absolute spam. Absolute spam. I wanted to compare prices online after my rates went up. What I got was was non stop phone calls and texts from Everquote. At no point did I want to talk to any of these people much less get harassed by spoofed numbers. There is nothing I have good to say about these spammers. I am just bracing myself for all the calls I will get from whoever they sold my information to."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6530065e56de2f6b6dd6e449>

"Caution. I've had a few quotes through SelectQuote over the years. What I've come to realize is that the first quote they give you is highly optimistic. They often promise no-health-exam options. But despite being pretty high up on the health ladder, that has never proven true. Inevitably, they will find something that raises the rates. In my case, the rate doubled over a pretty minor change. SelectQuote is easier than calling each of The insurers individually, but take their quotes and promises with a grain of salt. Be prepared for your rate to increase during the process..."

— TrustPilot · SelectQuote · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/673f88d32eed2b72c99cee0f>

Doctors and hospitals that drop the plan

"As a physician, I'd highly recommend going Traditional Medicare route if you can afford it... You are >65, this is time people start to get sick. Many hospitals are dropping Medicare Advantage plans, and we CONSTANTLY see prior authorization on Advantage plans on drugs that actually matter. Not mentioning the prior auths for surgeries. It is concerning that she undersells how much denials MA plans do compared to Traditional Medicare. Life is precious, this is not an arena to go cheap as an elderly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 258 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyvkvZTQrEFv_Sdwrl4AaABAq

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAq

"Another negative for Advantage plans is that hospitals in my area are refusing to accept certain Advantage plans. So if you have a doctor you like and he works out of a certain hospital you could find yourself looking for another doctor and hospital. I was on an Advantage plan but was able to get on Plan G because the hospital I use stopped accepting the Advantage plan I was on. I didn't have to get approved or pass any medical tests to go on Plan G since it wasn't my fault that my Advantage plan was no longer valid. Best thing that could have happened to me."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 32 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugx4MOWZuO_w_2-SLoV4AaABAq

"The only hospital within 100 miles of me has stopped accepting Humana advantage plans as in-network due to claim denials and long waits for pre-approvals. Switching to plan N while I can pass underwriting."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxNqF0wOHim1a8HT3J4AaABAq>

"My brother chose Medicare Advantage when it was relatively new. Years later, he needed a very specialized surgery that no hospital in his network could do. After months of fighting with insurance, they finally agreed to cover it at KU Med Center. On the 4 hr drive on the morning of his surgery, he received a call from the hospital saying that they had just dropped his Medicare Advantage company and couldn't do his surgery. He never found another way to get that surgery and he died. If this scenario happens often, Medicare Advantage saves a lot of money by not having to pay for life saving surgeries."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyQFMPprBbPsPUb1Q14AaABAq>

"I was warned by everyone not to take Medicare Advantage-so glad I listened. It's next to impossible to switch back-I would encourage anyone just about to enter-don't do it. The premiums are very attractive to rope you in but like they say-lots of exceptions, some doctors won't accept the plan etc"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugxxi6snmCvpHtHoLXp4AaABAg>

"I wanted expert advice before I went on Medicare. So I hired a consultant. She call Medicare Advantage Medicare Disadvantage and told me to stay away from it. Why? Because it isn't real Medicare. It's private insurance that can end up making you go bankrupt. So I went with traditional Medicare with Part G supplement. I've never spent a dime out of pocket. Im glad I rejected Advantage. Rye largest hospital in my area announce last year that they were dropping out of Advantage. So have more than half of the areas physicians. This has left a lot of people without good healthcare choices. And I don't live in podunk. I live in a major metropolitan area with a population of over 6 million."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugy-HagNdaMnA1ecAZ14AaABAg>

"I am a retired RN on original Medicare and a supplement. I chose this over an Advantage plan based on my experience working in a cardiology clinic where we had to get pre-approval for various diagnostics and procedures from Advantage plans. It was sometimes a drawn out procedure, resulting in delays or denials from these insurance companies who are not in a good position to make these determinations. One time, an agent from one Advantage plan sent a message to one of our cardiologists asking why he thought he should do a particular test. The exasperated cardiologist said to tell her "because I am a cardiologist and you are not." I will say that it is also true that some doctors have stopped accepting original Medicare because their reimbursement is lower, not sure if that is regional or by specialty or what, and I don't know how widespread that is. But those doctors may then have the added expense of a larger staff to deal with pre-approvals. All I know is there is no one between you and your doctor, slowing or stopping your care with original Medicare, and you have a network wherever you go."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxaIRJNCNDvJUR8NwR4AaABAg>

"Sunburn. Great job on this video. I love your chart, as well. I am 71, and have had \$0.00 Premium Advantage Plans so far. I had to change to a different company a couple years ago because my Primary Doctor dropped my plan, because he was tired of arguing with them on proper care for his patients. Both of my Advantage Plan companies have worked out well for me so far. However, I am now leaning towards switching to a Supplement Plan after I saw how wonderful they worked for both of my parents, who each had a lot of issues through their lives, and they never had to pay for anything, other than their monthly premiums. As I get older, I think it might give me a bit more peace of mind to have a Supplement that has more complete coverage and I will have more control over which doctors I see. Your video was very helpful as I do my research to make my decision for 2026. Thanks again!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzJ0S3dtITngj28Ghl4AaABAg>

"Can't disagree with the wonderful presentation in a difficult climate to find relevance in the system. According to insight of original Medicare, the coverage to doctors has dropped 25% since 2002. Can a doctor be found in view of this deficit? Very appreciative for bringing the worsening of hmo system to light. I'd only add that the break on prices for free OTC medicines and gives an opportunity for seniors (while ignoring the practicing medical treatment as implied) to walk out of a store with free stuff is a recipe for, and has led to inflated prices people under 65 are being charged. So we expect these youths to suffer weeks on end because Sudafed or the like has gone up 400%. A pet peeve, doubt, and/or concern."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyPolrJbduu2sx09W94AaABAq.AOu_egArbCnAOxdw6d36G2

"A Medicare Advantage plan + Cancer policy might be the *least expensive* total cost, but I am seeing in other videos that many hospitals are no longer accepting Advantage plans coverage due to their burdensome pre-authorization processes and higher incidences of fraud. So that might not be the *best* option. An Original Medicare plan is accepted everywhere, and bundled with a good Supplement plan, appears to be a close second in terms of cheapest overall cost."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCl8m0OI18&lc=UgyCX_t3mhh0eD7T-7V4AaABAq

"Do not, I repeat NOT use United Health Care on the Advantage plan. UHC is a sunburn of a nightmare - a mess and my hospital dropped them. I signed up with the Advantage plan at the hospital. All went smooth until they sent a letter that said Advantage is going away in Oregon? :("

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugys1pC3NFzodwwwYlh4AaABAq.AKdMkH291hCANZVXQWelul>

"Simply Awful. Since enrolling this past year, I have had 2 primary care doctors dropped from the plan. The first time I was forced to switch was early June and the second time was today. Twice in a little over 2 months!! The sole reason for switching to United Health was that my previous plan was discontinued and I wanted to keep my doctor. The customer support is abysmal. The entire experience is bad."

— TrustPilot · UnitedHealthcare · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a7e5deb516c46b17065eb68>

"DO NOT USE OSCAR. DO NOT USE OSCAR. I had a number of issues with OSCAR: mainly the list of providers on the website is FALSE (do not exist at that location or do not accept OSCAR; which is FRAUD). I was told by cust service messaging that I am the one who needs to verify the accuracy of what is posted...!!!. The last time I tried to enroll, my regular doctor had stopped accepting OSCAR because: 'they are so difficult to deal with and get paid'. Looking for nother provider in my area (I live in a dense urban center, 3 subway stops from the World Trade Center, with 3 large medical centers at walking or one stop distance and many doctor's office). OSCAR could not find a MD as primary care provider for me in my area accepting them: only a PA or a Nurse....!!!! I switched as soon as enrollement period allowed and kept my current MD."

— TrustPilot · Oscar Health · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a8d2ac24614691023f80a0c>

Calls, mail and ads that won't stop

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

"@nancybryant4325 Thank you again for your response. I had been told by someone I trusted that I should be on Medicare. I do not have lots of expenses now but I can see that investing before I need it, which most of us definitely will, will give me more security if something major were to happen. I also find most of the so-called benefits of the advantage plan actually not that valuable when I try to use them. And no I don't use referrals because often when I have asked for a specific referral I have either been denied or the payment to the caregiver is denied even though a legitimate referral and I paid a copay. Here I am talking about physical therapy which now I pay out-of-pocket and don't even bother trying to get the referral. I negotiate for a cash price. Many won't take my plan anymore anyhow because of the endless denials, etc. Someone is paying for all those slick commercials bombarding us."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzMVDXyviom5xLUtIF4AaABAg.9TDdw-WtTCC9Tta6FO3qEN>

"I am soon to be 65. I have not signed up. I may not. Too confusing. Somehow my husband phone number was spread far and wide and he gets 30+ phone calls almost every day. They know his name and address. This is the only way all of that was in one package was through his health care one way or another. If I do sign up there will be no phone number!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzRNZ0EF4QHZfWoinJ4AaABAg>

"Love love love this information! Even without knowing it previously, I always felt there was something fishy going on. They call me constantly wanting to "help" me set up a doctor's appointment for a wellness screening. I am a very blessed, active, healthy 68 yo female. Im not on any medication and get really mad that they won't leave me alone! Well, anyway, here's my question: When I was planning for a total knee replacement in 2019, I was on plain old Medicare A and B. I was advised by a friend to get on an Advantage plan to greatly reduce my out of pocket cost for the surgery. I made many calls to Medicare to confirm this information. The amount they told me I would be responsible for was thousands. Two different reps, two different calls at different times. I then spoke with the Advantage plan people and was assured that I would only be responsible for \$275 after meeting my deductible (\$250 I think?). So, I took the Advantage plan, which I still have, and yes indeed, that was all I had to pay. Lock, stock, and barrel. I believe what you're saying but, in my case, why was the Advantage plan a decided "advantage"?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwFXhp6HLxl9GRaZAB4AaABAg>

"★★★★★ . ★★★★★ I want to thank Kevin Barron at Boomer Benefits for his amazing help with my Medicare supplemental plan. It took almost two weeks of calls because I had so many questions, and Kevin never got tired or rushed me even once. He patiently explained everything about doctors, hospitals, and deductibles so I could really understand my options. Most people going on Medicare, like me, have no idea what to look for or which plan is right for them. Kevin took the time to walk me through it all and gave me space to think before deciding, instead of pushing me to rush. He truly cared about finding the best plan for my needs, not just making a sale. Thanks to Kevin, I finally feel confident and at ease about my Medicare choice. Boomer Benefits is lucky to have someone so knowledgeable and patient on their team. I highly recommend Kevin and Boomer Benefits to anyone who needs help navigating Medicare!"

— TrustPilot · Boomer Benefits · 5★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aa9c022c41de81af19f1736>

"paying for "exclusive" leads that are.... paying for "exclusive" leads that are already marked as dnc in our system, since they have been sold to my agency a few months prior. Calling "exclusive" leads that complain about bombardment, so how exclusive are they? This isn't one or two leads, this is a problem with most if not all of the leads purchased lately. A few years back, exclusive meant exclusive, but not anymore. Prices are up, productivity is down."

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d670590f0186907ac964abe>

"Non stop robo calls and AI texts. Non stop robo calls and AI texts. They keep changing numbers so even after blocking a number they keep slamming me with more robo calls and AI texts."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a6237062f8d7d604d15e6f7>

"They are spammers. These guys keep calling from various spoofed local exchange phone numbers about a free insurance quote that I never requested. If they were a legitimate business, why would they be robo calling 5-10 times a day from different, spoofed numbers?"

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69d6d1a79813e5fa834bc852>

"Harassing me endlessly. Annoying. . Calling nonstop for two days. Leave me alone."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6997403d94d8d4db41bbe3f5>

"ZERO STARS!!! HASTLE and MORE DIFFICULT Experience . I tried to inquire about auto insurance quotes while at work and of course they call me NONSTOP and ask all the same information I entered online. They harass you. I should've known better but what an abomination of a business. They make searching for auto insurance MORE difficult."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/66a00f045759534894a7576c>

"Everquote keeps calling me non-stop.... Everquote keeps calling me non-stop even after being taken off of their call list several times. I've blocked countless numbers, including the one that comes up as "Everquote", but it keeps coming through. I've never talked to them about insurance, and I have no idea who sold them my info."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6696bb0977f004b29ce87f2d>

"Don't waste your time. An AI lead generator.. I was specifically asked whether I wanted to search for car insurance online or thru an agent. I strictly said "online." Soon thereafter - I was robo-called 4 times and texted. I had to block 4 numbers. This isn't an insurance company, nothing more than a lead generation machine using AI. Pathetic."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/654d5803ff760aa9e53bc6dc>

"They knowingly use off-shore scammers.... They knowingly use off-shore scammers for marketing lead generation. How can you trust a company who does this? I receive calls from scammers constantly who are in violation of DNC laws and caller ID spoofing laws who are attempting to "connect" me with someone who can get me a quote. Guess who it is - QuoteWizard. So they pay for inbound leads?"

— TrustPilot · QuoteWizard · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69b45f733099d5a23856d2c1>

Agents who pushed Advantage or misled

"Thank you Erin for so well explained these healthcare confusions! I wish this video would have came out a year ago. I'm 66 and I was confused by all these last year when I needed to enroll. My broker only pushed me to enroll in Medicare Advantage and it seems to be a better choice due to the lower cost. As you said, I'm lucky that I'm still healthy now but choosing Medigap may be a better choice down the road."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwZrnBS3BHQIMpP7-x4AaABAg>

"Thank you for this. I found it informative & helpful. I've been on regular Medicare plus a Supplemental (not Advantage) for the past few years. My agent has never tried to push me onto Advantage (even though he would get paid a commission for that), nor has he pushed Medicare-only (even though my expense have been thankfully minimal). I may choose the "HD" plan for next year after seeing your video... but will consider all options carefully. Thanks for shedding some SUNBURN... I mean, sunlight--- on these issues!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugwz6sk-OCmNb4s28VR4AaABAg>

"@AbtInsuranceAgency The payout to agents is almost triple from what I researched. I was not correct that agents aren't paid every year for Medigap plans, they are but it's generally 10% of the premium. The Medicare Advantage plans pay \$600-750 the first year with a much higher yearly payout. It's in the salesperson's best interest to sell an MA policy. I think that's something you should be exposing; there's a financial incentive for agents to push an MA policy. Source: The Commonwealth Fund"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgyMntrSGH2A9tiPQUh4AaABAg_A_I2YT78_TjA_J8E3hEv8a

"Thanks for this! I am turning 65 in a few months. I talked to two brokers today, and both tried to push me towards a Medicare Advantage plan. I did my due diligence prior to the call and immediately came to the conclusion I did not want a Medicare Advantage plan due to out of pocket costs and more importantly the horror stories I have heard of denials and referral red tape."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyYUuvwB4My7vox9p14AaABAg>

"@ don fannin - read the comments above. There is a comment from an agent that states they make 3 times the commission to have you go with an Advantage plan. My agent "pushed me & assumed I wanted an Advantage plan" I chose a supplement - plan G. Now I know why I was pushed as I am new to Medicare. Her attitude changed when I decided on the supplement."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugzn2_uF65H8JzoiVpt4AaABAg.9Sux7M1FTTh9WR12J3iarR

"My DOG and I thank you for such an indepth yet simple explanation of the medicare jungle! I have an Advantage give back plan which I love--no major medical problems yet. My broker has been pushing me towards a plan G but I really don't want the monthly premiums. I'm still undecided... Do you all provide brokerage services?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=Ugyl2ieaUFe2xWpzB1h4AaABAg>

"I blame ALL insurance brokers who pushed consumers into the Medicare Advantage Plans because of the spiffs they received by doing that."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgzL6CiYJfrMCId7yCB4AaABAg>

"If I could do 0 stars I would. If I could do 0 stars I would - Their support agents try to be helpful - but the reality is, their ads are misleading - more calls about a free 40000 or 25000, and prospects think the government or social security is going to give them that money for free. If more than one person thinks its free, dont you think you should change your ads?"

— TrustPilot · Allcalls.io · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69fdf2f85a3e11011e7843b1>

"This company is a scam! They just want a sale!. This company is all about sales. I made the 3-way call with my brother and overheard a supervisor come in on his line. His supervisor was berating him for being on the phone 37 minutes with us, not using a "opening statement" & not getting him (my brother) into a plan. When the agent came back on the phone, he pushed for us to "go ahead and get coverage" not knowing we already knew this was a scam! EHealth has their supervisors listening in on all of our calls. That means everything you gave your SSN and Medicare number, it is being recorded and used God knows how. EHealth just want your money. They don't care about helping us old people. They sit around teaching people how to sell & berate them if we don't get scammed because they paid for us to call. EHealth does not give flex card, those are for people with food stamps already! These ads are scams and we will be taking that recorded call straight to 1800 Medicare and suing. EHealth probably makes billions off the suffering of senior citizens. DO NOT GET INTO A PLAN WITH EHEALTH!"

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6852b9dce2cb0fb78ee41b2b>

"Very unimpressed with service. Very unimpressed with service. Called for help with part D plan. Agent just wanted to push an advantage plan in which I had no interest. Really pressed " advantages " but would not consider any possible disadvantages. Especially as these plans are very good for " low income people like you " I still need to research part d plans. Was a waste of time phone call."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6712ee03331a61a8c0d70d37>

"The agent lied to me.. The agent lied to me."

— TrustPilot · GoHealth · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/61b24e730b7cbbcbfe071065>

"Run away from HealthMarkets. Do not fill out any applications. I filled out one while searching for a new health insurance plan and highly regret it. The day after I submitted my application, I received 76 calls from different agents, starting as early as 6:10 am and continuing until 5 pm PT (California). Honestly, I became overwhelmed with such 'service.' The next day, I received 28 calls. Four days later, I am still receiving calls. In conclusion, I haven't chosen a new plan. Agents are pressuring you to buy a new plan right away, but I need a plan to cover 2024. I don't want to pay extra for two months. Their goal is just to sell a plan, whether it fits my needs or not. I feel like I'm surrounded by aggressive sellers, similar to the experience with pushy sellers in Eastern Europe. I contacted HealthMarkets and requested to remove my application, but unfortunately, they had already sold my data to third parties, and it's impossible to stop it. So, think twice before sharing your data with HealthMarkets. If you need a health insurance plan, just find a few local agents and work with them. Do not work with Health Markets!!!"

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/654d53b75923eedf083fa7e0>

"Please do yourself a HUGE favor and run.... Please do yourself a HUGE favor and run from this company. An agent Hunter Vail lied to me numerous times assuring me that I qualified for an extra \$200 a month & my Medicaid insurance would not be changed whatsoever. At least 12-15 times. No exaggeration. Three days later I receive my new insurance packet & new card. I called them back & I told them that I did not approve this insurance change & Hunter would not return my call. That never happened. I called them back and was told that Hunter had left the company! They then proceeded to cancel the new insurance or so they said. My insurance was changed supposedly & 2 weeks later I'm still trying to clear this up & without being able to get my medication. For someone who has Medicaid this was a huge deal with no support that was helpful or truthful. They transferred me 4 times my last call and every agent said the exact same thing to me. They are NOT BBB approved. UNTRUTHFUL & VERY DISHONEST."

— TrustPilot · HealthInsurance.com · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/67ee0b0cbc3bfde7e2234f5e>